CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY

TEACHING MANUAL

Digital Marketing

Session Roadmap · Lesson Notes · Concept Diagrams · Answer Keys

READY TO TEACH

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OVERVIEW

Course Roadmap

What we cover in every session

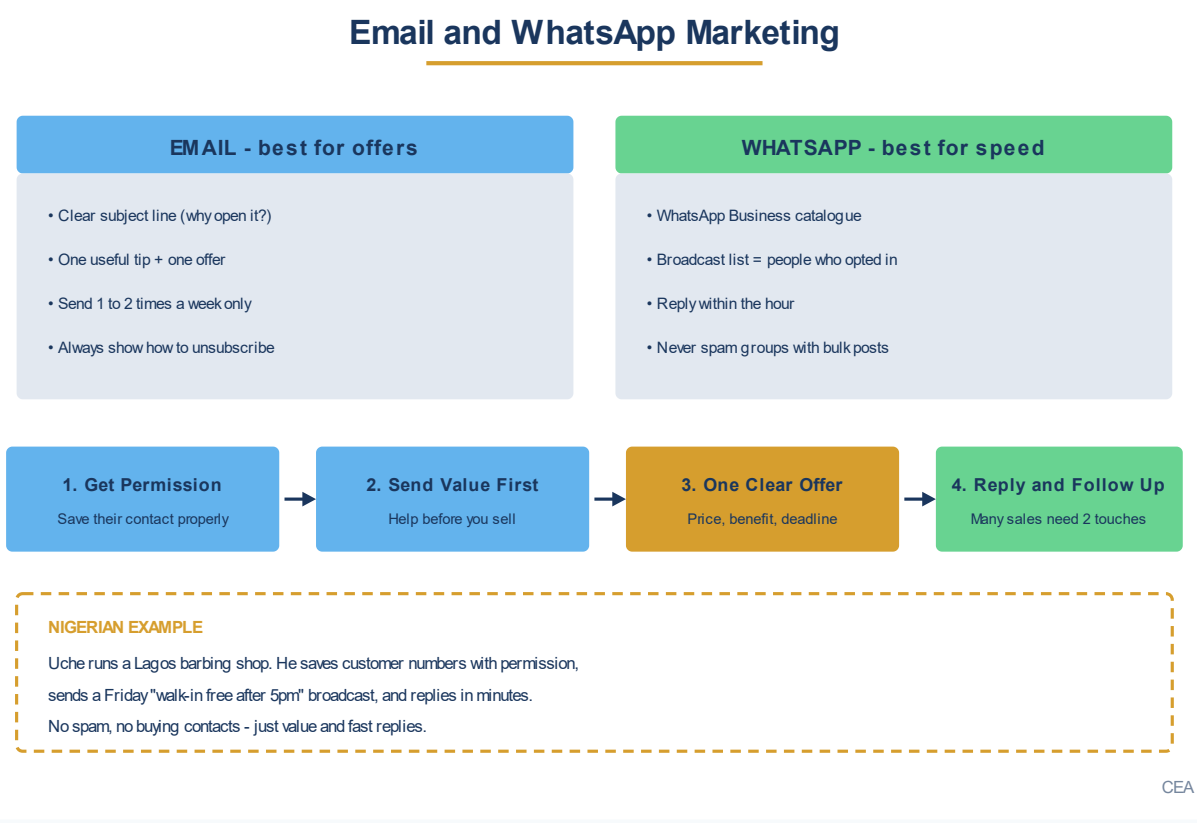
#	SESSION TOPIC	WEEK / MODULE	DURATION
01	Digital Marketing Foundations	Week 1 â€" Module 1: Foundations	105 minutes
02	Customer and Positioning	Week 1 â€" Module 1: Foundations	105 minutes
03	Branding and Online Presence	Week 1 â€" Module 1: Foundations	105 minutes
04	Content and Social Marketing	Week 2 â€" Module 2: Channels	105 minutes
05	SEO and Google Basics	Week 2 â€" Module 2: Channels	105 minutes
06	Email and WhatsApp Marketing	Week 2 â€" Module 2: Channels	105 minutes
07	Paid Ads Basics	Week 3 â€" Module 3: Convert and Measure	105 minutes
08	Analytics Tracking and Optimisation	Week 3 â€" Module 3: Convert and Measure	105 minutes
09	Capstone Integrated Digital Marketing Campaign Plan	Week 3 â€" Module 3: Convert and Measure	105 minutes

How to use this book: Each session below is a complete, ready-to-teach lesson note. Section A tells you what to prepare, B lists the outcomes, D–F are the teaching content, G–H are your demos and practicals, and the knowledge check with answer key is at the end. The concept diagram for each session is embedded as a visual aid.

SESSION 01 OF 9

Digital Marketing Foundations

CONCEPT DIAGRAM — SESSION 01



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" DIGITAL MARKETING

SESSION 1 â€" DIGITAL MARKETING FOUNDATIONS

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	1 of 9
Session title	Digital Marketing Foundations
Week / Module	Week 1 â€" Module 1: Foundations
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Course fee	â‚¦35,000 (paid once at enrolment â€" all sessions, materials and the certificate included)
Difficulty level	Beginner (first contact with digital marketing)

Item	Detail
Prerequisite knowledge	Basic smartphone use â€” scrolling, typing, opening apps, taking a photo, using WhatsApp or social media. No prior marketing, design, website or analytics knowledge required. Learners without a smartphone may pair with a classmate and use academy computers, but must tell the instructor at the start of the session.
Connection to previous work	This is the first session of the course. There is no previous digital marketing session. It connects to everyday life: every learner has a phone, uses social media, searches Google, and has seen online shops and adverts. Many learners already post about a business or side hustle without any plan â€” today we give that activity a structure.
Preparation before class	Print the eight channel cards (Section F.2) and the funnel-stage sorting cards (Section F.3) â€” one set per group of 3â€“4 learners. Prepare a projector slide showing the running example business, *Mama Nkechi's Kitchen* (fictional Port Harcourt food business). Print the Funnel and Journey Mapping Worksheet (Section H) per learner. Have a whiteboard or flip chart ready with four columns drawn: Awareness, Consideration, Conversion, Retention. Prepare a short 2-minute verbal introduction of Mama Nkechi's Kitchen (name, location, what she sells, current situation). Confirm the class understands the academy's Ethics and Professional Conduct rules (Section 15 of the Design Document) â€” read them aloud at the start.

Instructor note on tone: This session must feel *empowering*, not overwhelming. Many learners have been told digital marketing is "complicated" or "expensive." Your job in the first 105 minutes is to prove the opposite: that they already live inside digital marketing, that the ideas are simple, and that a clear plan is worth more than any expensive tool. Keep the mood practical, friendly and confident.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Define** digital marketing in their own words and explain why it matters for a small Nigerian business, using at least one everyday example from their own phone use.
2. **Name and describe** the eight main digital marketing channels (website, search, social media, content, email, WhatsApp, paid ads, Google Business Profile) and match each channel to the job it does for a business.
3. **Explain** the four marketing funnel stages â€” Awareness, Consideration, Conversion and Retention â€” in their own words, and correctly classify at least 4 of 5 given marketing tactics to the correct funnel stage.
4. **Map a simple customer journey** for a named customer of a real or fictional business, describing what the customer sees, thinks and does at each stage from first hearing about the business to becoming a repeat customer.
5. **Explain why channels work together** rather than alone, using the running example of Mama Nkechi's Kitchen to show how one customer might move across three or four channels before buying.
6. **Apply the academy's ethics rules** by stating, in their own words, what honest, permission-based marketing means and why buying followers or posting fake reviews is wrong.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner (with a notes app) or an academy computer with a browser and Google Docs.
- Instructor computer connected to a projector or large screen.
- Whiteboard or flip chart with markers.

Software

- A simple text app: phone Notes, Google Docs, Microsoft Word, or paper and pen. No special software is needed for this session â€” it is a thinking-and-mapping session.
- Optional: access to Instagram, Facebook or Google Search on the projector to show real channel examples (if academy Wi-Fi is available).

Sample files

- **Eight Channel Cards** (Section F.2), each card showing the channel name and one-line description â€" one printed set per group.
- **Funnel-Stage Sorting Cards** (Section F.3), 20 small cards with a tactic written on each (e.g., "Instagram reel showing food", "Google search for jollof near me", "WhatsApp broadcast with menu") â€" one set per group.
- **Funnel and Journey Mapping Worksheet** (Section H) â€" one per learner.
- **Ethics and Professional Conduct summary sheet** (Section 15 of the Design Document) â€" printed for reference and signature.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 1.1 â€" "Channel Match-Up" (a blank table: channel name â†' what job it does).
- Worksheet 1.2 â€" "Funnel Stage Sorter" (a table with four columns â€" Awareness, Consideration, Conversion, Retention â€" and empty rows to paste or write tactics).

Accounts

- None required this session. (Gmail accounts are needed from Session 3 â€" remind learners now.)

Internet

- Not required, but useful for showing real examples of channels (a Google Business Profile, an Instagram page, a Google Search results page). The session works fully offline with printed examples.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- Any phone with a notes app works. A learner who cannot type quickly may write by hand or dictate to a classmate; the skill is the *thinking*, not the typing. Academy computers are available for learners who do not have a smartphone.

Safety and ethics note for the instructor (read aloud at the start):

> *"Before we begin, one important rule. Everything we do in this course is honest. We will never buy followers, post fake reviews, scrape phone numbers or spam WhatsApp groups. We will never pretend an ad is something it is not. If a tactic feels deceptive, it is â€" and we will not use it. These rules are in your Ethics and Professional Conduct sheet. Please read them and sign before we continue."*

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show a slide with a simple question and a photo of a busy Port Harcourt street market or a phone showing Instagram. Do not explain anything yet.

The question on the screen:

> *"Hands up â€" who has used their phone today to look for something to buy, eat, watch or visit?"*

Pause. Nearly every hand goes up. Nod and acknowledge.

Then ask:

> *"Keep your hand up if you found what you were looking for on your phone â€" maybe on Google, Instagram, WhatsApp, or a friend's page."*

Most hands stay up. A few drop. Say:

> *"The hands that dropped â€" you are the customers digital marketers dream about. Someone did not reach you today. Today, we learn how to make sure businesses like yours are the ones that get found."*

Then introduce the running example. On the projector, show a simple slide:

> ***Mama Nkechi's Kitchen*** *A fictional small food business in Port Harcourt, Rivers State. Sells home-cooked meals, soups and small chops for delivery and pickup. Has been running for two years. Has walk-in and WhatsApp customers. Has an Instagram page with a few hundred followers â€" posts once in a while, no plan. Wants more orders but does not know where to start.*

Say:

> *"For the next three weeks, this is our client. Every session, we will add one piece to her marketing plan. By Session 9, you will hand her a complete campaign she can actually use. You can also use your own real or fictional business â€" but Mama Nkechi's Kitchen is the example I will use."*

Expected learner response: Learners will nod, smile, or say things like "my auntie has a kitchen like that" or "that is my side hustle." Accept all answers warmly. The goal is recognition: *this is someone like me, and this problem is real.*

Why this opener works: It starts from the learner's own experience (everyone uses their phone to find things), creates instant personal connection, and frames digital marketing not as a technical subject but as a *bridge between a business and the people already looking for it* â€" which is exactly what it is.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector. Keep it moving â€" no question should take more than 90 seconds.

Question 1: "What apps do you use on your phone every day? Name three."

- Expected answer: WhatsApp, Instagram, Facebook, TikTok, Google, YouTube, Chrome, Gmail, maps, banking apps â€" any three.
- Common gap: some learners name only one or two. Prompt gently: "What do you open first in the morning?"

Question 2: "Have you ever searched for something on Google â€" a food, a place, a price? What did you type?"

- Expected answer: anything realistic â€" "jollof rice near me", "barber shop Port Harcourt", "price of Ankara fabric".
- Common gap: some learners have only ever browsed social media feeds and never typed a search. Acknowledge this: "That is fine â€" some of you are browsers, some are searchers. Both are customers, and both matter today."

Question 3: "When you see a post or advert on Instagram or Facebook, what makes you stop and look â€" and what makes you scroll past?"

- Expected answer: "a nice picture", "something cheap", "a video", "a friend shared it", "it looked fake", "too long", "too many words".
- Common gap: learners give vague answers. Draw out the two sides: *what stops* (visual, relevance, curiosity) and *what sends them away* (boring, fake, too long, not for them). Write both lists on the board.

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"You already know more than you think. You know what stops you and what sends you away. You know the apps people use. You know what you type when you want something. Today we take that everyday knowledge and give it a structure â€" a map of the places businesses show up online, and the steps a customer takes from 'I have never heard of them' to 'I am a regular customer'. That map is the foundation of everything we will build in this course."*

If more than a third of the class cannot answer Question 1 with three apps, spend 2 extra minutes asking learners to name apps they see on each other's phones before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 What digital marketing actually is

The idea. Digital marketing is how a business finds people, talks to them and wins their custom using the internet and digital tools â€" phones, websites, social media, search engines, email and messaging apps.

Plain-English definition. Digital marketing is everything a business does online to get noticed, build trust and sell â€" from a Google search result to an Instagram post to a WhatsApp message. If a customer sees it, reads it or clicks it on a phone or computer, it is digital marketing.

Why it exists. Before the internet, a small business found customers through its location, word of mouth, flyers, radio and TV. Those still work â€" but most people now spend hours every day on their phones. A young person in Port Harcourt might walk past a shop every day and never notice it, but search "food delivery near me" at 7pm and order from a kitchen they have never visited. Digital marketing makes sure your business is the one they find.

What it does:

- **Gets you found** â€" someone looking for what you sell can discover you.
- **Builds trust** â€" a stranger sees your page, reads reviews, looks at photos and decides you are real.
- **Starts a conversation** â€" they message you, call you, send a DM.
- **Turns interest into a sale** â€" they order, pay, book, come to your shop.
- **Keeps them coming back** â€" you stay in touch, remind them, reward them.

Real-life comparison. Think of a market trader in Mile 1 or Mile 3 market in Port Harcourt. She has a stall (her location), she calls out to passers-by (advertising), she lets you taste a piece of what she sells (social proof), she remembers your name and asks about your family (retention), and she writes her number on a piece of paper and says "call me when you need more" (direct marketing). Digital marketing is doing all of those things â€" but on a phone screen, to people who are not physically walking past your stall.

Important limitation / misconception. Digital marketing is not magic. It will not save a bad product, fix terrible customer service or make a dishonest business succeed for long. It is a *megaphone and a bridge* â€" it amplifies what is already there. If the food is good and the service is fair, digital marketing brings more customers. If the food is bad, digital marketing just helps more people discover how bad it is, faster.

How a learner recognises digital marketing in the wild. Open any app on your phone. Every time you see a business name, a product photo, a "sponsored" label, a review, a search result, a message from a shop â€" that is digital marketing. You are surrounded by it. The question is whether *your* business or *your client's* business is the one doing it well.

F.2 The eight main digital marketing channels

The idea. A **channel** is simply a place or method a business uses to reach customers. There are many, but eight cover almost everything a small business needs. You do not need all eight â€" you need the two or three that match where your customers actually spend time.

Plain-English definition. A channel is a road between a business and a customer. Social media is a road. Google Search is a road. WhatsApp is a road. Your job is to pick the roads your customers actually walk on â€" not to build eight roads and leave seven of them empty.

The eight channels, explained one by one:

1. Website. A website is your business's home on the internet â€" a collection of pages on a web address (like www.example.com). For a small business, a simple one-page site is often enough: what you sell, where you are, how to contact you, and how to order. A website is *owned* â€" nobody can change the rules or delete it overnight. Think of it as your shop building: it is permanent, you control what is inside, and customers can visit any time. For Mama Nkechi's Kitchen, a simple one-page site showing her menu, location and order number would be enough to start.

2. Search (Google). When someone types "caterer in Port Harcourt" or "jollof rice delivery near me" into Google, the results they see are the search channel. Businesses try to appear high in those results â€" this is called SEO (Search Engine Optimisation), which we cover in Session 5. Search is powerful because the person is *already looking* â€" they have intent. If someone is typing "food near me" at 7pm, they are hungry now. That is a warm customer.

3. Social media. Platforms like Instagram, Facebook, TikTok, Twitter (X) and YouTube where people share content and businesses post, interact and build an audience. Social media is where you show your personality, your food, your work, your customers. It is the channel most small businesses already use â€" but often without a plan. We fix that in Session 4. For Mama

Nkechi's Kitchen, Instagram and Facebook are the right social channels because food photographs well and her customers are already there.

4. Content. Content is the material you create to inform, entertain or inspire â€" blog posts, videos, photos, infographics, guides, recipes. Content marketing means giving something useful for free that makes people trust you and want to buy. A food kitchen might share a "how to make the perfect jollof" video â€" people watch it, trust the kitchen, and order. Content is the *fuel* for social media and search. Without content, social media is an empty shop with no products.

5. Email. Sending messages directly to a person's email inbox. Email is *owned* â€" you have the list, nobody can take it away, and you can reach people without depending on an algorithm. It is the best channel for repeat business: newsletters, special offers, reminders. For a small business, even a simple monthly email to 50 customers can bring orders. We cover this in Session 6.

6. WhatsApp. In Nigeria, WhatsApp is not just a messaging app â€" it is a business tool. WhatsApp Business lets a business create a profile, a catalogue of products, labels for customers, and broadcast messages. For many small Nigerian businesses, WhatsApp is *the* sales channel â€" customers message, order, pay on delivery. It is personal, direct and trusted. We cover it in Session 6. For Mama Nkechi's Kitchen, WhatsApp is already her main order channel â€" we will make it work harder.

7. Paid ads. Paying a platform (Meta for Facebook/Instagram, Google for Search and YouTube) to show your business to more people. Paid ads are *rented* attention â€" while you pay, you get seen; when you stop, you disappear. They can work well for a new business that has no audience yet, but they must be done carefully and with a real budget. We cover this in Session 7. For Mama Nkechi's Kitchen, a small paid campaign could help her reach new customers in her area â€" but only after her free channels are working.

8. Google Business Profile. A free listing on Google that shows your business name, address, phone number, photos, reviews and opening hours when people search for you or your category on Google Search and Google Maps. For a local business â€" a kitchen, a salon, a shop â€" this is often the *single most important* channel, because it puts you in front of people searching for exactly what you sell, in your area. We cover it in Session 3. For Mama Nkechi's Kitchen, setting up a complete Google Business Profile is the first practical win we will aim for.

How the channels work together (the key lesson):

> *"A customer rarely sees one thing and buys. A real journey looks like this: someone sees a friend's Instagram story about Mama Nkechi's jollof (social media). Curious, they Google 'Mama Nkechi's Kitchen Port Harcourt' (search) and find her Google Business Profile with good photos and reviews (Google Business Profile). They visit her one-page website to see the full menu (website). They message her on WhatsApp to ask about delivery (WhatsApp). They order (conversion). A week later, she sends a WhatsApp broadcast: 'New soup menu this week' (WhatsApp again), and they order again (retention). That is not five separate tactics â€" that is one customer journey across five channels, all working together."*

Common misconception. Learners often think they must be on *all* eight channels at once, posting everywhere every day. This is the fastest way to burn out and fail. The right approach: pick two or three channels that match where your customers are, do them well, and expand later. For Mama Nkechi's Kitchen, the right starting three are: Google Business Profile, Instagram, and WhatsApp. Not Facebook, not TikTok, not email, not paid ads â€" not yet. We will add channels as we learn them.

How a learner recognises which channels a business uses. Open the business's Instagram page â€" that is social media. Google the business name â€" if a listing appears with a map, that is Google Business Profile. Check if they have a web address â€" that is a website. Ask how you order â€" if it is WhatsApp, that is the WhatsApp channel. Every business is using at least one channel; the skill is seeing *which* ones and judging whether they are doing them well.

F.3 The marketing funnel â€" awareness, consideration, conversion, retention

The idea. Not every customer is ready to buy the moment they hear about you. Some have never heard of you. Some have heard but are not sure. Some are ready to buy. Some have bought and might buy again. The funnel is a way of thinking about these four stages, so you know *what to say* and *where to say it* depending on where the customer is.

Plain-English definition. The funnel is the journey a customer travels from first discovering you to becoming a loyal repeat buyer. It is called a funnel because many people enter at the top (awareness) and fewer and fewer reach the bottom (purchase) â€" like water poured into a wide funnel narrowing to a small opening.

The four stages, explained:

Stage 1 â€" Awareness. The customer has just discovered you exist. They do not know you, do not trust you yet, and probably were not actively looking for you. They saw your Instagram post, heard a friend mention you, or saw your Google listing. At this

stage, your job is simple: get noticed and make a good first impression. You do not ask for a sale here â€" you ask for attention. Example: an Instagram reel showing sizzling jollof rice with steam rising. The viewer thinks "that looks good" and maybe watches to the end. That is awareness.

Stage 2 â€" Consideration. The customer now knows you exist and is actively thinking about whether to buy. They are comparing you to alternatives. They are reading your reviews, checking your menu, asking a friend, looking at your photos, checking your prices. At this stage, your job is to build trust and answer their questions. Example: the customer visits Mama Nkechi's Google Business Profile, reads five reviews saying "food is always hot and on time", and looks at photos of the small chops. They are considering.

Stage 3 â€" Conversion. The customer decides to buy. They place an order, make a booking, pay a deposit, walk into your shop. This is the moment you have been working toward. At this stage, your job is to make buying easy and frictionless. Example: the customer messages Mama Nkechi on WhatsApp: "Please send one plate of jollof and small chops to GRA." She replies with the price, the customer pays via transfer or on delivery, and the food is sent. Conversion complete.

Stage 4 â€" Retention. The customer has bought once. Now the real opportunity begins: will they come back? Most businesses ignore this stage and lose customers to competitors who do not. At this stage, your job is to stay in touch, reward them and remind them you exist. Example: two weeks later, Mama Nkechi sends a WhatsApp broadcast to her customer list: "Good morning! New bean cake recipe this week. Reply YES to order." The customer replies and orders again. That is retention â€" and it is far cheaper than finding a brand-new customer.

Why the funnel matters (the key lesson):

> *"If you try to sell to someone at the awareness stage, you will fail. If you send a 'buy now' message to someone who has never heard of you, they will ignore you or block you. If you only focus on getting new customers and never follow up, you will lose the ones you already won. The funnel tells you what to say and when. At awareness: show them something good. At consideration: prove you are trustworthy. At conversion: make it easy to buy. At retention: stay in touch. Match the message to the stage."*

Real-life comparison. The funnel is like dating. At first, someone sees you across the room (awareness). Then they come over and talk to you, ask questions, check if you are real (consideration). Then they agree to go on a date (conversion). Then, if the date went well, they keep seeing you â€" a relationship (retention). You would not propose marriage the first time you see someone across the room. Marketing works the same way. Do not rush the stages.

Funnel stages in the running example â€" Mama Nkechi's Kitchen:

Funnel stage	What Mama Nkechi does	Where it happens
Awareness	Instagram reel of jollof being cooked; Google listing appears when people search "food near me"	Instagram, Google Search/Maps
Consideration	Customer reads reviews, sees photos, checks menu on website	Google Business Profile, website
Conversion	Customer messages on WhatsApp and places an order	WhatsApp
Retention	Weekly WhatsApp broadcast with new menu; friendly follow-up	WhatsApp

Common misconception. "The funnel is about tricking people into buying." No. The funnel is about understanding where a person is in their decision and giving them the right information and experience at each stage. Pushing a sale too early is not persuasive â€" it is pushy. Building trust at the right pace is what actually works.

How a learner recognises funnel stages in real life. Think about the last thing you bought online. Trace back: where did you first see it (awareness)? What did you check before buying (consideration)? How did you actually buy it (conversion)? Have you bought from that business again, and did they stay in touch (retention)? Every purchase you have ever made follows this pattern.

F.4 The customer journey â€" mapping the real path a customer takes

The idea. The funnel is the *theory* â€" the four stages. The customer journey is the *practice* â€" the specific steps a real customer takes, channel by channel, from first hearing about you to becoming a repeat buyer. Mapping the journey means writing down those steps so you can see where to improve.

Plain-English definition. A customer journey is the story of one customer's experience with your business, told step by step: what they see, what they think, what they do, and where they do it. Mapping means drawing that story out so you can see the whole path at a glance.

Why it exists. Without a journey map, you are guessing. You might spend all week on Instagram posts when your customers actually find you through Google. You might write long captions when your customers decide based on reviews. Mapping the journey shows you the *actual* path customers take, so you can put your effort where it matters.

The five parts of a customer journey map:

1. **Who** â€" the specific customer (we will build a detailed customer avatar in Session 2; for now, a simple description is fine).
2. **What they see** â€" the thing that reaches them (an ad, a post, a search result, a friend's recommendation).
3. **What they think** â€" their reaction ("that looks good", "is this real?", "how much?").
4. **What they do** â€" the action they take (click, search, message, visit, order, nothing).
5. **Where it happens** â€" the channel (Instagram, Google, WhatsApp, website, in person).

Worked example â€" Mama Nkechi's Kitchen, customer journey for "Chinedu, a young professional in GRA":

Step	Who	What they see	What they think	What they do	Where
1	Chinedu (28, works in GRA, lives alone)	Friend shares an Instagram story of Mama Nkechi's small chops plate	"That looks proper. Who is this?"	Watches the story, taps to see the page	Instagram
2	Chinedu	Mama Nkechi's Instagram profile â€" a few posts, bio says "Home-cooked meals, delivery in PH"	"Okay, but is it real? Let me check Google"	Searches "Mama Nkechi's Kitchen Port Harcourt"	Google Search
3	Chinedu	Google Business Profile â€" photos of food, 4.2 stars, 12 reviews, "open now", phone number	"Good reviews. Looks legit. Let me see the menu"	Taps the website link	Google Business Profile
4	Chinedu	One-page website â€" menu with prices, delivery areas, order number	"â‚¦1,500 for a plate. Fair. I will message them"	Taps the WhatsApp button	Website
5	Chinedu	WhatsApp chat â€" Mama Nkechi replies quickly with a photo of today's menu	"Good service. Let me order"	Sends order and address; pays on delivery	WhatsApp
6	Chinedu	Food arrives â€" hot, well packaged	"This is good. I will remember this"	Eats, saves the number	In person
7	Chinedu (two weeks later)	WhatsApp broadcast: "New soup menu this week"	"Let me try the new soup"	Replies and orders again	WhatsApp

What this map tells us (say this to the class):

> *"Look at this journey. Chinedu did not buy because of one post. He bought because of a chain: Instagram story â†' Google search â†' Google Business Profile â†' website â†' WhatsApp order. If any link in that chain was broken â€" no Google listing, no website, slow WhatsApp reply â€" the sale would not happen. Mapping the journey shows us which links to strengthen. For Mama Nkechi, the weak links today are: no Google Business Profile, no website, and an Instagram page with no plan. Those are exactly what we fix in the next two sessions."*

Why the journey and the funnel work together:

> *"The funnel gives you the four stages. The journey gives you the specific path through those stages for one type of customer. Funnel = theory. Journey = practice. You need both. In your practical today, you will build both for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen."*

Common misconception. "The customer journey is the same for every customer." No. A young professional in GRA has a different journey from a student in Choba or a mother in Rumuokwuta. That is why we build a *customer avatar* (Session 2) â€" to understand one specific type of customer and map *their* journey first, then expand to others later.

How a learner builds a journey map. Pick one real customer you know (or imagine one for Mama Nkechi). Write down, step by step: how did they first hear about the business? What did they check before buying? How did they actually buy? What happened after? What channel was each step on? Write it as a table with the five columns above. That is a customer journey map.

F.5 How it all fits together â€" channels, funnel and journey

The idea. By now you have three tools: channels (the places you reach people), the funnel (the four stages customers go through) and the journey (the specific path one customer takes). The final piece is seeing how they work together.

The relationship (say it slowly):

> *"Channels are the roads. The funnel is the map showing the stages of the trip. The journey is the actual route one customer drives. You pick the roads your channels give you. You use the funnel to know what to say at each stage. You use the journey map to see the real route your customer takes â€" and fix the potholes."*

Worked example â€" putting it all together for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen:

Funnel stage	Channel	What we do	What the customer experiences
Awareness	Instagram	Post a reel of jollof cooking three times a week with good hooks	Chinedu sees the reel on his feed
Awareness	Google	Set up Google Business Profile with photos and correct info	When friends mention the kitchen, Chinedu finds it on Google
Consideration	Google Business Profile	Collect honest reviews, post weekly updates	Chinedu reads reviews and trusts the business
Consideration	Website	One-page site with menu, prices, delivery areas, order number	Chinedu checks the menu and sees it is affordable
Conversion	WhatsApp	Fast replies, clear prices, easy payment options	Chinedu orders in two minutes
Retention	WhatsApp	Weekly broadcast with new menu, friendly follow-up	Chinedu orders again and tells a friend

The key insight (say this):

> *"Notice that no single channel does the whole job. Instagram alone did not get the sale. Google alone did not get the sale. WhatsApp alone did not get the sale. It was the combination â€" the chain of channels working together â€" that moved Chinedu from awareness to a repeat customer. This is the most important idea in digital marketing: **channels work together.** A business that posts on Instagram but has no Google listing, no website and no plan is like a shop with a beautiful signpost, a locked door and no shop behind it. We build the whole chain."*

Common misconception. "I should pick one channel and focus only on it." Focusing on one channel is actually good advice *for execution* â€" but only after you understand how it connects to the others. Instagram content should drive people to Google or WhatsApp. Google Business Profile should drive people to the website or WhatsApp. WhatsApp should drive people to order. Every channel should point to the next step in the journey. If your channels do not connect, each one works alone and the customer falls through the gaps.

How a learner checks whether channels are working together. Look at a business's Instagram page. Does the bio have a link? Does it say where the business is? Does it tell you how to order? Now Google the business â€" does a listing appear? Does it have the same name, address and phone number? If the Instagram page and the Google listing tell different stories, the channels are not working together. In Session 3, you will audit real local businesses and see this for yourself.

F.6 The ethics foundation â€" honest marketing from day one

The idea. Before we build any channel or write any post, we must agree on the rules. Digital marketing gives you power â€" the power to reach thousands of people. That power must be used honestly. The academy's Ethics and Professional Conduct rules (Section 15 of the Design Document) are not optional. They are the foundation.

The five rules that matter most today (read aloud and explain each):

1. **Honest advertising.** Never claim what you cannot prove. If the jollof is â‚¦1,500, say â‚¦1,500. If delivery takes 2 hours, say 2 hours â€" not "30 minutes" to look good. If you say "made fresh every morning", it must be true. Fake discounts, invented urgency ("only 2 left!" when there are 200) and miracle results ("this cream will make you fair in 7 days") are all dishonest. They might work once â€" and then destroy your reputation for good.
2. **No fake reviews.** Never write a review for your own business, pay someone to write a good review, or ask a friend to pretend they are a customer. Reviews are the digital word of mouth â€" they are the most trusted thing a business has. Fake reviews are fraud. If a real customer leaves a bad review, reply professionally and fix the problem â€" do not delete it (if you can even) or retaliate. A business that responds well to a bad review often earns *more* trust than one with only perfect fives.
3. **No buying engagement.** Never buy followers, likes, views, comments or shares. Bought followers are fake accounts â€" they will never buy from you, they distort your data (so you cannot tell what is working), and platforms penalise accounts that use them. Growth must be earned. 500 real followers who actually buy are worth more than 50,000 fake ones who never will.
4. **Respect privacy and data (NDPR-minded).** Nigeria's Data Protection Regulation (NDPR) says you must collect only the data you need, use it only for the agreed purpose, keep it secure and never sell it. In practice: do not scrape phone numbers from Facebook groups. Do not buy a list of phone numbers. Do not add people to WhatsApp broadcasts without their permission. In this course, we use only our own data and invented business data â€" never real customer lists.
5. **Permission-based messaging and anti-spam.** Email and WhatsApp messages go only to people who said yes. Identify yourself, give an easy opt-out ("reply STOP to unsubscribe"), honour it immediately, and never spam groups. Unsolicited bulk messaging is spam â€" it is illegal under NDPR-minded practice, it annoys people and it gets your number blocked. We cover the details in Session 6, but the rule starts today: **always ask before you send.**

Why ethics matter for a small business (say this):

> *"A big company can survive a scandal. A small business cannot. Mama Nkechi's Kitchen lives on trust â€" her customers order because they trust her food and her word. If she lies in an advert, uses fake reviews or spams people, she might get a few orders today and lose her reputation for good. Honest marketing is not just the right thing to do â€" it is the smart thing to do for a small business. Trust is the most valuable asset a small business has. We protect it."*

The academy's ethics motto (say it together with the class):

> *Honest claims. Real reviews. Earned growth. Asked permission. Protected data.*

Common misconception. "Everyone else is doing it â€" fake followers, fake reviews, spam. If I do not, I will fall behind." This is false. The businesses that win long-term are the ones that build real trust. Fake growth collapses â€" when the platform catches on, when customers realise, when the data makes no sense. Real growth is slower but it is *permanent*. And in a course like this, we teach the permanent way.

How a learner applies ethics from today. Before you post anything, send anything or claim anything, ask three questions: Is this true? Would I be comfortable if the customer knew exactly how I got their attention? Would I do this if the customer were standing in front of me? If the answer to any of these is no â€" do not do it.

F.7 Summary of the lecture

- **Digital marketing** is how a business finds people, talks to them and wins their custom using the internet and digital tools.
- **The eight main channels** are: website, search, social media, content, email, WhatsApp, paid ads and Google Business Profile. Pick the two or three that match your customers â€" not all eight.
- **The funnel** has four stages: Awareness (they discover you), Consideration (they check you out), Conversion (they buy), Retention (they come back). Match your message to the stage.

- **The customer journey** is the specific path one customer takes through the funnel, channel by channel. Map it to see where to improve.
- **Channels work together.** No single channel does the whole job. Build a chain: each channel points to the next step.
- **Ethics come first.** Honest claims, real reviews, earned growth, asked permission, protected data â€” always.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Awareness] --> B[Interest] --> C[Desire] --> D[Action] --> E[Loyal customer]
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- On the projector: a blank slide with four columns drawn â€” Awareness, Consideration, Conversion, Retention.
- A set of 20 tactic cards (printed or on a slide) â€” see the list in G.2.
- A blank customer journey table (five columns: Step, Who, What they see, What they think, What they do, Where).
- Mama Nkechi's Kitchen slide ready.

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€” sort tactics into funnel stages (6 minutes)

Say: "Before we map the journey, let me show you how to think about the funnel in practice. I have 20 tactics here. Let us sort them into the four stages â€” which stage does each one belong to?"

Put the 20 tactics on the projector (read them aloud as you go):

1. Instagram reel showing jollof being cooked
2. Google ad for "caterer in Port Harcourt"
3. Customer reads reviews on Google Business Profile
4. Customer messages on WhatsApp to order
5. WhatsApp broadcast: "New soup menu this week"
6. Blog post: "5 tips for perfect party jollof"
7. Customer sees a friend share Mama Nkechi's page
8. Customer compares prices on the website
9. Customer pays for the order
10. Customer tells a friend about the food
11. Facebook post with a discount code
12. Customer searches "jollof rice delivery near me"
13. Customer saves the WhatsApp number for later
14. Email newsletter with a special offer
15. Customer asks "do you deliver to GRA?"
16. Google Business Profile shows "open now"
17. Customer leaves a 5-star review
18. TikTok video of small chops packaging
19. Customer orders for the third time
20. Instagram story showing behind the kitchen

Ask the class to call out the stage for each one. Write each tactic in the correct column on the projector as they answer. Guide them when they are wrong â€” explain why.

The correct sorting (reveal after discussion):

Awareness	Consideration	Conversion	Retention
1. Instagram reel	3. Reads reviews	4. Messages to order	5. WhatsApp broadcast

Awareness	Consideration	Conversion	Retention
6. Blog post	8. Compares prices	9. Pays for order	13. Saves the number
7. Friend shares page	11. Discount code post	15. Asks about delivery	17. Leaves a review
12. Searches "jollof near me"	16. GBP shows "open now"		19. Orders third time
18. TikTok video			
20. Instagram story			

Say: "Notice a few things. First, some tactics sit between stages â€” a friend sharing the page is awareness, but it can also start consideration. That is normal. Second, the retention stage is often empty in real businesses â€” most stop after the sale. That is a missed opportunity. Third, notice how many tactics happen across different channels â€” Instagram, Google, WhatsApp. The funnel is not one channel; it is the whole chain."

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€” build a customer journey live (6 minutes)

Say: "Now let us take the funnel and make it real. Let us map the actual journey of one customer â€” Chinedu, a 28-year-old professional in GRA. I will think out loud as I build the map."

Fill the journey table on the projector, narrating each decision:

Step	Who	What they see	What they think	What they do	Where
1	Chinedu	Friend's Instagram story of jollof	"That looks good"	Watches, taps to see page	Instagram
2	Chinedu	Instagram profile	"Is this real?"	Searches the name	Google Search
3	Chinedu	Google Business Profile with reviews	"Good reviews. Trust it."	Opens website link	Google Business Profile
4	Chinedu	Website with menu and prices	"â‚¦1,500. Fair."	Taps WhatsApp button	Website
5	Chinedu	WhatsApp chat	"Good service."	Sends order, pays	WhatsApp
6	Chinedu	Food arrives, hot and good	"I will remember this"	Eats, saves number	In person
7	Chinedu (2 weeks later)	WhatsApp broadcast	"New soup? Let me try"	Replies, orders again	WhatsApp

After building it, ask:

- "Which step is the most important to get right?" (Most will say the order step. Say: "Every step matters â€” if step 3 fails, there is no step 5. The chain is only as strong as its weakest link.")
- "Where could Chinedu fall out of the journey?" (Discuss: no Google listing â†' he never finds her. Slow WhatsApp reply â†' he orders elsewhere. Bad food â†' he never returns.)
- "What would you fix first for Mama Nkechi?" (The missing Google Business Profile and website â€” the weak links in the chain.)

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€” connect channels to the journey (3 minutes)

Say: "Last piece. Let me show you the channels working together." Draw arrows on the projector between the journey steps, labelling each arrow with the channel name:

> *Instagram (awareness) â†' Google Search â†' Google Business Profile (consideration) â†' Website (consideration) â†' WhatsApp (conversion) â†' WhatsApp (retention)*

Say:

> *"This is the whole session in one line: Instagram gets him curious, Google gets him found, the Business Profile and website build trust, WhatsApp closes the sale, WhatsApp keeps him coming back. Five channels, one journey. If you remember nothing else today, remember this:* ***channels work together, and the customer journey is the story of how they do.***"

G.5 Questions to ask during the demo

- "Which funnel stage is this tactic for?" (For each card as you sort.)
- "Why is a Google review consideration, not awareness?" (Because the customer already found the business and is now deciding.)
- "What happens if Mama Nkechi has no Google Business Profile?" (Chinedu searches, finds nothing, orders from a competitor who does.)
- "Why is retention cheaper than finding new customers?" (Because you already have their trust and their number â€" you just need to remind them.)
- "Can you name one channel that does more than one funnel stage?" (Yes â€" Google does awareness and consideration; WhatsApp does conversion and retention.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding step by step, each learner (or pair) builds a funnel map and a customer journey map for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen, using the printed worksheets.

Starting materials: The Funnel and Journey Mapping Worksheet (printed per learner), the 20 tactic cards (one set per group of 3â€"4), a pen or pencil.

Procedure (instructor calls out each numbered step; learners follow; instructor walks the room):

1. Write your name at the top of the worksheet. In the business box, write "Mama Nkechi's Kitchen."
2. Look at the four funnel columns on your worksheet. Take the 20 tactic cards and sort them into the four stages â€" Awareness, Consideration, Conversion, Retention. Place each card in the correct column. If you disagree with your group, explain your reason.
3. When you have sorted all 20, check your sorting against the projector (the instructor will reveal the correct answer). Mark any you got wrong and write a note explaining why the correct stage is right.
4. Now turn to the customer journey table. Choose one customer for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen â€" you may use Chinedu (the GRA professional) or create your own (e.g., "Ada, a student in Chobi" or "Mama Nkechi's regular customer, Mr. Tunde"). Write the customer's name and a one-line description at the top.
5. Fill in the journey table with at least 5 steps. For each step, write: what the customer sees, what they think, what they do, and where it happens (the channel).
6. **Pause and predict:** Cover the last column (Where) with your hand. Look at your steps. Is there a step where you are not sure which channel it happens on? Uncover it and check. Can you name the channel for every step?
7. When you have at least 5 steps, draw arrows between the steps to show the journey. Label each arrow with the channel name.
8. Look at your journey. Where is the weakest link? Circle it. Write one sentence: "The weakest step is _____ because _____."
9. Compare your journey with the person beside you. If your journeys are different, discuss why â€" there is more than one valid path.
10. Keep your worksheet â€" you will add to it in the assignment and it becomes part of your capstone folder.

Expected result (model answer â€" instructor key):

A completed worksheet with:

- 20 tactics sorted into the four funnel columns (with corrections marked).
- A customer journey table with at least 5 steps, each with what they see / think / do / where.
- Arrows connecting the steps, labelled with channel names.
- One weakest link circled with a sentence explaining why.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 3: "Did anyone put a tactic in the wrong column? Why do you think it belongs somewhere else?" (Use this to clarify the trickiest ones â€" e.g., reviews are consideration, not awareness.)
- After step 6: "Is your journey realistic? Could this actually happen to a real person in Port Harcourt?" (If a learner writes "TV advert" as a channel, remind them: Mama Nkechi cannot afford TV â€" we are mapping what is realistic for a small business.)

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Learner puts all 20 tactics in Awareness â†' "Read each one carefully. Is the customer just discovering the business, or are they deciding to buy?"
- Learner leaves the Conversion column empty â†' "How does the customer actually pay or place an order? That is conversion."
- Learner's journey has only 2 steps â†' "Add more detail. What happens between 'I see a post' and 'I order'? Did they check anything? Ask anyone?"
- Learner's journey includes unrealistic channels (TV, radio billboard) â†' "Remember: Mama Nkechi is a small kitchen. What can she realistically do with a phone and free tools?"
- Learner cannot decide between two stages for a tactic â†' "That is okay â€" some tactics sit between stages. Pick the one where the tactic does its *main* job and explain why."

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ All 20 tactics sorted into the four funnel columns
- ☐ Any mistakes corrected with a note explaining why
- ☐ Customer journey table has at least 5 steps
- ☐ Each step has: what they see, what they think, what they do, where it happens
- ☐ Arrows drawn between steps and labelled with channel names
- ☐ Weakest link circled with a sentence explaining why
- ☐ Worksheet kept safe for the assignment and capstone

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task (new task, done alone): You are a digital marketing consultant. A new client, *Blessing's Braids and Beauty* (a fictional hair salon in Port Harcourt that does braids, weaves and natural hair care), has asked for your help. She has a Facebook page with 800 followers, posts when she remembers, and gets most of her customers by walk-in and word of mouth. She wants more bookings, especially from young women in GRA and Trans-Amadi.

Requirements:

1. List **four** marketing tactics Blessing could use (one for each funnel stage: Awareness, Consideration, Conversion, Retention). Each tactic must be realistic for a small salon â€" think phone, free tools, social media, WhatsApp.
2. Write a **customer journey** for one specific customer of Blessing's â€" e.g., "Kelechi, a 24-year-old bank worker in GRA who needs a new hairstyle for a wedding." Include at least 4 steps, each with what she sees, what she thinks, what she does, and where it happens.
3. For each step in the journey, **name the funnel stage** it belongs to (Awareness, Consideration, Conversion or Retention).
4. Circle the **weakest link** in the journey and write one sentence explaining what Blessing should fix first.

Constraints:

- Do not use paid ads â€" Blessing has no budget for ads yet.
- Do not use any channel that requires money to set up.
- Every tactic must be something Blessing can do with a smartphone and free tools.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- Four tactics listed, one per funnel stage, all realistic for a small salon.
- Customer journey has at least 4 steps with all four parts (see, think, do, where).
- Each step labelled with the correct funnel stage.

- Weakest link identified with a reason.

Hints if stuck:

- Hint 1: For Awareness, think about what a young woman in GRA might see on her phone â€" a TikTok video? A friend's post? A Google search?
- Hint 2: For Conversion, think about how Blessing takes bookings â€" does she have a WhatsApp number? A booking form? Does she answer messages quickly?
- Hint 3: For Retention, think about what happens *after* the hairstyle is done â€" does Blessing follow up? Does she remind the customer to come back?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

Four tactics, one per funnel stage:

1. **Awareness:** A TikTok video showing a 15-second braid transformation (before/after) with a hook like "POV: you have a wedding on Saturday and no hairstyle."
2. **Consideration:** A Google Business Profile with photos of past work, prices, and real reviews from customers saying "she listens to what you want."
3. **Conversion:** A WhatsApp message from Blessing: "Hi Kelechi! Thanks for reaching out. Saturday at 2pm works. My braids start from â‚¦5,000. Shall I reserve your seat?" â€" making it easy to say yes.
4. **Retention:** A WhatsApp broadcast two weeks later: "Hi! How is your hair holding up? Book a touch-up this month and get 10% off. Reply YES to book."

Customer journey for Kelechi (24, bank worker, GRA):

Step	What she sees	What she thinks	What she does	Where	Funnel stage
1	TikTok video of a braid transformation	"That is beautiful. Who did this?"	Watches, taps to see the profile	TikTok	Awareness
2	Blessing's Instagram page â€" photos of braids, prices in bio	"Looks good. Is she good?"	Searches "braids salon GRA Port Harcourt"	Google Search	Consideration
3	Google Business Profile â€" 4.5 stars, 20 reviews, photos of work	"Reviews are good. Let me message her"	Taps the WhatsApp button	Google Business Profile	Consideration
4	WhatsApp chat â€" Blessing replies fast with prices and availability	"â‚¦5,000. She is professional. I will book"	Replies "Saturday 2pm, please" and pays a deposit	WhatsApp	Conversion
5	Two weeks later: WhatsApp broadcast with 10% off touch-up	"My braids still look good. Let me book a touch-up"	Replies YES and books	WhatsApp	Retention

Weakest link: Step 2 â€" Kelechi's Instagram page has no clear pricing and few posts, so she might not trust it enough to message. Blessing should fix this by posting regularly (3 times a week) with clear photos, prices in the bio, and a link to WhatsApp.

Learner marking (out of 10):

- Four tactics, one per funnel stage, all realistic (4)
- Journey has at least 4 steps with all four parts (2)
- Each step labelled with correct funnel stage (2)
- Weakest link identified with a clear reason (2)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Adaeze* runs a small Ankara clothing shop in Port Harcourt. She sells ready-made dresses and takes custom orders. She has an Instagram page with 600 followers â€" mostly friends and family. She posts a photo of a new dress maybe once a

month, with captions like "New stock. Call us." She has no Google Business Profile, no website, and no WhatsApp Business account â€" she uses her personal WhatsApp. She gets a few customers a week, mostly people who walk past her shop or hear about her from a friend. She wants more customers but does not know where to start.

Relevant facts.

- Adaeze's dresses are well made and fairly priced (â‚¦3,000â€"â‚¦15,000).
- Her Instagram page has beautiful photos of her dresses â€" but no prices, no location, no way to order except "call us."
- She does not appear when someone searches "Ankara dress shop Port Harcourt" on Google.
- She keeps her customers' phone numbers in her personal phone but never follows up after a sale.
- A competitor, *Zara's Fabrics*, has a Google Business Profile with 4.8 stars and 30 reviews, a simple website with a catalogue, and a WhatsApp Business account. Zara gets customers every week from Google searches and WhatsApp enquiries.

Decision point. Adaeze has â‚¦5,000 to spend on marketing this month. She is thinking about three options:

1. Boost her Instagram posts with â‚¦5,000 in paid ads.
2. Hire someone to manage her social media full-time.
3. Spend the â‚¦5,000 on a small printing run of flyers to distribute in her area.

What should she do?

Possible approaches.

1. **Run Instagram ads with â‚¦5,000.** This could get her posts in front of more people â€" but if those people click and find a page with no prices, no location and no clear way to order, they will leave. Ads bring people to the door; they do not build the house first.
2. **Hire a social media manager.** This could work long-term â€" but it is a recurring monthly cost (â‚¦20,000â€"â‚¦50,000), and Adaeze does not have that yet. She needs to build her foundation first.
3. **Print and distribute flyers.** Flyers can work for a local shop â€" but they are one-time, hard to measure, and most flyers end up in the bin. The â‚¦5,000 might buy 500 flyers and zero customers.

Recommended solution. None of the three. Adaeze's problem is not awareness â€" her dresses are good and her Instagram photos are beautiful. Her problem is that the *chain is broken*: people who find her on Instagram cannot easily find her location, prices or reviews, and people searching on Google cannot find her at all. The â‚¦5,000 is better spent â€" or rather, not spent at all â€" on fixing the foundation first:

1. **Set up a Google Business Profile** (free). Add her shop name, address, phone number, photos of her best dresses, opening hours, and start asking real customers to leave honest reviews. This makes her visible when people search "Ankara dress shop Port Harcourt" â€" the exact moment someone is looking to buy.
2. **Fix her Instagram page** (free). Add prices to her photos, put her location and WhatsApp number in the bio, and post once a week with a clear call-to-action ("DM 'DRESS' to order"). This turns her existing page into a real sales channel.
3. **Switch to WhatsApp Business** (free). Set up a catalogue with her dresses and prices, create labels for customers, and send a gentle follow-up after each purchase: "Thank you! How do you love your dress? Reply with a photo and get 10% off your next order." This builds retention at no cost.
4. **Only then, consider paid ads.** Once the foundation is solid â€" Google listing, clear Instagram page, WhatsApp catalogue â€" a small paid campaign (â‚¦5,000 over two weeks) would work because the chain is complete. People who click the ad will find a real business they can trust and buy from.

Trade-offs.

- Option 1 (ads now): fast reach, but wasted money because the chain is broken. The â‚¦5,000 would buy clicks, not customers.
- Option 2 (hire a manager): too expensive for Adaeze's current stage. She needs to build the foundation herself first, then hire help when the business can afford it.
- Option 3 (flyers): cheap and local, but unmeasurable and unlikely to reach the young women in GRA who are already searching on Google.
- Recommended (fix the foundation): free or nearly free, builds permanent assets (Google listing, WhatsApp catalogue, better Instagram), and makes any future spending â€" ads, flyers, or hiring â€" work much better.

Professional connection. This is exactly what a digital marketing consultant does in their first week with a client: **audit the foundation before recommending any spending.** A consultant who immediately says "run ads" without checking the Google listing, the website and the follow-up process is wasting the client's money. The foundation first, the spending second. This is the mindset you are building in this course â€" and it is why Session 3 (online presence) comes before Session 7 (paid ads).

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the live guide. Point learners to the row rather than giving the answer.

K.1 Confusing digital marketing with "social media"

Symptoms: Learner says "digital marketing is Instagram" or "I need to go viral." **Likely cause:** Social media is the most visible channel, so learners assume it is the only one. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Is a Google search result social media? Is a WhatsApp message social media? Is a website social media?" **Corrective steps:** Re-explain the eight channels. Show that social media is one channel among eight, and that the funnel and journey span all of them. **How to confirm resolved:** Learner can name at least four channels that are not social media. **Prevention:** Use the eight-channel cards from the first session; keep them visible on the wall.

K.2 Putting a tactic in the wrong funnel stage

Symptoms: Learner says "a Google review is awareness" or "an Instagram post is conversion." **Likely cause:** The learner has not separated *discovering* the business from *deciding* to buy. **How to investigate:** Ask: "At this step, has the customer already found the business? If yes, it is probably consideration or later." **Corrective steps:** Re-explain: Awareness = they discover you exist. Consideration = they found you and are deciding. Conversion = they buy. Retention = they come back. **How to confirm resolved:** Learner correctly sorts a new tactic and explains why. **Prevention:** Use the sorting exercise regularly; make learners explain their reasoning, not just pick a column.

K.3 Thinking one channel does the whole job

Symptoms: Learner maps a journey with only one channel (e.g., "she sees an Instagram post and buys"). **Likely cause:** The learner has not yet internalised that real customers move across channels. **How to investigate:** Ask: "If that channel disappeared tomorrow, would the customer still find the business?" **Corrective steps:** Re-draw the worked example journey (Chinedu) and point out every channel change. Ask the learner to add a second channel to each step of their own journey. **How to confirm resolved:** Learner's journey includes at least three different channels. **Prevention:** In every example you give, use at least three channels. Never tell a story with only one.

K.4 Ignoring the retention stage

Symptoms: Learner's funnel has an empty Retention column; their journey ends at the first purchase. **Likely cause:** The learner thinks marketing ends when the customer buys. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What happens after the customer buys? Do they ever hear from the business again?" **Corrective steps:** Explain that retention is cheaper than finding new customers. A repeat customer spends more, refers friends and gives reviews. Show Mama Nkechi's WhatsApp broadcast example. **How to confirm resolved:** Learner's journey includes at least one post-purchase step. **Prevention:** In every journey you build together, always ask: "What happens next week? Next month?"

K.5 Mapping an unrealistic journey

Symptoms: Learner's journey includes TV ads, billboards, radio or a website she cannot afford. **Likely cause:** The learner is not yet thinking about what a small business can realistically do. **How to investigate:** Ask: "How much does that cost? Can Mama Nkechi afford that? What free tools could she use instead?" **Corrective steps:** Remind learners of the "no paid subscription" rule and the realistic toolset: smartphone, free Google tools, free Canva, free WhatsApp Business. **How to confirm resolved:** Every step in the learner's journey uses a free or already-owned tool. **Prevention:** At the start of every journey exercise, remind learners: "Small business. Phone only. No budget for ads yet."

K.6 Thinking the funnel is about tricking people

Symptoms: Learner says "the funnel is how you manipulate people into buying." **Likely cause:** The learner has heard "funnel" used in a pushy, salesy context. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Is pushing a sale to someone who has never heard of you persuasive or just annoying?" **Corrective steps:** Re-explain: the funnel is about understanding where the customer is and giving them the right information at each stage. Pushing too early drives people away. Building trust at the right pace is what works. **How to confirm resolved:** Learner explains the funnel as a way to help the customer decide, not force them. **Prevention:** Always pair the funnel explanation with the dating analogy â€" it keeps the tone right.

K.7 Forgetting that channels must connect

Symptoms: Learner's journey has steps that do not lead to each other (e.g., Instagram post â†' nothing â†' website â†' nothing â†' sale). **Likely cause:** The learner has not drawn the arrows between steps. **How to investigate:** Ask: "How does the customer get from step 1 to step 2? What makes them take that next action?" **Corrective steps:** Have the learner add arrows between every step and label what drives the transition (e.g., "the bio says 'order on WhatsApp' â†' customer taps the link"). **How to confirm resolved:** Every step in the journey has an arrow to the next, with a reason. **Prevention:** In every journey you build on the board, always draw the arrows and say what drives each transition.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it (e.g., the learner can point to the exact step where the journey breaks). Teach learners to confirm before concluding â€" ask them to show you the step, not just say "it is wrong."

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "Channel and Funnel Map â€" Mama Nkechi's Kitchen"

Purpose: To practise classifying real-world tactics to the correct funnel stage, and to build a complete customer journey map with channels working together â€" the foundation of the capstone's "how the channels work together" reasoning.

Realistic scenario. You are the digital marketing consultant for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen (the running example). She has asked you to prepare a one-page plan showing: (1) what marketing tactics to use at each funnel stage, and (2) how a typical customer will move from first hearing about her to becoming a regular customer. She will use this plan to decide where to spend her time and effort over the next month.

Detailed instructions:

1. On a fresh sheet (or your workbook), draw a table with four columns: Awareness, Consideration, Conversion, Retention.
2. List **at least three** marketing tactics for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen in each column. Each tactic must be realistic for a small kitchen â€" think phone, free tools, social media, WhatsApp, Google Business Profile.
3. Draw a customer journey table with at least **6 steps** for a named customer of Mama Nkechi's Kitchen. You may use Chinedu (the GRA professional) or create your own. For each step, write: what the customer sees, what they think, what they do, and where it happens (the channel).
4. For each step in the journey, label which funnel stage it belongs to (Awareness, Consideration, Conversion or Retention).
5. Draw arrows between the steps to show the journey. Label each arrow with what drives the customer to the next step (e.g., "the Instagram bio says 'order on WhatsApp'").
6. Circle the weakest step in the journey and write one sentence explaining what Mama Nkechi should fix first.
7. Write a short paragraph (3â€"4 sentences) at the end: "The channels work together becauseâ€¦" â€" explain, in your own words, why no single channel does the whole job.

Required deliverables:

- A completed funnel table with at least 3 tactics per stage (12 total).
- A completed customer journey table with at least 6 steps.
- Arrows and labels connecting the journey steps.
- Weakest link circled with a reason.
- The "channels work together" paragraph.

Submission format: Handwritten or typed, submitted at the start of Session 2. Keep a copy in your working folder (`CEA-DM-FirstnameLastname`).

Deadline: Before Session 2.

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Funnel table complete	6	At least 3 realistic tactics per stage (12 total), all correctly classified
Journey table complete	5	At least 6 steps, each with see / think / do / where
Funnel stages labelled	3	Each journey step correctly labelled with its funnel stage
Channels connected	3	Arrows between steps with reasons; at least 3 different channels used

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Weakest link & reasoning	2	Clearly identified with a sensible fix
"Channels work together" paragraph	1	Clear, in own words, shows understanding

Common mistakes to avoid: putting tactics in the wrong funnel stage; using only one channel in the journey; ending the journey at the first purchase (no retention); using unrealistic channels (TV, radio, billboard); not labelling funnel stages; not drawing arrows between steps.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

Funnel table â€" Mama Nkechi's Kitchen:

Awareness	Consideration	Conversion	Retention
Instagram reel of jollof cooking (3x/week)	Google Business Profile with photos and reviews	WhatsApp message ordering with clear prices	Weekly WhatsApp broadcast with new menu
Google listing appears for "food near me"	Website with full menu, prices, delivery areas	Fast WhatsApp reply with "your order is confirmed"	Follow-up message after delivery: "How was the food?"
Friend shares the Instagram page	Customer reads reviews and checks photos	Payment via transfer or on delivery	Special offer for repeat customers: "Order 3 times, get a free drink"
TikTok video of small chops packaging	Customer asks on WhatsApp "do you deliver to GRA?"	Customer pays and receives the food	Monthly customer appreciation message with a new recipe

Customer journey â€" Chinedu (28, GRA):

Step	See	Think	Do	Where	Stage
1	Friend's Instagram story of jollof	"That looks good"	Watches, taps to see page	Instagram	Awareness
2	Instagram profile	"Is this real?"	Searches the name	Google Search	Awareness
3	Google Business Profile â€" 4.2 stars, reviews	"Good reviews. Trust it."	Opens website link	Google Business Profile	Consideration
4	Website â€" menu, prices, delivery areas	"â‚¦1,500. Fair."	Taps WhatsApp button	Website	Consideration
5	WhatsApp chat â€" fast reply, clear price	"Good service."	Sends order, pays on delivery	WhatsApp	Conversion
6	Food arrives â€" hot, well packaged	"I will remember this"	Eats, saves the number	In person	Conversion
7	WhatsApp broadcast 2 weeks later	"New soup? Let me try"	Replies, orders again	WhatsApp	Retention

Weakest link: Step 3 â€" if Mama Nkechi has no Google Business Profile, Chinedu searches, finds nothing, and orders from a competitor. Fix: set up a complete Google Business Profile with photos, correct address, opening hours and reviews.

"Channels work together" paragraph (model):

> *"The channels work together because no single channel does the whole job. Instagram gets Chinedu curious, but if there is no Google Business Profile he cannot find her when he searches. The website shows the menu, but if there is no WhatsApp button he cannot order easily. WhatsApp closes the sale, but if there is no follow-up broadcast he forgets and orders elsewhere next time. Each channel is a link in the chain â€" if one link is missing, the customer falls out of the journey.*

Mama Nkechi must build all the links: Instagram for awareness, Google Business Profile and website for consideration, WhatsApp for conversion and retention."

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. In your own words, what is digital marketing? Give one example of how a small business in Port Harcourt might use it.

Q2. Multiple choice. Which of these is NOT one of the eight main digital marketing channels? a) Social media b) Television c) Email d) WhatsApp

Q3. Match the funnel stage. Match each situation to the correct funnel stage (Awareness, Consideration, Conversion, Retention). a) A customer sees an Instagram reel of jollof rice for the first time. b) A customer reads reviews on a Google Business Profile. c) A customer sends a WhatsApp message and pays for an order. d) A customer receives a WhatsApp broadcast two weeks later and orders again.

Q4. Explain in your own words. Why do channels need to work together? What happens if one channel is missing from the chain?

Q5. Scenario. A tailor in Port Harcourt has a Facebook page with 500 followers but no Google Business Profile and no website. A customer sees his Facebook post, wants to order, but cannot find his phone number or location. Which funnel stage has failed, and what should the tailor fix first?

Q6. Ethics. Your friend asks you to write a fake 5-star Google review for her salon to help it rank higher. What do you say, and why?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q6)

A1. Digital marketing is how a business finds people, talks to them and wins their custom using the internet and digital tools â€" phones, websites, social media, search engines, email and messaging apps. Example: a Port Harcourt kitchen posts photos of its food on Instagram, appears on Google when people search "food near me", and takes orders on WhatsApp. (Accept any answer that covers reaching customers online and one realistic example.)

A2. (b) Television. Television is a traditional/ offline channel, not one of the eight digital channels taught in this session.

A3. a) Awareness â€" the customer is just discovering the business. b) Consideration â€" the customer has found the business and is deciding whether to trust it. c) Conversion â€" the customer takes action and pays. d) Retention â€" the customer has bought before and is coming back.

A4. Channels need to work together because no single channel does the whole job. A customer might discover a business on Instagram, check its Google Business Profile, visit its website and order on WhatsApp â€" if any link is missing, the journey breaks and the sale is lost. For example, if there is no Google Business Profile, a customer who searches for the business cannot find it and orders from a competitor. (Accept any answer that explains the chain and gives a realistic consequence.)

A5. The consideration stage has failed â€" the customer found the business (awareness) but cannot complete the next step because there is no contact information, location or reviews to build trust. The tailor should fix this first by setting up a Google Business Profile with his shop name, address, phone number, photos and opening hours, and by adding a clear "order on WhatsApp" link to his Facebook page. (Accept any answer that identifies the broken link and gives a realistic fix.)

A6. I would say no. Fake reviews are dishonest â€" they mislead real customers who are trying to make a decision, and they break the academy's ethics rules. I would suggest instead that she asks real customers to leave honest reviews, which builds real trust and actually helps her ranking over time. (Accept any answer that refuses the request and explains why, ideally referencing honesty or the ethics rules.)

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned the map of digital marketing. You learned that digital marketing is how a business finds people, talks to them and wins their custom using the internet and digital tools â€" phones, websites, social media, search engines, email and messaging apps. You met the eight main channels: website, search, social media, content, email, WhatsApp, paid ads and Google Business Profile â€" and you learned to pick the two or three that match where your customers actually are, rather than trying to be everywhere at once. You learned the marketing funnel: Awareness (they discover you), Consideration (they check you out), Conversion (they buy), Retention (they come back) â€" and why you must match your message to the stage. You learned to map a customer journey: the specific path one customer takes, channel by channel, from first hearing about you to becoming a repeat buyer. And you learned the most important idea of all: **channels work together.** No single channel does the whole job â€" you must build a chain, and every link must be strong. Finally, you learned that ethics come first: honest claims, real reviews, earned growth, asked permission, protected data â€" always.

Five important takeaways:

1. Digital marketing is how a business reaches customers online â€" and everyone with a phone is already part of it.
2. There are eight main channels; pick the two or three that match your customers, not all eight.
3. The funnel has four stages â€" Awareness, Consideration, Conversion, Retention â€" and your message must match the stage.
4. The customer journey is the real path a customer takes; map it to find the weak links.
5. Channels work together â€" build the chain, and never skip ethics.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I name the eight digital marketing channels and explain what each one does?
- Can I sort a marketing tactic into the correct funnel stage and explain why?
- Can I map a customer journey with at least five steps, each with a channel?
- Can I explain why channels need to work together, using a real example?
- Can I state the academy's ethics rules in my own words?

Connection to the next session. You now have the map â€" the channels, the funnel and the journey. But there is one thing missing: **who is the customer?** A funnel and a journey are only as good as the person they describe. Next session we build a **customer avatar** â€" a detailed picture of one specific customer, with their goals, pains, objections and favourite platforms â€" so that every tactic, message and journey we build is aimed at a real person, not at "everybody." Because marketing to everyone, as you will learn, is marketing to nobody.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner names at least six of the eight channels correctly and explains what each does, without reading from the board.
- Learner correctly sorts a new tactic (one not used in class) into the right funnel stage and explains the reasoning.
- Learner builds a customer journey with at least five steps, using at least three different channels, and can point to the weakest link.
- Learner explains, in their own words, why channels must work together â€" not just repeats the phrase.
- Learner applies the ethics rules correctly in discussion (e.g., refuses a fake review, questions a bought-follower suggestion).
- Learner's assignment journey is realistic for a small business â€" no TV ads, no billboards, no unaffordable tools.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "Digital marketing is social media." â†' No â€" social media is one of eight channels; Google, WhatsApp, email and more are equally important.
- "The funnel is about pushing people to buy." â†' No â€" the funnel is about matching the message to the customer's stage; pushing too early drives them away.
- "More channels = better." â†' No â€" pick two or three that match your customers and do them well. Spreading thin across eight channels is how businesses fail.
- "The customer journey is the same for everyone." â†' No â€" different customers have different journeys; that is why we build an avatar (Session 2) first.
- "Fake followers and reviews are a shortcut." â†' No â€" they are fraud, they distort data and they destroy trust. Real growth is earned.

- "Marketing ends when the customer buys." â†' No â€" retention is where the profit is; a repeat customer is cheaper than a new one.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Channel naming drill:** Show a screenshot of a business's Instagram page, Google listing and website. Ask the learner to name which channel each one is and what job it does.
2. **Funnel sorting drill:** Give five new tactic cards (not used in class) and ask the learner to sort them and explain each choice.
3. **Journey building drill:** Give the learner a started journey (first two steps) and ask them to add three more steps, naming the channel for each.
4. **Weakest link drill:** Give the learner a completed journey and ask them to circle the weakest step and suggest a fix.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** Provide a partially completed funnel table (three tactics already placed per stage) and ask the learner to add one more per stage. Provide a journey template with the first three steps filled in; the learner adds three more.
- **Level 2 (standard):** The session as written â€" full funnel sort and journey build for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen, plus the independent exercise for Blessing's salon.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** Ask the learner to build *two* different customer journeys for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen â€" one for a young professional (Chinedu) and one for a student with a smaller budget â€" and explain how the journeys differ and why the marketing should differ. Then ask them to identify which funnel stage is most important for each customer type and why.

Timing guidance. The priority is the funnel sort (Section G.2) and the guided journey build (Section H) â€" these are the core skills. If the room is slow, shorten the lecture (combine F.2 and F.3) and reduce the case study (Section J) to a 5-minute discussion. Protect the practical time â€" a learner who leaves without a completed funnel map and journey has no foundation for the rest of the course. If the room is fast, let learners present their journeys to the class and discuss the differences.

Capstone link. The funnel map and journey map built today become the "how the channels work together" reasoning in the capstone's channel plan section. The weakest link identified today points to the first priority in the capstone's action plan. Keep the worksheet safe â€" it will be referenced in Session 3 (online presence), Session 4 (content) and Session 9 (capstone assembly).

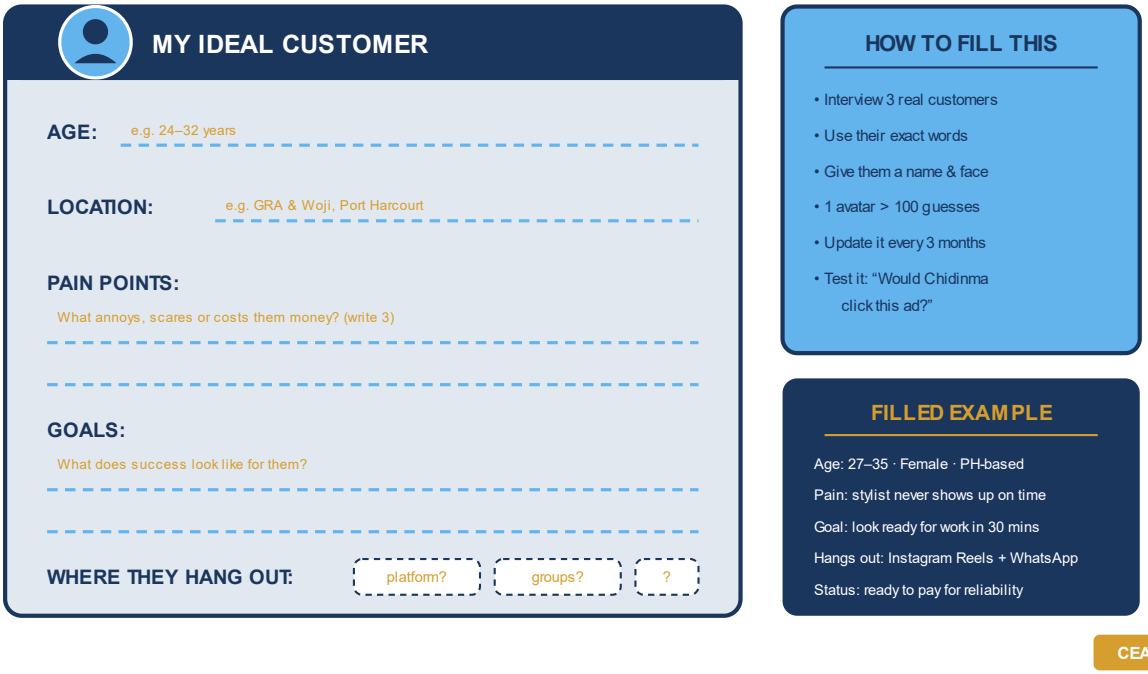
END OF SESSION 1

Next: Session 2 â€" Understanding the Customer and Positioning.

SESSION 02 OF 9

Customer and Positioning

CONCEPT DIAGRAM — SESSION 02



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" DIGITAL MARKETING

SESSION 2 â€" UNDERSTANDING THE CUSTOMER AND POSITIONING

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	2 of 9
Session title	Understanding the Customer and Positioning
Week / Module	Week 1 â€" Module 1: Foundations
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (thinking and writing, not software)
Prerequisite knowledge	Session 1 â€" Digital Marketing Foundations. Learners must be able to describe the four funnel stages and name at least four channels. No prior marketing, writing or design

Item	Detail
	knowledge required.
Connection to previous work	In Session 1 we built the map â€" channels, funnel, customer journey â€" and we met Mama Nkechi's Kitchen. We mapped Chinedu's journey from Instagram to repeat WhatsApp orders. But we mapped it for *one imagined person*. Today we go deeper: we build a proper **customer avatar** (a detailed picture of one specific customer), learn why marketing to "everybody" fails, write a **value proposition**, and practise **messaging** that names a real pain and answers it.
Preparation before class	Print the Customer Avatar Worksheet (Section H) per learner and the "So What?" Challenge Cards (Section G) â€" one set per pair. Prepare a projector slide showing a weak and a strong value proposition side by side. Print the Paired Pitch Feedback Form (Section H). Have the Session 1 funnel and journey maps available for reference. Prepare one real learner example (with permission) or a fictional one for the live avatar-building demo.

Instructor note on tone: This session is about empathy and precision. Many learners have never been asked to think this carefully about *one specific customer*. Resist the urge to rush â€" the avatar work feels slow at first, but it is the skill that separates thoughtful marketers from people who just post randomly. Keep the room supportive; learners will share real business ideas and personal details.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Explain** why marketing to "everybody" is marketing to nobody, using at least one concrete example from their own experience as a customer.
2. **Build a complete customer avatar** for a named individual â€" including demographics (age, location, income), goals, pains, objections and preferred platforms â€" with at least two specific details in each category.
3. **Write a one-sentence value proposition** that states who the business is for, what it gives them and why it is different, using the formula: *For [who], we [do what] so that [benefit], unlike [alternative]*.
4. **List three common customer objections** for a given business and write one honest counter-message for each.
5. **Write three messaging lines** aimed at a named pain, each following the formula: *We understand [pain]. That is why we [solution]. [Proof or differentiator]*.
6. **Defend a positioning choice** by explaining, in plain language, why the business should target one specific customer type first rather than trying to serve everyone.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner (with a notes app) or an academy computer with Google Docs.
- Instructor computer connected to a projector.
- Whiteboard or flip chart.

Software

- Phone Notes, Google Docs, Microsoft Word, or paper and pen. No special software needed.

Sample files

- **Customer Avatar Worksheet** (Section H) â€" one per learner.
- **"So What?" Challenge Cards** (Section G) â€" a set of 10 cards, each with a vague marketing claim (e.g., "We sell quality food", "Best service in Port Harcourt").
- **Paired Pitch Feedback Form** (Section H) â€" one per pair.
- **Weak vs. Strong Value Proposition Slide** â€" projector-ready.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 2.1 â€" "Customer Avatar Builder" (the avatar worksheet above).
- Worksheet 2.2 â€" "Objection and Counter" table (objection / why they feel this / honest counter-message).

Accounts

- None required this session.

Internet

- Not required. The session works fully offline with printed materials.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- Any phone with a notes app works. A learner who cannot type quickly may write by hand or dictate to a classmate. The skill is the *thinking about the customer*, not the typing.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show two slides. Slide 1: a vague advertisement.

> *"QUALITY FOOD! BEST SERVICE! AFFORDABLE PRICES! Call Mama Nkechi's Kitchen today!"*

Slide 2: a specific, customer-focused message.

> *"Too tired to cook after work? Mama Nkechi's Kitchen delivers hot jollof and small chops to GRA in 45 minutes. Order on WhatsApp by 6pm. â‚¦1,500 a plate."*

What the instructor says:

> *"Two adverts for the same kitchen. Hands up â€" which one would make you stop and read? â€¦ The second one, almost every time. Now â€" why? What is the difference?"*

Expected learner response: Learners will say things like "it says who it is for", "it mentions a problem", "it gives a price", "it tells you what to do", "the first one says nothing". Accept all answers and draw out the three key differences:

1. The first ad talks about the business ("quality food, best service"). The second talks about the **customer's problem** ("too tired to cook").
2. The first ad uses vague words ("quality", "best", "affordable"). The second uses **specifics** ("hot jollof", "45 minutes", "â‚¦1,500").
3. The first ad gives no clear action. The second tells you **exactly what to do** ("Order on WhatsApp by 6pm").

Then reveal the lesson:

> *"The first advert is marketing to everybody â€" it says nothing to anyone. The second advert is marketing to one person â€" a busy professional in GRA who is tired at 6pm and wants food fast. Today you learn to think like the second advert. You learn to know your customer so well that your message feels like it was written just for them. Because the best marketing does."*

Why this opener works: It shows, in 30 seconds, the difference between vague marketing and customer-focused marketing â€" before any theory. Learners recognise the pattern instantly because they see vague ads like the first one every day on social media.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "What are the four funnel stages, in order?"

- Expected answer: Awareness, Consideration, Conversion, Retention.
- Common gap: learners mix up the order. Have them say it as a story: "First they discover you, then they check you out, then they buy, then they come back."

Question 2: "In Session 1, we mapped Chinedu's journey for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen. Name three channels his journey passed through."

- Expected answer: Instagram, Google Search, Google Business Profile, website, WhatsApp â€" any three.
- Common gap: learners remember only the first and last step. Prompt: "What did he check *between* seeing the post and ordering?"

Question 3: "What is a channel, in one sentence?"

- Expected answer: A place or method a business uses to reach customers (social media, Google, WhatsApp, email, etc.).
- Common gap: Some learners still say "Instagram is a channel" as if that is the definition. Clarify: "Instagram is *one* channel. A channel is *any* road between a business and a customer."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"Last session we built the map. Today we put a person on that map. Because right now, our funnel and journey are generic â€" they could be for any customer. But real customers are specific. A 28-year-old professional in GRA has different pains, different budgets and different habits from a student in Chobi or a mother of three in Rumuokwuta. If you do not know who you are talking to, your message will be vague â€" like that first advert. Today you learn to build a* ***customer avatar****: one specific, detailed picture of your most important customer. And you learn to write messages that speak to their pain, not to 'everybody'."*

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 Why marketing to everybody is marketing to nobody

The idea. Every business owner says "my customer is everybody." A food kitchen says "everybody eats." A salon says "everybody needs hair care." A phone repair shop says "everybody has a phone." This feels logical â€" but it is the single most common reason small businesses fail at marketing.

Why it fails â€" the three problems:

1. **Your message becomes vague.** If you are talking to everybody, you cannot name a specific pain. You end up with "quality food, best service" â€" words that mean nothing to anybody. A message for everyone is a message for no one.
2. **Your channels become scattered.** If your customer is "everybody," you will try to be on every channel, post every kind of content, and chase every trend. You will spread yourself so thin that nothing works well.
3. **Your money (when you have it) is wasted.** If you ever run paid ads and target "everybody," you will pay to show your ad to thousands of people who will never buy â€" and the algorithm will learn to show it to the wrong people.

The alternative â€" the focused approach:

> *"Pick one type of customer. Understand them better than anyone else. Build your message, your channels and your content around them. Win them first. Then, later, expand to a second type. This is not limiting yourself â€" this is being clear. A sharp message to the right person beats a loud message to the wrong person every time."*

Real-life comparison. Think of a fisherman. If he throws one big net into the ocean and pulls, he might catch a few fish â€" but also a lot of rubbish, and the fish he catches are random. If he instead studies where one specific type of fish swims, what it eats, and when it is active, he can place a hook exactly where that fish will find it. Both methods catch fish â€" but the focused fisherman catches *more of the fish he actually wants*, with less waste. Marketing is the same.

Worked example â€" Mama Nkechi's Kitchen, two possible avatars:

Who	28-year-old professional, works in GRA	19-year-old student, lives in Chobi
Income	â‚¦200,000+/month salary	â‚¦20,000/month allowance
Goal	Hot, tasty food delivered fast after work	Affordable food that fills me up
Pain	Too tired to cook; worried about hygiene of street food	Limited budget; needs value for money
Objection	"Is it clean? Will it arrive on time?"	"Can I afford it regularly?"
Platform	Instagram, Google Maps, WhatsApp	WhatsApp, Instagram, word of mouth
Price comfort	â‚¦2,000â€"â‚¦3,000 per order	â‚¦800â€"â‚¦1,200 per order

Say to the class:

> *"Look at these two customers. They are both real. They both buy food. But they are not the same. Chinedu wants speed and quality â€" he will pay more. Ada wants affordability â€" she will not. If Mama Nkechi writes one message for both, it will be too expensive for Ada and too cheap-seeming for Chinedu. She must pick one first. Today we help her pick â€" and build the avatar to match."*

Common misconception. "If I focus on one customer type, I will lose the others." No. A sharp message for one type *attracts* others who are similar. A clear brand for students also appeals to young professionals on a budget. A clear brand for professionals also appeals to anyone who values quality. Focus creates clarity, and clarity attracts â€" vagueness repels.

How a learner applies this today. For Mama Nkechi's Kitchen, choose *one* avatar to build today. In the assignment, you will build a second one. By the capstone, you will have two or three avatars and know which one to target first and why.

F.2 Building a customer avatar

The idea. A **customer avatar** (also called a buyer persona) is a detailed, fictional-but-realistic description of your ideal customer. It is not a real person â€" it is a *type* of person, built from observation, conversation and common sense. You give them a name, a life, specific pains and specific goals â€" so that when you write a post or a message, you know exactly who you are talking to.

Why it exists. Marketing without an avatar is like cooking for a guest you have never met â€" you guess what they like, and you usually guess wrong. An avatar lets you prepare a meal (a message) that your guest will actually love.

The six parts of a complete avatar:

Part 1 â€" Demographics (the basics). Age, gender, location, income level, education, job, family situation. These are the "surface" facts. They matter, but they are the *least* important part of the avatar â€" because two people with the same demographics can have completely different needs. A 30-year-old and a 50-year-old can both live in GRA, but one wants fast food after work and the other wants a catering service for parties.

Part 2 â€" Goals (what they want to achieve). What is this person trying to accomplish? For Chinedu: "Eat well without cooking or wasting time." For Ada: "Eat enough food to stay full on a small budget." Goals are about the *outcome* the customer wants â€" not about your product.

Part 3 â€" Pains (what is stopping them). What frustrates, worries or annoys them? This is the most important part of the avatar â€" because marketing works best when it names a real pain and offers a solution. For Chinedu: "Too tired to cook after work", "worried about food hygiene", "tired of the same old food." For Ada: "Food prices keep rising", "small portions at restaurants", "nothing filling near campus."

Part 4 â€" Objections (why they might not buy). Even if they have the pain and want the goal, they will hesitate. What holds them back? For Chinedu: "Is the kitchen clean?", "Will it arrive on time?", "Is it worth the price?" For Ada: "Can I afford this every week?", "Is the portion big enough?" Objections are the questions you must answer in your marketing â€" before the customer has to ask.

Part 5 â€" Platforms (where they spend time online). Which apps and websites does this person actually use? For Chinedu: Instagram (scrolls at lunch), Google Maps (searches "food near me"), WhatsApp (messages businesses). For Ada: WhatsApp (student groups), Instagram (follows food pages), word of mouth from friends. Platforms tell you *where* to reach them.

Part 6 â€" Messaging style (what tone and format they respond to). Does this person respond to formal or casual language? Quick videos or long captions? Emojis or no emojis? Chinedu responds to fast, clear, professional messages. Ada responds to fun, casual, relatable content with emojis and student-friendly language. The same business speaks differently to different avatars.

Worked example â€" complete avatar for Chinedu:

Part	Chinedu's details
Demographics	Male, 28, lives in GRA Phase 2, works at a bank, earns ~â,¦200,000/month, single, cooks rarely
Goals	Eat tasty, hot food quickly after work; feed well on weekends without stress
Pains	Too exhausted to cook after long workdays; distrusts street food hygiene; bored of the same meals; delivery apps are expensive
Objections	"Is the kitchen clean and licensed?", "Will it arrive within 45 minutes?", "Is â,¦2,000 per plate worth it compared to a restaurant?"
Platforms	Instagram (scrolls during lunch break), Google Maps (searches "jollof delivery GRA"), WhatsApp (orders directly)
Messaging style	Short, clear, professional; values speed and reliability; responds to specific times, prices and proof (reviews, photos)

Say to the class:

> *"Notice what makes this avatar useful. It is not just 'male, 28, GRA'. It is the pains, objections and platforms that matter most. Because now I can write a message: 'Too tired to cook after work? Mama Nkechi's delivers hot jollof to GRA in 45 minutes â€" order by 6pm on WhatsApp.' That message names his pain, answers his objection (speed), and tells him where to order (WhatsApp). That is what an avatar buys you â€" a message that fits like a glove."*

Common misconception. "An avatar is just a guess." No â€" it is an *informed hypothesis*. You build it from what you already know: conversations with real customers, comments on your posts, questions people ask, observations at your shop. Over time, you test and refine it. It is never perfect, but it is always better than "everybody."

How a learner builds an avatar. Start with one real customer you know well (or a realistic imagined one). Interview them if you can â€" or watch how they behave. Fill in all six parts. Be specific: not "likes good food" but "wants hot jollof after work, worries about hygiene, will pay â,¦2,000 for speed." Specificity is the whole point.

F.3 Pain points â€" the engine of good marketing

The idea. A **pain point** is a specific problem, frustration or fear that your customer experiences â€" that your product or service can solve. Marketing that names a pain point is marketing that resonates, because it shows the customer that you *understand* them.

Why pain points matter. People do not buy products â€" they buy *solutions to problems*. Nobody buys a drill because they want a drill; they buy it because they want a hole. Nobody buys jollof rice because they want rice; they buy it because they are tired, hungry and do not want to cook. Your job is to name the problem you solve â€" clearly, specifically and empathetically.

The three types of pain points:

1. **Functional pains** â€" something is not working or is too slow/expensive/hard. "Delivery apps take 90 minutes and charge â,¦1,500 delivery fee." "Cooking after work takes 2 hours."
2. **Emotional pains** â€" something makes them feel bad. "I feel guilty feeding my family food I am not sure is clean." "I feel stressed every evening wondering what to cook."
3. **Social pains** â€" something affects how others see them. "I cannot invite friends over because I have no time to cook a proper meal." "I feel embarrassed when colleagues ask me out for lunch and I cannot afford it."

Worked example â€" Mama Nkechi's Kitchen, pain points by avatar:

Avatar	Functional pain	Emotional pain	Social pain
Chinedu	Too tired to cook; delivery apps slow and expensive	Feels guilty about street food hygiene; stressed after work	Wants to host friends for football weekends without cooking all day
Ada	Restaurant portions too small for the price	Feels left out when friends order food she cannot afford	Wants to treat her roommate occasionally without breaking her budget

How to find your customer's pain points:

- **Ask them.** "What frustrates you about ordering food?" "What is the last thing you wish you could solve?"
- **Listen in comments.** Read the comments on your posts and competitors' posts. People volunteer their pains: "I wish someone delivered to my area", "Why is everything so expensive now?"
- **Observe behaviour.** If customers always ask the same question ("Do you deliver?"), that is a pain point. If they always hesitate at the price, that is an objection to address.
- **Check reviews of competitors.** Read 3-star reviews of similar businesses. The complaints in those reviews are your opportunity.

Common misconception. "Pain points are negative â€" should I avoid talking about problems?" No â€" naming a pain point is not being negative; it is being *relevant*. You name the problem so you can position your business as the solution. "Too tired to cook?" is not an insult â€" it is an empathetic observation that makes the customer feel seen. The key is to *always* pair the pain with the solution. Never leave the customer hanging on the problem.

F.4 Value propositions â€" what you give, to whom, why you are different

The idea. A **value proposition** is one clear sentence that says: *who* you serve, *what* you give them, and *why* you are different from the alternatives. It is the single most important sentence in your marketing â€" because if a customer cannot understand what you offer and why it matters in five seconds, they will scroll past.

Plain-English definition. A value proposition is your answer to the customer's silent question: *"Why should I choose you?"* â€" answered before they have to ask.

The formula:

> *For [who â€" the avatar], we [do what â€" the service], so that [benefit â€" the outcome they want], unlike [alternative â€" what they use today].*

Worked example â€" Mama Nkechi's Kitchen, value proposition for Chinedu:

> *For busy professionals in GRA, we deliver home-cooked jollof and small chops to your door in 45 minutes, so that you can eat well after work without cooking â€" unlike delivery apps that charge high fees and arrive cold.*

Break it down:

- **For busy professionals in GRA** â€" the avatar (who).
- **we deliver home-cooked jollof and small chops** â€" the service (what).
- **so that you can eat well after work without cooking** â€" the benefit (outcome).
- **unlike delivery apps that charge high fees and arrive cold** â€" the differentiator (why you are different).

Why each part matters:

- **The "for" part** makes it specific. "For everybody" is a value proposition for nobody.
- **The "we do" part** must be concrete. "We provide quality food" is vague. "We deliver home-cooked jollof in 45 minutes" is clear.
- **The "so that" part** is the *benefit*, not the feature. A feature is "delivery in 45 minutes." A benefit is "you can eat well after work without cooking." Customers buy benefits, not features.
- **The "unlike" part** is your edge. Why are you better than the alternative the customer already uses? If you cannot answer this, you do not have a positioning yet.

Weak vs. strong value propositions â€" compare:

Weak	Strong
"Quality food at affordable prices."	"For busy professionals in GRA, we deliver hot jollof in 45 minutes, so you can eat well after work without cooking â€" unlike delivery apps that charge â‚¦1,500 and arrive cold."
"We sell the best Ankara dresses in Port Harcourt."	"For young women who want stylish Ankara without tailor stress, we make ready-to-wear dresses that fit perfectly, so you look great at every event â€" unlike ordering from a tailor and waiting 3 weeks."
"Your number one salon in Port Harcourt."	"For working women in GRA who need a salon they trust, we do neat braids that last 3 weeks, so you look professional every day â€" unlike salons that rush and leave your hair damaged."

Say to the class:

> *"The weak ones are about the business. The strong ones are about the customer. The weak ones use empty words â€" 'quality', 'best', 'number one'. The strong ones are specific â€" they name the avatar, the service, the benefit and the difference. When you write your value proposition, test it: could this sentence only be about your business, or could any business say it? If any business could say it, it is not specific enough."*

Common misconception. "A value proposition is a slogan." A slogan is short and catchy ("Just Do It"). A value proposition is a clear, complete sentence that explains who you serve and why. You can *derive* a slogan from a value proposition, but they are not the same. For Mama Nkechi, the value proposition is the full sentence; the slogan might be "Hot jollof, at your door, fast."

How a learner writes a value proposition. Use the formula. Fill in each part. Read it aloud. Ask: "Does this make sense to the avatar? Would they say 'yes, that is for me'?" If not, refine it until it fits.

F.5 Objections â€" what holds customers back, and how to answer honestly

The idea. An **objection** is a reason a customer hesitates to buy. It is not a rejection â€" it is a question they have not yet had answered. If you can name your customer's objections and answer them *before* they have to ask, you remove the friction from buying.

The four most common objections for small businesses:

1. **"Is it worth the price?"** â€" The customer is not sure the value matches the cost. *Answer honestly:* Show what is included, what it compares to, and what the outcome is. "â‚¦2,000 for a full plate of jollof, small chops and a drink â€" that is less than the cost of cooking at home, and you save two hours."
2. **"Can I trust you?"** â€" The customer is not sure you are real, reliable or honest. *Answer honestly:* Show proof â€" reviews, photos, a real address, a real phone number, a real person. "We have been in GRA for two years â€" here are 30 real reviews from customers in your area."
3. **"What if it goes wrong?"** â€" The customer fears a bad experience â€" late delivery, wrong order, poor quality. *Answer honestly:* Show your guarantee and your process. "If your order arrives late or cold, we refund you or send a fresh one â€" no arguments."
4. **"Why you and not the alternative?"** â€" The customer is comparing you to someone else. *Answer honestly:* Show your difference â€" not by putting the competitor down, but by showing what *you* do well. "We cook fresh every morning â€" we do not reheat yesterday's food. That is why our jollof tastes different."

The golden rule of answering objections: be honest. Never lie to overcome an objection. If you cannot answer it honestly, fix the business instead of the message. A business that overcomes objections with truth earns trust. One that overcomes them with lies earns refunds and bad reviews.

Worked example â€" Mama Nkechi's Kitchen, objection table for Chinedu:

Objection	Why he feels this	Honest counter-message
"Is the kitchen clean?"	He has heard stories of dirty home kitchens	"We are licensed by the Rivers State Food Safety Agency â€" our kitchen is inspected monthly. Here are photos of our kitchen and our licence."

Objection	Why he feels this	Honest counter-message
"Will it arrive in 45 minutes?"	Delivery apps in PH often promise 30 minutes and take 90	"We cook in small batches so orders go out fast. If we are ever late, we tell you before you pay â€" and you can cancel for a full refund."
"Is â‚¦2,000 worth it?"	He compares it to cooking at home (~â‚¦800)	"â‚¦2,000 buys you a full plate, a drink, delivery, and two hours of your evening back. If you cooked at home, you would spend â‚¦800 on ingredients and 2 hours of your time â€" which is worth more?"

Say to the class:

> *"Notice that none of these answers are tricks. They are honest answers to real concerns. That is how you build trust. A business that says 'trust me, we are the best' is not trustworthy. A business that says 'here is our licence, here are our reviews, here is our refund policy' is trustworthy."*

F.6 Messaging that connects â€" naming the pain, offering the solution

The idea. A **messaging line** is a short piece of copy â€" a sentence or two â€" that speaks directly to one specific pain and offers your solution. It is the building block of every post, caption, WhatsApp message and advert. Good messaging is not clever wordplay â€" it is *clarity about the customer's problem and your answer to it.*

The messaging formula:

> *We understand [pain]. That is why we [solution]. [Proof or differentiator].*

Worked examples â€" Mama Nkechi's Kitchen, messaging lines for Chinedu's pains:

1. **Pain: "Too tired to cook after work."**

   > *"We know you are tired after a long day at work. That is why Mama Nkechi's Kitchen delivers hot jollof and small chops to your door in GRA â€" order by 6pm on WhatsApp and dinner is sorted."*

2. **Pain: "Worried about food hygiene."**

   > *"We understand you want to know your food is safe. Our kitchen is licensed and inspected monthly â€" and we post fresh photos of our cooking every morning on Instagram."*

3. **Pain: "Delivery apps are expensive."**

   > *"Why pay â‚¦1,500 delivery fee and arrive at your door cold? Mama Nkechi's delivers to GRA for free when you order two plates or more â€" hot, fresh, and no extra charges."*

What makes these messages work:

- They **name the pain** in the customer's own words ("tired after work", "worried about hygiene").
- They **offer a clear solution** (delivery in 45 minutes, licensed kitchen, free delivery).
- They **include proof or a differentiator** (licence, photos, free delivery for two plates).
- They are **specific** â€" no vague words like "quality" or "best".
- They are **honest** â€" every claim is verifiable.

How a learner writes messaging lines:

1. Pick one pain from the avatar.
2. Write: "We understand [pain]."
3. Write: "That is why we [what you do differently]."

4. Write: "[One piece of proof or difference]."
5. Read it aloud. Would the avatar say "yes, that is for me"? If yes, it works.

Common misconception. "Good marketing uses fancy words and clever slogans." No â€” good marketing uses *clear words that the customer actually thinks in*. If your customer says "I am tired of cooking", your message should say "tired of cooking" â€” not "exhausted from culinary endeavours." Speak like a person, not a brochure.

F.7 Positioning â€” choosing who to serve first and why

The idea. Positioning is the decision to place your business in the customer's mind as *the choice for a specific type of person with a specific problem*. It is not what you do to the product â€” it is what you do to the *idea* of the product in the customer's head.

Why positioning matters. A food kitchen cannot be "the best food in Nigeria" â€” that is too big a claim and too broad a market. But it *can* be "the fastest home-cooked meal delivery for busy professionals in GRA" â€” that is a clear position that a specific group of customers will remember and choose.

The positioning decision for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen:

Option A: Position as **the affordable food kitchen for students** (â‚¦800â€“â‚¦1,200, large portions, Chobi area). Option B: Position as **the fast, quality meal delivery for busy professionals** (â‚¦2,000â€“â‚¦3,000, 45-minute delivery, GRA area). Option C: Position as **the party and event caterer** (large orders, bookings, events across Port Harcourt).

The recommendation (say this to the class):

> *"Option B â€” the fast, quality meal delivery for busy professionals â€” is the strongest starting position for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen. Why? Three reasons. First, the avatar (Chinedu) has money to spend â€” professionals earn more than students. Second, the pain is strong and frequent â€” every working professional faces the 'what for dinner' problem, not just students during exam season. Third, the differentiator is real â€” free delivery for two plates and a 45-minute promise is something delivery apps cannot match. Start with Option B, win that market, and then expand to Option C (events) later using the same reputation."*

How a learner makes a positioning decision:

1. List your possible customer types (avatars).
2. For each, ask: How strong is their pain? How often do they buy? Can they afford your price? Do you have a real differentiator for them?
3. Pick the avatar with the strongest combination of pain, frequency, budget and difference.
4. Write your value proposition and messaging for *that* avatar first.
5. Later, build a second avatar and expand â€” but never at the same time. One position, one message, one channel focus â€” then grow.

Common misconception. "Positioning means I can never serve other customers." No â€” positioning is about *focus*, not exclusion. Mama Nkechi can still sell to a student who walks in off the street. But her *marketing* â€” her posts, her ads, her messaging â€” will target professionals first, because that is where the strongest opportunity is. Focus your marketing, not your doors.

F.8 Summary of the lecture

- Marketing to everybody is marketing to nobody â€” focus on one avatar first.
- A complete avatar has six parts: demographics, goals, pains, objections, platforms, messaging style.
- Pain points are the engine of good marketing â€” name them specifically and offer the solution.
- A value proposition states who you serve, what you give, and why you are different â€” in one clear sentence.
- Objections are unasked questions â€” answer them honestly with proof, not tricks.
- Messaging names the pain, offers the solution, and includes proof.
- Positioning is choosing who to serve first â€” and why â€” based on pain, budget and differentiator.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Who?] --> B[Age, location, job]
    A --> C[Pain points]
    A --> D[Goals]
    A --> E[Where they hang out online]
    B --> F[Your message]
    C --> F
    D --> F
    E --> F
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- On the projector: a blank Customer Avatar Worksheet.
- The "So What?" Challenge Cards (10 cards with vague claims).
- A notes document open for live writing.
- The weak vs. strong value proposition slide.

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€" dissect a vague claim with "So What?" (4 minutes)

Say: "I have a card here that says 'We sell quality food.' Let us test it. When I read a claim, I ask one question: *So what?*"

Write on the board:

> *"We sell quality food." â†' **So what?** â†' "The food is good." â†' **So what?** â†' "You will like it." â†' **So what?** â†' "You will buy it." â†' **So what?** â†' (silence)*

Say:

> *"See what happened? The claim sounds meaningful, but when you keep asking 'so what?', it falls apart. 'Quality food' does not tell me who it is for, what makes it quality, or why I should care. It is a claim that any kitchen in Nigeria could make. Now let me show you what happens when we make it specific."*

Write the improved version on the board:

> *"For busy professionals in GRA, we deliver hot jollof and small chops to your door in 45 minutes â€" order by 6pm on WhatsApp and dinner is sorted."*

Ask: "Now â€" so what?" (Pause.) "Now there is an answer. So what â€" you get hot food fast after work without cooking. So what â€" you save two hours and eat well. So what â€" you will order tonight because you are already tired. The specificity *is* the persuasion."

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€" build an avatar live (5 minutes)

Say: "Let us build a proper avatar together. I will use Mama Nkechi's Kitchen and the avatar Ada â€" the student in Chobi."

Fill the avatar worksheet on the projector, narrating each decision:

Part	Ada's details
Demographics	Female, 19, student at University of Port Harcourt, lives in Chobi, monthly allowance ~â‚¦20,000, shares a room with one roommate
Goals	Eat enough food to stay full; save money for other needs; occasionally treat her roommate
Pains	Restaurant portions are small and expensive; she is tired of the same food; she cannot cook well in the shared kitchen; she feels left out when friends order food she cannot afford

Part	Ada's details
Objections	"Can I afford this every week?", "Is the portion big enough?", "Is it worth skipping a cooked meal at the canteen?"
Platforms	WhatsApp (student groups, forwards), Instagram (follows food pages and campus influencers), word of mouth from friends
Messaging style	Casual, fun, uses emojis; responds to student-friendly language, prices in naira, and content that feels relatable (not corporate)

After filling it, say:

> *"Look at this avatar. She is not 'everybody'. She is not even 'all students' â€" she is a specific 19-year-old with â‚¦20,000 a month, specific pains, specific objections and specific platforms. Now I can write a message that fits her perfectly. Watch."*

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€" write a value proposition and messaging lines live (4 minutes)

Say: "Using Ada's avatar, let me write a value proposition and two messaging lines."

Write on the projector:

Value proposition for Ada:

> *For students in Chobi who want filling meals without cooking, we sell large-portion jollof and small chops at canteen prices, so you can eat well on a student budget â€" unlike campus restaurants that charge double for half the food.*

Messaging line 1 (pain: small portions):

> *"Tired of paying â‚¦1,500 for food that leaves you hungry an hour later? Mama Nkechi's jollof plate is big enough to fill you up â€" â‚¦1,200, with small chops included. Order on WhatsApp."*

Messaging line 2 (pain: FOMO when friends order):

> *"When your friends are ordering food and you are counting coins â€" we get it. That is why our student plate is â‚¦1,200 and feeds you properly. Treat yourself without guilt. WhatsApp us."*

Say:

> *"Notice â€" these messages are different from the ones I wrote for Chinedu. Same kitchen, same food, different avatar â€" different words, different price point, different tone. That is the power of an avatar. You are not changing the business; you are changing how you speak to each customer."*

G.5 Demonstration 4 â€" the "So What?" challenge (2 minutes)

Say: "One last thing. Let us practise together. I will read a vague claim â€" you shout 'So what?' and then tell me how to make it specific."

Read three cards from the Challenge set:

1. "We sell quality food." â†' Class: "So what?" â†' Ask: "How would you make this specific for Ada?"
2. "Best service in Port Harcourt." â†' Class: "So what?" â†' Ask: "Best service *for whom*, *doing what*?"
3. "Affordable prices." â†' Class: "So what?" â†' Ask: "Affordable *compared to what*? *How much* exactly?"

Expected result: Learners begin to naturally ask "so what?" and suggest specifics â€" names, prices, times, places. Praise specific suggestions. The goal is to make "so what?" a reflex.

G.6 Questions to ask during the demo

- "What is wrong with 'we sell quality food'?" (It is vague â€" no avatar, no specifics.)
- "Why do we build an avatar before writing a message?" (So the message fits a real person's pains and words.)
- "What makes a value proposition strong?" (Specific avatar, concrete service, clear benefit, honest difference.)
- "How do you answer an objection honestly?" (With proof â€" reviews, licence, policy â€" not with tricks.)
- "Why are the messages for Ada different from the messages for Chinedu?" (Different avatar â€" different price, tone, pain, platform.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding, each learner builds a complete customer avatar for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen (or their own approved business), writes a value proposition, and drafts three messaging lines for that avatar's pains.

Starting materials: The Customer Avatar Worksheet (printed), the Objection and Counter table, a pen.

Procedure (instructor calls out each step; learners follow; instructor walks the room):

1. Choose your avatar for today. You may use Ada (the student) or create your own (e.g., "Mama Nkechi's party customer, Mrs. Okonkwo" or a customer for your own business). Write their name and one-line description at the top of the worksheet.
2. Fill in the **Demographics** row â€" age, location, income, job, family situation. Be specific. If you are building for your own business, think of a real customer you know.
3. Fill in the **Goals** row â€" what is this person trying to achieve? Write at least two goals.
4. Fill in the **Pains** row â€" what frustrates or worries them? Write at least three pains. Be specific â€" not "likes good food" but "tired of small restaurant portions."
5. Fill in the **Objections** row â€" what might stop them from buying? Write at least three objections.
6. Fill in the **Platforms** row â€" where does this person spend time online? Name at least two apps.
7. Fill in the **Messaging style** row â€" what tone and format do they respond to?
8. **Pause and predict:** Cover the worksheet with your hand. Can you describe this person in two sentences without looking? If not, go back and add more specific details.
9. Write a **value proposition** for this avatar using the formula: *For [who], we [do what] so that [benefit], unlike [alternative].*
10. Write **three messaging lines** for three different pains from your avatar. Use the formula: *We understand [pain]. That is why we [solution]. [Proof].*
11. **Pause and predict:** Read each messaging line aloud. Would your avatar say "yes, that is for me"? If not, refine it.
12. Swap worksheets with a partner. Read their avatar and messaging. Give one piece of feedback: "The strongest part is _____ because _____. One thing to make more specific is _____."

Expected result (model answer â€" instructor key):

A completed worksheet with all six avatar parts filled with specific details, a value proposition, and three messaging lines â€" all tailored to the chosen avatar â€" plus partner feedback.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 5: "Are your avatar's objections the *real* reasons someone would hesitate â€" or are they your guesses? If you are guessing, what could you do to find out?" (Answer: ask a real customer, read competitor reviews.)
- After step 9: "Does your value proposition mention a specific alternative? If not, add 'unlike _____'."
- After step 11: "Read your messaging line to your partner. Does it sound like it was written for a real person â€" or like a poster on a wall?"

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Avatar demographics are vague ("lives in Port Harcourt") â†' "Which part? What is their monthly income? What do they do every day?"
- Pains are features, not pains ("the food is jollof") â†' "That is what you sell. What *problem* does the customer have that jollof solves?"
- Objections are missing â†' "If you were this person, what would make you hesitate? Price? Trust? Time?"
- Value proposition is a slogan ("Hot jollof, fast!") â†' "That is a slogan. A value proposition answers: who, what, benefit, unlike what."

- Messaging lines are all the same â†' "You have three different pains â€" make each message name a *different* pain and offer a *different* solution."
- Learner uses vague words ("quality", "best", "affordable") â†' Ask "so what?" and have them replace each vague word with a specific fact.

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Avatar has a name and one-line description
- ☐ All six parts completed with specific details
- ☐ At least 3 pains and 3 objections listed
- ☐ Value proposition uses the full formula (who / what / benefit / unlike)
- ☐ Three messaging lines, each naming a different pain
- ☐ Each messaging line includes a proof or differentiator
- ☐ Partner feedback received and one improvement made

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task (new task, done alone): You are a digital marketing consultant. A new client, *Chinedu's Phone Repairs* (a fictional phone repair shop in Port Harcourt that fixes screens, batteries and software issues), has asked for you to help him reach more customers. He has a Facebook page with 400 followers, posts rarely, and gets most customers from walk-ins near his shop in Trans-Amadi. He wants more bookings, especially from young professionals whose phones break during the workday.

Requirements:

1. Build a **complete customer avatar** for Chinedu's best potential customer â€" a young professional in Trans-Amadi or GRA. Fill in all six parts: demographics, goals, pains, objections, platforms, messaging style.
2. Write a **value proposition** for the phone repair shop using the full formula.
3. Write **three messaging lines** for three different pains of your avatar.
4. Write a short **positioning statement** (2â€"3 sentences): "Chinedu's Phone Repairs should position itself as _____ for _____, because _____." Explain why this is the strongest position.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- Avatar has all six parts with specific details (not vague).
- Value proposition uses the full formula and is specific.
- Three messaging lines each name a different pain and offer a solution with proof.
- Positioning statement explains *why* this position is the strongest.

Hints if stuck:

- Hint 1: Think about what a young professional needs when their phone breaks â€" speed? Trust? A warranty? Convenience?
- Hint 2: The value proposition should answer: why Chinedu, not the other repair shop down the street?
- Hint 3: Positioning is about choosing who to serve first â€" pick the customer with the strongest combination of pain, urgency and money.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

Customer avatar â€" "Kelechi, 26, bank worker in Trans-Amadi":

Part	Details
Demographics	Male, 26, works at a bank in Trans-Amadi, earns ~â‚¦180,000/month, lives alone, relies on phone for work and banking
Goals	Get phone fixed fast without losing data; avoid buying a new phone; trust the repairer not to steal data
Pains	Phone broke and he needs it for work NOW; worried repairers will steal his data; tired of repair shops that say "come back tomorrow"; has heard stories of phones coming back with new problems

Part	Details
Objections	"Will I get my phone back today?", "Can I trust them with my data?", "Is the repair guaranteed?", "Is it worth repairing vs buying new?"
Platforms	WhatsApp (messages repairers directly), Instagram (follows tech pages), Google Maps (searches "phone repair near me")
Messaging style	Direct, professional, wants clear timelines and prices; responds to proof (warranty, reviews, before/after photos)

Value proposition:

> *For young professionals in Trans-Amadi who need their phones fixed fast without losing data, we repair screens and batteries in 2 hours with a 30-day warranty, so you get back to work the same day â€" unlike other repair shops that keep your phone for 3 days and give no guarantee.*

Three messaging lines:

1. *"Screen broke at 9am and you have a meeting at 11? We fix cracked screens in 2 hours â€" walk in, wait with a free coffee, walk out with a working phone. 30-day warranty included."*
2. *"Worried a repair shop will steal your photos and bank details? We repair in front of you â€" you watch the whole process. No data leaves your phone, no secrets, no stress."*
3. *"Told to 'come back tomorrow' by your repairer? Same-day service is our promise. If we cannot fix it today, we tell you upfront â€" no wasted trips."*

Positioning statement:

> *"Chinedu's Phone Repairs should position itself as the fast, trusted same-day repair service for young professionals in Trans-Amadi, because this customer type has the strongest combination of urgency (they need their phone for work NOW), budget (they can afford â‚¦15,000â€"â‚¦30,000 repairs), and repeat potential (they will refer colleagues). This is stronger than positioning as the cheapest repair shop for students â€" students have less money and less urgency."*

Learner marking (out of 10):

- Avatar complete with specific details in all six parts (3)
- Value proposition uses full formula and is specific (2)
- Three messaging lines, each naming a different pain with proof (3)
- Positioning statement explains the "why" (2)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Ngozi* runs a small bakery in Port Harcourt â€" *Ngozi's Cakes* â€" specialising in custom birthday cakes, small chops and pastries. She has an Instagram page with 1,200 followers, posts beautiful photos of her cakes, and gets a few orders a month â€" mostly from people who already know her. She has no Google Business Profile, no website, no WhatsApp Business account, and no clear value proposition. Her Instagram bio says: "Ngozi's Cakes ðŸŽ‚ Order your cakes and small chops." She wants more orders, especially for birthday cakes, which are her most profitable product (â‚¦8,000â€"â‚¦25,000 per cake).

Relevant facts.

- Ngozi's cakes are excellent â€" beautiful, tasty, and always delivered on time.
- Her Instagram photos are professional-looking, but her captions are vague: "Order now", "Call us", "Quality cakes."
- She does not appear when someone searches "birthday cakes Port Harcourt" on Google.
- She takes orders on her personal Instagram DM and personal WhatsApp â€" she has no system, no catalogue, no order form.
- A competitor, *Sweet Treats PH*, has a Google Business Profile with 4.9 stars and 40 reviews, a simple website with a cake catalogue and prices, and a WhatsApp Business account. Sweet Treats gets 10â€"15 cake orders a month from Google

searches alone.

- Ngozi's average customer is a woman aged 25â€“40 who needs a cake for a child's birthday, a wedding, or a corporate event. These customers typically search on Google, check reviews, compare prices, and order 1â€“2 weeks before the event.

Decision point. Ngozi has â‚¦10,000 to invest in marketing this month. She is considering three options:

1. Spend â‚¦10,000 on Instagram ads to promote her cake photos.
2. Spend â‚¦10,000 on a professional photoshoot to improve her Instagram content.
3. Spend â‚¦10,000 on printing flyers and distributing them near schools and churches.

What should she do?

Possible approaches.

1. **Run Instagram ads.** This would put her cake photos in front of more people â€” but if those people click and find a vague page with no prices, no reviews and no clear way to order, they will leave. The ads would drive traffic to a funnel with a broken bottom.
2. **Professional photoshoot.** Her photos are already good â€” this would improve them, but it does not solve the real problem. The issue is not the quality of her photos; it is that people cannot *find* her and cannot *trust* her easily.
3. **Print and distribute flyers.** Flyers can work for local businesses â€” but they are one-time, hard to measure, and most end up in the bin. â‚¦10,000 might buy 1,000 flyers and zero cake orders.

Recommended solution. None of the three. Ngozi's problem is not awareness or content quality â€” it is *positioning and presence*. Her cakes are beautiful and her photos are good, but she is invisible on Google, her Instagram page does not sell, and she has no way to build trust with strangers. The â‚¦10,000 is better used â€” or rather, mostly not used â€” to fix the foundation:

1. **Set up a Google Business Profile** (free). Add her bakery name, address, phone number, photos of her best cakes, opening hours, and start asking real customers to leave honest reviews. This makes her visible when people search "birthday cakes Port Harcourt" â€” the exact moment someone is planning an event and ready to spend â‚¦15,000.
2. **Rewrite her Instagram page** (free). New bio: "Custom birthday cakes & small chops in Port Harcourt ðŸŽ‚, Order 2 weeks ahead. Free delivery within PH. WhatsApp us for prices." Add prices to her posts, add a WhatsApp button, and post once a week with a clear call-to-action and a specific pain point.
3. **Switch to WhatsApp Business** (free). Set up a catalogue with her cake types and price ranges, create labels for "birthday cakes", "wedding cakes", "small chops", and send a follow-up after each order: "How was the cake? Leave us a review on Google â€” it helps other mums find us."
4. **Write a clear value proposition** (free): "For mums planning birthday parties in Port Harcourt, we make custom cakes that look stunning and taste better â€” delivered free to your event, ordered 2 weeks ahead, unlike bakeries that need 3 weeks and charge delivery fees."
5. **Only then, consider paid ads.** Once the Google listing is live, the Instagram page sells, the WhatsApp catalogue is ready and the value proposition is clear â€” a small paid campaign (â‚¦10,000 over two weeks) would work because the foundation is solid. People who click the ad will find a real business they can trust and order from.

Trade-offs.

- Option 1 (ads now): fast reach, but wasted money â€” the funnel is broken at the bottom. People click, find no prices or reviews, and leave.
- Option 2 (photoshoot): better photos, but the problem is not photos â€” it is discoverability and trust. Good photos help, but they do not fix a missing Google listing.
- Option 3 (flyers): cheap and local, but unmeasurable and unlikely to reach the specific customer type (mums planning parties) at the right moment (2 weeks before the event).
- Recommended (fix the foundation): free or nearly free, builds permanent assets (Google listing, WhatsApp catalogue, clear positioning), and makes any future spending work much better.

Professional connection. This is the same pattern we saw in Session 1 with Adaeze's Ankara shop â€” and it is the pattern you will see again and again as a digital marketing professional: **the foundation first, the spending second.** A consultant who immediately recommends ads without checking the avatar, value proposition, Google listing and ordering process is wasting the client's money. The work you did today â€” building an avatar, writing a value proposition, naming pains and objections â€” is exactly what you would do in your first week with a real client. This is not theory; this is the job.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the live guide. Point learners to the row rather than giving the answer.

K.1 Marketing to "everybody"

Symptoms: Avatar is "everyone who eats food" or "all phone users in Nigeria." Messages are generic. **Likely cause:** Fear of excluding potential customers. **How to investigate:** Ask: "If you showed your post to 10 different people, would all 10 feel it was written for them?" **Corrective steps:** Narrow to one specific avatar. Give them a name, an age, an income, a specific pain. Write the message for that one person. **How to confirm resolved:** Avatar has a name and specific details; message would not make sense for a different avatar. **Prevention:** At the start of every exercise, ask: "Who is this for? Name one person."

K.2 Vague words ("quality", "best", "affordable")

Symptoms: Messages use words that any business could say. No specifics. **Likely cause:** The learner has not asked "so what?" enough times. **How to investigate:** Ask: "So what? What specifically makes it quality? Best compared to whom? Affordable â€" how much exactly?" **Corrective steps:** Replace every vague word with a specific fact â€" a price, a time, a number, a place, a name. **How to confirm resolved:** Every claim can be verified or measured. **Prevention:** The "So What?" drill from the opening activity â€" use it whenever a vague word appears.

K.3 Avatar without pains and objections

Symptoms: Avatar has demographics but no real pains or objections. Messages are features, not benefits. **Likely cause:** The learner described the customer's surface, not their struggles. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What frustrates this person? What makes them hesitate?" **Corrective steps:** Interview a real customer or read competitor reviews. Find the complaints and fears â€" those are the pains and objections. **How to confirm resolved:** Avatar has at least 3 specific pains and 3 specific objections. **Prevention:** Always ask "what is stopping them?" after filling in demographics.

K.4 Value proposition is a slogan

Symptoms: "Hot jollof, fast!" or "Quality cakes, delivered." â€" catchy but incomplete. **Likely cause:** The learner confused a slogan with a value proposition. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Who is this for? What benefit does it give? Why is it different from the alternative?" **Corrective steps:** Use the full formula: For [who], we [do what] so that [benefit], unlike [alternative]. **How to confirm resolved:** The value proposition answers who, what, benefit and unlike â€" in one sentence. **Prevention:** Teach the difference: a slogan is derived FROM a value proposition, not instead of it.

K.5 Messaging that describes the product instead of naming the pain

Symptoms: "We sell jollof rice and small chops" â€" but no pain, no solution, no proof. **Likely cause:** The learner is thinking about the business, not the customer. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What problem does the customer have that this solves?" **Corrective steps:** Rewrite using the formula: We understand [pain]. That is why we [solution]. [Proof]. **How to confirm resolved:** The message names a pain the customer actually feels. **Prevention:** Always start with the pain, not the product.

K.6 Answering objections with tricks instead of honesty

Symptoms: "Trust us, we are the best!" or "Everyone loves us!" â€" no proof, no specifics. **Likely cause:** The learner does not have the proof yet and is covering up. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What proof do you have for that claim? Can the customer verify it?" **Corrective steps:** If the proof exists (reviews, licence, warranty, photos), show it. If it does not exist, fix the business first â€" then market it. **How to confirm resolved:** Every objection is answered with verifiable proof. **Prevention:** The golden rule: never lie to overcome an objection. If you cannot answer honestly, fix the business.

K.7 Copying a competitor's positioning

Symptoms: "We want to be like Sweet Treats PH" â€" the learner models their avatar and messaging on a competitor. **Likely cause:** The learner thinks the competitor has it figured out and copying is the fast route. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What is YOUR differentiator? Why should a customer choose you over them?" **Corrective steps:** Find what makes the business unique â€" speed, price, quality, service, location â€" and position around that. **How to confirm resolved:** The positioning is based on the business's own strengths, not a competitor's. **Prevention:** Positioning is about being the best choice *for a specific customer* â€" not about being a copy of someone else.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it (e.g., the learner can point to the exact word in their message that is vague). Teach learners to confirm before concluding â€" ask them to show you the sentence,

not just say "it is generic."

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "Customer Avatar and Value Proposition â€" My Business or Mama Nkechi's"

Purpose: To practise building a complete customer avatar, writing a strong value proposition and drafting messaging that connects â€" the core skills that feed the capstone's audience and positioning section.

Realistic scenario. You are the digital marketing consultant for a small business of your choice. You may use Mama Nkechi's Kitchen, your own real or fictional business, or one approved by your instructor. The business owner has asked you to prepare a one-page "customer brief" that they can use to guide all their marketing going forward.

Detailed instructions:

1. Choose one business and one avatar. Give the avatar a name and write a one-line description.
2. Build a **complete avatar** â€" all six parts: demographics, goals, pains, objections, platforms, messaging style. Use the Customer Avatar Worksheet.
3. Write a **value proposition** using the full formula: *For [who], we [do what] so that [benefit], unlike [alternative].*
4. List **three objections** your avatar might have, and write one **honest counter-message** for each.
5. Write **three messaging lines** for three different pains of your avatar. Use the formula: *We understand [pain]. That is why we [solution]. [Proof].*
6. Write a short **positioning statement** (2â€"3 sentences): who should this business target first, and why is that the strongest position?
7. Write one final sentence: "If I could only tell this customer one thing, it would be _____."

Required deliverables:

- A completed avatar worksheet (all six parts, specific details).
- A value proposition (full formula).
- Three objections with honest counter-messages.
- Three messaging lines (each naming a different pain).
- A positioning statement.
- The "one thing" sentence.

Submission format: Handwritten or typed, submitted at the start of Session 3. Keep a copy in your working folder (`CEA-DM-FirstnameLastname`).

Deadline: Before Session 3.

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Avatar complete & specific	6	All six parts filled with specific, realistic details
Value proposition (full formula)	3	Who / what / benefit / unlike â€" all present and specific
Objections & honest counters	3	Three real objections, each answered with proof not tricks
Messaging lines	5	Three lines, each naming a different pain, with solution and proof
Positioning statement	2	Clear choice with reasoning
"One thing" sentence	1	Clear, honest, customer-focused

Common mistakes to avoid: vague avatar ("everybody"); vague words without "so what?" testing; value proposition as a slogan; messaging that describes the product instead of naming the pain; objections answered with tricks; copying a competitor's positioning.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners â€" model for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen, avatar: Chinedu):

Avatar: Chinedu (see Section G.3 and F.2 for full details)

Value proposition:

> *For busy professionals in GRA, we deliver home-cooked jollof and small chops to your door in 45 minutes, so that you can eat well after work without cooking â€" unlike delivery apps that charge high fees and arrive cold.*

Three objections and counters:

1. "Is the kitchen clean?" â†' "We are licensed by the Rivers State Food Safety Agency â€" kitchen inspected monthly. Here are photos of our kitchen and our licence."
2. "Will it arrive on time?" â†' "We cook in small batches so orders go out fast. If we are ever late, we tell you before you pay â€" and you can cancel for a full refund."
3. "Is â‚¦2,000 worth it?" â†' "â‚¦2,000 buys you a full plate, a drink, delivery, and two hours of your evening back. Cooking at home costs â‚¦800 in ingredients and 2 hours of your time â€" which is worth more?"

Three messaging lines:

1. "Too tired to cook after work? Mama Nkechi's delivers hot jollof to GRA in 45 minutes â€" order by 6pm on WhatsApp and dinner is sorted."
2. "Worried about food hygiene? Our kitchen is licensed and inspected monthly â€" and we post fresh photos of our cooking every morning on Instagram."
3. "Why pay â‚¦1,500 delivery fee and arrive cold? Mama Nkechi's delivers to GRA free when you order two plates or more â€" hot, fresh, no extra charges."

Positioning statement:

> *"Mama Nkechi's Kitchen should position itself as the fast, quality meal delivery for busy professionals in GRA, because this customer type has money to spend, a frequent pain (every workday dinner), and a real differentiator (free delivery for two plates, 45-minute promise). Start with this position, win this market, then expand to event catering later."*

"One thing" sentence:

> *"If I could only tell this customer one thing, it would be: 'You do not have to cook tonight â€" we have you covered, hot and fast, for â‚¦2,000.'"*

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. In your own words, why is marketing to "everybody" a mistake? Give one example.

Q2. Multiple choice. Which of these is the strongest value proposition? a) "Quality food at affordable prices." b) "For busy professionals in GRA, we deliver hot jollof in 45 minutes, so you can eat well after work without cooking â€" unlike delivery apps that charge high fees." c) "Best jollof in Port Harcourt!" d) "We sell food. Call us."

Q3. Match the avatar part. Match each piece of information to the correct avatar part (demographics, goals, pains, objections, platforms). a) "Instagram, Google Maps, WhatsApp" b) "Too tired to cook after work" c) "Male, 28, lives in GRA, earns â‚¦200,000/month" d) "Is the kitchen clean? Will it arrive on time?" e) "Eat tasty food quickly without cooking"

Q4. Explain. Your friend says "I want to sell my cakes to everyone in Port Harcourt." Write two or three sentences explaining why this is a problem and what she should do instead.

Q5. Practical. Write one messaging line for a phone repair shop whose avatar is a young professional who needs a broken screen fixed before an important meeting. Name the pain and include proof.

Q6. Ethics. A customer leaves a 2-star review saying your food arrived cold. Your business partner says "just delete it or write a fake 5-star review to balance it out." What do you do, and why?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€“Q6)

A1. Marketing to everybody is a mistake because the message becomes vague â€” if you are talking to everyone, you cannot name a specific pain, so you end up with empty words like "quality" and "best" that mean nothing to anyone. Example: "We sell quality food" could be said by any kitchen in Nigeria. A focused message like "Too tired to cook after work? Hot jollof delivered to GRA in 45 minutes" speaks to one specific person and makes them feel understood.

A2. (b). It has a specific avatar (busy professionals in GRA), a concrete service (deliver hot jollof in 45 minutes), a clear benefit (eat well after work without cooking), and an honest differentiator (unlike delivery apps that charge high fees). The other options are vague or empty.

A3. a) platforms; b) pains; c) demographics; d) objections; e) goals.

A4. Selling to everyone means her message will be vague and her marketing will be scattered. Instead, she should pick one specific avatar â€” for example, "mums planning children's birthday parties in Port Harcourt" â€” build a detailed avatar for that person, and write her value proposition and messaging to speak directly to that person's pains (need a beautiful cake on time, within budget, with delivery). Once she wins that market, she can expand to a second avatar.

A5. (Accept any answer that names a specific pain, offers a solution, and includes proof.) Example: "Screen broke and you have a meeting in 2 hours? We fix cracked screens in 2 hours â€” walk in, wait with a free coffee, walk out with a working phone. 30-day warranty included." Pain: broken screen before a meeting. Proof: 30-day warranty.

A6. I would not delete the review and I would not write a fake review. Deleting a review (if possible) hides a real problem from future customers, and writing a fake review is dishonest and breaks the academy's ethics rules. Instead, I would reply professionally: "Thank you for letting us know. We are sorry your food arrived cold â€” this is not our standard. We would like to make it right. Please message us on WhatsApp." Then I would fix the actual problem (packaging, delivery time) so it does not happen again. A business that responds well to bad reviews often earns more trust than one with only perfect fakes.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned to know your customer. You learned that marketing to "everybody" is marketing to nobody â€” because a message for everyone is a message for no one. You learned to build a **customer avatar**: a detailed picture of one specific customer, with demographics, goals, pains, objections, platforms and messaging style. You learned that **pains** are the engine of good marketing â€” name the customer's problem specifically and offer the solution. You learned to write a **value proposition**: one clear sentence that says who you serve, what you give them, and why you are different â€” using the formula *For [who], we [do what] so that [benefit], unlike [alternative]*. You learned to answer **objections** honestly with proof, not tricks. You learned to write **messaging lines** that name a pain, offer a solution and include proof. And you learned about **positioning**: choosing who to serve first and why, based on pain, budget and differentiator.

Five important takeaways:

1. Focus on one avatar â€” marketing to everybody is marketing to nobody.
2. A complete avatar has six parts: demographics, goals, pains, objections, platforms, messaging style.
3. A value proposition answers: who, what, benefit, unlike what â€” in one sentence.
4. Objections are unasked questions â€” answer them honestly with proof.
5. Positioning is choosing who to serve first â€” and why.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I build a complete avatar for a real or fictional customer?
- Can I write a value proposition using the full formula?
- Can I name three pains and three objections for my avatar?
- Can I write messaging lines that name a different pain each?
- Can I explain why my business should target one avatar first?

Connection to the next session. You now know *who* you are talking to â€” the avatar, their pains, their objections, their platforms. Next session we build the *home* they arrive at: a Google Business Profile, a simple one-page website, consistent social profiles and the trust signals that make a stranger pay. Because knowing your customer is only half the job â€” the other half is giving them somewhere trustworthy to find you. That is what we build in Session 3: Branding and Online Presence.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner builds an avatar with specific details in all six parts â€" not just demographics.
- Learner asks "so what?" spontaneously when they see or write a vague claim.
- Learner's value proposition uses the full formula and would not make sense for a different business.
- Learner names real pains and objections â€" and answers objections with verifiable proof.
- Learner's messaging lines each name a different pain and use the customer's own words.
- Learner's positioning statement explains the "why" with reference to pain, budget and differentiator.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "My customer is everybody." â†' No â€" pick one avatar first. You can expand later.
- "Quality and best are good words." â†' They are empty without specifics. Ask "so what?" until they become concrete.
- "An avatar is just demographics." â†' Demographics are the surface; pains, objections and platforms are what make it useful.
- "A value proposition is a slogan." â†' A slogan is derived from a value proposition; it is not the same thing.
- "I can overcome objections by insisting I am the best." â†' Only proof overcomes objections. If you do not have the proof, fix the business.
- "I should copy my competitor's positioning." â†' Find your own differentiator â€" what makes *you* the best choice for a specific customer.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Avatar completion drill:** Give the learner a half-built avatar (demographics only) and ask them to add goals, pains, objections and platforms.
2. **"So What?" drill:** Give five vague claims and ask the learner to ask "so what?" three times for each and then rewrite them specifically.
3. **Value proposition repair drill:** Give three broken value propositions (missing who, missing unlike, missing benefit) and ask the learner to fix each one.
4. **Pain-finding drill:** Give the learner a real business (or Mama Nkechi's) and ask them to interview a friend or family member who is a potential customer â€" then write down three pains and three objections from the conversation.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** Provide a partially completed avatar (demographics and goals already filled in) and ask the learner to add pains, objections, platforms and messaging style. Provide the value proposition formula with an example filled in.
- **Level 2 (standard):** The session as written â€" full avatar build, value proposition, messaging lines, objections and positioning for Mama Nkechi's or the learner's own business.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** Ask the learner to build *two* avatars for the same business (e.g., Chinedu and Ada for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen) and then write a value proposition and messaging for each â€" explaining how and why the messages differ. Then ask them to recommend which avatar to target first and justify the choice using pain strength, budget and differentiator.

Timing guidance. The priority is the avatar build (Section H) and the value proposition / messaging practice. If the room is slow, shorten the lecture (combine F.3 and F.4) and reduce the case study (Section J) to a 5-minute discussion. Protect the practical time â€" a learner who leaves without a completed avatar and value proposition has no positioning for the rest of the course. If the room is fast, let learners present their avatars to the class and give peer feedback.

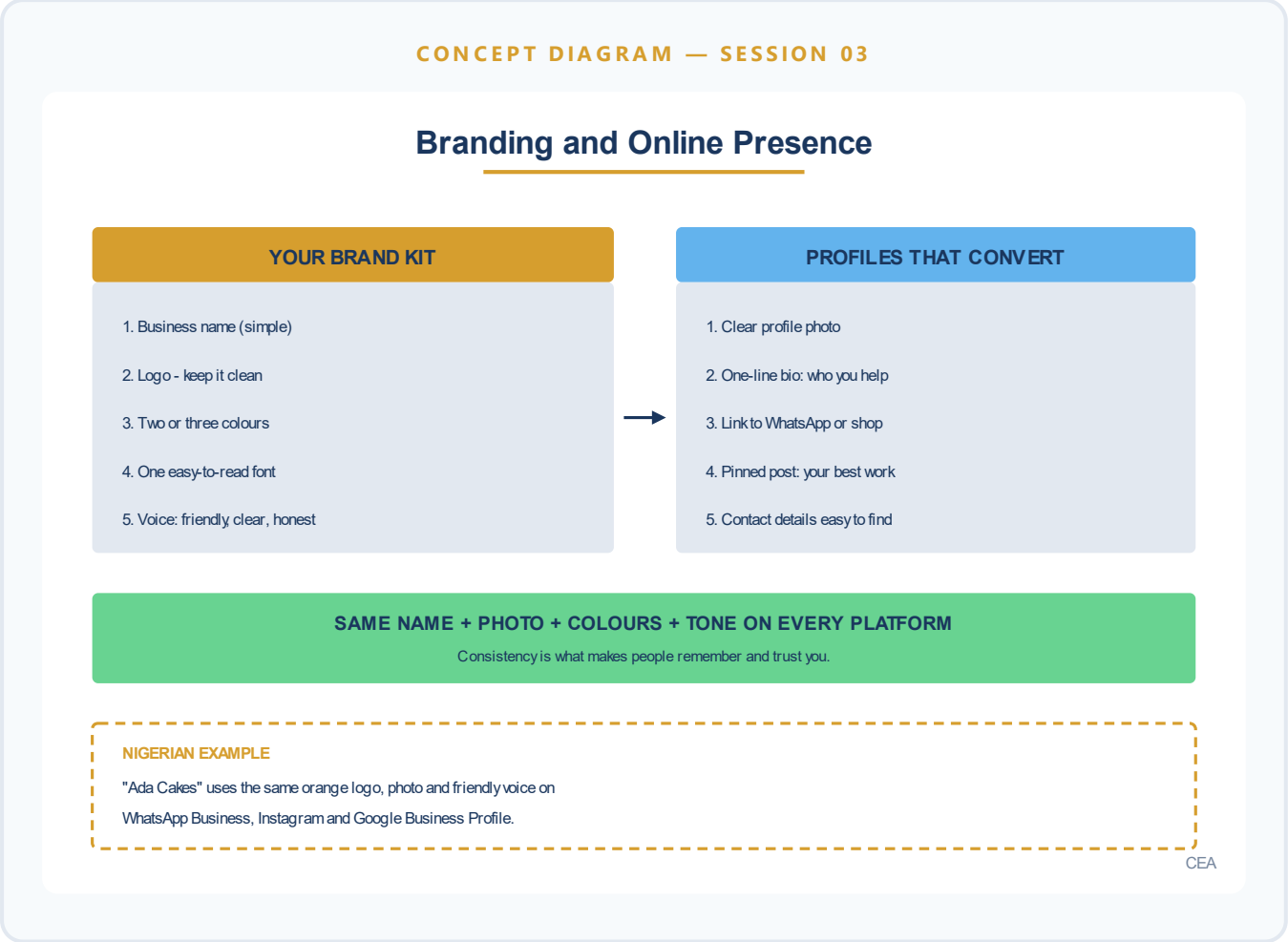
Capstone link. The avatar built today becomes the capstone's audience and positioning section. The value proposition and messaging lines become the capstone's messaging document. The positioning statement becomes the capstone's channel reasoning. The objections and counters become the capstone's trust and conversion strategy. Keep the worksheet safe â€" it is the foundation of the capstone's most important section.

END OF SESSION 2

Next: Session 3 â€" Branding and Online Presence.

SESSION 03 OF 9

Branding and Online Presence



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" DIGITAL MARKETING

SESSION 3 â€" BRANDING AND ONLINE PRESENCE

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	3 of 9
Session title	Branding and Online Presence
Week / Module	Week 1 â€" Module 1: Foundations
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (setup and writing, not coding)
Prerequisite knowledge	Sessions 1 and 2. Learners should be able to name the funnel stages, explain why channels work together, and describe a customer avatar. A Gmail account is strongly recommended for

Item	Detail
	this session (Google Business Profile requires one) â€” the instructor helps learners create one in class.
Connection to previous work	In Session 1 we built the map (channels, funnel, journey). In Session 2 we built the customer (avatar, value proposition, messaging). Now we build the *home* the customer arrives at: a Google Business Profile, a simple one-page website or landing page, consistent social profiles, and the trust signals that make a stranger pay. Without this home, the journey map from Session 1 breaks â€” the customer clicks and finds nothing.
Preparation before class	Academy computers with internet ready (learners need Gmail for Google Business Profile). Prepare a projector slide showing a complete Google Business Profile (a fictional one for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen). Print the Online Presence Audit Worksheet (Section H) per learner. Prepare a list of five real local Port Harcourt businesses (a salon, a kitchen, a barbershop, a shop, a school) for the audit exercise â€” choose businesses with a range of online quality (some strong, some weak). Have Canva open on the instructor computer for the brand kit demo. Ensure learners have their Gmail accounts ready or plan 10 minutes in class for account creation.

Instructor note on tone: Many learners feel anxious about "building a website" â€” they imagine coding, expense and technical difficulty. Your first job is to remove that fear. A one-page website can be free and built in minutes with Google Sites or a free website builder. A Google Business Profile is a form you fill in. Brand consistency is just "use the same colours and fonts everywhere." This session is about confidence: you can build a professional online presence with a phone and free tools. Say that early and often.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Explain** why a trustworthy online presence is the foundation of digital marketing, using the customer journey from Session 1 to show what happens when the "home" is missing or broken.
2. **Set up or complete a Google Business Profile** for a fictional or real business, including business name, category, address, phone number, opening hours, photos and description â€” with consistent name, address and phone (NAP) across all platforms.
3. **Describe** the six essential elements of a simple one-page website or landing page (headline, what you sell, where you are, prices or menu, how to order, trust signals) and build one using a free tool.
4. **Apply basic brand consistency** â€” business name, logo, two colours, two fonts and one tone of voice â€” across a Google Business Profile, a social profile and a Canva graphic, using only free Canva assets.
5. **List five trust signals** that make a stranger buy online and explain why each one works.
6. **Complete an online presence audit** of three real local businesses, scoring each on a checklist of presence elements and identifying the strongest and weakest.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner AND/OR an academy computer with internet (Google Business Profile and website builders need a computer or a phone with a browser).
- Instructor computer connected to a projector.
- Whiteboard or flip chart.

Software

- Gmail account (required for Google Business Profile and Google Sites).
- Google Business Profile (free â€” set up at business.google.com).
- Google Sites (free â€” sites.google.com) or a free website builder (WordPress.com free, Wix free, or a one-page builder).

- Canva (free tier) for brand kit and graphics.
- A camera or smartphone for taking photos (if available).

Sample files

- **Online Presence Audit Worksheet** (Section H) â€" one per learner.
- **Google Business Profile demo** â€" a completed fictional profile for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen ready to show on the projector.
- **Brand Kit Template** â€" a Canva file with logo, two colours, two fonts set up for the demo.
- **Five real local business names** for the audit exercise (instructor-prepared list).

Worksheets

- Worksheet 3.1 â€" "Google Business Profile Setup Checklist" (a tick-list of every field to fill in).
- Worksheet 3.2 â€" "Landing Page Structure Planner" (six empty boxes: headline / what you sell / where / prices / how to order / trust signals).
- Worksheet 3.3 â€" "Online Presence Audit Scorecard" (the audit worksheet above).

Accounts

- Gmail (free â€" required). WhatsApp Business and Instagram/Facebook accounts are useful but not essential for this session.
- Google Business Profile account (created with Gmail).
- Google Sites account (created with Gmail).
- Canva account (free â€" email sign-up).

Internet

- Required for this session (Google Business Profile, Google Sites and Canva all need internet). Academy Wi-Fi should be available.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- A smartphone with a browser can set up a Google Business Profile and use Google Sites mobile. Canva works on mobile. If a learner has only a phone and no Gmail, the instructor helps them create a Gmail account in class (10 minutes). Learners without any device pair with a classmate using academy computers.

Safety and ethics note:

- Only the learner's own business or a fictional business (like Mama Nkechi's Kitchen) may be used. Do not create or edit a real business's Google Business Profile without the owner's written permission.
- Use only free, licensed or original images â€" never copy photos from another business or from Google Images without permission.
- Real customer data (phone numbers, emails, addresses) must never be used in class exercises.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show two Google Search results side by side. Left: a search for a business with a complete Google Business Profile â€" photo, 4.7 stars, 30 reviews, "Open now", address, phone number, a "Order" button. Right: a search for a business with no profile â€" just a name and an address, no photos, no reviews, no hours.

What the instructor says:

> *"Two businesses in Port Harcourt. Someone searches for each one on Google. Hands up â€" which business would you call? â€¦ The one with the profile, almost every time. Why?"*

Expected learner response: Learners will say "it has reviews", "it looks real", "you can see photos", "it has the address and phone", "the other one looks fake or closed". Accept all answers and draw out the key point:

> *"Exactly. When a customer searches for you on Google and finds a complete profile â€" photos, reviews, hours, a way to order â€" they trust you. When they find nothing, or a bare page with no details, they assume you are not serious, or worse,*

not real. That is the power of your online presence. Today we build that presence â€" a Google Business Profile, a simple website, and the trust signals that turn a searcher into a customer."

Then reveal the stakes (say this):

> *"Here is the number that should wake you up: Google says that 46% of all searches on Google are looking for local information â€" 'food near me', 'salon in GRA', 'phone repair Trans-Amadi'. And 76% of people who search for a local business on their phone visit that business within 24 hours. That means your Google Business Profile is not a nice-to-have â€" it is the front door of your business. Today we open that door."*

Why this opener works: It uses a visual comparison (strong vs. weak presence) that learners can instantly judge, and it backs it up with a startling local statistic. It frames the session's importance before any teaching begins.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "In Session 1, we mapped Chinedu's journey for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen. What were the two weak links we identified â€" the places where the journey could break?"

- Expected answer: No Google Business Profile, no website, an Instagram page with no plan.
- Common gap: learners remember the channels but not the specific gaps. Prompt: "What could Chinedu NOT find when he searched?"

Question 2: "In Session 2, we built a customer avatar for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen. What were Chinedu's top two pains?"

- Expected answer: Too tired to cook after work; worried about food hygiene. (Or for Ada: small portions, budget concerns.)
- Common gap: learners give generic answers. Prompt: "Be specific â€" what exactly frustrated him?"

Question 3: "What is a value proposition? Give me the formula."

- Expected answer: *For [who], we [do what] so that [benefit], unlike [alternative].*
- Common gap: learners give a slogan instead. Remind them: "A value proposition is a complete sentence, not a catchphrase."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"We know the customer. We know their pains. Now we build the place they arrive at when they decide to check you out. In Session 1, we called this the 'consideration' stage â€" the moment the customer is deciding whether to trust you. Your online presence â€" your Google Business Profile, your website, your social profiles â€" is where that decision happens. If your presence is strong, they trust you and move to conversion. If it is weak, they leave and find a competitor. Today we build a presence they can trust."*

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 Why your online presence is the foundation of everything

The idea. Every channel we have learned about â€" social media, search, WhatsApp, email, content â€" eventually leads the customer to one of two places: your Google Business Profile or your website. These two places are your **online home** â€" the controlled, trustworthy spaces where a stranger decides whether to become a customer. If your home is missing, broken or untrustworthy, every other marketing effort leaks.

The leaky bucket analogy (say this):

> *"Imagine your marketing is water poured into a bucket. Social media, ads, word of mouth â€" they all pour water in. But if the bucket has holes â€" no Google listing, no website, no reviews, inconsistent information â€" the water leaks out. You can pour in as much as you like; the bucket never fills. Fixing the holes â€" building a complete, trustworthy online presence â€" is the highest-leverage thing you can do. It makes every other channel work better."*

What "online presence" means:

- **Google Business Profile** â€" your listing on Google Search and Maps. The first thing many customers see.
- **Website or landing page** â€" your own controlled space on the internet with your full offer.
- **Social profiles** â€" your Instagram, Facebook, TikTok pages. The places you post and interact.
- **Consistency** â€" the same name, address, phone number, colours, fonts and tone across all of them.

Why consistency matters (the NAP rule):

> *"NAP stands for Name, Address, Phone number. These three must be identical everywhere â€" on your Google Business Profile, your website, your Instagram bio, your WhatsApp Business profile, your flyers. If your Google listing says 'Mama Nkechi's Kitchen, 12 Aggrey Road' and your Instagram bio says 'Mamas Kitchen, Aggrey Rd', Google gets confused, customers get confused, and trust drops. Google uses consistency as a signal: if your information matches everywhere, Google trusts you more and ranks you higher. Inconsistency is one of the most common and most damaging mistakes small businesses make."*

Real-life comparison. Think of your online presence like the front of a physical shop. If the signboard says one thing, the door has another name, and the person inside gives a different address â€" you would walk away. Your online presence is your digital signboard, door and shop assistant. It must tell one clear, consistent story.

Common misconception. "I need an expensive website." No. A simple one-page website â€" or even just a well-built Google Business Profile with a link to WhatsApp â€" is enough to start. Expensive websites come later, when the business can afford them and needs them. The goal today is a *complete, trustworthy, consistent* presence â€" not a fancy one.

F.2 Google Business Profile â€" your front door on Google

The idea. A **Google Business Profile** (GBP) is a free listing that appears when someone searches for your business or your category on Google Search and Google Maps. It shows your business name, address, phone number, photos, opening hours, reviews, and a way to contact you or order. For a local business â€" a kitchen, a salon, a shop, a school â€" this is often the single most important digital marketing asset you can have.

Why it is so important:

- It puts you in front of people searching for exactly what you sell, in your area, at the moment they are looking.
- It is free.
- It is often the first thing a customer sees â€" before your website, before your Instagram.
- It carries social proof: reviews, photos, Q&A.
- It has a "message" button and a "call" button, so customers can reach you instantly.

The nine parts of a complete Google Business Profile:

1. **Business name** â€" your real, exact business name. Not "Mama Nkechi's Kitchen ðŸŒŸ Best Food in PH" â€" just "Mama Nkechi's Kitchen". Google may suspend profiles with keyword-stuffed names.
2. **Category** â€" what you are. Choose the most specific accurate category: "Restaurant", "Food Delivery Service", "Caterer". You can add secondary categories. Categories affect what searches you appear in.
3. **Address** â€" your physical address. If you deliver from home and do not want your home address public, you can hide the address and set a service area (the areas you deliver to). This is common for home kitchens.
4. **Phone number** â€" a number customers can call. Use a number that is answered â€" a missed call is a lost customer.
5. **Opening hours** â€" when you are open. Set these accurately and update them for holidays. "Open now" / "Closed" signals strongly affect whether customers choose you.
6. **Photos** â€" at least 10 photos: your food or products, your shop front, your team, your packaging. Businesses with photos get more calls and direction requests. Use real photos, not stock.

7. **Description** â€" a short paragraph (up to 750 characters) saying what you do, who you serve and what makes you different. Include your value proposition naturally.
8. **Products or services** â€" list your menu or services with prices. This helps customers decide before they even message you.
9. **Reviews** â€" ask real customers to leave honest reviews. Reviews are the #1 trust signal on a Google Business Profile. Never buy or fake reviews.

Worked example â€" Mama Nkechi's Kitchen, complete Google Business Profile:

Field	What to enter
Business name	Mama Nkechi's Kitchen
Category	Restaurant (primary); Food Delivery Service (secondary)
Address	Service area: GRA, Trans-Amadi, Rumuokwuta, Port Harcourt (hide home address)
Phone	0803-XXX-XXXX (WhatsApp-enabled)
Hours	Monâ€"Sat 9amâ€"8pm; Sun 11amâ€"4pm
Photos	12 photos: jollof, small chops, soup, kitchen, packaging, delivery
Description	"Home-cooked Nigerian meals, soups and small chops for delivery and pickup in Port Harcourt. We cook fresh every morning â€" no reheating. Order on WhatsApp for delivery in 45 minutes within GRA and Trans-Amadi. Licensed and inspected."
Products	Jollof rice plate â‚¦1,500; Small chops (20 pcs) â‚¦1,200; Ogbono soup â‚¦2,000; Full catering packages from â‚¦15,000
Reviews	15 real reviews from customers, avg 4.3 stars

Say to the class:

> *"Look at this profile. It is complete, specific and consistent. A customer searching 'food delivery GRA' sees: a name, a category, a phone number, hours, 12 photos, a description with prices, and 15 reviews. They do not need to wonder anything â€" they can decide in 30 seconds. That is a profile that converts."*

How to set it up (the process):

1. Go to business.google.com and sign in with your Gmail.
2. Enter your business name. If it already exists, claim it (do not create a duplicate).
3. Choose your category.
4. Add your address or service area.
5. Add your phone number and website (or WhatsApp link).
6. Add your opening hours.
7. Add photos and description.
8. Add products/services with prices.
9. Verify the business (Google sends a postcard or calls â€" this is required for the profile to appear fully).
10. Start asking real customers for reviews.

Common mistakes and how to avoid them:

- Keyword-stuffing the name ("Mama Nkechi's Kitchen Best Jollof Food Delivery") â†' Use your real name only.
- No photos â†' Add at least 10 real photos.
- Inconsistent NAP â†' Make sure your name, address and phone match your website and social profiles exactly.
- Never responding to reviews â†' Reply to every review, good and bad, within 24 hours.
- Forgetting to update hours â†' Set holiday hours and keep them current.

F.3 The one-page website â€" your home on the internet

The idea. A **website** is a page (or a few pages) on the internet that you own and control. Unlike social media â€" where the platform can change the rules, limit your reach or suspend your account â€" your website is yours. For a small business, a **one-page website** (also called a landing page) is often enough: a single page that tells the customer everything they need to know and gives them a clear way to order.

Why a website matters even if you have a Google Business Profile:

- Your website shows your full offer â€" your complete menu, your price list, your story.
- It gives you a link to put in your Instagram bio, your WhatsApp messages, your email signature.
- It builds credibility â€" a business with a website looks more established than one without.
- It can rank on Google for searches like "Mama Nkechi's Kitchen menu" â€" capturing people who search for you by name.
- It lets you collect customer emails or WhatsApp numbers (with permission) for future marketing.

The six essential elements of a one-page landing page:

1. **Headline** â€" one clear sentence saying what you do and who it is for. "Home-cooked jollof and small chops, delivered hot to your door in Port Harcourt."
2. **What you sell** â€" your menu, products or services with prices. Use photos. Make it scannable â€" customers should find what they want in 10 seconds.
3. **Where you are** â€" your location or delivery areas. "Serving GRA, Trans-Amadi, Rumuokwuta and surrounding areas."
4. **How to order** â€" a clear call-to-action: a WhatsApp button, a phone number, an order form. Make it impossible to miss.
5. **Trust signals** â€" reviews, photos, a licence number, "serving since 2024", a guarantee. Anything that makes a stranger feel safe.
6. **Contact and hours** â€" your phone number, WhatsApp, opening hours, social media links.

Worked example â€" Mama Nkechi's Kitchen, one-page landing page structure:

Element	What goes there
Headline	"Hot jollof & small chops, delivered to your door in PH ðŸ²"
What you sell	Menu with photos: Jollof â‚¦1,500 Â· Small chops â‚¦1,200 Â· Ogbono soup â‚¦2,000 Â· Catering from â‚¦15,000
Where	"Serving GRA, Trans-Amadi, Rumuokwuta, Choba and surrounding areas"
How to order	Big green WhatsApp button: "Order on WhatsApp â€" 0803-XXX-XXXX"
Trust signals	"Licensed & inspected Â· 4.3 stars on Google Â· 15 real reviews Â· Cooking fresh since 2024"
Contact & hours	"Open Monâ€"Sat 9amâ€"8pm Â· Call or WhatsApp 0803-XXX-XXXX Â· @MamaNkechisKitchen"

How to build it for free (three options):

1. **Google Sites** (sites.google.com) â€" completely free, very simple, integrates with Gmail. Best for beginners. Drag and drop, choose a template, publish. No coding.
2. **WordPress.com free** â€" slightly more flexible, free tier available. Good if you want a blog later.
3. **Canva Websites** (canva.com) â€" free, design-first, publishes as a Canva site. Good if you want it to look beautiful quickly.

Say to the class:

> *"You do not need to know how to code. You do not need to pay a developer. You need a free tool, 30 minutes, and the six elements we just learned. In your practical today, you will build the structure for a one-page site. If you have time, you will publish it. If not, the structure is the skill â€" you can finish it at home."*

Common misconception. "A website needs many pages." No. A one-page site with the six elements is enough for most small businesses. You can add more pages later â€" a menu page, an about page, a blog â€" but start with one clear page that answers the customer's questions and tells them how to order.

F.4 Brand consistency â€" looking like one professional business everywhere

The idea. Brand consistency means your business looks and sounds the same everywhere â€" your Google Business Profile, your website, your Instagram, your WhatsApp, your flyers. The same name, the same colours, the same fonts, the same tone of voice. When a customer sees your Instagram post, then visits your Google listing, then opens your website â€" they should feel like they are meeting the same business, not three different ones.

Why it matters: Consistency builds recognition and trust. When your visuals and voice are consistent, customers recognise you faster and trust you more. When they are inconsistent â€" different names, different colours, different tones â€" customers assume you are disorganised, or worse, a scam.

The five brand assets to keep consistent:

1. **Business name** â€" spelled identically everywhere. Not "Mama Nkechi's" on Instagram and "Mama Nkechis Kitchen" on Google.
2. **Logo** â€" one logo (even a simple text logo) used everywhere. Create it once in Canva, save it, reuse it.
3. **Two colours** â€" pick two brand colours (e.g., warm orange and deep brown for a food kitchen) and use only those in your graphics. Consistency is easier with two than with ten.
4. **Two fonts** â€" pick two fonts (one for headings, one for body text) and use them everywhere. Canva makes this easy with brand kits.
5. **Tone of voice** â€" how you sound in writing. Friendly and professional? Casual and funny? Warm and motherly? Pick one tone and use it in your Google description, your Instagram captions, your WhatsApp messages.

Worked example â€" Mama Nkechi's Kitchen brand kit:

Asset	Choice
Name	Mama Nkechi's Kitchen (spelled exactly the same everywhere)
Logo	Simple text logo: "Mama Nkechi's Kitchen" in a warm font, with a small pot icon
Colours	Warm orange (#E67E22) and deep brown (#5D4037)
Fonts	"Playfair Display" for headings, "Open Sans" for body
Tone	Warm, motherly, honest â€" "we cook like we are feeding our own family"

How to apply it: Create a free Canva account, set up a Brand Kit (Canva's free tier allows brand colours and fonts), and use it for every graphic you make â€" your Google Business Profile cover photo, your Instagram posts, your WhatsApp catalogue images, your flyer. When everything comes from the same kit, consistency is automatic.

Common misconception. "Branding is just a logo." No â€" branding is the whole experience: the name, the colours, the fonts, the tone, the photos, the way you answer the phone. A logo is one piece. Brand consistency means *every* piece matches.

How a learner applies this today: Pick two colours and two fonts for your business (or Mama Nkechi's Kitchen). Create a simple logo in Canva. Write your Google Business Profile description in your chosen tone. Make one Instagram post graphic using your colours and fonts. You now have the start of a consistent brand.

F.5 Trust signals â€" what makes a stranger buy online

The idea. A **trust signal** is anything that reduces a stranger's fear of being scammed, ripped off or disappointed. When a customer finds you online, they are thinking: "Is this real? Will they deliver? Is the food safe? What if it goes wrong?" Trust signals answer those questions before they have to ask.

The five most important trust signals for a small business:

1. **Real reviews with responses.** Google reviews, Facebook reviews, testimonials on your website. Not just 5-star â€" a mix of ratings with genuine, specific comments. And crucially: the business *responds* to reviews, especially negative ones. A business that responds well to a bad review is more trustworthy than one with only perfect fakes.
2. **Real photos of real work.** Photos of your actual food, your actual shop, your actual team â€" not stock images. Customers can spot stock photos, and stock photos reduce trust. Show the real thing, even if it is imperfect. A real photo of a steaming pot of jollof is worth more than a stock image of a perfect plated dish.
3. **Clear contact information.** A real phone number that is answered, a real address, a real WhatsApp. A business that hides its contact details looks like a scam. Make it easy to reach you.

4. **Credentials and proof.** A licence number, a certification, "serving since 2024", a guarantee, a refund policy. Anything that shows you are established and accountable. "Licensed by the Rivers State Food Safety Agency" is a powerful trust signal for a food business.
5. **Consistent presence.** The same name, address and phone number everywhere. A Google listing that matches your website that matches your Instagram bio. Consistency tells the customer: "This is a real business that pays attention to details."

Worked example â€" Mama Nkechi's Kitchen, trust signals:

Trust signal	What Mama Nkechi does
Real reviews	15 Google reviews, avg 4.3 stars, with specific comments ("jollof was hot and tasty, delivered in 40 minutes")
Real photos	12 photos of actual food, kitchen, packaging and delivery
Clear contact	Phone number on Google, website and Instagram bio; WhatsApp answered within minutes
Credentials	"Licensed by Rivers State Food Safety Agency" in the Google description and on the website
Consistent presence	Same name, address, phone on Google, website, Instagram and WhatsApp Business

Say to the class:

> *"Notice that none of these trust signals cost money. They cost effort â€" taking real photos, asking customers for honest reviews, keeping your information consistent, getting a licence. But they are worth more than any ad. A customer who sees real reviews, real photos, real contact details and consistent information will order. A customer who sees none of those will leave."*

Common misconception. "I need perfect 5-star reviews to be trusted." No â€" perfect 5-star reviews with no specifics can actually *reduce* trust (they look fake). A 4.3-star average with genuine, specific comments â€" some 4-star, one 3-star with a professional response â€" is more believable and more trustworthy than an unbroken line of generic 5-star reviews.

How a learner builds trust signals: Start today. Take 10 real photos of your business. Ask three real customers for honest Google reviews. Add your licence number to your Google description. Make sure your name, address and phone match everywhere. These four actions will put you ahead of most small businesses in Port Harcourt.

F.6 What a strong online presence looks like â€" and what a weak one looks like

Strong presence (example â€" fictional "Sweet Treats PH" bakery):

- Complete Google Business Profile: 4.9 stars, 40 reviews, 20 photos, correct hours, products with prices, "Order" button.
- One-page website: headline, full cake catalogue with prices, delivery areas, WhatsApp order button, reviews, licence number.
- Instagram: 2,000 followers, posts 3x/week, consistent colours and fonts, bio has location and WhatsApp link, highlights show real customer photos.
- WhatsApp Business: catalogue with cakes and prices, labels for customers, fast replies.
- Consistency: same name, address, phone, colours, fonts and tone across all four.

Weak presence (example â€" fictional "Ngozi's Cakes" bakery):

- No Google Business Profile at all.
- Instagram page with 1,200 followers, beautiful photos but no prices, no location, bio says only "Order your cakes and small chops", posts once a month.
- Personal WhatsApp, no business profile, no catalogue.
- No website.
- Inconsistency: name spelled differently on Instagram vs. flyers; phone number changed and not updated anywhere.

Say to the class:

> *"The strong presence wins customers every time â€" not because the cakes are better, but because the customer can find, trust and order easily. The weak presence loses customers who would have bought â€" not because the cakes are bad, but but because the customer cannot find the price, cannot find the address, and cannot be sure the business is real. The difference is not the product. The difference is the presence. And the good news is: the weak presence can be fixed in one afternoon with free tools."*

F.7 Summary of the lecture

- Your online presence â€" Google Business Profile, website, social profiles â€" is the home the customer arrives at. Fix the leaks before pouring more water in.
- Google Business Profile is your front door on Google: complete it with name, category, address, phone, hours, photos, description, products and reviews.
- A one-page website needs six elements: headline, what you sell, where, how to order, trust signals, contact and hours. Build it free with Google Sites, WordPress.com free, or Canva.
- Brand consistency: one name, one logo, two colours, two fonts, one tone â€" everywhere. Use a Canva Brand Kit.
- Trust signals: real reviews with responses, real photos, clear contact info, credentials, consistent presence.
- NAP (Name, Address, Phone) must be identical across all platforms â€" inconsistency damages trust and Google ranking.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Consistent logo] --> D[Trust]
    B[Consistent colors] --> D
    C[Consistent tone] --> D
    D --> E[More customers]
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- On the projector: a completed Google Business Profile for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen (fictional).
- A blank Google Sites or Canva website open for the live build.
- Canva open with a Brand Kit set up (two colours, two fonts, one logo).
- A worksheet showing the six landing page elements.

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€" audit a profile live (4 minutes)

Say: "Before we build, let me show you how to *read* a Google Business Profile like a marketer."

Show the completed Mama Nkechi's Kitchen profile on the projector. Walk through it field by field:

- **Name:** "Mama Nkechi's Kitchen" â€" clean, no keyword stuffing.
- **Category:** "Restaurant" â€" affects what searches it appears in.
- **Photos:** 12 real photos â€" food, kitchen, packaging.
- **Description:** includes value proposition, delivery promise, licence.
- **Products:** menu with prices â€" jollof â‚¦1,500, small chops â‚¦1,200.
- **Reviews:** 15 reviews, 4.3 stars, business has responded to each one.
- **Hours:** accurate and current.

Ask the class: "What is this profile missing?" (Answer: nothing â€" it is complete. That is the point.) "Now â€" what would you improve if this were your business?" (Let them suggest: more reviews, better photos, a website link, more products listed.)

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€" build a one-page website live (6 minutes)

Say: "Now let me build a one-page website for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen using Google Sites. Watch how fast this is."

Open Google Sites (sites.google.com) on the projector. Narrate each step:

1. Click "Blank" to create a new site.
2. Enter the site name: "Mama Nkechi's Kitchen".
3. Add a header: "Hot jollof & small chops, delivered to your door in PH".
4. Add a section with the menu: "Jollof rice â‚¦1,500 Â· Small chops â‚¦1,200 Â· Ogbono soup â‚¦2,000".
5. Add a "How to order" section with a WhatsApp button linking to wa.me/234803XXXXXXXX.
6. Add a "Trust" section: "Licensed & inspected Â· 4.3 stars on Google Â· Cooking fresh since 2024".
7. Add a contact section: phone, hours, delivery areas.
8. Publish â€" get the link.

Say:

> *"That took five minutes. No code, no cost, no developer. The site is live on the internet right now. A customer can find it, read it and order from it. That is all a one-page site needs to do."*

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€" create a brand kit and one graphic in Canva (4 minutes)

Say: "Last piece â€" brand consistency. Let me set up a Canva Brand Kit and make one Instagram post."

Open Canva. Narrate:

1. Create a Brand Kit: set brand colours (orange #E67E22, brown #5D4037), brand fonts (Playfair Display, Open Sans), and upload or create a simple logo.
2. Create an Instagram post: choose a template, apply the brand colours and fonts.
3. Write the post: "Hot jollof, delivered to your door in PH ðŸ² Order on WhatsApp â€" 0803-XXX-XXXX. â‚¦1,500 a plate."
4. Export the image.

Say:

> *"Notice that this post uses the same colours, fonts and tone as the Google Business Profile and the website. That is brand consistency. A customer who sees this post, then visits the website, then checks the Google listing â€" sees one business, not three. That is how you build recognition and trust."*

G.5 Questions to ask during the demo

- "Why do we hide the home address for a delivery kitchen?" (Privacy and safety â€" set a service area instead.)
- "Why is a WhatsApp button better than an order form for Mama Nkechi?" (Her customers are on WhatsApp â€" meet them where they are.)
- "What happens if our Google name does not match our Instagram name?" (Trust drops, Google ranking drops, customers get confused.)
- "Why do we need real photos, not stock images?" (Customers can tell â€" real photos build trust, stock images destroy it.)
- "Can we build a website without Gmail?" (Google Sites needs Gmail, but Canva and WordPress.com can use any email.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding, each learner sets up a Google Business Profile for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen (or their own approved fictional business), plans a one-page landing page structure, and creates one branded graphic in Canva.

Starting materials: Academy computer or smartphone with internet, Gmail account (created in class if needed), Google Sites open, Canva open.

Procedure (instructor calls out each step; learners follow; instructor walks the room):

1. Open business.google.com and sign in with your Gmail.
2. Enter the business name: "Mama Nkechi's Kitchen" (or your own fictional business name).
3. Choose the category: "Restaurant" (or the most accurate category for your business).

4. Set the address: hide the home address, set service areas (GRA, Trans-Amadi, Rumuokwuta).
5. Add the phone number: 0803-XXX-XXXX.
6. Add opening hours: Monâ€“Sat 9amâ€“8pm, Sun 11amâ€“4pm.
7. Add the description: use the value proposition from Session 2 â€” "Home-cooked Nigerian meals, soups and small chops for delivery and pickup in Port Harcourt. We cook fresh every morning. Order on WhatsApp for delivery in 45 minutes within GRA."
8. Add products/services with prices (at least 3).
9. **Pause and predict:** Check your NAP â€” is the name, address and phone exactly the same as what you wrote on your worksheet? If not, fix it.
10. Open the Landing Page Structure Planner (Worksheet 3.2). Fill in the six elements for your business: headline, what you sell, where, how to order, trust signals, contact and hours.
11. Open Google Sites. Create a new blank site. Add the headline and the six sections from your planner.
12. Add a WhatsApp button linking to your order number.
13. **Pause and predict:** Show your site to a partner. Can they tell what you sell, where you are, and how to order â€” in 10 seconds?
14. Open Canva. Set up a Brand Kit: two colours, two fonts, one logo (or simple text logo).
15. Create one Instagram post using your Brand Kit: a photo or simple graphic with your headline and order information.
16. Save everything. Keep your worksheet, your site link and your Canva design in your working folder.

Expected result: A Google Business Profile set up (or the structure planned if verification is pending), a landing page structure completed, a one-page site started, and one branded Instagram post created.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 9: "Is your NAP identical to what you wrote yesterday in your avatar worksheet? If your phone number changed, which platforms need updating?"
- After step 13: "Could a stranger order from your site in under a minute? If not, what is missing?"
- After step 15: "Does your Canva post use your brand colours and fonts? If not, open the Brand Kit and apply them."

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Gmail not created yet â†’ Pair the learner with a classmate or use an academy computer; help them create Gmail (10 minutes).
- Google Business Profile says "already exists" â†’ The business may already be listed. Help the learner claim it rather than creating a duplicate.
- Cannot hide address â†’ Walk through Settings â†’ Business Profile â†’ uncheck "show address" and set service areas instead.
- Google Sites is confusing â†’ Use the simplest template; focus on text content, not design perfection.
- Canva Brand Kit not available on free tier â†’ Use the free colour picker and font picker manually; save your choices on the worksheet.
- Learner uses stock photos â†’ Gently remind them: real photos build trust. Use a photo from their phone or skip photos for now.

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Google Business Profile set up with name, category, service area, phone, hours, description and products
- ☐ NAP checked for consistency across profile, worksheet and Instagram bio
- ☐ Landing page structure completed with all six elements
- ☐ One-page site started on Google Sites with headline, menu, order button and trust signals
- ☐ Canva Brand Kit created with two colours, two fonts, one logo
- ☐ One branded Instagram post created
- ☐ All files saved in working folder

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task: Complete an **online presence audit** of three real local Port Harcourt businesses. The instructor will assign you three businesses from the prepared list (e.g., a salon, a food kitchen, a barbershop, a shop, a school). For each business, search for it

on Google and Instagram, and complete the audit scorecard.

For each business, score the following (1 point each, maximum 10):

#	Presence element	Yes/No
1	Has a Google Business Profile	
2	GBP has a real address or service area	
3	GBP has a phone number	
4	GBP has opening hours	
5	GBP has at least 5 photos	
6	GBP has a description with details	
7	GBP has at least 3 reviews	
8	Has a website or landing page	
9	Has an Instagram or Facebook page with posts in the last month	
10	Name, address and phone are consistent across all platforms	

Also answer for each business:

- What is the strongest part of their online presence?
- What is the weakest part?
- What is the ONE thing you would fix first if you were their marketing consultant?

Time allowance: 15 minutes (5 minutes per business).

Success criteria:

- Three businesses audited with all 10 points scored.
- Strengths and weaknesses identified for each.
- One clear recommendation per business.

Hints if stuck:

- Hint 1: If a business has no Google listing, that is an automatic 0 on questions 1â€“7 â€” and a major red flag.
- Hint 2: Check the Instagram bio â€” does it have a phone number, a location, a link? Or just "DM for orders"?
- Hint 3: Compare the three businesses. Which one would YOU choose as a customer? Why?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model scores â€” will vary by business):

Example â€” fictional "Kelechi's Barbershop, GRA":

#	Element	Score
1	Has a Google Business Profile	1
2	GBP has a real address	1
3	GBP has a phone number	1
4	GBP has opening hours	0 (missing)
5	GBP has at least 5 photos	1
6	GBP has a description	0 (missing)
7	GBP has at least 3 reviews	1 (7 reviews)
8	Has a website	0
9	Has Instagram page with recent posts	1
10	NAP consistent	0 (phone number different on Instagram)

#	Element	Score
	Total	**6/10**

Strongest part: Good Google Business Profile with 7 reviews and photos â€" the trust signals are working. *Weakest part:* No website and no opening hours on Google â€" customers cannot check if the shop is open or see prices. *First fix:* Add opening hours to the Google Business Profile and create a simple one-page site with prices and a WhatsApp booking button.

Example â€" fictional "Ada's Hair Salon, Trans-Amadi":

#	Element	Score
1	Has a Google Business Profile	0
2â€"7	(all GBP elements)	0
8	Has a website	0
9	Has Instagram page with recent posts	1
10	NAP consistent	0
	Total	**1/10**

Strongest part: Active Instagram page with recent posts â€" the owner is making an effort. *Weakest part:* No Google Business Profile at all â€" invisible to the 46% of searches looking for local businesses. *First fix:* Set up a complete Google Business Profile immediately â€" this is the single highest-impact action.

Learner marking (out of 10):

- Three businesses audited with all 10 points scored (4)
- Strengths and weaknesses identified with specific evidence (3)
- One clear, realistic recommendation per business (3)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Emeka* runs a barbershop in Port Harcourt â€" *Emeka's Cuts* â€" in a busy area near a market. He has been cutting hair for 10 years. His shop is always busy with walk-ins, but he has no online presence at all: no Google listing, no Instagram, no WhatsApp Business. He keeps his regular customers' phone numbers in his personal phone and calls them occasionally. A young barber two streets away â€" *Kelechi's Cuts* â€" opened just one year ago. Kelechi has a Google Business Profile with 4.8 stars and 25 reviews, an Instagram page with before/after photos posted every week, and a WhatsApp Business account where customers can see his price list and book ahead. Kelechi's shop is often full â€" with customers who found him on Google or Instagram.

Relevant facts.

- Emeka is the better barber â€" more experience, more skill, more loyal customers.
- Kelechi is the better marketer â€" complete Google listing, consistent Instagram, easy WhatsApp booking.
- Emeka's customers are mostly walk-ins and regulars who have been coming for years.
- Kelechi's customers are mostly new â€" young men who searched "barber near me" or saw his Instagram photos.
- A customer searching "barbershop near me" on Google sees Kelechi's profile â€" with photos, reviews, prices and a "Call" button â€" and does not know Emeka exists.
- Emeka loses potential new customers every day â€" not because his work is worse, but because he is invisible online.

Decision point. Emeka comes to you for advice. He says: "I have been here 10 years. I do not need Instagram. My customers know me." What do you tell him?

Possible approaches.

1. **"You are right â€" ignore online marketing. Your work speaks for itself."** â€" This feels respectful, but it is wrong. Emeka is losing new customers to Kelechi every day. His existing customers will age and move away; without new ones, the business shrinks.

2. **"Spend money on Instagram ads to compete with Kelechi."** â€" Ads could work, but Emeka has no Google listing, no Instagram page, no WhatsApp Business. The ads would drive traffic to nothing. Foundation first, ads later.
3. **"Build your online presence â€" Google Business Profile, Instagram, WhatsApp Business â€" for free, and show up where your customers are searching."** â€" This is the right answer.

Recommended solution. Approach 3. Emeka does not need to become a social media star. He needs to do four things â€" all free:

1. **Set up a Google Business Profile** (30 minutes). Add his shop name, address, phone number, hours, and 10 photos of his work. Ask his regular customers to leave honest Google reviews. This alone will put him in front of people searching "barber near me" â€" the exact customers he is losing to Kelechi.
2. **Post on Instagram once a week** (15 minutes). Before/after photos of his cuts. That is it. He does not need captions or hashtags to start â€" just proof of his skill. His customers will share.
3. **Switch to WhatsApp Business** (10 minutes). Create a catalogue with his services and prices (fade â‚¦1,500, beard trim â‚¦1,000, etc.), create labels for regulars, and send a monthly message: "It has been a while â€" book your next cut this week and get a free shaping." This builds retention.
4. **Match his NAP** â€" make sure his name, address and phone number are identical on Google, Instagram and WhatsApp.

Say to the class:

> *"Emeka does not need to beat Kelechi at Instagram. He needs to stop being invisible. A complete Google Business Profile with 10 photos and 10 reviews would put him in the search results next to Kelechi â€" and his 10 years of experience would show in the quality of his work photos. The customer would choose based on what they see. Right now, they cannot choose Emeka because they cannot find him. That is the problem â€" and it is solvable in one afternoon with free tools."*

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 (ignore online): comfortable, but the business slowly shrinks as existing customers age and move.
- Approach 2 (ads without foundation): wasted money â€" ads drive traffic to a business with no online home.
- Approach 3 (build the presence): free, permanent, makes every other marketing effort work better. Takes one afternoon.

Professional connection. This is the most common situation a digital marketing professional faces: a skilled business owner who is invisible online. The fix is almost never "spend more money on ads." It is "complete the foundation first." The Google Business Profile is the single highest-leverage action for any local business â€" free, fast, and immediately visible to customers searching for exactly what you sell. Every learner in this room should be able to set one up by the end of today.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the live guide. Point learners to the row rather than giving the answer.

K.1 Inconsistent NAP (name, address, phone)

Symptoms: Google listing says one thing, Instagram says another, website says a third. Customers get confused; Google ranking suffers. **Likely cause:** The business changed its phone number or moved and did not update everywhere. **How to investigate:** Search the business on Google, Instagram and their website. Compare the name, address and phone number character by character. **Corrective steps:** Choose the correct information and update every platform to match exactly. **How to confirm resolved:** All three sources show identical name, address and phone number. **Prevention:** Write your NAP once on a master sheet and copy it everywhere. Update all platforms simultaneously when anything changes.

K.2 Keyword-stuffed business name

Symptoms: "Mama Nkechi's Kitchen Best Jollof Food Delivery Port Harcourt" â€" Google may suspend the profile. **Likely cause:** Trying to rank for keywords by stuffing them into the name. **How to investigate:** Compare the Google business name to the real registered/commonly known business name. **Corrective steps:** Change the Google name to the real business name only. Put keywords in the description and products instead. **How to confirm resolved:** The Google name matches the name on the shop sign, flyers and website. **Prevention:** Use your real name. Google's guidelines are clear â€" and enforcement is real.

K.3 No photos or only stock photos

Symptoms: Profile has no photos, or uses generic stock images that do not show the real business. **Likely cause:** The owner thinks photos are not important, or does not have good photos. **How to investigate:** Count the photos. Are they real or stock? **Corrective steps:** Take 10 real photos with a smartphone â€" products, shop front, team, packaging. Upload them. **How to confirm resolved:** The profile shows real photos of the actual business. **Prevention:** Take photos regularly â€" every time you make something new, photograph it. Build a library.

K.4 Not responding to reviews

Symptoms: Reviews are left unanswered â€" especially negative ones. **Likely cause:** The owner does not know they should respond, or is afraid of negative reviews. **How to investigate:** Check the Google listing â€" does the business have a response under each review? **Corrective steps:** Reply to every review within 24 hours. Thank positive reviewers. Respond to negative ones professionally: "Thank you for letting us know. We are sorry â€" this is not our standard. Please message us so we can make it right." **How to confirm resolved:** Every review has a response. **Prevention:** Set a daily reminder to check and respond to reviews. It takes 5 minutes.

K.5 No call-to-action on the website

Symptoms: Website shows information but no clear "Order" or "Book" button. **Likely cause:** The owner built a brochure, not a sales page. **How to investigate:** Open the website â€" can a customer place an order or make contact in one click? **Corrective steps:** Add a prominent WhatsApp button, phone number or order button. Make it impossible to miss. **How to confirm resolved:** A stranger can order from the site in under one minute. **Prevention:** Every website needs one clear primary action. For most small businesses, that is "Order on WhatsApp."

K.6 Different tone and design on every platform

Symptoms: Instagram is casual and colourful, the website is formal and plain, WhatsApp is all emojis. **Likely cause:** No brand kit â€" each platform was designed separately without a shared style. **How to investigate:** Compare the colours, fonts and tone across platforms. Do they feel like the same business? **Corrective steps:** Create a Canva Brand Kit with two colours, two fonts and one tone. Apply it everywhere. **How to confirm resolved:** The platforms look and sound like one business. **Prevention:** Set up a Canva Brand Kit before creating any graphic. Use it for everything.

K.7 Claiming a business that is not yours

Symptoms: Learner tries to set up a Google Business Profile for a real business without the owner's permission. **Likely cause:** Not understanding that Google Business Profile represents the business, not the individual. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Does the business owner know you are doing this? Do you have their permission?" **Corrective steps:** Only create or edit profiles for your own business or a fictional one. For real businesses, get written permission from the owner. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner can confirm the owner's permission. **Prevention:** State the rule clearly at the start of the session: your own business or a fictional one only.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it (e.g., the learner can show you the exact platform where the NAP does not match). Teach learners to confirm before concluding â€" ask them to show you the mismatch, not just say "it is inconsistent."

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "Online Presence Audit â€" Three Local Businesses"

Purpose: To practise auditing real local businesses against the presence checklist, identifying strengths and weaknesses, and making realistic recommendations â€" the skill that feeds the capstone's online presence section.

Realistic scenario. You have been hired as a digital marketing consultant by CEA to audit the online presence of three local Port Harcourt businesses. The academy will assign you three businesses (or you may choose three with instructor approval). Your job is to assess each one and write a one-page report per business with a score, a diagnosis and a recommendation.

Detailed instructions:

1. For each business, search for it on Google and Instagram. Complete the 10-point Online Presence Audit Scorecard (from Section I).
2. For each business, write a one-page report with:

- **Score:** X out of 10.
- **Strengths:** What is working well? (At least 2 specific points with evidence.)
- **Weaknesses:** What is missing or broken? (At least 2 specific points with evidence.)
- **Top recommendation:** The ONE thing you would fix first, with a specific action and why.

3. For one of the three businesses, draft a **sample Google Business Profile description** (max 750 characters) and a **sample Instagram bio** (max 150 characters) that the business could use.
4. Write a short paragraph at the end: "What I learned from this audit isâ€¦" â€" one insight about online presence that surprised you or that you will apply to your own business.

Required deliverables:

- Three completed audit scorecards.
- Three one-page reports (score, strengths, weaknesses, top recommendation).
- One sample Google description and Instagram bio.
- The "what I learned" paragraph.

Submission format: Handwritten or typed, submitted at the start of Session 4. Keep a copy in your working folder.

Deadline: Before Session 4.

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Three audits completed	6	All 10 points scored for each business
Strengths identified	3	At least 2 specific, evidence-based strengths per business
Weaknesses identified	3	At least 2 specific, evidence-based weaknesses per business
Top recommendations	3	One clear, realistic, prioritized action per business
Sample Google description & Instagram bio	3	Correct format, specific, consistent NAP
"What I learned" paragraph	2	Gives a real insight, not a generic statement

Common mistakes to avoid: scoring without evidence ("it looks bad"); vague recommendations ("do social media"); inconsistent NAP in the sample descriptions; auditing businesses you did not actually search for; copying the sample descriptions instead of writing your own.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (one business, as a model):

Business: Fictional "Kelechi's Barbershop, GRA" (see Section I for full audit).

Score: 6/10

Strengths:

- Complete Google Business Profile with address, phone, 7 reviews and 5 photos â€" the trust signals are working.
- Active Instagram page with recent before/after photos â€" shows proof of skill.

Weaknesses:

- No opening hours on Google Business Profile â€" customers cannot check if the shop is open.
- No website or landing page â€" no way to see prices or book ahead.
- Phone number on Instagram bio is different from the Google listing â€" inconsistent NAP.

Top recommendation: Add opening hours to the Google Business Profile and fix the phone number on Instagram to match Google exactly. These are free, take 5 minutes, and directly remove friction for customers trying to visit or call.

Sample Google description:

> *"Emeka's Cuts is a barbershop in GRA, Port Harcourt, offering fades, beard trims and all haircuts. Walk-ins welcome. 10 years of experience. Open Monâ€"Sat 8amâ€"7pm. Call 0803-XXX-XXXX to book."*

Sample Instagram bio:

> *"Barbershop in GRA, Port Harcourt ðŸ'ˆ Fades Â· Beard trims Â· All cuts Open Monâ€"Sat 8amâ€"7pm Call/WhatsApp: 0803-XXX-XXXX"*

"What I learned":

> *"I learned that a business can be excellent at what it does and still lose customers because it is incomplete online. Kelechi's Barbershop has good reviews and photos but is missing hours and has an inconsistent phone number â€" small things that cost real customers. I will make sure my own business has complete and consistent information everywhere."*

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. What does NAP stand for, and why is it important?

Q2. Multiple choice. Which of these is NOT one of the six essential elements of a one-page landing page? a) Headline b) How to order c) A blog with 10 articles d) Trust signals

Q3. Match the trust signal. Match each trust signal to why it works. a) Real reviews with responses b) Real photos of real work c) Clear contact information d) Consistent presence

1. Customers can verify the business is real and reach it easily
2. Customers trust other customers' experiences more than the business's claims
3. Customers can tell stock images from reality â€" real photos prove the business exists
4. Consistency shows the business pays attention to details and is accountable

Q4. Explain. Why is a Google Business Profile often more important than a website for a local small business? Give two reasons.

Q5. Scenario. A food kitchen has a Google Business Profile with 3 photos, no description, no products listed, and 1 review. List three specific things the owner should fix first, in order of priority.

Q6. Ethics. Your friend asks you to set up a Google Business Profile for her aunt's salon, but the aunt does not know about it. What do you do, and why?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q6)

A1. NAP stands for Name, Address, Phone number. It is important because these three must be identical across all platforms â€" Google Business Profile, website, Instagram, WhatsApp, flyers. Inconsistency confuses customers and damages trust; Google also uses consistency as a ranking signal.

A2. (c) A blog with 10 articles. A blog is not essential for a one-page landing page. The six essentials are: headline, what you sell, where you are, how to order, trust signals, and contact/hours.

A3. a) 2 â€" reviews are social proof; b) 3 â€" real photos prove the business exists; c) 1 â€" customers can reach and verify the business; d) 4 â€" consistency shows attention to detail.

A4. A Google Business Profile is often more important than a website for a local business because: (1) it is often the first thing a customer sees when searching â€" it appears in Google Search and Maps before any website; (2) it is free and carries reviews and photos that build trust immediately; (3) it has call and message buttons that let customers reach the business instantly. (Accept any two valid reasons.)

A5. In order of priority: (1) Add a description with details â€" what the kitchen sells, where it delivers, and its value proposition; (2) Add products/services with prices â€" so customers can decide before messaging; (3) Add more photos â€" at least 10 real photos of food, kitchen and packaging. (Also acceptable: ask real customers for honest Google reviews.)

A6. I would not set it up without the aunt's knowledge and permission. A Google Business Profile represents the business, and the owner must know about it, be able to verify it (Google sends a verification postcard or call), and be responsible for it. I would explain to my friend that the aunt should be involved â€" or that we should ask her first. Creating a profile for a real business without the owner's knowledge could cause real problems (suspension, incorrect information, the owner losing control of their own listing).

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you built the home your customer arrives at. You learned that your online presence â€" your Google Business Profile, your website, your social profiles â€" is the foundation of everything else. If it is missing or broken, every other channel leaks. You learned to set up a complete Google Business Profile: name, category, address or service area, phone, hours, photos, description, products and reviews. You learned the six elements of a one-page website: headline, what you sell, where, how to order, trust signals, and contact â€" and that you can build one for free with Google Sites or Canva. You learned brand consistency: one name, one logo, two colours, two fonts, one tone â€" everywhere. And you learned the five trust signals that make a stranger buy: real reviews with responses, real photos, clear contact info, credentials, and consistent presence. You audited three real local businesses and saw the difference between a presence that converts and one that repels.

Five important takeaways:

1. Your online presence is the home â€" fix the leaks before pouring more water in.
2. Google Business Profile is your front door on Google â€" complete it with all nine parts.
3. A one-page website needs six elements â€" build it free, build it simple.
4. Brand consistency: name, colours, fonts and tone must match everywhere.
5. Trust signals: real reviews, real photos, clear contact, credentials, consistency.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I set up a complete Google Business Profile with all nine parts?
- Can I plan a one-page website with all six elements?
- Can I create a simple brand kit and one branded graphic in Canva?
- Can I list five trust signals and explain why each works?
- Can I audit a local business and identify its strongest and weakest presence points?

Connection to the next session. You now have a customer (Session 2) and a home (Session 3). Next session we fill that home with content and start showing up where your customer already spends time. You will learn content pillars, a simple weekly calendar, why organic reach must be earned through saves, shares and comments, and how to tell a short story that makes people stop, watch and act. That is Session 4: Content and Social Marketing â€" where we turn your online presence into a living, breathing channel that reaches and persuades.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner sets up a Google Business Profile with all nine parts â€" not just name and address.
- Learner checks NAP consistency across platforms without being reminded.
- Learner's landing page structure includes all six elements with specific, realistic content.
- Learner creates a Canva Brand Kit and applies it to a graphic â€" colours and fonts match.
- Learner's audit scores are evidence-based, not just opinions.
- Learner's recommendations are prioritized and realistic â€" one clear action per business.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "I need an expensive website." â†' No â€" a one-page free site is enough to start.
- "My Google name should include keywords." â†' No â€" use your real name only; keyword stuffing risks suspension.
- "Stock photos are fine." â†' No â€" real photos build trust, stock images destroy it.
- "I do not need to respond to reviews." â†' Responding â€" especially to negative reviews â€" is one of the most powerful trust signals.
- "I can set up a Google profile for any business." â†' Only your own or a fictional one; real businesses need the owner's permission and verification.
- "A website needs many pages." â†' One clear page with six elements is enough for most small businesses.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **GBP completion drill:** Give the learner a half-completed Google Business Profile (name and category only) and ask them to fill in the remaining seven parts.
2. **Landing page repair drill:** Give a weak landing page (missing headline, no order button, no trust signals) and ask the learner to identify and fix the three biggest problems.
3. **Brand consistency check:** Show the learner a business's Instagram page, Google listing and website â€" all with different colours and fonts. Ask them to identify the inconsistencies and suggest a simple brand kit (two colours, two fonts, one tone).
4. **Trust signal hunt:** Give the learner a strong and a weak Google Business Profile and ask them to circle all the trust signals in the strong one and list what is missing in the weak one.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** Provide a Google Business Profile with most fields pre-filled; the learner adds photos, description and products. Provide a landing page template with the six elements as section headers; the learner fills in the content.
- **Level 2 (standard):** The session as written â€" full GBP setup, landing page structure, Canva Brand Kit, and audit of three real businesses.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** Ask the learner to build and *publish* a complete one-page website (not just the structure) and then write a 200-word explanation of why they chose each of the six elements and how each one answers a customer objection from Session 2. Then ask them to set up a complete Google Business Profile for the same fictional business and verify that the NAP matches the website exactly.

Timing guidance. The priority is the guided practical (Section G/H) â€" learners setting up a Google Business Profile and planning a landing page. If the room is slow, shorten the lecture (combine F.3 and F.4) and reduce the case study (Section J) to a 5-minute discussion. If learners struggle with Gmail creation, allocate 10 minutes at the start of the practical for account setup. Protect the practical time â€" a learner who leaves without a started Google Business Profile has no online home.

Capstone link. The Google Business Profile and landing page built today become the capstone's online presence section. The brand kit becomes the capstone's brand consistency document. The audit skill becomes the capstone's competitive awareness. The trust signals become the capstone's conversion strategy. Keep all files safe â€" the capstone assembles them in Session 9.

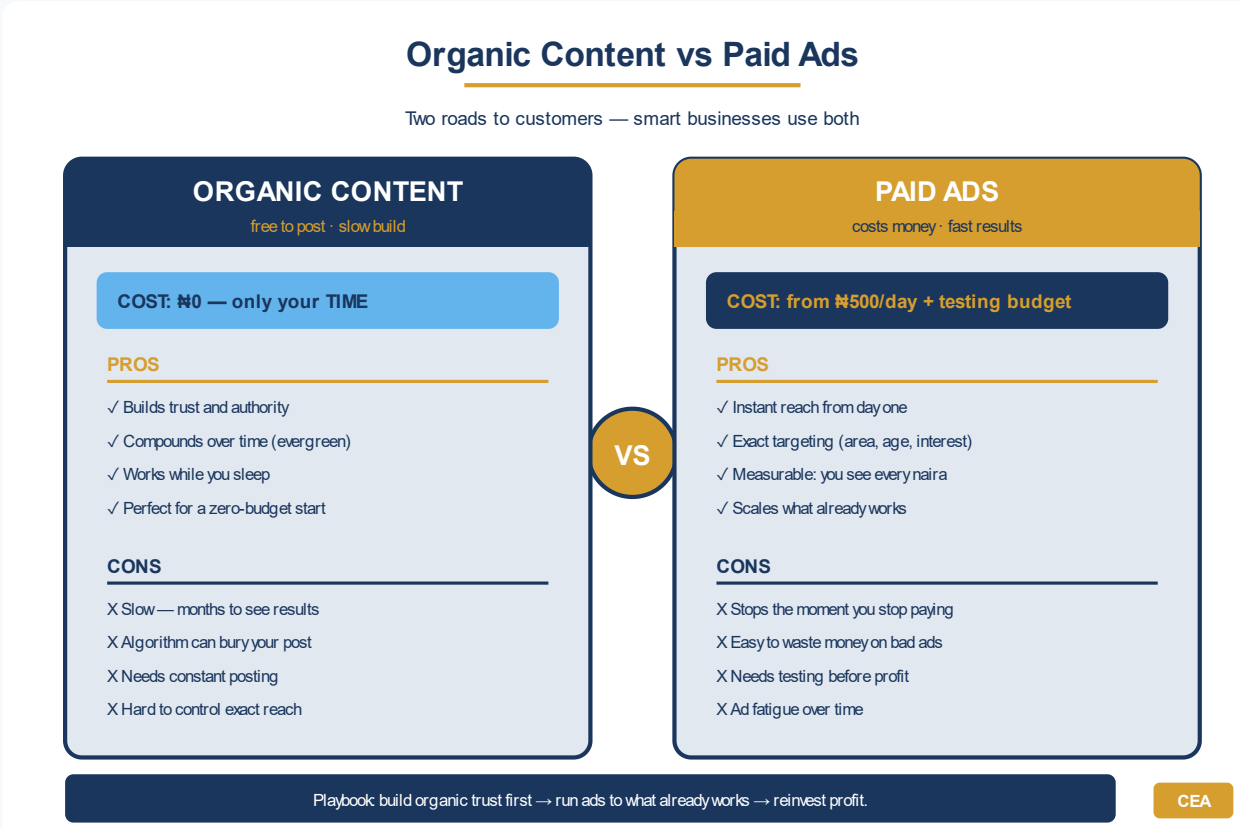
END OF SESSION 3

Next: Session 4 â€" Content and Social Marketing.

SESSION 04 OF 9

Content and Social Marketing

CONCEPT DIAGRAM — SESSION 04



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" DIGITAL MARKETING

SESSION 4 â€" CONTENT AND SOCIAL MARKETING

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	4 of 9
Session title	Content and Social Marketing
Week / Module	Week 2 â€" Module 2: Channels
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (writing and planning, not software)
Prerequisite knowledge	Sessions 1â€"3. Learners should be able to describe the funnel, build a customer avatar, set up a Google Business Profile, and write a value proposition. Basic smartphone and social media

Item	Detail
	use required.
Connection to previous work	In Sessions 1â€“3 we built the map (funnel, journey), the customer (avatar, messaging) and the home (Google Business Profile, website, brand). Now we bring that home to life. Content and social marketing is how you show up, get noticed and build trust with your audience â€” it is the engine that feeds every other channel. Without content, your social media is an empty shop; without a plan, you post randomly and get nothing. Today we learn to plan, create and repurpose content that works.
Preparation before class	Print the Content Pillar Worksheet and the One-Week Content Calendar template (Section H) per learner. Prepare a projector slide showing a real or fictional Instagram feed â€” one with random posting, one with a planned content pillar structure. Prepare a Canva account open for the live demo. Print the Repurposing Map template (Section I). Have the Session 2 avatar worksheet and Session 3 brand kit available for reference.

Instructor note on tone: This session is creative and practical. Many learners think "content" means being a video star or a professional photographer. It does not. Content is simply *useful or entertaining material that shows your work and builds trust*. A kitchen can content its food. A barbershop can content before/after photos. A phone repair shop can content 30-second tips. The skill is not creativity â€” it is *planning*. A good plan beats raw talent every time. Keep the room energetic and hands-on.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Explain** what content marketing is and why it is the engine of social media, using the "empty shop" analogy.
2. **Build a content pillar plan** with three to five pillars for a small business, each pillar tied to a customer pain, goal or interest from their avatar.
3. **Create a one-week content calendar** with format, topic, hook, call-to-action and funnel stage for each post â€” realistic for one person with a phone.
4. **Write a story-led post** using the situationâ€”struggleâ€”solutionâ€”next step structure, with a scroll-stopping hook and a clear call-to-action.
5. **Explain organic reach** and why it must be earned through saves, shares, comments and watch time rather than bought.
6. **Repurpose one idea into at least three formats** â€” for example, one menu photo becoming an Instagram post, a WhatsApp broadcast and a video script.
7. **Apply ethical content rules** â€” honest claims, real photos, no copying, no fake engagement â€” in every piece of content they create.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner (with a notes app and Canva) or an academy computer with internet.
- Instructor computer connected to a projector.
- Whiteboard or flip chart.

Software

- Canva (free tier) for graphics and the brand kit.
- Instagram, Facebook or TikTok (any one) for posting practice â€” posting is optional, planning is essential.
- Phone Notes, Google Docs or paper and pen.
- A camera or smartphone for photos (if available).

Sample files

- **Content Pillar Worksheet** (Section H) â€” one per learner.
- **One-Week Content Calendar template** (Section H) â€” one per learner.

- **Repurposing Map template** (Section I) â€" one per learner.
- **Story Post Template** â€" the situationâ€"struggleâ€"solutionâ€"next step structure printed or on the projector.
- **Example Instagram feed slides** â€" random posting vs. planned pillar structure.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 4.1 â€" "Content Pillar Planner" (pillar / why it matters to the avatar / example topics / funnel stage).
- Worksheet 4.2 â€" "One-Week Content Calendar" (day / format / topic / hook / CTA / funnel stage).
- Worksheet 4.3 â€" "Repurposing Map" (one idea â† 3+ formats).

Accounts

- Canva account (free). At least one social media account for reference. Posting is optional.

Internet

- Required for Canva. Useful for looking at real Instagram feeds. The planning parts work offline.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- A phone with a notes app and Canva works. A learner who cannot type quickly may write by hand. The skill is the *planning and structure*, not the tool.

Safety and ethics note:

- Use only original or free-licensed images â€" never copy photos from other businesses or from Google Images without permission.
- All claims must be honest â€" no fake discounts, no invented urgency, no copied content presented as original.
- Posting to real accounts is optional; the assessed skill is the *plan and the drafts*.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show two Instagram feeds side by side.

Feed A (random posting): A business page with 20 posts â€" random photos of food, a random quote, a random selfie, a random advert, no pattern, no captions with purpose, posted at random times. The profile has 300 followers and 2â€"3 likes per post.

Feed B (planned content): A business page with 20 posts â€" organised into clear themes: "Menu Mondays" (food photos), "Customer Love" (reviews), "Behind the Scenes" (kitchen tips), "Special Offers" (weekly deals). Consistent colours and fonts. 1,500 followers and 30â€"50 likes per post.

What the instructor says:

> *"Two food businesses in Port Harcourt. Both have phones. Both can take photos. But look at the difference. Feed A posts whenever they feel like it â€" a random photo today, nothing for two weeks, a quote that has nothing to do with food. Feed B posts with a plan â€" same themes every week, same style, each post has a purpose. Feed A has 300 followers and 2 likes. Feed B has 1,500 followers and 40 likes. Same effort. Different result. Why?"*

Expected learner response: Learners will say "Feed B looks organised", "it has a pattern", "the posts look like they belong together", "Feed A is just random". Accept all answers and draw out the key point:

> *"Feed B has a plan. It has content pillars â€" recurring themes that tell you what to post before you open the app. Feed A has no plan â€" so they post whatever comes to mind, and the audience never knows what to expect. Today you learn to build the plan. You learn content pillars, a weekly calendar, and how to turn one idea into many posts. Because the difference between 2 likes and 40 likes is not talent â€" it is a plan."*

Why this opener works: It shows, visually, the difference between random and planned content â€" before any theory. Learners recognise the pattern because they see random posting every day on their own feeds.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "In Session 2, we built a customer avatar for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen. What were Chinedu's top two pains?"

- Expected answer: Too tired to cook after work; worried about food hygiene.
- Common gap: learners give generic answers. Prompt: "Be specific â€" what exactly frustrated him?"

Question 2: "In Session 3, we set up a Google Business Profile. What does NAP stand for, and why does it matter?"

- Expected answer: Name, Address, Phone number â€" must be identical across all platforms for trust and Google ranking.
- Common gap: learners remember the acronym but not the reason. Ask: "What happens if they do not match?"

Question 3: "In Session 1, we said channels work together. What is the journey from Instagram to a WhatsApp order for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen?"

- Expected answer: Instagram post â†' Google search â†' Google Business Profile â†' website â†' WhatsApp order.
- Common gap: learners remember the channels but not the sequence. Have them say it as a story.

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"We have the customer, the home and the map. But a home with no furniture is still empty. Content is the furniture â€" the photos, videos, captions and stories that fill your social profiles and make people want to stay. Today we plan that content: what to post, when to post, and how to make one idea work five times. Because the businesses that win on social media are not the ones with the best cameras â€" they are the ones with the best plans."*

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 What content marketing is â€" and why it is the engine

The idea. Content marketing is creating and sharing useful, entertaining or inspiring material â€" photos, videos, captions, stories, posts â€" that attracts people, builds trust and moves them toward buying. Instead of saying "buy my food", you show your food, tell the story behind it, share a tip, make people laugh â€" and they come to you.

Plain-English definition. Content marketing is showing your work and your personality in a way that makes people want to buy â€" without directly asking them to buy every time.

Why it is the engine of social media: Social media platforms are like big markets. Anyone can set up a stall (create a page). But the stalls that get customers are the ones with attractive displays, friendly staff and interesting things to look at. Content is your display, your staff and your products. Without content, your page is an empty stall â€" people walk past. With good content, people stop, look, trust and eventually buy.

What content does:

- **Attracts** â€" a good photo or video stops the scroll.
- **Builds trust** â€" consistent, honest content shows you are real and reliable.
- **Educates** â€" you teach customers what you offer and why it matters.
- **Entertains** â€" you give people a reason to follow you beyond buying.
- **Sells (indirectly)** â€" people who consume your content regularly are ready to buy when the need arises.

Real-life comparison. Think of content marketing like cooking with the window open. If your food smells good, people walking past stop and look. If they see you cooking with clean hands and fresh ingredients, they trust you. If they taste a sample and it is good, they come inside and order. You did not chase them down the street â€" you made something good and let it speak. Content marketing is the same: make something good, put it where people can see it, and let it pull them in.

Common misconception. "Content means I have to be a video star or a professional photographer." No. Some of the best-performing content from small businesses is a simple photo of the actual product with an honest caption. A 15-second video of jollof rice being stirred, with steam rising â€" that is content. A before/after photo of a haircut â€" that is content. A 30-second tip on how to keep your phone battery healthy â€" that is content. The bar is lower than you think. The skill is not production quality â€" it is *consistency and relevance*.

How a learner recognises good content. Ask three questions: Does this stop the scroll? Does it make me trust the business more? Does it tell me what to do next? If yes to all three, it is good content. If no to any, it needs work.

F.2 Content pillars â€" the plan behind the posts

The idea. A **content pillar** is a recurring theme or topic that you post about regularly. Instead of asking "what should I post today?" every morning, you decide in advance: "I post about these three to five things, and I rotate through them." Pillars give your content a structure, make it easy to plan, and tell your audience what to expect from your page.

Why pillars exist: Without pillars, you post randomly â€" a food photo on Monday, a random quote on Wednesday, a selfie on Friday. The audience never knows what to expect, so they do not follow. With pillars, they know: "This page posts recipes on Mondays, behind-the-scenes on Wednesdays, and special offers on Fridays." They follow because they know what they are getting.

How to choose your pillars: Your pillars should be a mix of:

- **What you sell** (your products or services â€" food photos, haircuts, repairs).
- **What your audience cares about** (their pains, goals and interests â€" not just your product).
- **What shows your personality** (behind the scenes, your story, your values).

Worked example â€" Mama Nkechi's Kitchen, five content pillars:

Pillar	What it covers	Why it works	Example post
1. The Menu	Photos and videos of the food	Shows what you sell; makes people hungry	"Today's special: smoky jollof with fried plantain ðŸ□² â‚¦1,500"
2. The Kitchen	Behind the scenes â€" cooking, prep, packaging	Builds trust through transparency and hygiene	"Morning prep â€" fresh ingredients, clean kitchen, every single day âœ¨"
3. The Customer	Reviews, testimonials, customer photos	Social proof â€" people trust other people	"Chinedu ordered for the third time this month. Thank you! ðŸ™□"
4. The Tip	Quick food tips, recipes, advice	Gives value beyond buying; builds loyalty	"3 tips for reheating jollof without drying it out ðŸ'‡"
5. The Offer	Special deals, discounts, bundles	Drives conversion without being pushy	"Order 2 plates, get a free drink this weekend only ðŸ¥¤"

Say to the class:

> *"Notice the balance. Three pillars are about the product (menu, offer, tip). Two are about trust and relationship (kitchen, customer). If you only post about your product, people get bored â€" it feels like an advert. If you only post tips and behind-the-scenes, people enjoy your content but forget to buy. The mix is the magic. Three to five pillars, rotated weekly, is the sweet spot for a small business."*

How many pillars should a beginner have? Three to five. Fewer than three and your content feels repetitive. More than five and you cannot keep them all going. Start with three strong pillars and add more later.

Common misconception. "Pillars limit my creativity." No â€" pillars *free* your creativity. Instead of staring at a blank screen wondering what to post, you think: "It is Wednesday â€" today is The Kitchen pillar. What can I show from the kitchen today?" The structure gives you a starting point, not a cage.

F.3 The one-week content calendar â€" planning before posting

The idea. A **content calendar** is a simple plan that says what you will post, on which day, in what format, with what hook and what call-to-action. It turns "I should post something" into "On Monday at 12pm I post a menu photo with the hook 'Hungry?' and the CTA 'Order on WhatsApp'."

Why a calendar exists: Most small businesses fail at social media not because they post bad content, but because they post *inconsistently*. They post five times one day, then nothing for two weeks. The algorithm notices â€" and so do the followers. A

calendar makes consistency possible, even when you are busy. You can even plan a whole week of content in one sitting â€" this is called **batching**.

The six parts of a calendar entry:

1. **Day and time** â€" when to post.
2. **Format** â€" photo, video, carousel, story, reel, text.
3. **Topic** â€" what the post is about (which pillar).
4. **Hook** â€" the first line or visual that stops the scroll.
5. **Call-to-action (CTA)** â€" what you want the viewer to do.
6. **Funnel stage** â€" awareness, consideration, conversion or retention.

Worked example â€" Mama Nkechi's Kitchen, one-week calendar:

Day	Format	Pillar	Topic	Hook	CTA	Stage
Mon	Photo	The Menu	Jollof rice plate	"Monday blues? Hot jollof fixes everything ðŸ□²"	"Order on WhatsApp"	Conversion
Tue	Story	The Kitchen	Morning prep behind-the-scenes	"POV: it is 7am and your lunch is being cooked fresh"	"Watch till the end"	Awareness
Wed	Photo	The Customer	Customer review screenshot	"Chinedu just ordered for the 3rd time ðŸ□"	"Join him â€" order today"	Conversion
Thu	Reel	The Tip	3 tips for perfect party jollof	"Stop making dry jollof at parties â€" here is why"	"Save this for your next event"	Awareness
Fri	Photo	The Offer	Weekend bundle	"2 plates + small chops + 2 drinks = â,¦3,500. This weekend only."	"Order before 2pm Saturday"	Conversion
Sat	Story	The Menu	Saturday special â€" ofe nsala	"Today only: white soup with goat meat ðŸ□□"	"Order now â€" limited quantity"	Conversion
Sun	Carousel	The Customer	Customer photos from the week	"Our customers this week â€" thank you all ðŸ™□"	"Tag a friend who needs this"	Retention

Say to the class:

> *"Look at this calendar. Every post has a purpose. Every post has a hook. Every post has a CTA. Every post fits a pillar. And notice the mix: three conversion posts (directly driving orders), two awareness posts (building reach), one consideration post (building trust), one retention post (staying in touch). That is a balanced week. And the best part: you can plan this whole week in 30 minutes on Sunday evening â€" then post each day without thinking."*

How often should a small business post? Three to five times per week is the sweet spot. Daily is fine if you have the content. Less than three and the algorithm forgets you. More than ten and you burn out. Consistency beats frequency â€" three posts every week for a year beats ten posts in one week and nothing for a month.

Best times to post (general guidance for Nigeria): Lunch time (12pmâ€"1pm) and evening (7pmâ€"9pm) â€" when people are on their phone and thinking about food. But the best time for *your* audience is the time *they* are online. Check your Instagram Insights (free) to see when your followers are most active.

Common misconception. "I must post every day or the algorithm kills me." No. The algorithm rewards *engagement* â€" saves, shares, comments, watch time â€" not raw frequency. One post that gets 50 saves is worth more than ten posts that get 2 likes. Quality and consistency beat quantity.

F.4 Organic reach â€" why it must be earned, not bought

The idea. Organic reach is the number of people who see your post *without you paying for it* â€" because the platform showed it to them in their feed or explore page. This is the opposite of paid reach (ads). Organic reach is free â€" but it must be *earned* by creating content that people actually engage with.

Why organic reach matters: Most small businesses cannot afford to run ads every day. Organic reach is how you get seen without spending money. But organic reach is not guaranteed â€" it depends on whether people engage with your content. The algorithm (the platform's internal system) shows your post to more people if it sees people stopping, watching, saving, sharing and commenting.

What the algorithm rewards (the four engagement signals):

1. **Watch time** â€" people watching your video to the end (or most of it). This is the strongest signal. If people watch your 15-second reel for 12 seconds, the algorithm thinks "this is good" and shows it to more people.
2. **Saves** â€" people tapping "save" on your post. This means "I want to come back to this" â€" very strong signal. Tips, recipes and how-to content get saved a lot.
3. **Shares** â€" people sending your post to a friend or sharing it to their story. This means "someone I know needs to see this" â€" extremely strong signal. Funny, relatable or very useful content gets shared.
4. **Comments** â€" people writing a comment. More comments = more algorithm love. Questions in your caption ("What is your favourite soup?") drive comments.

What the algorithm punishes:

- Boring content that people scroll past.
- Content that people hide or report.
- Engagement pods (groups that artificially like and comment on each other's posts) â€" the algorithm can detect these.
- Buying likes, followers or views â€" detected and penalised.

How to earn organic reach (practical rules):

- **Hook in the first 3 seconds** â€" start your video or caption with something that stops the scroll.
- **Make content worth saving** â€" tips, recipes, checklists, how-to guides.
- **Make content worth sharing** â€" relatable humour, "tag a friend" posts, impressive transformations.
- **Ask questions** â€" in your caption, in your video, in your story. Questions drive comments.
- **Post consistently** â€" the algorithm rewards accounts that post regularly.
- **Respond to comments** â€" conversation doubles engagement.

Worked example â€" how one post earned organic reach:

> *Mama Nkechi's Kitchen posts a 20-second reel: "Stop making dry jollof at parties â€" here is the one mistake everyone makes." The video shows jollof being cooked, then a close-up of dry, crumbly jollof, then the fix (add more stock, lower the heat).*
>
> *Result: 500 views in 2 hours. 45 people saved it ("need this for my sister's wedding"). 20 people shared it to their story ("this is why my jollof is always dry!"). 30 comments ("Oh no, I have been doing this wrong!"). The algorithm sees high watch time, saves, shares and comments â€" and shows it to 5,000 more people. By the next day: 8,000 views, 3 DMs asking "do you deliver to GRA?" â€" two new orders.*
>
> *Total cost: zero naira. Total effort: 20 seconds of video and a hook that stops the scroll.*

Say to the class:

> *"That is the power of organic reach. One good post, earned through a real hook and real value, can reach thousands of people and bring real orders â€" for free. But notice: it was earned. It earned saves by being useful. It earned shares by being relatable. It earned watch time by being interesting. You cannot buy that. You can only earn it by making content people actually want."*

Common misconception. "Organic reach is dead â€" you must pay for ads." No. Organic reach is harder than it was five years ago, but it is very much alive â€" especially for small, local businesses with a clear niche and good content. The businesses that give up on organic and go straight to ads are often the ones whose content was not good enough in the first place. Fix the content first; consider ads later (Session 7).

F.5 Storytelling â€" the situationâ€"struggleâ€"solutionâ€" next step structure

The idea. People do not remember facts â€" they remember **stories**. A story-led post takes the viewer through a mini-narrative: a situation they recognise, a struggle they feel, a solution they want, and a next step they can take. This structure turns a flat product post into something people actually feel.

The four-part story structure:

1. **Situation** â€" set the scene. Something the viewer recognises. "It is 6pm. You have just finished work. You are tired."
2. **Struggle** â€" name the problem. The pain the viewer feels. "The last thing you want to do is cook. But you are hungry, and you deserve a proper meal."
3. **Solution** â€" offer the answer. Your product or service. "Mama Nkechi's Kitchen delivers hot jollof and small chops to your door in 45 minutes."
4. **Next step** â€" tell them what to do. A clear call-to-action. "Order on WhatsApp now â€" 0803-XXX-XXXX. â‚¦1,500 a plate."

Worked example â€" story-led post for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen:

> ***Situation:*** *"Friday evening. You have survived a long week."* ***Struggle:*** *"All you want is good food and a couch. But the thought of cooking makes you want to cry."* ***Solution:*** *"Mama Nkechi's Kitchen has you. Smoky jollof, crispy small chops, delivered hot to your door."* ***Next step:*** *"Order on WhatsApp before 7pm â€" 0803-XXX-XXXX. â‚¦1,500. You have earned this. ðŸ²"*

Why this works: It does not start with the product â€" it starts with the *viewer's life*. The viewer sees themselves in the situation. They feel the struggle. They want the solution. And they know exactly what to do next. That is persuasion â€" not through pressure, but through empathy.

Another worked example â€" story-led post for a barbershop:

> ***Situation:*** *"Job interview on Monday. You need to look sharp."* ***Struggle:*** *"Your last barber rushed the fade and it is still growing out badly."* ***Solution:*** *"At Kelechi's Cuts, we take our time. Every fade is done right â€" walk out looking like the best version of yourself."* ***Next step:*** *"Book today â€" 0803-XXX-XXXX. Walk-ins welcome, GRA."*

How a learner writes a story-led post:

1. Pick one pain from your avatar.
2. Write the situation â€" when does this pain happen?
3. Write the struggle â€" how does it feel?
4. Write the solution â€" how does your business fix it?
5. Write the next step â€" what should the viewer do now?
6. Read it aloud. Does it feel like a real story or a brochure? If it feels like a brochure, add more feeling.

Common misconception. "Stories are only for long captions." No. A story can be four lines in a caption, a 15-second video, or a carousel of four slides. The structure is the same: situation â†' struggle â†' solution â†' next step. Length does not matter â€" structure does.

F.6 Hooks and calls-to-action â€" the two lines that decide everything

The idea. A **hook** is the first thing a viewer sees or reads â€" the line that decides whether they stop scrolling or keep going. A **call-to-action (CTA)** is the line that tells them what to do next. These two lines â€" the first and the last â€" are the most important words in your post.

Why the hook matters: On a platform where people scroll past hundreds of posts per session, you have roughly 1â€"3 seconds to win attention. If your hook does not stop them, nothing else in your post matters â€" they will never read it.

Five hook formulas (with Nigerian examples):

1. **The Question** â€" ask something the viewer wants answered.
   - "Still paying â‚¦2,000 for food that arrives cold?"
   - "Tired of your phone dying by 2pm?"
2. **The Bold Claim** â€" state something strong and honest.

- "This is the jollof rice your mother wishes she made."
- "The only fade you will ever need."

3. **The Number/List** â€" promise a specific count.
   - "3 mistakes that ruin every party jollof."
   - "5 things to check before hiring a caterer."
4. **The Warning** â€" warn them about a common error.
   - "Stop making dry jollof â€" here is why it happens."
   - "Do not book a photographer until you ask these 3 questions."
5. **The Story** â€" open a mini-narrative.
   - "A customer came in for one dress â€" and left with five."
   - "I lost â‚¦18,000 on one cake order. Here is the mistake I made."

Why the CTA matters: Without a CTA, people who enjoyed your post often do nothing â€" because you never asked. A clear CTA removes the decision: it tells them precisely what to do and where. "Order on WhatsApp" is a CTA. "Message us" is weak. "DM 'JOLLOF' to order" is strong â€" specific and easy.

The CTA matching table:

Goal	Strong CTA	Weak CTA
Get orders	"Order on WhatsApp â€" 0803-XXX-XXXX"	"Message us"
Get calls	"Call 0803-XXX-XXXX to book today"	"Contact us"
Get DMs	"DM 'JOLLOF' for the menu"	"Check our DMs"
Get saves	"Save this for your next party"	"Nice, right?"
Get shares	"Tag a friend who needs this"	"Share if you like"
Get comments	"Comment your favourite soup below"	"What do you think?"

Common misconception. "A strong video sells itself." No. Even happy viewers need to be told what to do. Always end with a CTA. Always.

F.7 Repurposing â€" one idea, five posts

The idea. Repurposing is taking one piece of content and adapting it into multiple formats and posts. Instead of creating five separate ideas from scratch, you create one strong idea and turn it into five different posts. This saves time, keeps you consistent, and maximises the value of every piece of content you create.

Why repurposing exists: Content is hard work. Shooting a video, writing a caption, designing a graphic â€" it takes time. If you only use each idea once, you will run out of content within a month. Repurposing lets you create once and publish five times.

Ways to repurpose one idea:

Worked example â€" one menu photo of jollof rice becomes:

1. **Instagram post** â€" the photo with a caption: "Monday blues? Hot jollof fixes everything ðŸ□² â‚¦1,500. Order on WhatsApp."
2. **WhatsApp broadcast** â€" the same photo sent to the customer list: "Good morning! Today's special: smoky jollof, â‚¦1,500. Reply YES to order."
3. **Reel/Video** â€" a 15-second video of the same jollof being stirred, with steam rising, set to music, with the text overlay: "POV: your Monday just got better."
4. **Story** â€" the photo as an Instagram story with a poll: "Jollof today? Yes / Definitely yes."
5. **Carousel** â€" a 3-slide post: slide 1 = the photo, slide 2 = "3 reasons our jollof is different", slide 3 = "Order on WhatsApp â€" 0803-XXX-XXXX."

Say to the class:

> *"One photo. Five posts. That is repurposing. You cooked the jollof once â€" you photographed it once â€" and you used it five times across three platforms. That is how a one-person business stays consistent on social media without burning out. You do not need to create new content every day. You need to repurpose what you already have."*

Common misconception. "Repurposing means posting the same thing everywhere." No â€" it means *adapting* the same core idea for each format and platform. The caption changes, the format changes, the CTA changes â€" but the core idea (this jollof looks good, order it) stays the same.

F.8 Content ethics â€" honesty in every post

The idea. Every piece of content you create must be honest. This is not optional â€" it is the foundation of trust, and trust is the foundation of your business.

The five content ethics rules:

1. **Honest claims.** If you say "45-minute delivery", it must be 45 minutes. If you say "made fresh every morning", it must be true. No fake discounts ("was â‚¦3,000, now â‚¦1,500" when it was always â‚¦1,500). No invented urgency ("only 2 plates left" when there are 200).
2. **Real photos.** Use photos of your actual products. Do not use stock images of food you did not make. Do not copy photos from another business's Instagram. If your product is not photogenic yet, improve the product or the presentation â€" do not fake it.
3. **No copying.** Do not copy another business's caption, idea or design and present it as your own. You can be inspired by others â€" but create your own version. Plagiarism is intellectual dishonesty, and it is easily spotted.
4. **No fake engagement.** Do not buy likes, followers, comments or shares. Do not use engagement pods or bots. Do not ask friends to like every post (a genuine share is fine â€" a coordinated like-fest is fake). Earned engagement is real; bought engagement is fraud.
5. **Give credit.** If you use someone's photo, music or idea, credit them. Use free or licensed assets â€" Canva's free library, royalty-free music, your own photos. Never use copyrighted material without permission.

Say to the class:

> *"These rules are not just academy policy â€" they are good business. A business that lies in its content gets caught. A business that uses fake photos gets called out. A business that buys followers gets penalised by the platform. The businesses that win long-term are the ones that build real trust through honest content. That is the only sustainable way â€" and it is the only way we practice in this course."*

F.9 Summary of the lecture

- **Content marketing** is the engine of social media â€" showing your work so people want to buy.
- **Content pillars** are your recurring themes â€" three to five, mixing product, value and personality.
- **A content calendar** plans what to post, when, with what hook and CTA â€" for a whole week in 30 minutes.
- **Organic reach** must be earned through watch time, saves, shares and comments â€" not bought.
- **Storytelling** follows situation â†' struggle â†' solution â†' next step â€" persuasion through empathy.
- **Hooks and CTAs** are the first and last lines â€" they decide whether people stop and act.
- **Repurposing** turns one idea into five posts â€" the key to consistency without burnout.
- **Ethics** â€" honest claims, real photos, no copying, no fake engagement, give credit â€" always.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[One idea] --> B[Blog post]
    A --> C[Social post]
    A --> D[Video]
    A --> E[Email]
```

```
B --> F[Reach audience]
C --> F
D --> F
E --> F
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- On the projector: the Content Pillar Worksheet and the One-Week Content Calendar template.
- Canva open with the Mama Nkechi's Kitchen Brand Kit (from Session 3).
- A sample menu photo (or a Canva food template).

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€" build content pillars live (4 minutes)

Say: "Let us build content pillars for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen. We have the avatar â€" Chinedu. We have his pains â€" too tired to cook, worried about hygiene. We have the brand â€" warm, motherly, honest. What should she post about?"

Fill the pillar worksheet on the projector, narrating:

Pillar	Why it matters to Chinedu
The Menu	Shows the food â€" makes him hungry, answers "what do they sell?"
The Kitchen	Shows the hygiene â€" answers "is it clean?"
The Customer	Shows social proof â€" answers "do others trust them?"
The Tip	Gives value â€" saves his jollof, builds loyalty
The Offer	Drives action â€" gives a reason to order this week

Ask the class: "What would you add or change?" Let them suggest; discuss briefly.

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€" plan one week of content live (5 minutes)

Say: "Now let us take these pillars and build a week of content. I will think out loud."

Fill the calendar template on the projector:

- **Monday â€" The Menu:** "Monday blues? Hot jollof fixes everything ðŸ²" â€" CTA: Order on WhatsApp â€" Stage: Conversion
- **Tuesday â€" The Kitchen (story):** "POV: it is 7am and your lunch is being cooked fresh" â€" CTA: Watch till the end â€" Stage: Awareness
- **Wednesday â€" The Customer:** "Chinedu just ordered for the 3rd time ðŸ'" â€" CTA: Join him â€" Stage: Conversion
- **Thursday â€" The Tip (reel):** "Stop making dry jollof â€" here is the one mistake" â€" CTA: Save this â€" Stage: Awareness
- **Friday â€" The Offer:** "2 plates + small chops + 2 drinks = â‚¦3,500. This weekend only." â€" CTA: Order before 2pm â€" Stage: Conversion
- **Saturday â€" The Menu (story):** "Today only: white soup with goat meat ðŸ" â€" CTA: Order now â€" Stage: Conversion
- **Sunday â€" The Customer (carousel):** "Our customers this week â€" thank you all ðŸ™" â€" CTA: Tag a friend â€" Stage: Retention

Say:

> *"That took three minutes. A whole week of content, planned. Each post has a pillar, a hook, a CTA and a funnel stage. And the mix is balanced â€" conversion, awareness and retention are all covered. This is how you plan a week in one sitting."*

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€" repurpose one photo into three posts (4 minutes)

Say: "Last piece. I have one photo of jollof rice. Watch me turn it into three posts."

Using Canva with the Brand Kit:

1. **Instagram post:** The photo with the headline "Hot jollof, delivered to your door in PH" and the CTA "Order on WhatsApp â€" 0803-XXX-XXXX."
2. **WhatsApp broadcast text:** "Good morning! Today's special: smoky jollof, â‚¦1,500. Reply YES to order."
3. **Reel concept (sketch on paper):** 15-second video â€" stir the jollof, steam rises, text overlay "POV: your Monday just got better", end card "Order on WhatsApp."

Say:

> *"One photo. Three posts. Three platforms. That is repurposing. And notice â€" I used the same brand colours, fonts and tone in all three. That is consistency. That is how you build recognition."*

G.5 Questions to ask during the demo

- "Why do we plan a week at a time instead of day by day?" (Efficiency â€" batching saves time and keeps you consistent.)
- "Why does every post need a funnel stage?" (So you know what job each post is doing â€" awareness, trust, sale or retention.)
- "Why is the CTA different for each post?" (Because the goal is different â€" some posts drive orders, some build awareness, some reward loyalty.)
- "What happens if we post only conversion content?" (People get tired of being sold to â€" they unfollow. The mix keeps them engaged.)
- "Can we repurpose the same content next month?" (Yes â€" but adapt it. New hook, new angle, new CTA. The core idea stays, the words stay fresh.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding, each learner builds a content pillar plan and a one-week content calendar for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen (or their own approved business), and repurposes one idea into three formats.

Starting materials: The Content Pillar Worksheet, the One-Week Content Calendar template, the Repurposing Map template, a pen. Canva open for the repurposing demo.

Procedure (instructor calls out each step; learners follow; instructor walks the room):

1. Choose your business â€" Mama Nkechi's Kitchen or your own approved business. Write the name at the top of the Content Pillar Worksheet.
2. Build **three to five content pillars**. For each pillar, write: the name, why it matters to your avatar, two example topics, and which funnel stage it mainly serves.
3. **Pause and predict:** Look at your pillars. Do they cover the mix â€" product, value and personality? If all your pillars are "buy my product", add a trust or value pillar.
4. Turn to the One-Week Content Calendar. Plan **five posts** for one week (Monday to Friday). For each post, fill in: day, format, pillar, topic, hook, CTA and funnel stage.
5. **Pause and predict:** Read your calendar aloud. Does each post have a clear purpose? Is there a mix of conversion, awareness and retention? If not, adjust.
6. Choose **one** of your five posts â€" preferably a photo or a strong idea. On the Repurposing Map, write the core idea in the centre.
7. Repurpose that one idea into **three different formats** â€" for example, an Instagram post, a WhatsApp broadcast and a story. Write the caption or script for each.
8. **Pause and predict:** Read your three versions. Are they adapted for each format â€" or copy-pasted? If copy-pasted, rewrite at least one so it fits its format better.
9. If you have time, open Canva and create a simple graphic for your strongest post using your brand kit (two colours, two fonts).
10. Keep all worksheets in your working folder â€" this is the start of your capstone content plan.

Expected result (model answer â€" instructor key):

A completed pillar worksheet with 3â€“5 pillars, a completed 5-post calendar with hooks, CTAs and funnel stages, and a repurposing map with one idea turned into three adapted formats.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 3: "Do your pillars serve only one funnel stage? If so, what are you missing?" (A plan with only conversion posts will feel pushy â€” add awareness and trust pillars.)
- After step 5: "Read your hooks aloud. Would a stranger stop for each one? Which hook is weakest?" (Have them rewrite the weakest hook.)
- After step 8: "Are your three repurposed versions different enough? What would make each one feel native to its platform?"

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Pillars are all product-focused â†' "Add a pillar that gives value without selling â€" a tip, a behind-the-scenes, a customer story."
- Calendar has no variety in format â†' "You have five photo posts. Add a reel, a story or a carousel for variety."
- Hooks are greetings ("Hello everyone") â†' "Replace with a question, warning, number or bold claim."
- CTAs are missing or vague ("Check us out") â†' "Add a specific action: Order on WhatsApp, DM 'JOLLOF', Call now."
- Repurposed posts are identical â†' "Adapt each one: shorter for WhatsApp, visual for Instagram, interactive for a story."
- Learner has no ideas for pillars â†' "Go back to your avatar. What do they care about? What do they need? Build pillars around their pains and goals."

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ 3â€“5 content pillars defined, each tied to the avatar
- ☐ Pillars cover product, value and personality (not just selling)
- ☐ 5-post calendar completed with day, format, pillar, topic, hook, CTA, stage
- ☐ Calendar has a mix of funnel stages (not all conversion)
- ☐ One idea repurposed into 3 adapted formats
- ☐ Repurposed versions are adapted, not copy-pasted
- ☐ All worksheets saved in working folder

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task: You are the content manager for *Kelechi's Phone Repairs* (the fictional phone repair shop from Session 2). Build a content pillar plan and a one-week calendar for them, and repurpose one post into three formats.

Requirements:

1. Build **four content pillars** for Kelechi's Phone Repairs. Remember: Kelechi's avatar is Kelechi (26, bank worker in Trans-Amadi, needs fast, trustworthy phone repair). Pillars should cover product, value and personality.
2. Plan **five posts** for one week. Each must have: format, topic, hook, CTA and funnel stage.
3. Choose one post and repurpose it into **three formats** (e.g., Instagram post, WhatsApp broadcast, story or reel).
4. Write one sentence explaining your pillar mix: "I chose these pillars becauseâ€¦"

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- Four pillars defined, each tied to the avatar's pains and goals.
- Five posts with all six calendar elements completed.
- One idea repurposed into three adapted formats.
- Pillar mix explanation is clear and references the avatar.

Hints if stuck:

- Hint 1: Think about what a phone repair customer needs to know â€" what you fix, how fast, how much, why trust you.
- Hint 2: Your pillars could include: The Fix (before/after repairs), The Tip (phone care advice), The Trust (reviews, warranty, credentials), The Offer (deals, bundles).

- Hint 3: For the repurposing, take your strongest post and adapt it â€" shorter for WhatsApp, visual for Instagram, interactive for a story.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

Four content pillars for Kelechi's Phone Repairs:

Pillar	Why it matters to Kelechi (the avatar)	Example topics	Funnel stage
The Fix	Shows proof of skill â€" answers "can they actually fix it?"	Before/after screen repairs, battery swaps	Consideration
The Tip	Gives value beyond buying â€" builds loyalty	"3 habits that kill your battery", "Why your phone overheats"	Awareness
The Trust	Answers "can I trust them with my data?"	Warranty info, repair process, reviews	Consideration
The Offer	Drives action â€" gives a reason to book now	"Screen + battery combo: â‚¦18,000 (save â‚¦2,000)"	Conversion

Five-post calendar:

Day	Format	Pillar	Topic	Hook	CTA	Stage
Mon	Photo	The Fix	Cracked screen before/after	"Screen broke at 9am. Fixed by 11am. ðŸ"±"	"Book today â€" 0803-XXX-XXXX"	Conversion
Tue	Reel	The Tip	3 habits killing your battery	"Stop charging your phone to 100% â€" here is why"	"Save this for later"	Awareness
Wed	Photo	The Trust	Warranty and process	"Every repair comes with a 30-day warranty. Here is how it works."	"Ask us anything â€" WhatsApp"	Consideration
Thu	Story	The Offer	Combo deal	"Screen + battery this week: â‚¦18,000. Save â‚¦2,000."	"Reply YES to book"	Conversion
Fri	Carousel	The Fix	Top 3 repairs this week	"This week we fixed 47 phones. Here are the top 3 problems."	"Tag a friend who needs this"	Retention

Repurposing â€" the Monday post (cracked screen before/after):

1. **Instagram post:** The before/after photo with caption: "Screen broke at 9am. Fixed by 11am. ðŸ"± We repair in front of you â€" you watch the whole process. 30-day warranty. Call 0803-XXX-XXXX to book."
2. **WhatsApp broadcast:** "Cracked your screen? We fix in 2 hours â€" walk in, wait with a free coffee, walk out with a working phone. 30-day warranty. Call 0803-XXX-XXXX to book."
3. **Instagram story:** The before photo with a poll: "Cracked screen? We can fix this. Yes / Definitely yes" â†' link to WhatsApp.

Pillar mix explanation: "I chose these pillars because Kelechi's avatar (the bank worker) needs proof of skill (The Fix), answers to trust questions (The Trust), value that builds loyalty (The Tip) and a reason to book now (The Offer). This mix covers the full journey from awareness to conversion."

Learner marking (out of 10):

- Four pillars defined and tied to the avatar (3)
- Five-post calendar with all elements (4)
- One idea repurposed into three adapted formats (2)
- Pillar mix explanation clear (1)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Adaeze* runs a small bakery in Port Harcourt â€" *Adaeze's Bakes* â€" specialising in custom cakes and small chops. She has an Instagram page with 800 followers, posts beautiful photos of her cakes, but only when she remembers â€" sometimes three times a week, sometimes once a month. Her captions are usually just "Order now" or "Available." She has no

content pillars, no calendar, and no repurposing system. She gets a few cake orders a month, mostly from people who already know her. Meanwhile, a competitor â€" *Sweet Treats PH* â€" posts three times a week with a clear structure: "Cake of the Week" every Monday, "Behind the Scenes" every Wednesday, "Customer Love" every Friday. Sweet Treats has 5,000 followers and gets 10â€"15 cake orders a month from Instagram alone.

Relevant facts.

- Adaeze's cakes are excellent â€" as good as or better than Sweet Treats.
- Her Instagram photos are professional and beautiful.
- She has no content plan â€" she posts whenever she has a new cake photo.
- Her captions have no hooks, no stories, no CTAs.
- Sweet Treats uses a simple three-pillar system and repurposes every cake photo into three posts.
- Both businesses are in the same area and target the same customers (mums planning parties, young people planning events).

Decision point. Adaeze comes to you and says: "I post good photos. Why do they get more orders than me? Is it because they have more followers?"

Possible approaches.

1. **"Yes â€" you need more followers. Buy some or run ads to get them."** â€" This is wrong. Followers do not buy cakes; *content* buys cakes. Buying followers or running ads without a content plan will waste money.
2. **"Your photos are the problem â€" hire a better photographer."** â€" Her photos are already good. This solves a problem she does not have.
3. **"You need a content plan â€" pillars, calendar, hooks, CTAs and repurposing."** â€" This is the right answer.

Recommended solution. Approach 3. Adaeze's problem is not her product or her photos â€" it is her *content system*. She needs to:

1. **Build three to four content pillars:** "Cake of the Week" (the product), "Behind the Scenes" (trust and personality), "Customer Love" (social proof), "The Tip" (baking advice â€" gives value and builds loyalty).
2. **Plan a one-week calendar:** Monday â€" Cake of the Week with a hook and CTA. Wednesday â€" Behind the Scenes (baking process, clean kitchen, packaging). Friday â€" Customer Love (review, testimonial, customer photo). Sunday â€" The Tip (a baking tip or a "save this" post).
3. **Write hooks and CTAs for every post:** Not "Order now" but "Planning a birthday party? This cake will steal the show ðŸŽ‚, Order 2 weeks ahead â€" 0803-XXX-XXXX."
4. **Repurpose every cake photo:** One photo becomes an Instagram post, a WhatsApp broadcast and a story. Three posts from one photo.
5. **Post consistently:** Three times a week, every week â€" no more random posting.

Say to the class:

> *"Adaeze does not need more followers or better photos. She needs a system. The same effort she already puts in â€" taking beautiful photos â€" will produce five times the results when it is organised into pillars, planned in a calendar, and repurposed across formats. That is the difference between 800 followers and 5,000 followers â€" and between 3 cake orders and 15 cake orders a month. The product was never the problem. The plan was."*

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 (buy followers/ads): wastes money on an audience that has no relationship with the business â€" they will not buy.
- Approach 2 (better photographer): her photos are already good â€" this solves a non-problem.
- Approach 3 (content system): free, uses the effort she already puts in, builds a real audience that actually buys.

Professional connection. This is the most common content marketing situation: a business with a good product and good photos but no system. The consultant's job is not to tell them to work harder â€" it is to tell them to work *smarter*. A content plan is the highest-leverage intervention you can make for a small business on social media. It costs nothing, uses what they already have, and multiplies the results. That is the skill you are building today.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the live guide. Point learners to the row rather than giving the answer.

K.1 Posting randomly with no plan

Symptoms: Inconsistent posting â€” five posts one day, nothing for two weeks. No clear themes. **Likely cause:** No content pillars or calendar. The owner posts "when they feel like it." **How to investigate:** Look at the Instagram feed â€” is there a pattern? Are there recurring themes? **Corrective steps:** Build 3â€“5 pillars. Plan a one-week calendar. Batch the planning (30 minutes on Sunday for the whole week). **How to confirm resolved:** The feed shows a consistent pattern â€” same pillars rotating, regular posting schedule. **Prevention:** Plan every week. A calendar is not optional â€” it is the difference between random and consistent.

K.2 Only posting "buy my product" content

Symptoms: Every post is a product photo with "Order now" or "Available." Followers stop engaging. **Likely cause:** No pillar mix â€” the owner thinks social media is just a catalogue. **How to investigate:** Count the posts. How many are direct sales pitches vs. value/trust/personality? **Corrective steps:** Add at least two non-sales pillars: a tip, a behind-the-scenes, a customer story. Aim for a 60/40 mix â€” 60% value/trust, 40% sales. **How to confirm resolved:** The feed shows variety â€” product posts mixed with tips, stories and customer content. **Prevention:** Use the pillar mix rule: product, value and personality â€” always.

K.3 No hooks (greetings or descriptions instead of stoppers)

Symptoms: Posts start with "Hello everyone" or "Our new product." Low engagement. **Likely cause:** The owner does not know hook formulas. **How to investigate:** Read the first line of the last five posts. Would a stranger stop? **Corrective steps:** Replace every hook with a question, warning, number, bold claim or story. Use the five formulas from Section F.6. **How to confirm resolved:** Every post's first line would make a stranger stop. **Prevention:** Write the hook first. If the hook does not stop you, rewrite it before you finish the post.

K.4 No CTAs (or vague ones)

Symptoms: People like the post but do not order, message or call. **Likely cause:** The owner forgot to ask, or thinks "order now" is pushy. **How to investigate:** Read the last line of the post. Is there one clear action? **Corrective steps:** Add a specific CTA that matches the post's goal. "Order on WhatsApp â€” 0803-XXX-XXXX" for conversion. "Save this for later" for awareness. "Tag a friend" for reach. **How to confirm resolved:** Every post ends with one clear, specific action. **Prevention:** Never publish a post without a CTA. Write it before the caption, not after.

K.5 Copy-pasting the same caption on every platform

Symptoms: The same long caption appears on Instagram, Facebook and WhatsApp Status. It feels off on each. **Likely cause:** The owner does not understand platform adaptation. **How to investigate:** Check the same post on different platforms â€” is the caption identical? **Corrective steps:** Adapt for each platform. Instagram: 2â€“3 short paragraphs with line breaks and hashtags. WhatsApp: 1â€–2 lines, no hashtags. Story: short text with a poll or question. **How to confirm resolved:** Each platform's version feels native â€” the right length, tone and format. **Prevention:** Create one master post, then tailor a short version per platform. Never copy-paste.

K.6 Using fake engagement or bought likes

Symptoms: 500 followers, 3 likes per post, suspicious comment patterns ("great post!" from accounts with no profile photo). **Likely cause:** The owner bought followers or likes, or is in an engagement pod. **How to investigate:** Check the follower-to-engagement ratio. Check the comments â€” are they generic? **Corrective steps:** Stop all bought engagement immediately. Focus on earning real engagement through good hooks, useful content and responding to comments. **How to confirm resolved:** Engagement rate is consistent with follower count (3â€–5% is healthy). Comments are specific and real. **Prevention:** The ethics rule â€” no buying engagement, no pods, no bots. Earned growth is the only growth.

K.7 Inconsistent brand (different colours, fonts and tone on every post)

Symptoms: The feed looks like it belongs to five different businesses. **Likely cause:** No brand kit â€” each post was designed separately. **How to investigate:** Look at five posts side by side. Do the colours, fonts and tone match? **Corrective steps:** Create a Canva Brand Kit â€” two colours, two fonts, one tone. Use it for every post. **How to confirm resolved:** Five posts side by side look like they belong to one business. **Prevention:** Set up the Brand Kit before creating any graphic. Save it. Use it every time.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it (e.g., the learner can point to the exact post with the weak hook). Teach learners to confirm before concluding â€" ask them to show you the post, not just say "it is boring."

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "One Idea, Five Ways â€" Content Plan and Repurposing Set"

Purpose: To practise building a content pillar plan, a one-week calendar and a repurposing set â€" the skills that feed the capstone's content plan section.

Realistic scenario. You are the content manager for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen (or your own approved business). She has asked you to prepare a one-week content plan that she can follow without thinking â€" and to show her how one good photo can become five posts so she does not run out of content.

Detailed instructions:

1. Build a **content pillar plan** with four pillars. For each pillar, write: the name, why it matters to the avatar, two example topics and the funnel stage it serves.
2. Create a **one-week content calendar** with seven posts (one per day). For each post, fill in: day, format, pillar, topic, hook, CTA and funnel stage.
3. Choose **one** post from your calendar â€" your strongest one. Repurpose it into **five formats**: an Instagram post, a WhatsApp broadcast, an Instagram story, a reel concept (describe it in 2â€"3 sentences) and a carousel concept (describe the slides).
4. Write a short **pillar mix explanation** (2â€"3 sentences): "I chose these pillars becauseâ€¦"
5. Write one final sentence: "The most important thing I learned about content planning isâ€¦"

Required deliverables:

- A completed content pillar plan (four pillars).
- A completed one-week calendar (seven posts).
- A repurposing set (one idea, five formats).
- The pillar mix explanation and the final reflection sentence.

Submission format: Handwritten or typed, submitted at the start of Session 5. Keep a copy in your working folder.

Deadline: Before Session 5.

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Content pillar plan	5	Four pillars, each tied to the avatar, with example topics and funnel stages
One-week calendar	7	Seven posts with day, format, pillar, topic, hook, CTA, stage â€" all complete
Repurposing set	5	One idea turned into five adapted formats, each native to its platform
Pillar mix explanation	2	Clear reasoning, references the avatar
Reflection sentence	1	Gives a real insight, not a generic statement

Common mistakes to avoid: pillars that are all product-focused; calendar entries missing hooks or CTAs; repurposed posts that are copy-pasted instead of adapted; inconsistent brand style; posting more than is realistic for one person with a phone.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners â€" model for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen):

Four pillars: The Menu, The Kitchen, The Customer, The Tip (see Section G.2 for full details).

Seven-post calendar: (See Section G.3 for the full Mondayâ€"Sunday calendar with hooks, CTAs and stages.)

Repurposing set â€" the Monday menu post (jollof rice photo):

1. **Instagram post:** Photo with caption: "Monday blues? Hot jollof fixes everything ðŸ² â¦1,500 a plate. Order on WhatsApp â€" 0803-XXX-XXXX."

2. **WhatsApp broadcast:** "Good morning! Today's special: smoky jollof, â‚¦1,500. Reply YES to order."
3. **Instagram story:** Photo with a poll: "Jollof today? Yes / Definitely yes."
4. **Reel concept:** 15-second video â€" stir the jollof, steam rises, text overlay "POV: your Monday just got better", end card "Order on WhatsApp."
5. **Carousel concept:** Slide 1: the photo. Slide 2: "3 reasons our jollof is different â€" fresh stock, smoky flavour, hot delivery." Slide 3: "Order on WhatsApp â€" 0803-XXX-XXXX. â‚¦1,500."

Pillar mix explanation: "I chose these pillars because Chinedu (the avatar) needs to see the food (The Menu), trust the hygiene (The Kitchen), see proof from other customers (The Customer) and get value that builds loyalty (The Tip). This mix covers awareness, consideration, conversion and retention â€" the full funnel."

Reflection sentence: "The most important thing I learned about content planning is that a good plan beats raw talent â€" a business with a clear pillar system and a weekly calendar will outperform a business that posts randomly, even if the random poster has better photos."

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. What is a content pillar, and why does a business need them?

Q2. Multiple choice. Which of these is the strongest hook line? a) "Hello everyone, welcome back." b) "Our new product is available." c) "Stop making dry jollof â€" here is the one mistake everyone makes." d) "Please check our page."

Q3. Match the CTA to the goal. Match each CTA to its goal. a) "Save this for your next party" b) "Order on WhatsApp â€" 0803-XXX-XXXX" c) "Tag a friend who needs this" d) "Comment your favourite soup below"

1. Get shares
2. Get orders
3. Get saves
4. Get comments

Q4. Explain. Why does organic reach need to be "earned"? Name two engagement signals the algorithm rewards.

Q5. Practical. A barbershop has a beautiful before/after photo of a fade. Write three ways to repurpose that one photo into three different posts (Instagram post, WhatsApp broadcast, and one more format of your choice).

Q6. Ethics. Your friend says "everyone buys likes these days â€" just buy 1,000 likes for â‚¦2,000 and your page will look popular." What do you tell her, and why?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q6)

A1. A content pillar is a recurring theme or topic that a business posts about regularly. A business needs pillars because they provide structure â€" instead of wondering what to post each day, the owner rotates through their pillars. Pillars also tell the audience what to expect, which builds trust and makes the page feel organised rather than random. (Accept any answer that explains recurring themes and the benefit of structure.)

A2. (c) "Stop making dry jollof â€" here is the one mistake everyone makes." It is a warning that promises specific value and stops the scroll. The others are greetings or descriptions that give no reason to stop.

A3. a) 3 â€" save; b) 2 â€" order; c) 1 â€" share; d) 4 â€" comment.

A4. Organic reach needs to be earned because the algorithm shows your post to more people only when it sees real engagement â€" proof that people want to see your content. Two signals: watch time (people watching your video to the end) and saves (people saving your post to come back to it). Also acceptable: shares and comments. (Accept any two valid signals.)

A5. (Accept any three adapted formats.) Example: (1) Instagram post: the photo with caption "Fresh fade, done right. Walk-ins welcome at GRA. Call 0803-XXX-XXXX to book." (2) WhatsApp broadcast: "Looking sharp this week? Fresh fade, done in 30 minutes. Walk-ins welcome, GRA. Call 0803-XXX-XXXX." (3) Instagram story: the photo with a poll "Need a fresh fade? Yes / Definitely yes" and a link to WhatsApp.

A6. I would tell her not to do it. Bought likes are fake â€" they come from bots or fake accounts that will never buy from her, they distort her data so she cannot tell what is working, and Instagram penalises accounts that use them. Real engagement from

real people is the only growth that actually brings customers. The â‚¦2,000 is better spent on nothing â€" saved for a real need â€" because bought likes bring zero value and real risk. (Accept any answer that refuses and explains why, ideally mentioning fake accounts, distorted data or platform penalties.)

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned to plan and create content that works. You learned that **content marketing** is the engine of social media â€" showing your work so people want to buy. You learned **content pillars**: three to five recurring themes that mix product, value and personality. You learned to build a **one-week content calendar** â€" planning what to post, when, with what hook and CTA, in 30 minutes for the whole week. You learned that **organic reach** must be earned through watch time, saves, shares and comments â€" not bought. You learned **storytelling**: situation â†' struggle â†' solution â†' next step â€" persuasion through empathy. You learned that **hooks and CTAs** are the first and last lines that decide whether people stop and act. You learned **repurposing**: one idea, five posts â€" the key to consistency without burnout. And you learned that **ethics** â€" honest claims, real photos, no copying, no fake engagement â€" apply to every single post.

Five important takeaways:

1. Content is the engine â€" without it, your social media is an empty shop.
2. Pillars give you a plan â€" three to five themes that mix product, value and personality.
3. A calendar makes you consistent â€" plan a week in one sitting, then post without thinking.
4. Organic reach is earned â€" watch time, saves, shares and comments are the currency.
5. Repurpose everything â€" one idea, five posts; one photo, three platforms.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I build four content pillars for a business and explain why each matters?
- Can I plan a one-week content calendar with hooks, CTAs and funnel stages?
- Can I write a story-led post using situation â†' struggle â†' solution â†' next step?
- Can I repurpose one idea into five different formats?
- Can I explain why organic reach must be earned, not bought?

Connection to the next session. You now have content â€" the fuel for your channels. But there is one more free channel we have not opened: **search**. When someone in Port Harcourt types "caterer near me" or "jollof delivery GRA" into Google, they are looking for exactly what you sell â€" right now, with money ready. Next session we learn how search works, how to find the keywords your customers actually type, and how to make sure your business appears when they do. That is Session 5: SEO and Google Basics â€" the biggest free source of customers you will ever have.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner builds pillars that mix product, value and personality â€" not just selling.
- Learner's calendar entries all have specific hooks, CTAs and funnel stages.
- Learner repurposes one idea into genuinely adapted formats â€" not copy-paste.
- Learner uses the story structure (situation â†' struggle â†' solution â†' next step) naturally.
- Learner explains organic reach correctly â€" earned through engagement, not bought.
- Learner's content is honest â€" real photos, real claims, no copied captions.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "Content means I need to be creative or funny." â†' No â€" content means useful and consistent. A clear tip is better than a clever joke that gets no saves.
- "I must post every day." â†' No â€" three to five times a week, consistently, is better than daily posting followed by silence.
- "Followers are what matter." â†' No â€" engagement rate matters more. 500 followers who save and share beat 5,000 who scroll past.

- "I can copy a competitor's caption if I change a few words." â†' No â€" that is still copying. Be inspired, then create your own version.
- "Bought likes are a shortcut." â†' No â€" they are fraud that distorts data and risks penalties.
- "A good product sells itself." â†' No â€" good content is how people discover the good product. The best food in the world sells nothing if nobody knows it exists.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Pillar building drill:** Give the learner a business and ask them to list five possible pillars, then narrow to the best three and explain why.
2. **Hook rewrite drill:** Give five weak first lines and ask the learner to rewrite each using one of the five hook formulas.
3. **Repurposing drill:** Give one photo and ask the learner to write three captions â€" one for Instagram, one for WhatsApp, one for a story â€" each adapted to its platform.
4. **Calendar fill drill:** Give a blank calendar with the pillars already chosen and ask the learner to fill in the week with topics, hooks and CTAs.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** Provide the pillar names (The Menu, The Kitchen, The Customer) and ask the learner to fill in example topics and hooks for each. Provide a calendar with days and formats pre-filled.
- **Level 2 (standard):** The session as written â€" full pillar plan, one-week calendar, repurposing set.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** Ask the learner to plan *two* weeks of content and then write a short reflection: "If I could only do three posts per week instead of seven, which three would I keep and why?" â€" prioritising by funnel stage and expected impact.

Timing guidance. The priority is the guided practical (Section H) â€" learners building pillars, a calendar and a repurposing set. If the room is slow, shorten the lecture (combine F.4 and F.5) and reduce the case study (Section J) to a 5-minute discussion. If learners struggle with hooks, run an extra 5-minute hook rewrite drill before the practical. Protect the practical time â€" a learner who leaves without a completed calendar has no content plan.

Capstone link. The content pillars and one-week calendar built today become the capstone's content plan section. The repurposing set becomes the capstone's repurposing note. The hooks and CTAs become the capstone's messaging document. The pillar mix explanation becomes the capstone's content reasoning. Keep all worksheets safe â€" the capstone assembles them in Session 9.

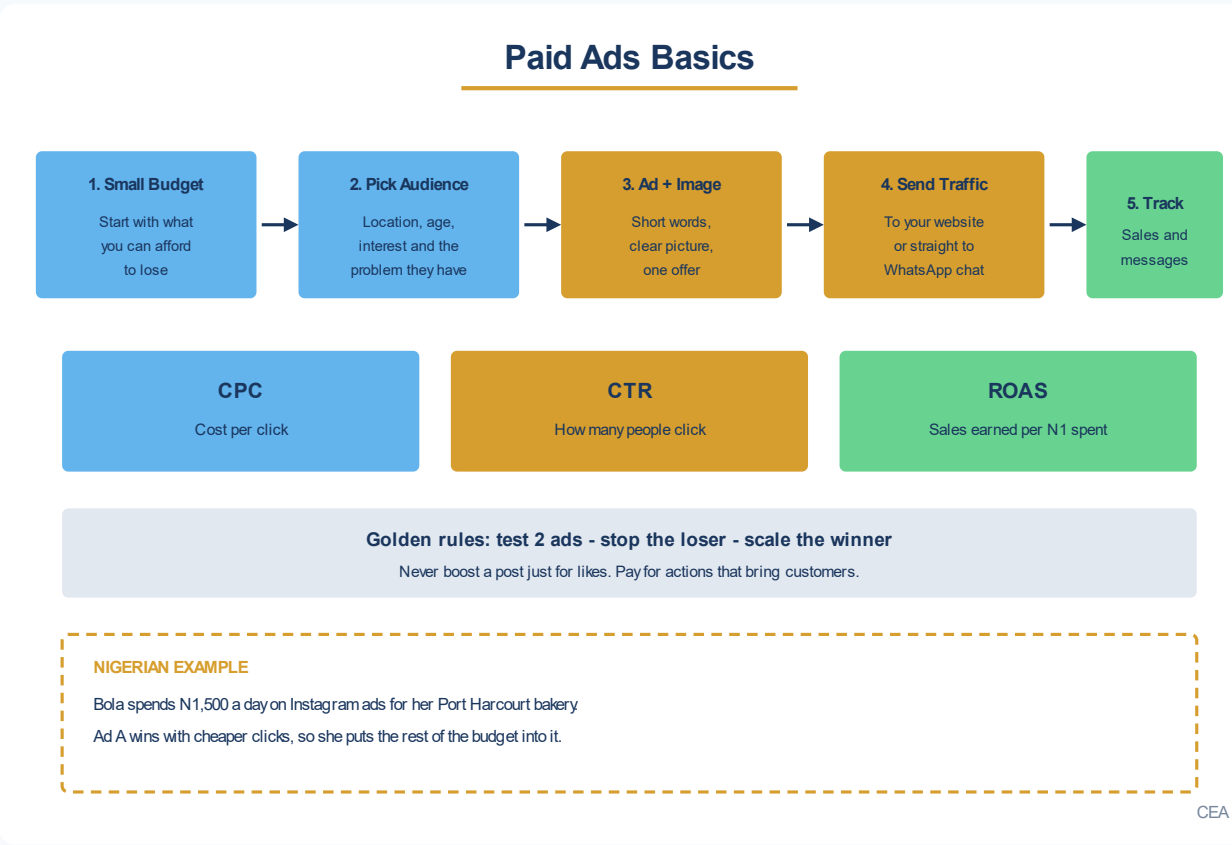
END OF SESSION 4

Next: Session 5 â€" SEO and Google Basics.

SESSION 05 OF 9

SEO and Google Basics

CONCEPT DIAGRAM — SESSION 05



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" DIGITAL MARKETING

SESSION 5 â€" SEO AND GOOGLE BASICS

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	5 of 9
Session title	SEO and Google Basics
Week / Module	Week 2 â€" Module 2: Channels
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (concepts and free tools, no coding)
Prerequisite knowledge	Sessions 1â€"4. Learners should be able to describe the funnel, build an avatar, set up a Google Business Profile, and plan content. A Gmail account is required (for Keyword Planner

Item	Detail
	basics).
Connection to previous work	In Session 4 we learned to plan content that attracts and engages on social media. But social media is rented land â€" the algorithm decides who sees your post. Search is different: when someone types "caterer in Port Harcourt" into Google, they are raising their hand and saying "I need this now." Today we learn how search works, how to find the keywords your customers actually type, and how to make sure your business appears â€" for free â€" when they do.
Preparation before class	Academy computers with internet ready. Prepare a projector slide showing a Google Search results page for a local query (e.g., "caterer in Port Harcourt") â€" with the map pack, organic results and ads visible. Print the Keyword Worksheet (Section H) per learner. Have Google Keyword Planner accessible (it requires a Google Ads account â€" help learners create one in class; no spend needed). Print the Local SEO Checklist. Prepare a demo of Google Business Profile insights.

Instructor note on tone: SEO has a reputation for being technical and intimidating. Your first job is to strip that away. SEO at this level is three things: understanding what people type, putting those words where Google can see them, and being honest and useful. No coding, no algorithms to game, no magic. Just: know what people search for, answer their questions, and be easy to find. Keep it practical and jargon-free.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Explain** in simple terms how search engines work â€" crawling, indexing and ranking â€" using the library analogy.
2. **Distinguish** the three types of search intent (informational, navigational, transactional) and match keywords to the correct intent for a small business.
3. **Find relevant keywords** for a small business using free tools and observation, and list at least 10 keywords with notes on volume and competition.
4. **Use Google Keyword Planner basics** to judge keyword search volume and competition, explaining what the numbers mean for a small business.
5. **List the local SEO actions** that lift a Google Business Profile â€" categories, keywords in the description, photos, posts, reviews, Q&A, and consistent NAP.
6. **Explain honestly** why "number one on Google" promises are usually false, and what realistic local SEO results look like over time.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner AND/OR an academy computer with internet.
- Instructor computer connected to a projector.
- Whiteboard or flip chart.

Software

- Google Keyword Planner (free â€" needs a Google Ads account; no spend required).
- Google Search (for live demonstrations).
- Google Maps (for local search demos).
- A spreadsheet or paper for the keyword worksheet.

Sample files

- **Keyword Worksheet** (Section H) â€" one per learner.
- **Local SEO Checklist** (Section F.5) â€" one per learner.
- **Google Search results page screenshot** (projector slide).

- **Keyword Planner demo data** (instructor-prepared, if live access is unreliable).

Worksheets

- Worksheet 5.1 â€" "Keyword Finder" (keyword / intent type / volume estimate / competition / relevance to business).
- Worksheet 5.2 â€" "Local SEO Action Checklist" (action / where / done?).

Accounts

- Gmail (from Session 3). Google Ads account (free â€" required for Keyword Planner; the instructor helps learners create one; no spend needed).

Internet

- Required for this session (Keyword Planner, live search demos).

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- A smartphone with a browser works for Keyword Planner and search demos. If Keyword Planner access is limited, the instructor can share volume/competition data on printed cards.

Safety and ethics note:

- Use only free Keyword Planner data. Do not run paid ads â€" this session is about understanding, not spending.
- Do not use keyword stuffing or any black-hat SEO tactics. We practice honest, white-hat SEO only.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show a Google search results page for "jollof rice delivery Port Harcourt". Circle three areas: the map pack (3 business listings with pins), the paid ads at the top, and the organic results below.

What the instructor says:

> *"Someone in Port Harcourt just typed 'jollof rice delivery Port Harcourt' into Google. Look at what they see. First, three business listings with a map â€" names, stars, photos, phone numbers. Then paid adverts. Then regular results â€" websites and listings further down. Now â€" hands up: if you were hungry right now and needed food delivered, which result would you click? â€¦ The map pack, almost always. Those three listings at the top with the map, the stars and the photos. That is where the money is. Today we learn how to get your business into that map pack â€" and how to rank higher when people search for what you sell. This is SEO â€" Search Engine Optimisation â€" and it is the biggest free source of customers you will ever have."*

Then ask: "What do the three businesses in the map pack have in common?"

- Expected answer: They all have photos, reviews, names, addresses. They look complete.
- Draw out: They all have Google Business Profiles â€" complete ones. That is what got them there.

Why this opener works: It shows the destination (the map pack) before explaining the journey. Learners see exactly what they are aiming for â€" and it is achievable, not abstract.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "In Session 3, we set up a Google Business Profile. What were the nine parts we filled in?"

- Expected answer: Name, category, address/service area, phone, hours, photos, description, products/services, reviews.
- Common gap: learners remember the basics but forget products or description. Prompt: "What did we add so customers can see prices?"

Question 2: "In Session 4, we built content pillars. What makes a good content mix?"

- Expected answer: A balance of product, value and personality â€" not just selling.
- Common gap: learners say "post a lot". Clarify: "Post a lot of *what kind* of content?"

Question 3: "In Session 2, we built a customer avatar. Why does knowing the avatar matter for SEO and search?"

- Expected answer: Because the avatar tells you what the customer is looking for â€" and what words they type into Google.
- Common gap: learners do not connect avatar to search. Say: "If you know your customer's pains, you can guess what they type when they need a solution. That is your keyword."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"You have the profile (Session 3), the content (Session 4) and the customer (Session 2). Today we connect them to search. When your customer types their pain into Google â€" 'food near me', 'caterer Port Harcourt', 'phone repair GRA' â€" you want your business to appear. SEO is how you make that happen. Not with tricks or money â€" but by being complete, relevant and honest."*

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 How search engines work â€" crawling, indexing, ranking

The idea. When you type a question into Google, the answer appears in less than a second. How? Because Google has already been everywhere on the internet, read almost everything, filed it away, and ranked it â€" so it can pull the best answer to your question instantly. This happens in three steps: crawling, indexing and ranking.

Step 1 â€" Crawling. Google sends out automated programs called **crawlers** (or spiders) that travel across the internet, following links from page to page, reading everything they find. Think of them as librarians walking through every book in a giant library, scanning every page.

Step 2 â€" Indexing. Everything the crawlers find gets filed into a massive **index** â€" like a catalogue of the entire internet. When a crawler reads your Google Business Profile or your website, it files the information: your name, your address, your photos, your description, the words you used. Think of it as the librarian writing a summary card for every book and putting it in the catalogue.

Step 3 â€" Ranking. When someone searches, Google looks through its index and ranks the results â€" putting the most relevant, most trustworthy and most useful results at the top. It uses hundreds of signals to decide the order, but the most important ones for a local business are: **relevance** (does your listing match what they searched?), **distance** (are you near them?) and **prominence** (do other people trust you â€" reviews, links, mentions?).

The library analogy (say this):

> *"Imagine Google is the world's biggest library. Crawling is the librarians reading every book. Indexing is them filing every card in the catalogue. Ranking is them recommending the best book when you ask a question. If your business is not in the library â€" no Google Business Profile, no website â€" the librarian cannot recommend you. If you are in the library but your card is blank or wrong â€" incomplete profile, no reviews, inconsistent information â€" the librarian is unsure about you and recommends someone else. If your card is complete, accurate and full of good reviews â€" the librarian points people to you first."*

Why this matters for a small business: You cannot pay Google to be in the index â€" you must *earn* your place by being complete, relevant and trustworthy. A Google Business Profile is how you get into the library. Completing it fully is how you get a good card. Reviews and consistent information are how the librarian learns to trust you.

Common misconception. "SEO is about tricking Google." No â€" modern SEO is about *helping* Google understand and trust you. Google's goal is to show the best answer to every search. Your goal is to be that best answer. When those goals align, you win â€" and so does the customer.

F.2 Search intent â€" what the searcher actually wants

The idea. Not every search is the same. Someone typing "what is jollof rice" wants information. Someone typing "Mama Nkechi's Kitchen" wants a specific business. Someone typing "jollof rice delivery Port Harcourt" wants to buy. Understanding **search intent** â€" what the searcher actually wants â€" is the foundation of choosing the right keywords.

The three types of search intent:

1. **Informational intent** â€” the searcher wants to learn something. "How to make jollof rice", "what is SEO", "best time to post on Instagram". They are not ready to buy â€” they are researching. Content that answers these questions builds awareness and trust.
2. **Navigational intent** â€” the searcher wants to find a specific website or business. "Mama Nkechi's Kitchen", "Instagram login", "CEA Port Harcourt". They already know what they want â€” they are looking for it. Your job is to make sure they find *you*, not a competitor with a similar name.
3. **Transactional intent** â€” the searcher wants to buy or take action. "jollof rice delivery Port Harcourt", "caterer in GRA", "phone repair near me". These are the golden searches â€” the person has money ready and is choosing who to give it to. For a local business, transactional local searches are the most valuable keywords.

The local transactional sweet spot (say this):

> *"For Mama Nkechi's Kitchen, the most valuable keywords are transactional local searches: 'jollof rice delivery Port Harcourt', 'food near me', 'caterer GRA', 'small chops delivery'. Why? Because the person typing these is hungry, in Port Harcourt, and ready to order. They are not researching â€” they are buying. Your Google Business Profile and your content must answer their question: 'Where can I get jollof delivered near me?' â€” and your answer must be the best one in the results."*

How to match keywords to intent: For each keyword you find, ask: "Is the person typing this wanting to learn, to find, or to buy?" If they want to buy â€” that is a high-value keyword for your Google Business Profile and your website. If they want to learn â€” that is a good keyword for your content pillars (The Tip, The Kitchen). If they want to find â€” make sure your name is consistent everywhere.

Worked example â€” keyword intent for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen:

Keyword	Intent type	Value for Mama Nkechi
"jollof rice delivery Port Harcourt"	Transactional	Very high â€” ready to buy, local
"food near me"	Transactional	Very high â€” ready to buy, local
"caterer in GRA"	Transactional	High â€” planning an event, needs a caterer
"how to make smoky jollof"	Informational	Medium â€” builds awareness and trust
"Mama Nkechi's Kitchen"	Navigational	Medium â€” people looking for her specifically

Common misconception. "More keywords = better." No â€” the right keywords beat more keywords. Ten keywords that match your customer's real intent and your business's real offer will outperform a hundred random keywords.

F.3 Finding keywords â€” what your customers actually type

The idea. Keywords are the words and phrases people type into Google. Your job is to find the keywords your customers actually use â€” not the words you *think* they use, but the words they *actually* type. This is the foundation of SEO.

Four free ways to find keywords:

1. **Google Autocomplete.** Start typing a search and see what Google suggests. Type "jollof rice" and Google might suggest "jollof rice near me", "jollof rice delivery", "jollof rice recipe". These suggestions are based on what real people are typing â€” they are gold.
2. **"People Also Ask" and Related Searches.** Scroll down any Google results page and you will see "People also ask" questions and "Related searches" at the bottom. These are real queries from real searchers â€” write them down.
3. **Keyword Planner.** Google's free tool (in Google Ads) that shows search volume and competition for keywords. We cover this in Section F.4.
4. **Ask your customers.** The simplest method: when a customer calls or messages, ask "How did you find us?" or "What did you search for?" Their exact words are your best keywords.

Worked example â€” finding keywords for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen:

- Google Autocomplete: "jollof rice delivery Port Harcourt", "small chops near me", "food delivery GRA", "caterer Port Harcourt", "party jollof rice"
- People Also Ask: "How much does a plate of jollof cost in Port Harcourt?", "What is the best food delivery in GRA?", "How do I order Mama Nkechi's Kitchen?"
- Customer question: "Do you deliver to Trans-Amadi?" â€" keyword: "food delivery Trans-Amadi"
- Result: a list of 10â€"15 real keywords that match what customers actually type.

The 10+ keyword goal: For your assignment, you will build a keyword list of at least 10 keywords with notes on volume, competition and relevance. Do not panic if you cannot access Keyword Planner â€" you can estimate volume (high/medium/low) based on how specific the keyword is. "Food near me" is very high volume. "Ofe nsala soup delivery Port Harcourt" is lower volume but very specific â€" and specificity is good.

Common misconception. "I should target the biggest, most popular keyword." No â€" the biggest keyword ("food") is too broad and too competitive. A small business wins by targeting *specific local keywords* that match what customers actually type. "Jollof rice delivery Port Harcourt" is better than "food" â€" smaller but more relevant and more likely to convert.

F.4 Keyword Planner basics â€" volume and competition

The idea. Google Keyword Planner is a free tool (inside Google Ads) that shows you how many people search for a keyword each month (search volume) and how many businesses are bidding on it (competition). It does not require spending money â€" you can use it for research only.

How to access it:

1. Go to ads.google.com and sign in with your Gmail.
2. Create a Google Ads account (free â€" no billing info needed for research).
3. Go to Tools â† Keyword Planner.
4. Enter your keywords and see the results.

What the numbers mean:

- **Search volume** â€" how many times per month people search for this keyword on average. In Nigeria, local keywords typically range from 10 to 1,000 monthly searches. "Food near me" might be 1,000+. "Ofe nsala delivery GRA" might be 10. Neither number is bad â€" they mean different things.
- **Competition** â€" how many advertisers are bidding on this keyword (low/medium/high). For organic SEO, high competition means many businesses are trying to rank for it â€" harder to break into. Low competition means less fight â€" easier to rank.

How to interpret the data for a small business:

Scenario	What it means	What to do
High volume, high competition	Many people search, many businesses fight for it	Hard to rank for â€" use it in content, not as your main target
High volume, low competition	Many people search, few businesses target it	Goldmine â€" prioritise this keyword
Low volume, low competition	Few people search, few businesses target it	Easy to rank for â€" good for long-tail local keywords
Low volume, high competition	Few people search, many businesses fight	Ignore â€" not worth the effort

Worked example â€" keyword analysis for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen (estimated data):

Keyword	Intent	Volume (est.)	Competition	Verdict
"food near me"	Transactional	High (1,000+)	High	Too broad â€" use in profile, not as main target
"jollof rice delivery Port Harcourt"	Transactional	Medium (100â€"500)	Medium	Good target â€" specific and local

Keyword	Intent	Volume (est.)	Competition	Verdict
"small chops delivery GRA"	Transactional	Lowâ€“Medium (50â€“100)	Low	Excellent â€” specific, low competition
"caterer in GRA"	Transactional	Lowâ€“Medium (50â€“100)	Low	Excellent â€” matches her catering service
"how to make smoky jollof"	Informational	Medium (100â€“500)	Medium	Good for content â€” builds awareness
"party jollof rice Port Harcourt"	Transactional	Low (10â€“50)	Low	Excellent â€” very specific, high intent

Say to the class:

> *"Notice the pattern. The best keywords for a small local business are usually the specific, local, lower-competition ones. 'Small chops delivery GRA' might only get 50 searches a month â€” but those 50 people are in GRA, want small chops, and are ready to order. That is 50 potential customers you can realistically win. The big keyword 'food near me' gets 1,000 searches â€” but you will never rank number one for it against big apps and chains. Win the small fights first."*

Common misconception. "I need exact, precise volume numbers." No â€” Keyword Planner gives ranges and estimates, and for a small local business, the exact number matters far less than the *pattern*: is it local? Does it match my offer? Is the competition low enough for me to realistically rank? Focus on relevance and intent, not on chasing the biggest number.

F.5 Local SEO â€” lifting your Google Business Profile

The idea. Local SEO is the set of actions that help your business appear in local search results â€” the map pack and local organic results. For a small business, local SEO is the highest-impact SEO you can do â€” and most of it is free. The Google Business Profile is the centre of local SEO.

The eight local SEO actions that lift a Google Business Profile:

1. **Choose the right categories.** Your primary category should be the most accurate description of your business. For Mama Nkechi: "Restaurant" â€” not "Food" or "Business". Add secondary categories: "Food Delivery Service", "Caterer". Categories tell Google what searches to show you in.
2. **Put keywords in your description.** Write a natural description that includes your key services and location. "Home-cooked Nigerian meals, soups and small chops for delivery in Port Harcourt, GRA and Trans-Amadi." Do not stuff keywords â€” write for humans, include keywords naturally.
3. **Add photos regularly.** Businesses with 10+ photos get more calls and direction requests. Add photos of your products, your shop front, your team, your packaging. Add new photos monthly â€” freshness is a signal.
4. **Post weekly updates.** Google Business Profile posts (like social media posts) show up on your listing. Post once a week â€” a special offer, a new menu item, a behind-the-scenes photo. This keeps your listing active and gives customers a reason to choose you.
5. **Collect and respond to reviews.** Reviews are the #1 trust signal and a major ranking factor. Ask every real customer to leave an honest review. Respond to every review within 24 hours â€” thank positive reviewers, respond professionally to negative ones.
6. **Answer the Q&A.** Google Business Profile has a Q&A section where customers can ask questions. Answer every question promptly and accurately. You can also add your own frequently asked questions.
7. **Keep NAP consistent.** Your Name, Address and Phone number must be identical on your Google Business Profile, your website, your Instagram, your WhatsApp and everywhere else. Inconsistency is one of the biggest local SEO killers.
8. **Add products and services with prices.** List your menu or services with prices. This helps customers decide before they contact you â€” and it gives Google more content to match to searches.

The local SEO checklist (use this for your audit):

Action	Where	Done?
Correct primary category	GBP settings	
Keywords in description	GBP description	
10+ photos	GBP photos	
Weekly posts	GBP posts	
10+ reviews, all responded	GBP reviews	
Q&A answered	GBP Q&A	
NAP consistent everywhere	All platforms	
Products/services with prices	GBP products	

Say to the class:

> *"Eight actions. All free. Most take minutes, not hours. A business that does all eight will outrank a business that does three â€" not because of tricks, but because Google sees the complete one as more relevant, more trustworthy and more useful to the searcher. That is what local SEO is: being the most complete, most consistent, most trustworthy result for your local searches."*

Common misconception. "Local SEO is a one-time setup." No â€" it is ongoing. Photos, posts, reviews and Q&A need regular attention. A profile set up once and forgotten will slowly lose rank to a competitor who is active. Think of your Google Business Profile like a shop window â€" it needs regular tidying.

F.6 Honest expectations â€" why "number one" promises are usually false

The idea. You will see adverts online: "Get your business to number one on Google in 7 days!" or "Guaranteed first-page ranking!" These promises are almost always false â€" or they refer to something other than what you think.

Why "number one" promises are usually false:

1. **Google's algorithm has hundreds of signals.** No one controls all of them. A consultant cannot guarantee a position that depends on Google's secret formula, your competitors' actions and the searcher's location and behaviour.
2. **Local results are personalised.** Google shows different results to different people based on their location, search history and preferences. There is no single "number one" â€" there is "number one *for this person, in this place, at this time*."
3. **Promises often refer to paid ads.** "Number one on Google" might mean "we will run a paid ad that appears at the top" â€" which stops the moment you stop paying. That is not SEO; that is advertising (Session 7).
4. **Fast promises signal manipulation.** Anyone promising instant results is likely using tactics that violate Google's guidelines â€" and Google penalises businesses that use them, sometimes removing them from results entirely.

What honest, realistic local SEO looks like:

- **Weeks 1â€"2:** Set up a complete Google Business Profile. Add photos, description, products, categories. Ensure NAP consistency.
- **Weeks 3â€"4:** Start collecting reviews. Post weekly. Answer Q&A.
- **Months 2â€"3:** Begin to appear in the map pack for your most specific local keywords (e.g., "small chops delivery GRA").
- **Months 3â€"6:** Appear consistently in the map pack for broader local keywords (e.g., "food delivery Port Harcourt"). Get calls and direction requests from your listing.
- **Months 6â€"12:** Build a local reputation â€" more reviews, more consistent presence, more local mentions. Rank for a growing set of keywords.

Say to the class:

> *"Local SEO is not a sprint; it is a marathon. But it is a marathon where every step is free and every step compounds. A business that does the eight actions consistently for six months will be far ahead of a business that did nothing â€" and*

will stay ahead, because consistency builds trust that is hard to displace. The businesses that win at local SEO are not the ones that found a trick â€" they are the ones that showed up every week."

Common misconception. "SEO does not work anymore." SEO works â€" but it works slowly, honestly and cumulatively. The businesses that say "SEO does not work" are usually the ones that tried it for two weeks, saw no instant results, and gave up. SEO rewards patience and consistency â€" exactly the qualities that separate successful businesses from the rest.

F.7 Summary of the lecture

- **Search works in three steps:** crawling (reading the internet), indexing (filing it), ranking (recommending the best answer).
- **Search intent** is what the searcher wants: information, navigation or a transaction. Transactional local searches are gold for small businesses.
- **Keywords** are what customers type. Find them through Google Autocomplete, People Also Ask, Keyword Planner and asking customers.
- **Keyword Planner** shows volume and competition. For small businesses, specific low-competition local keywords beat big broad ones.
- **Local SEO** is eight free actions centred on the Google Business Profile: categories, keywords in description, photos, posts, reviews, Q&A, NAP consistency, products with prices.
- **Honest expectations:** SEO is a marathon, not a sprint. "Number one in 7 days" promises are usually false. Consistency over months is what wins.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Someone searches] --> B{Google results}
    B --> C[Ad result]
    B --> D[Google Business Profile]
    B --> E[Organic result]
    C --> F[You pay per click]
    D --> F[Free - local]
    E --> F[Free - long-term]
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- On the projector: Google Search, Google Maps, Google Keyword Planner.
- The Keyword Worksheet and Local SEO Checklist printed.
- A demo Google Business Profile for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen.

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€" watch a search happen live (4 minutes)

Say: "Let us watch search work in real time. I am going to search for something and you watch what Google shows."

Type "caterer in Port Harcourt" into Google. Narrate what appears:

> *"First, the map pack â€" three businesses with pins, names, stars, photos, phone numbers. These are Google Business Profiles. Google decided these three are the most relevant, nearest and most prominent results for this search in this location. Then paid ads â€" businesses that paid to be here. Then organic results â€" websites and listings further down. Now watch what happens when I change the locationâ€¦"*

Type "caterer in GRA" â€" show how the map pack changes to GRA businesses.

Say:

> *"Same search word â€" different location â€" different results. That is local SEO in action. The businesses in the map pack for GRA are the ones that won the local relevance, distance and prominence signals for that search in that place. Our job is to make sure Mama Nkechi's Kitchen is one of those three when someone searches 'caterer in GRA'."*

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€" find keywords live (5 minutes)

Say: "Now let me show you how to find keywords using Google's own suggestions."

Type "jollof rice" into Google and show the autocomplete suggestions:

> *"Google just told us what people are searching for: 'jollof rice near me', 'jollof rice delivery', 'jollof rice recipe'. These are not my ideas â€" they are real queries from real searchers. Write them down."*

Scroll to "People Also Ask" and "Related Searches":

> *"More real questions: 'How much does a plate of jollof cost?', 'What is the best food delivery?'. These are content ideas AND keyword ideas."*

Then open Keyword Planner (if accessible) and enter three keywords:

> *"Keyword Planner shows us volume and competition. 'Food near me' â€" high volume, high competition. 'Jollof rice delivery Port Harcourt' â€" medium volume, medium competition. 'Small chops delivery GRA' â€" lower volume, lower competition. For a small business, that third one is the sweet spot: specific, local, winnable."*

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€" audit a Google Business Profile live (4 minutes)

Say: "Last piece. Let me show you how to audit a local SEO profile â€" what Google sees and what the customer sees."

Open Mama Nkechi's Kitchen's Google Business Profile. Walk through the eight local SEO actions:

- Category: "Restaurant" â€" correct?
- Description: includes "jollof", "small chops", "GRA", "delivery" â€" keywords present?
- Photos: 12 photos â€" good?
- Posts: weekly â€" active?
- Reviews: 15 reviews, all responded â€" trust signals strong?
- Q&A: answered â€" helpful?
- NAP: matches Instagram and website â€" consistent?
- Products: menu with prices â€" complete?

Say:

> *"This profile is doing well on most actions. If I were auditing a competitor, I would look for what is missing â€" no photos, no reviews, no posts, inconsistent phone number. That is where you win: by being more complete than the businesses around you."*

G.5 Questions to ask during the demo

- "Why does the map pack change when the location changes?" (Local relevance â€" Google shows businesses near the searcher.)
- "Why is 'food near me' not the best keyword for a small business?" (Too broad, too competitive â€" big apps and chains dominate it.)
- "What is the single most important local SEO action?" (Complete, accurate, consistent Google Business Profile â€" everything else builds on that.)
- "How long does local SEO take to work?" (Months, not days â€" consistency compounds.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding, each learner builds a keyword list of 10+ keywords for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen (or their own business), analyses them using Keyword Planner basics or estimates, and completes a Local SEO Checklist audit.

Starting materials: The Keyword Worksheet (printed), the Local SEO Checklist (printed), a computer or phone with internet, Google Search and Keyword Planner open.

Procedure (instructor calls out each step; learners follow; instructor walks the room):

1. Open Google and type "jollof rice delivery Port Harcourt". Write down the first 5 autocomplete suggestions. These are your first keywords â€" real searches by real people.
2. Scroll down to "People Also Ask" and "Related Searches". Write down 5 more keyword ideas.
3. Open Keyword Planner (or estimate if access is limited). Enter your 10 keywords. For each, note: intent type (informational / navigational / transactional), volume (high/medium/low), competition (high/medium/low).
4. On the Keyword Worksheet, write your 10+ keywords with all four notes for each.
5. **Pause and predict:** Look at your list. Which 3 keywords are the most valuable â€" specific, local, matching what Mama Nkechi actually sells? Circle them.
6. Turn to the Local SEO Checklist. For each of the 8 actions, mark whether Mama Nkechi's Kitchen is doing it (based on what we set up in Session 3) or whether it needs work.
7. For any action marked "needs work", write one specific thing to fix â€" e.g., "Add 5 more photos" or "Respond to 3 unanswered reviews".
8. **Pause and predict:** If you could only fix 3 things this week, which 3 would have the biggest impact? Circle them and explain why in one sentence.
9. Compare your list with a partner. Did you find any keywords your partner did not? Share and add to your list.
10. Keep your worksheets â€" this is the start of your capstone SEO section.

Expected result (model answer â€" instructor key):

A keyword worksheet with 10+ keywords, each with intent, volume, competition and relevance notes; 3 priority keywords circled; a completed Local SEO Checklist with 3 priority fixes identified.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 5: "Are your priority keywords the ones that match what you actually sell â€" or just the ones with the most volume?" (A high-volume keyword for something you do not sell is worthless.)
- After step 8: "Why did you pick those 3 fixes? What makes them higher impact than the others?" (Look for reasoning based on customer behaviour â€" e.g., "photos are the first thing a customer sees".)

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Keyword Planner requires a Google Ads account â†' Help the learner create one (free, no spend). If time is tight, use estimates.
- Keywords are too broad ("food") â†' "Add the location and the specific dish: 'jollof rice Port Harcourt' not 'food'."
- Keywords are too narrow to matter ("Mama Nkechi's Kitchen") â†' "That is a navigational keyword â€" good for people who know you. You also need transactional keywords for people who do not know you yet."
- Learner cannot find People Also Ask â†' Show them on the projector; it appears on most Google searches.
- Local SEO Checklist is all "done" â†' "Look again â€" are the photos recent? Are the reviews responded to? Is the description updated? 'Done' is not the same as 'current'."

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ 10+ keywords listed with autocomplete and People Also Ask sources noted
- ☐ Each keyword has intent, volume, competition and relevance notes
- ☐ 3 priority keywords circled with a reason
- ☐ Local SEO Checklist completed â€" all 8 actions marked done/needs work
- ☐ 3 priority fixes identified with specific actions
- ☐ Worksheets saved in working folder

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task: You are the SEO consultant for *Kelechi's Phone Repairs* (the fictional phone repair shop from Sessions 2 and 4). Build a keyword list and a local SEO action plan for them.

Requirements:

1. List **10 keywords** for Kelechi's Phone Repairs. Use Google Autocomplete by searching "phone repair Port Harcourt" and related queries. Note the intent type for each.
2. Identify the **top 3 priority keywords** â€" the ones most likely to bring customers who are ready to pay. Explain why in one sentence each.
3. Write a **local SEO action plan**: 5 specific actions Kelechi should take in the next 30 days to improve his Google Business Profile ranking. Each action should be concrete and free.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- 10 keywords listed with intent types noted.
- Top 3 priority keywords identified with clear reasoning.
- 5 specific, free, actionable local SEO steps.

Hints if stuck:

- Hint 1: Think about what someone types when their phone breaks â€" "phone screen repair near me", "battery replacement Port Harcourt", "how much does phone repair cost".
- Hint 2: Priority keywords are transactional and local â€" the person is ready to pay and is near Kelechi's shop.
- Hint 3: Local SEO actions include photos, reviews, posts, Q&A, categories and NAP consistency.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

10 keywords for Kelechi's Phone Repairs:

#	Keyword	Intent
1	phone repair near me	Transactional
2	phone screen repair Port Harcourt	Transactional
3	battery replacement Port Harcourt	Transactional
4	how much does phone repair cost	Informational
5	phone repair Trans-Amadi	Transactional
6	cracked screen fix near me	Transactional
7	phone charging port repair	Transactional
8	best phone repair in Port Harcourt	Transactional
9	phone water damage repair	Transactional
10	how to fix a phone that won't charge	Informational

Top 3 priority keywords:

1. "phone repair near me" â€" highest transactional intent, person needs repair NOW and is searching locally.
2. "phone screen repair Port Harcourt" â€" specific service, specific location, high purchase intent.
3. "phone repair Trans-Amadi" â€" very local, matches Kelechi's shop location, low competition.

5 local SEO actions for the next 30 days:

1. Add 10+ photos to the Google Business Profile â€" before/after repairs, the shop front, Kelechi at work, the tools used.
2. Ask 10 recent customers to leave honest Google reviews â€" send a WhatsApp message after each repair asking for a review.
3. Post a weekly Google Business Profile update â€" a repair tip, a special offer, or a "repair of the week" before/after photo.

4. Add products/services with prices â€" "Screen repair from â‚¦10,000", "Battery replacement from â‚¦8,000", "Charging port repair from â‚¦5,000".
5. Ensure NAP consistency â€" check that the shop name, address and phone number are identical on Google, Instagram, WhatsApp and any flyers.

Learner marking (out of 10):

- 10 keywords listed with intent types (3)
- Top 3 priority keywords with clear reasoning (3)
- 5 specific, free, actionable local SEO steps (4)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Mama Tunde's Tuwo* is a small restaurant in Port Harcourt that serves tufo, soups and swallow foods â€" a favourite for lunch among office workers in the Rivers State Secretariat area. The owner, Mama Tunde, has been in business for 8 years. She has a loyal customer base who walk in every day, but she has no online presence: no Google Business Profile, no social media, no website. A new competitor opened six months ago â€" *Quick Bites* â€" which has a Google Business Profile with 4.6 stars and 25 reviews, an Instagram page posting daily lunch specials, and a WhatsApp ordering system. Office workers who do not know either restaurant search "lunch near me" or "food near Rivers State Secretariat" on Google â€" and they find Quick Bites, not Mama Tunde's Tuwo. Mama Tunde is losing potential new customers to a competitor with worse food but better online presence.

Relevant facts.

- Mama Tunde's food is better and cheaper than Quick Bites â€" regular customers say so openly.
- She has zero online presence â€" no Google listing, no social media.
- Quick Bites has a complete Google Business Profile, 25 reviews, daily Instagram posts and WhatsApp ordering.
- The lunch crowd in the Secretariat area includes many young office workers who search on their phones before choosing where to eat.
- Mama Tunde has a smartphone and can use WhatsApp â€" she just has never set up any online presence.

Decision point. Mama Tunde's daughter, who is in this class, asks you: "My mother's food is better. Why are customers going to the new place? And what can we do about it â€" we have no money for adverts?"

Possible approaches.

1. **"Your mother should lower her prices to compete."** â€" Her prices are already low. Lowering them further would hurt margins without fixing the real problem.
2. **"Your mother should start posting on Instagram every day."** â€" Social media would help, but without a Google Business Profile, she is still invisible in the map pack where most lunch searches happen.
3. **"Set up a complete Google Business Profile first â€" that is where the customers are searching."** â€" This is the right answer.

Recommended solution. Approach 3, with a supporting social media habit:

1. **Set up a Google Business Profile** (free, 30 minutes). Add the restaurant name, category ("Restaurant"), address near the Secretariat, phone number, hours (lunch-focused: 10amâ€"3pm), 10+ photos of the food, a description with keywords ("tufo, swallow, soup, lunch, Rivers State Secretariat, Port Harcourt"), and products with prices (lunch combos â‚¦800â€"â‚¦1,500).
2. **Ask 10 loyal customers for Google reviews** (free). These honest reviews will build trust fast â€" and Mama Tunde's food will shine in them.
3. **Post one Google Business Profile update per week** (free). A lunch special, a "soup of the day" photo, a customer thank-you.
4. **Post on Instagram 3 times a week** (free). Photos of the lunch spread, the soup of the day, the dining area. Use hooks: "Lunch near the Secretariat? Tufo and egusi for â‚¦800 ðŸ□²"
5. **Set up WhatsApp ordering** (free). Let office workers message their lunch order ahead â€" "Order by 11am, pick up by 12pm."

Say to the class:

"Mama Tunde does not need to outspend Quick Bites. She needs to out-complete them. A complete Google Business Profile with 10 photos, 10 honest reviews and weekly posts will put her in the map pack for 'lunch near me' and 'food near Rivers State Secretariat'. And once her food quality shows in the reviews â€" 'best tufo in Port Harcourt' â€" she will start winning the searches that matter. The competitor had a 6-month head start on online presence. Mama Tunde can catch up in 30 days â€" for free."

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 (lower prices): hurts margins, does not fix visibility.
- Approach 2 (social media only): builds some awareness but misses the map pack â€" where most lunch searches happen.
- Approach 3 (Google Business Profile first): free, fast, puts her where customers are already searching. Social media supports it.

Professional connection. This is the single most common local SEO situation: a long-established business with a great product being discovered less than a newer competitor with a complete online presence. The fix is never "spend more money" â€" it is "complete the foundation first." A Google Business Profile is the highest-leverage, lowest-cost action any local business can take. It levels the playing field between an 8-year-old restaurant and a 6-month-old competitor â€" and lets quality win.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the live guide. Point learners to the row rather than giving the answer.

K.1 Thinking SEO is about tricks

Symptoms: Learner asks about "hacks", "secrets" or "ways to fool Google". **Likely cause:** Misinformation from online sources that promise quick results. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What have you heard about SEO?" **Corrective steps:** Re-explain that modern SEO is about being complete, relevant and honest. Google rewards businesses that serve searchers well â€" not those that manipulate. **How to confirm resolved:** Learner describes SEO as "being the best result for what people search" â€" not "tricking Google". **Prevention:** Set the tone early: we practice honest, white-hat SEO only.

K.2 Targeting only big, broad keywords

Symptoms: All keywords are "food", "restaurant", "phone repair" â€" no location or specificity. **Likely cause:** The learner thinks bigger keywords = more customers. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Will you realistically rank for 'food' against every restaurant in Nigeria?" **Corrective steps:** Add location and specificity: "jollof rice delivery Port Harcourt", "phone repair GRA". Small and specific beats big and broad. **How to confirm resolved:** Every keyword includes a location or a specific service. **Prevention:** The keyword worksheet requires a relevance note â€" if the keyword does not match a specific service, it does not belong on the list.

K.3 Inconsistent NAP

Symptoms: Google listing says one phone number, Instagram says another, flyers say a third. **Likely cause:** The business changed numbers or moved and did not update everywhere. **How to investigate:** Search the business on Google, Instagram and their website â€" compare name, address and phone character by character. **Corrective steps:** Choose the correct information and update every platform to match exactly. **How to confirm resolved:** All sources show identical name, address and phone number. **Prevention:** Write NAP once on a master sheet and copy it everywhere. Update all platforms simultaneously.

K.4 Keyword stuffing

Symptoms: Description reads: "Best jollof rice jollof delivery jollof food jollof restaurant jollof Port Harcourt jollofâ€¦" **Likely cause:** The learner thinks repeating keywords boosts ranking. **How to investigate:** Read the description aloud. Does it sound natural? **Corrective steps:** Rewrite naturally. Include keywords once or twice in a way that reads like a human wrote it. **How to confirm resolved:** The description reads naturally and includes keywords without sounding forced. **Prevention:** Write for humans first. If a sentence sounds weird when read aloud, rewrite it.

K.5 Expecting instant results

Symptoms: Learner says "I set up my profile two days ago and I am not in the map pack." **Likely cause:** Unrealistic expectations about SEO timelines. **How to investigate:** Ask: "How long have you been working on this?" **Corrective steps:** Re-explain the honest timeline: weeks to appear, months to rank consistently, months to build reputation. Local SEO compounds â€" consistency over time is what wins. **How to confirm resolved:** Learner can describe realistic SEO expectations â€" weeks and months, not days. **Prevention:** Share the honest timeline from Section F.6 at the start of the session.

K.6 No reviews or fake reviews

Symptoms: Profile has zero reviews â€" or a suspicious cluster of generic 5-star reviews posted on the same day. **Likely cause:** The business never asked for reviews â€" or bought them. **How to investigate:** Check the reviews. Are they specific? Are they spread over time? Do they sound real? **Corrective steps:** If no reviews: start asking real customers. If fake reviews: remove them (if possible) and commit to earning real ones. **How to confirm resolved:** Reviews are genuine, specific and spread over time â€" and the business responds to all of them. **Prevention:** The ethics rule â€" real reviews only. Never buy or fake reviews.

K.7 Setting up a profile and forgetting it

Symptoms: Profile was set up months ago but has no new photos, no posts, no reviews since. **Likely cause:** The owner did not understand that local SEO is ongoing. **How to investigate:** Check the profile â€" when was the last post? How many photos? Are there new reviews? **Corrective steps:** Set a weekly reminder: one post, one photo, respond to reviews. 15 minutes a week keeps the profile alive. **How to confirm resolved:** The profile shows regular activity â€" new photos, posts, reviews over the past month. **Prevention:** Treat the Google Business Profile like a shop window â€" it needs regular tidying.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it (e.g., the learner can show you the exact keyword that is too broad, or the exact platform where NAP does not match). Teach learners to confirm before concluding.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "Keyword and Local SEO Worksheet"

Purpose: To practise finding and analysing keywords, and to audit and plan local SEO improvements â€" the skills that feed the capstone's SEO and local search section.

Realistic scenario. You are the SEO consultant for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen (or your own approved business). She has asked you to prepare a keyword list and a local SEO action plan that she can follow over the next 30 days to appear in more local searches.

Detailed instructions:

1. Find **12 keywords** for the business. Use at least three methods: Google Autocomplete, People Also Ask, and asking a friend or family member what they would search for. Write down where you found each keyword.
2. For each keyword, note: intent type (informational / navigational / transactional), estimated volume (high/medium/low), estimated competition (high/medium/low), and relevance to the business (high/medium/low).
3. Identify the **top 5 priority keywords** â€" the ones most likely to bring customers who are ready to pay. Write one sentence for each explaining why it is a priority.
4. Complete a **local SEO audit** of the business's Google Business Profile (use the 8-action checklist from Section F.5). Mark each action as done or needs work.
5. Write a **30-day local SEO action plan**: 5 specific actions the business should take, in order of priority, with a deadline for each.
6. Write one final sentence: "The most important thing about local SEO isâ€¦"

Required deliverables:

- A keyword list of 12 keywords with all four notes for each.
- Top 5 priority keywords with explanations.
- A completed local SEO audit checklist.
- A 30-day action plan with 5 actions and deadlines.
- The final reflection sentence.

Submission format: Handwritten or typed, submitted at the start of Session 6. Keep a copy in your working folder.

Deadline: Before Session 6.

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
12 keywords found using 3+ methods	5	Variety of methods, sources noted
Keyword analysis complete	4	Intent, volume, competition, relevance for each
Top 5 priority keywords	4	Specific, local, transactional â€" with clear reasoning
Local SEO audit	4	All 8 actions marked, gaps identified
30-day action plan	2	5 specific actions with deadlines, prioritised
Reflection sentence	1	Gives a real insight

Common mistakes to avoid: all broad keywords with no location; keywords that do not match what the business sells; volume/competition left blank; audit marked "done" without evidence; action plan with vague actions ("do SEO") instead of specific ones ("add 10 photos by next Friday").

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners â€" model for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen):

12 keywords (sources: Autocomplete, People Also Ask, customer question):

#	Keyword	Source	Intent	Volume	Competition	Relevance
1	jollof rice delivery Port Harcourt	Autocomplete	Transactional	Medium	Medium	High
2	food near me	Autocomplete	Transactional	High	High	Medium
3	small chops delivery GRA	Autocomplete	Transactional	Lowâ€"Med	Low	High
4	caterer in GRA	People Also Ask	Transactional	Lowâ€"Med	Low	High
5	party jollof rice	People Also Ask	Transactional	Low	Low	High
6	how to make smoky jollof	People Also Ask	Informational	Medium	Medium	Medium
7	food delivery Trans-Amadi	Customer question	Transactional	Lowâ€"Med	Low	High
8	soup and swallow near me	Autocomplete	Transactional	Medium	Medium	High
9	best food delivery Port Harcourt	Autocomplete	Transactional	High	High	Medium
10	Mama Nkechi's Kitchen	Autocomplete	Navigational	Low	Low	High
11	catering services Port Harcourt	People Also Ask	Transactional	Medium	Medium	High
12	how much is a plate of jollof	People Also Ask	Informational	Medium	Low	Medium

Top 5 priority keywords:

1. "jollof rice delivery Port Harcourt" â€" specific service, specific location, transactional intent.
2. "small chops delivery GRA" â€" matches her offer, low competition, local.
3. "caterer in GRA" â€" matches her catering service, high-value orders.
4. "party jollof rice" â€" high-value event orders, low competition.
5. "food delivery Trans-Amadi" â€" matches her service area, low competition.

Local SEO audit: (mark done/needs work for each of the 8 actions â€" see Section F.5 checklist.)

30-day action plan:

1. By day 7: Add 10 photos to Google Business Profile (food, kitchen, packaging).
2. By day 14: Ask 10 real customers for Google reviews (send WhatsApp message after each order).
3. By day 21: Add products/services with prices to the profile (full menu).
4. By day 28: Post first weekly Google Business Profile update (weekly special).
5. By day 30: Review and respond to all reviews; check NAP consistency across all platforms.

Reflection sentence: "The most important thing about local SEO is consistency â€" showing up every week with photos, posts and reviews so Google and customers learn to trust you."

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. In your own words, what are the three steps of how search engines work?

Q2. Multiple choice. Which keyword is the best target for a small food kitchen in Port Harcourt? a) "food" b) "jollof rice delivery Port Harcourt" c) "restaurant" d) "what to eat"

Q3. Explain. What is "search intent"? Give one example of a transactional local search.

Q4. Practical. A barbershop has a Google Business Profile with 2 photos, no reviews, and no posts in 3 months. List three specific things the owner should do this week to improve local SEO.

Q5. True or false. "If I pay an SEO expert, they can guarantee my business will be number one on Google in one week."

Q6. Ethics. Your friend wants to buy 100 fake Google reviews for â‚¦5,000 to make her salon look popular. What do you tell her, and why?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q6)

A1. Crawling (Google's bots read pages across the internet), indexing (filing everything in a catalogue), ranking (recommending the best results for each search). (Accept any answer covering the three steps in plain language.)

A2. (b) "jollof rice delivery Port Harcourt". It is specific, local, and transactional â€" the person typing it is ready to buy. The others are too broad or informational.

A3. Search intent is what the searcher actually wants â€" to learn something (informational), to find a specific site (navigational), or to buy or take action (transactional). Example of transactional local search: "jollof rice delivery Port Harcourt" or "caterer in GRA" â€" the person is ready to pay.

A4. Any three specific actions from the local SEO checklist: add more photos (at least 8 more), ask real customers for honest Google reviews, post a Google Business Profile update, add products/services with prices, ensure NAP consistency, answer the Q&A section.

A5. False. No honest SEO expert can guarantee number one on Google â€" the algorithm has hundreds of signals, results are personalised by location, and anyone promising guaranteed rankings is likely using tactics that violate Google's guidelines or is referring to paid ads.

A6. I would tell her not to do it. Fake reviews are dishonest â€" they mislead real customers, they break Google's guidelines (her profile could be suspended or removed), and they break the academy's ethics rules. Instead, she should ask real customers to leave honest reviews â€" it takes longer but builds real trust and is sustainable. The â‚¦5,000 is not worth the risk of losing her profile and her reputation. (Accept any answer that refuses and explains why.)

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you opened the biggest free source of customers: search. You learned how search engines work â€" crawling, indexing and ranking â€" like a giant library. You learned about **search intent**: what the searcher wants â€" information, navigation or a transaction â€" and that transactional local searches are the gold for small businesses. You learned to **find keywords** using Google Autocomplete, People Also Ask, Keyword Planner and asking customers. You learned that **Keyword Planner** shows volume and competition â€" and that for a small business, specific, local, low-competition keywords beat big, broad ones. You learned the **eight local SEO actions** that lift a Google Business Profile: categories, keywords in description, photos, posts, reviews, Q&A, NAP consistency and products with prices. And you learned to have **honest expectations**: SEO is a marathon, not a sprint â€" "number one in 7 days" promises are usually false, and consistency over months is what wins.

Five important takeaways:

1. Search is a library â€” crawling, indexing, ranking. Get into the library with a complete profile.
2. Search intent matters â€” transactional local searches are the most valuable.
3. Find keywords from real searches â€” Autocomplete, People Also Ask, customers.
4. Small, specific, local keywords beat big, broad ones.
5. Local SEO is 8 free actions â€” and consistency over months is what wins.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I explain how search works using the library analogy?
- Can I identify whether a keyword is informational, navigational or transactional?
- Can I find 10 real keywords using Google's own suggestions?
- Can I explain why "small chops delivery GRA" is better than "food" for a small business?
- Can I list the 8 local SEO actions and explain what each does?
- Can I explain why "number one in 7 days" promises are usually false?

Connection to the next session. You now know how to be found on Google â€” for free. Next session we learn the channels where you *own* the relationship with your customer: email and WhatsApp. Unlike social media or search â€” where the platform controls the reach â€” your email list and WhatsApp customer list are yours. No algorithm can take them away. We will learn to build them legally (never buying or scraping contacts), to send messages people actually want, and to stay on the right side of permission and anti-spam rules. That is Session 6: Email and WhatsApp Marketing â€” the channels that turn customers into regulars.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner explains crawling, indexing and ranking correctly in their own words.
- Learner identifies transactional local keywords as the most valuable for a small business.
- Learner finds keywords using Autocomplete and People Also Ask without being told.
- Learner's keyword worksheet is complete â€” intent, volume, competition and relevance for each.
- Learner's local SEO audit identifies specific gaps, not just "it is fine".
- Learner gives honest SEO timelines â€” weeks and months, not days.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "SEO is about tricking Google." â†' No â€ it is about being complete, relevant and honest.
- "Bigger keywords are better." â†' No â€ specific, local, low-competition keywords win for small businesses.
- "SEO works in days." â†' No â€ it takes weeks to appear, months to rank consistently.
- "Reviews do not matter." â†' Reviews are the #1 trust signal and a major ranking factor.
- "I can set up my profile once and forget it." â†' No â€ local SEO is ongoing: photos, posts, reviews and Q&A need regular attention.
- "Buying reviews is a shortcut." â†' No â€ it is fraud that risks suspension and destroys trust.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Intent matching drill:** Give 10 keywords and ask the learner to classify each as informational, navigational or transactional.
2. **Keyword finding drill:** Give a business type and ask the learner to find 5 keywords using only Google Autocomplete and People Also Ask.
3. **Local SEO gap drill:** Give a Google Business Profile with specific gaps (no photos, no reviews, inconsistent phone number) and ask the learner to identify the 3 most damaging gaps and suggest fixes.
4. **Timeline check:** Ask the learner to describe what realistic local SEO results look like at 2 weeks, 2 months and 6 months.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** Provide a pre-filled keyword list (12 keywords already found) and ask the learner to add intent, volume, competition and relevance notes, and identify the top 5. Provide the Local SEO Checklist with actions already marked â€ the learner writes specific fixes for each gap.
- **Level 2 (standard):** The session as written â€ full keyword research, analysis, audit and 30-day plan.

- **Level 3 (challenge):** Ask the learner to research keywords and write a local SEO action plan for a *competitor* of Mama Nkechi's Kitchen â€" then explain what Mama Nkechi should do differently to outrank that competitor. This requires analysing the competitor's profile and identifying weaknesses to exploit.

Timing guidance. The priority is the guided practical (Section H) â€" learners building a keyword list and completing a local SEO audit. If the room is slow, shorten the lecture (combine F.3 and F.4) and reduce the case study (Section J) to a 5-minute discussion. If Keyword Planner access is limited, use the estimated data from the lecture. Protect the practical time â€" a learner who leaves without a keyword list has no SEO foundation for the capstone.

Capstone link. The keyword list built today becomes the capstone's SEO keyword section. The local SEO audit and 30-day plan become the capstone's local search section. The honest understanding of SEO timelines becomes the capstone's measurement expectations. Keep all worksheets safe â€" the capstone assembles them in Session 9.

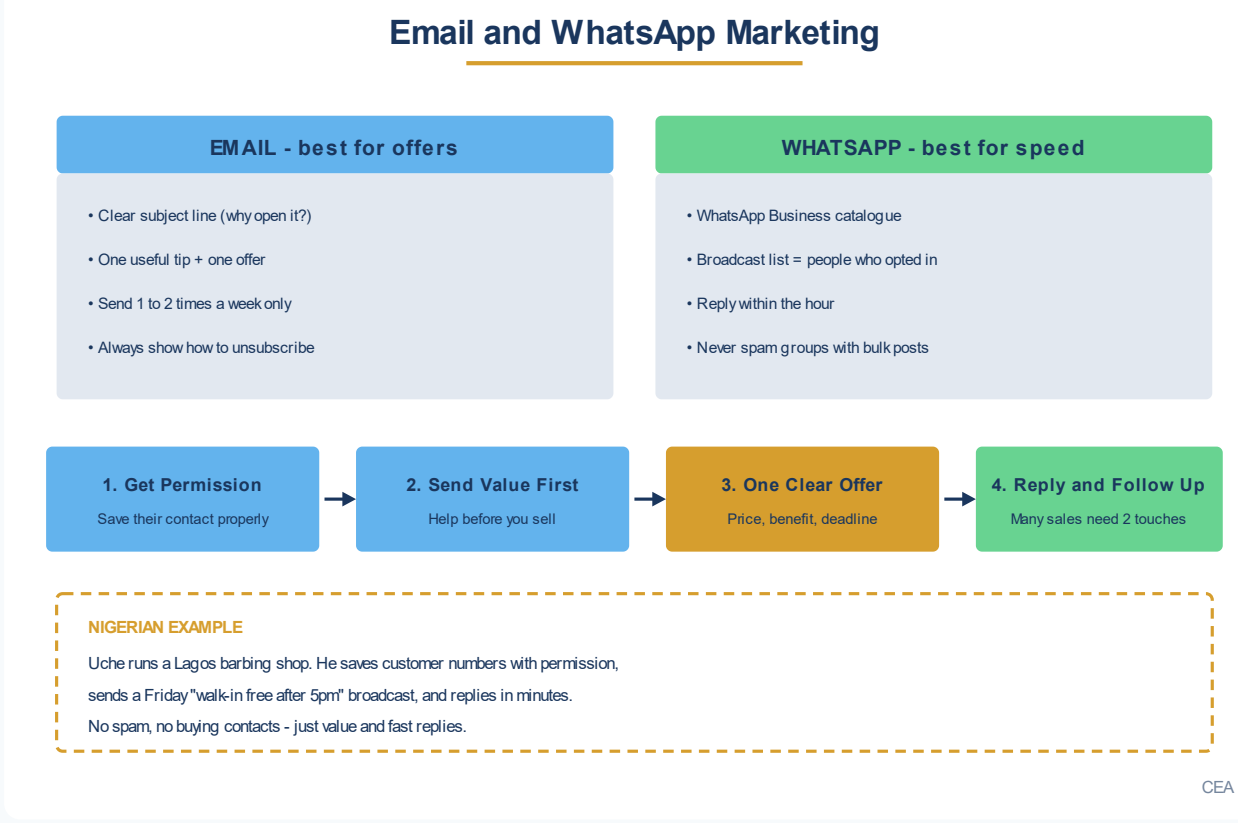
END OF SESSION 5

Next: Session 6 â€" Email and WhatsApp Marketing.

SESSION 06 OF 9

Email and WhatsApp Marketing

CONCEPT DIAGRAM — SESSION 06



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" DIGITAL MARKETING

SESSION 6 â€" EMAIL AND WHATSAPP MARKETING

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	6 of 9
Session title	Email and WhatsApp Marketing
Week / Module	Week 2 â€" Module 2: Channels
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (writing and setup, not software)
Prerequisite knowledge	Sessions 1â€"5. Learners should be able to build an avatar, write a value proposition, plan content, and set up a Google Business Profile.

Item	Detail
Connection to previous work	In Sessions 4 and 5 we learned free channels â€" content, social media and search â€" where the platform controls the reach. Today we learn the channels where YOU own the relationship: email and WhatsApp. No algorithm decides who sees your message. No platform can take your list away. But these channels come with the strictest ethics rules: permission first, always. Today we build lists legitimately, send messages people want, and stay on the right side of anti-spam and privacy rules.
Preparation before class	Academy computers or phones with internet ready. Prepare a projector slide showing a welcome email and a WhatsApp broadcast â€" one good, one bad. Print the Newsletter Structure Worksheet and the WhatsApp Opt-In Script per learner. Have a WhatsApp Business account ready for the demo. Prepare a fictional customer list (invented names and numbers only) for the broadcast exercise. Print the Ethics Check questions (Section M).

Instructor note on tone: This session carries the heaviest ethics weight of the course. Learners must understand that email and WhatsApp marketing is powerful *because* it is permission-based â€" and that violating that permission is spam, is harmful, and can have real legal consequences under Nigeria's data protection rules. Set the tone early: we ask, we identify, we give opt-outs, we honour them. Always. The technical skills are simple; the discipline is the skill.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Explain** why email and WhatsApp are "owned" channels â€" and why that makes them more valuable than rented channels like social media.
2. **Build a permission-based list** using at least three legitimate methods (sign-up link, giveaway, checkout question, WhatsApp opt-in) â€" and explain why buying or scraping contacts is wrong.
3. **Draft a simple newsletter** with one message, one story, one call-to-action and one unsubscribe link â€" following the structure taught in Section F.
4. **Create a WhatsApp broadcast list** and draft a permission-based WhatsApp message with an opt-out.
5. **Explain consent, unsubscribe and anti-spam/NDPR-minded practice** in their own words, scoring at least 70% on the ethics check.
6. **Read open and click rates** from a sample email report and explain what the numbers mean.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner (with WhatsApp installed) or an academy computer with internet.
- Instructor computer connected to a projector.
- Whiteboard or flip chart.

Software

- WhatsApp Business (free app â€" download from Play Store or App Store).
- An email tool: Gmail (free) for drafting, or a free email marketing platform (Mailchimp free tier, Brevo free tier) for the demo.
- Phone Notes or Google Docs for drafting.

Sample files

- **Newsletter Structure Worksheet** (Section H) â€" one per learner.
- **WhatsApp Opt-In Script** (Section F.4) â€" printed.
- **Fictional customer list** â€" invented names and numbers only, for the broadcast exercise.
- **Email report sample** â€" a screenshot or printed table showing opens, clicks and unsubscribes.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 6.1 â€" "Newsletter Structure Planner" (one message / one story / one CTA / one unsubscribe).
- Worksheet 6.2 â€" "Permission Checklist" (how did they opt in / when / what did they agree to / is there an opt-out?).

Accounts

- WhatsApp Business (free â€" install and set up with the learner's own number).
- Gmail (from Session 3). Optional: Mailchimp or Brevo free account for the email demo.

Internet

- Required for WhatsApp Business setup and the email demo.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- A phone with WhatsApp works for all exercises. If a learner does not have WhatsApp Business, they can plan the broadcast on paper â€" the skill is the *permission structure and message design*, not the app.

Safety and ethics note (read aloud at the start):

> *"Before we begin â€" one rule that cannot be broken. Email and WhatsApp messages go ONLY to people who said yes. We never buy lists. We never scrape numbers from Facebook groups. We never add people to broadcasts without their permission. We always identify ourselves. We always give an easy opt-out. And we honour opt-outs immediately. These are not suggestions â€" they are the law of this course, and they reflect Nigeria's data protection expectations and platform rules. Break them, and you fail this session's ethics check."*

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show two messages side by side.

Message 1 (bad â€" spam):

> *"CONGRATULATIONS! You have been selected for a special offer! Buy now at 50% discount! Limited time! Call 0803-XXXXXXX. Send money to this account to claim."*

Message 2 (good â€" permission-based):

> *"Hi Chinedu, it is Mama Nkechi here. You asked me to send you our new soup menu when it is ready. Here it is â€" 6 soups starting from â‚¦2,000. Reply YES to order, or STOP if you no longer want these messages. Enjoy! ðŸ²"*

What the instructor says:

> *"Two messages. One is spam â€" nobody asked for it, nobody wants it, and it could be a scam. The other is useful â€" the person asked for it, it is from someone they know, it offers something they wanted, and it gives them an easy way to say no. Hands up â€" which message would you actually read? â€¦ The second one. Hands up â€" which message would get you blocked, reported or ignored? â€¦ The first one."*
>
> *"Today you learn to send messages like the second one. Messages people actually want. Messages that build relationships instead of burning them. The skill is not just writing â€" it is discipline. Permission first. Always. Let us learn why."*

Why this opener works: It creates an immediate emotional contrast â€" everyone has received spam, and everyone hates it. The good message feels like a friend; the bad one feels like a scammer. That emotional anchor makes the ethics rules memorable before they are even explained.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "In Session 4, we learned that organic reach must be earned. Why is that different from email and WhatsApp?"

- Expected answer: Because email and WhatsApp are owned channels â€" no algorithm controls who sees your message. If someone gave you their email or WhatsApp, you can reach them directly.
- Common gap: learners say "because email is better". Clarify: "Better in what way? What is the structural difference?"

Question 2: "In Session 2, we built a customer avatar. What were Chinedu's top two pains for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen?"

- Expected answer: Too tired to cook after work; worried about food hygiene.
- Common gap: generic answers. Prompt for specifics.

Question 3: "In Session 3, we learned the NAP rule. Why does NAP consistency matter for email and WhatsApp too?"

- Expected answer: Because customers need to recognise and trust you â€" if your name or number is different everywhere, they do not know who is messaging them.
- Common gap: learners think NAP is only for Google. Clarify: NAP is about trust and recognition across ALL platforms.

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"We have content, search, and social media â€" all rented land where the platform decides who sees us. Today we build on land we own: the inbox and the WhatsApp chat. But to build on that land, we need permission â€" and we need to earn the right to stay there by sending messages people actually want. Let us learn how."*

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 Why email and WhatsApp are owned channels

The idea. A channel is **owned** when you control the relationship with the customer â€" no middleman decides whether they see your message. Email and WhatsApp are owned channels because once someone gives you their email address or phone number (with permission), you can reach them directly â€" no algorithm, no platform, no gatekeeper.

The three types of channels:

Channel type	Examples	Who controls reach?	Risk
Owned	Email list, WhatsApp list	You	Low â€" you control it
Rented	Social media, search, Google Maps	The platform	High â€" algorithm or policy changes can cut your reach overnight
Paid	Ads on Meta, Google, etc.	You (while you pay)	Stops when you stop paying

Why owned channels matter:

- **You own the list.** If Instagram shuts down tomorrow, your followers are gone. If you have 500 email addresses and 500 WhatsApp contacts who opted in, you still have 1,000 direct lines to customers.
- **No algorithm.** On Instagram, 10% of your followers might see your post. On email or WhatsApp, every message goes to every person who opted in.
- **Higher conversion.** People who give you their email or WhatsApp have already raised their hand â€" they are warmer than a social media follower.
- **It compounds.** A list built over a year is an asset that keeps delivering value.

The Nigerian context (say this):

> *"In Nigeria, WhatsApp is not just a messaging app â€" it is a business tool. Many small businesses take orders, send catalogues, and handle customer service entirely on WhatsApp. Email is more common in professional and corporate*

settings. Together, they cover almost every customer type. A business with a WhatsApp customer list AND an email list has two direct lines to its customers â€" and that is power."

Common misconception. "Email is dead â€" everyone uses WhatsApp." No. Email is alive and well for newsletters, formal communication, and reaching professionals. WhatsApp is dominant for casual, immediate, personal communication in Nigeria. They serve different purposes â€" smart businesses use both.

F.2 Building a permission-based list â€" legitimately

The idea. A **permission-based list** is a collection of email addresses or phone numbers from people who explicitly agreed to hear from you. Permission is the foundation of ethical email and WhatsApp marketing. Without it, you are spamming.

Why buying or scraping contacts is wrong:

- **It is spam.** People who did not ask for your messages see them as intrusive and annoying.
- **It is dishonest.** You are pretending to have a relationship that does not exist.
- **It is illegal.** Nigeria's data protection regulation (NDPR) and platform terms prohibit sending unsolicited bulk messages. WhatsApp actively bans numbers that send spam.
- **It does not work.** People who did not opt in will not buy from you â€" they will block, report and delete. You damage your reputation and your sender credibility.

The four legitimate ways to build a list:

1. Sign-up link or form. Add a form to your website or Google Business Profile: "Get our weekly menu and special offers â€" enter your email." People who fill it in are raising their hand.

2. Giveaway or lead magnet. Offer something free in exchange for contact details: "Get our free '10 Party Food Checklist' â€" just enter your email or WhatsApp." The free item must be genuinely useful.

3. Checkout or order question. When a customer orders, ask: "Would you like to receive our weekly menu and special offers on WhatsApp/email? Reply YES to join." This is permission asked at the perfect moment â€" they just bought from you.

4. WhatsApp opt-in. Add a WhatsApp button to your website and Google Business Profile. Send a first message that identifies you and gives an opt-out: "Thanks for contacting Mama Nkechi's Kitchen. You will receive our weekly menu and offers here. Reply STOP anytime to unsubscribe."

The permission rules (say these slowly):

- **Ask explicitly.** "Do you want to receive our messages?" â€" not a pre-ticked box.
- **Say what they will get.** "Weekly menu and special offers" â€" not "occasional updates".
- **Give an opt-out in every message.** "Reply STOP to unsubscribe" â€" always.
- **Honour opt-outs immediately.** When someone says STOP, remove them from the list that day. No exceptions.

Worked example â€" Mama Nkechi's Kitchen, list building:

- 50 customers have ordered on WhatsApp. She sends each one: "Hi! Thank you for your order. Would you like our weekly menu and special offers sent here? Reply YES to join."
- 35 say YES. She adds them to a WhatsApp broadcast list called "Customers - Weekly Menu".
- She adds a note to her Google Business Profile: "Message us on WhatsApp for our weekly menu."
- She adds a sign-up line to her website: "Get our weekly menu â€" WhatsApp us at 0803-XXX-XXXX."
- Result: 35 permission-based WhatsApp contacts â€" and growing.

Common misconception. "I can buy a list of 10,000 Nigerian phone numbers for â‚¦5,000 and send them my advert." No â€" that is spam. It is illegal, it gets your number banned, and it brings zero customers. A list of 100 people who actually asked to hear from you is worth more than 10,000 who did not.

F.3 Newsletter structure â€" one message, one story, one CTA

The idea. A **newsletter** is a regular email (weekly or monthly) sent to your permission-based email list. The best newsletters are not catalogues of everything you sell â€" they are focused, useful and human. One message, one story, one call-to-action, one unsubscribe link.

Why newsletters work:

- They keep you in your customer's mind between purchases.
- They build a relationship â€" people buy from people they trust.
- They drive repeat business â€" a weekly reminder with a special offer brings orders.
- They are measurable â€" you can see opens, clicks and unsubscribes.

The six parts of a simple newsletter:

1. **Subject line** â€" the most important line. It decides whether the email is opened. Make it specific and intriguing: "This week's soup: Ofe nsala ðŸ²" not "Newsletter #12".
2. **Preview text** â€" the short snippet that appears next to the subject line. Use it to extend the hook: "Plus: 2 tips for perfect party jollof".
3. **Greeting** â€" "Hi Chinedu," â€" personal, warm.
4. **One story or message** â€" the body. Tell one story, share one tip, or highlight one offer. Keep it short â€" 3â€"5 sentences. Example: "This week we are cooking Ofe nsala â€" white soup with goat meat. It is rich, spicy and perfect for the rainy weather. We only make 20 plates, so order early."
5. **One call-to-action** â€" what should they do? "Reply YES to order" or "Click here to see the full menu". One action, not three.
6. **Unsubscribe link** â€" required by law and by ethics. "Reply STOP to unsubscribe" or an automatic unsubscribe link in email marketing tools.

Worked example â€" Mama Nkechi's Kitchen, weekly newsletter:

> ***Subject:*** *This week's soup: Ofe nsala ðŸ²* ***Preview:*** *Plus: 2 tips for perfect party jollof*
>
> *Hi Chinedu,*
>
> *This week we are cooking Ofe nsala â€" white soup with goat meat, utazi and uziza. It is rich, spicy and perfect for this rainy weather.*
>
> *We only make 20 plates, so order early. â‚¦2,500 a plate, delivered hot to your door in GRA.*
>
> *Reply YES to order yours this week.*
>
> *Mama Nkechi ðŸ²*
>
> *P.S. Reply STOP anytime if you no longer want these messages.*

Say to the class:

> *"One message. One story. One CTA. One unsubscribe. That is a newsletter. Notice it does not list everything on the menu â€" it highlights ONE thing (the soup), tells a little story (rainy weather, only 20 plates), gives a price and a delivery promise, and asks for one action. That is it. A newsletter that tries to say everything says nothing."*

How often to send: Weekly or monthly â€" whatever you can sustain. A weekly newsletter you actually send beats a daily plan you abandon. Consistency is the magic.

Common misconception. "A newsletter must be long and professional." No â€" short and human beats long and corporate. Your customers are people, not machines. Write like you are messaging a friend who happens to be a customer.

F.4 WhatsApp Business â€" the tool, the catalogue, the broadcast

The idea. WhatsApp Business is a free app from WhatsApp designed for small businesses. It lets you create a business profile, a catalogue of products, labels for customers, quick replies and broadcast lists. For many Nigerian small businesses, WhatsApp Business is the entire sales system.

The four key features:

1. Business profile. Your name, description, address, hours, email and website. This is the first thing a customer sees when they open your chat. Complete it fully â€" it builds trust.

2. Catalogue. A list of your products with photos, prices and descriptions. For Mama Nkechi: "Jollof Rice â€" â‚¦1,500 â€" Smoky jollof with fried plantain", "Small Chops (20 pcs) â€" â‚¦1,200 â€" Spring rolls, samosa, peppered chicken". The catalogue lets

customers browse and order without asking.

3. Labels. Colour-coded tags to organise customers: "New customer", "Regular", "Catering enquiry", "Awaiting payment". Labels help you send the right message to the right people.

4. Broadcast lists. Send one message to many people at once â€" but only to people who have your number saved AND have opted in. This is the key difference from group messaging: broadcasts are one-to-many, private (each person sees it as an individual message), and respect the opt-in.

The WhatsApp broadcast rules (say these slowly):

- **Only message people who opted in.** They must have your number saved AND agreed to receive messages.
- **Identify yourself in the first message.** "This is Mama Nkechi's Kitchen."
- **Give an opt-out in every broadcast.** "Reply STOP to unsubscribe."
- **Honour opt-outs immediately.** Remove them from the broadcast list.
- **Do not spam groups.** Do not add people to WhatsApp groups without permission. Group-blasting is spam.
- **Respect WhatsApp's limits.** WhatsApp limits broadcast lists to 256 contacts per list. Work within that.

Worked example â€" Mama Nkechi's Kitchen, WhatsApp broadcast:

> *Subject (first line): Mama Nkechi's Kitchen ðŸ²*
>
> *Message: Good morning! This week's special: Ofe nsala â€" white soup with goat meat. â‚¦2,500 a plate. Only 20 plates available.*
>
> *Reply YES to order, or STOP if you no longer want these messages.*
>
> *Mama Nkechi's Kitchen Â· 0803-XXX-XXXX*

Common misconception. "I can add all my contacts to a broadcast list and send adverts." No â€" WhatsApp broadcasts only work reliably for people who have your number saved. And sending adverts to people who did not opt in is spam â€" it gets your number banned. The broadcast list must be built on permission, just like email.

F.5 Email marketing on a free tier â€" sending and measuring

The idea. To send newsletters to more than a handful of people, you need an email tool. Free tiers exist: Mailchimp (free for up to 500 contacts), Brevo (free for up to 300 emails/day), or others. These tools handle the unsubscribe links, the formatting and the delivery â€" and they give you reports.

The three key metrics:

1. **Open rate** â€" the percentage of people who opened your email. A healthy open rate for a small business is 20â€"40%. If it is low, your subject lines are weak or your list is cold.
2. **Click-through rate (CTR)** â€" the percentage of people who clicked a link in your email. A healthy CTR is 2â€"5%. If it is low, your content or your CTA is not compelling.
3. **Unsubscribe rate** â€" the percentage of people who opted out. A healthy unsubscribe rate is below 0.5% per email. If it is high, you are sending too often, to the wrong people, or with the wrong content.

Worked example â€" Mama Nkechi's Kitchen, email report after one newsletter:

Metric	Number	Rate	What it means
Sent	35	100%	35 people on the list
Opened	14	40%	Healthy â€" subject line worked
Clicked	3	8.6% of opens	Good â€" the soup offer was compelling
Unsubscribed	0	0%	Nobody wanted to leave â€" content is relevant

Say to the class:

> *"Forty percent open rate is good. Eight-point-six percent click rate is good. Zero unsubscribes is excellent. This newsletter worked because it went to 35 people who asked for it, with a clear subject line, one useful story and one easy action. That is email marketing. Not complicated â€" just disciplined."*

Common misconception. "I need thousands of subscribers for email to work." No â€" 50 engaged subscribers who actually open and click are worth more than 5,000 who ignore you. Start small. Build carefully. Grow slowly.

F.6 Consent, unsubscribe and anti-spam/NDPR-minded practice

The idea. This is the most important section of the session. The power of email and WhatsApp comes with responsibility. Misusing these channels is spam â€" and spam has real consequences.

The five rules of permission-based messaging:

1. **Consent first.** Only message people who explicitly agreed. Consent can be:
    - **Express** â€" they filled a form, replied YES, or asked to join.
    - **Inferred** â€" they bought from you and you asked if they want updates (but you must still give an opt-out).
    - Never assume consent. If in doubt, ask.
2. **Identify yourself.** Every message must say who it is from. "This is Mama Nkechi's Kitchen." No fake names, no misleading sender details.
3. **Give an easy opt-out.** Every message must include a way to unsubscribe. "Reply STOP" or an automatic link. No hoops, no "reply to this number to unsubscribe" â€" just one clear action.
4. **Honour opt-outs immediately.** When someone says STOP, remove them from the list that day. Do not send "are you sure?" messages. Do not delay. Immediate removal is the rule.
5. **Respect data (NDPR-minded).** Collect only what you need. Use it only for the agreed purpose. Keep it secure. Never sell it. Delete it when no longer needed. Nigeria's Data Protection Regulation expects this â€" and platforms enforce it.

What spam looks like (and why it is harmful):

- Messages to people who did not agree.
- Misleading subject lines ("Your account is blocked!" when it is not).
- No opt-out or a broken opt-out.
- Fake sender identities.
- Buying lists and blasting adverts.

The consequences of spam:

- **WhatsApp** bans numbers that send spam. A banned number means losing your business line.
- **Email platforms** block senders with high spam complaints â€" your legitimate emails stop reaching anyone.
- **Customers** lose trust in your brand â€" spam damages reputation permanently.
- **Legal** â€" Nigeria's data protection regulation and platform terms carry real penalties for unsolicited bulk messaging.

Say to the class:

> *"Spam is not just annoying â€" it is a trust destroyer. Every spam message you send tells a customer: 'I do not respect your time or your choice.' And once that trust is gone, no amount of good content wins it back. Permission-based messaging is not just the ethical choice â€" it is the effective choice. People who asked to hear from you will buy from you. People who did not will never buy â€" and will make sure others do not either."*

Common misconception. "But businesses spam WhatsApp groups all the time and they seem fine." Some do â€" until they do not. WhatsApp's enforcement is increasing, and the businesses that build permission-based lists are the ones that survive long-term. Short-term spam is a shortcut to a dead end.

F.7 Summary of the lecture

- Email and WhatsApp are **owned channels** â€" you control the relationship, no algorithm decides reach.

- Build lists **legitimately**: sign-up forms, giveaways, checkout questions, WhatsApp opt-ins. Never buy or scrape contacts.
- **Newsletters** have six parts: subject line, preview text, greeting, one story, one CTA, one unsubscribe link.
- **WhatsApp Business** gives you a profile, catalogue, labels and broadcasts â€" all permission-based.
- **Measure** open rate, click rate and unsubscribe rate â€" they tell you what is working.
- **Ethics first**: consent, identification, opt-out, honouring opt-outs, NDPR-minded data handling.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Get permission] --> B[Build list]
    B --> C[Send valuable content]
    C --> D[Include clear CTA]
    D --> E[Track clicks/sales]
    E --> B
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- WhatsApp Business installed and set up on the instructor's phone.
- A projector connection (screen mirroring or screenshots) to show WhatsApp Business features.
- A Gmail or Mailchimp draft open for the newsletter demo.
- The fictional customer list (invented names and numbers).

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€" set up WhatsApp Business live (5 minutes)

Say: "Let me show you how to set up WhatsApp Business. Watch â€" this takes five minutes."

Open WhatsApp Business. Narrate:

1. Download WhatsApp Business from the app store.
2. Register with your business phone number.
3. Set up the business profile: name "Mama Nkechi's Kitchen", category "Food & Beverage", description "Home-cooked Nigerian meals, soups and small chops. Delivery in Port Harcourt. Order on WhatsApp.", address, hours, email.
4. Add a catalogue: 5 items with photos and prices â€" Jollof Rice â‚¦1,500, Small Chops â‚¦1,200, Ogbono Soup â‚¦2,000, Fried Rice â‚¦1,500, Catering Package from â‚¦15,000.
5. Create labels: "New Customer", "Regular", "Catering".
6. Create a broadcast list: "Customers â€" Weekly Menu" (add 5 fictional contacts).

Say:

> *"That is the setup. Profile, catalogue, labels, broadcast list. All free. All taking minutes. Now Mama Nkechi has a professional WhatsApp Business presence that lets customers browse her menu, see prices and order â€" all in one app."*

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€" draft a WhatsApp broadcast live (4 minutes)

Say: "Now let me show you a good broadcast. I will write one for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen."

Draft on the projector (or screen mirror):

> ***Mama Nkechi's Kitchen ðŸ²***
>
> *Good morning! This week's special: Ofe nsala â€" white soup with goat meat. â‚¦2,500 a plate. Only 20 plates available.*
>
> *Reply YES to order, or STOP if you no longer want these messages.*
>
> *Mama Nkechi's Kitchen Â· 0803-XXX-XXXX*

Point out each part:

- First line: identification â€" "Mama Nkechi's Kitchen".
- The offer: one thing (Ofe nsala), one price, one reason to act now (only 20 plates).
- The CTA: one action â€" "Reply YES".
- The opt-out: "Reply STOP".
- Contact info: phone number.

Say:

> *"Six lines. One offer. One action. One opt-out. That is a broadcast that respects the customer's attention and their choice. Compare that to the spam message from the opening â€" the difference is night and day."*

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€" draft a newsletter live (4 minutes)

Say: "Now the email version. Same offer â€" different channel, slightly different style."

Open Gmail or Mailchimp. Draft:

> ***Subject:*** *This week's soup: Ofe nsala ðŸ²* ***Preview:*** *Plus: 2 tips for perfect party jollof*
>
> *Hi Chinedu,*
>
> *This week we are cooking Ofe nsala â€" white soup with goat meat, utazi and uziza. It is rich, spicy and perfect for this rainy weather.*
>
> *We only make 20 plates, so order early. â‚¦2,500 a plate, delivered hot to your door in GRA.*
>
> *Reply YES to order yours this week.*
>
> *Mama Nkechi ðŸ²*
>
> *P.S. Reply STOP anytime if you no longer want these messages.*

Say:

> *"Notice the structure: subject line, preview text, greeting, one story, one CTA, one unsubscribe. The story is short â€" three sentences. The CTA is one action. The opt-out is one line. That is a newsletter that gets opened, read and acted on."*

G.5 Questions to ask during the demo

- "Why do we put the opt-out in every message?" (Law, ethics, trust â€" and it is required by email platforms and WhatsApp.)
- "Why only one CTA?" (One action is clear. Three actions is confusing.)
- "What happens if someone replies STOP?" (You remove them from the list immediately. No exceptions.)
- "Can we send the same message on WhatsApp and email?" (Adapt it â€" WhatsApp is shorter and more casual; email can have a preview text and a slightly longer story.)
- "How do we know if our message worked?" (Open rate, click rate, unsubscribe rate â€" the email report tells you.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding, each learner drafts a newsletter and a WhatsApp broadcast for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen (or their own business), builds a permission checklist, and reads a sample email report.

Starting materials: The Newsletter Structure Worksheet, the Permission Checklist, the sample email report, a pen. WhatsApp Business or paper for drafting.

Procedure (instructor calls out each step; learners follow; instructor walks the room):

1. Choose your business â€" Mama Nkechi's Kitchen or your own approved business. Write the name at the top of the Newsletter Structure Worksheet.

2. Write a **subject line** for your newsletter. Make it specific and intriguing â€" not "Newsletter" but "This week's special: [something specific]".
3. Write the **preview text** â€" one short line that extends the hook.
4. Write the **greeting** â€" "Hi [Avatar name]," (e.g., "Hi Chinedu,").
5. Write **one story or message** â€" 3â€"5 sentences. Pick one product, one tip or one offer. Tell a mini-story.
6. Write **one call-to-action** â€" what should the reader do? Make it specific: "Reply YES to order" or "Click here to see the menu".
7. Write the **unsubscribe line** â€" "Reply STOP to unsubscribe" or "Click here to unsubscribe".
8. **Pause and predict:** Read your newsletter aloud. Does it have all six parts? Is the story short and clear? Is there exactly one CTA? If not, fix it.
9. Now draft a **WhatsApp broadcast** for the same offer. Adapt it â€" shorter, more casual, with identification, one offer, one CTA, one opt-out.
10. Turn to the Permission Checklist. For your business, write down: How will people opt in? What will they agree to receive? How will they opt out? How will you honour opt-outs?
11. Look at the **sample email report**. Write down: the open rate, the click rate, the unsubscribe rate. Are they healthy? What would you change to improve them?
12. Keep all worksheets â€" this is the start of your capstone owned-channel plan.

Expected result (model answer â€" instructor key):

A completed newsletter with all six parts, a WhatsApp broadcast adapted from the same offer, a completed permission checklist, and an analysis of the sample email report.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 8: "Is your subject line specific enough? Would you open it?"
- After step 9: "Is your WhatsApp version shorter and more casual than your email version? It should be."
- After step 11: "What would you do if someone replied STOP today? Write down the exact steps."

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Subject line is vague ("Newsletter #12") â†' "What is the specific thing you are telling them about? Put that in the subject."
- Story is too long â†' "Cut it to 3â€"5 sentences. One story, not three."
- No opt-out â†' "Add 'Reply STOP to unsubscribe' â€" it is not optional."
- WhatsApp version is identical to email â†' "Adapt it â€" shorter, more casual, with identification."
- Permission checklist is blank â†' "Start with the simplest: when a customer orders, ask 'Would you like our weekly menu on WhatsApp?' That is your first opt-in."

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Newsletter has all six parts (subject, preview, greeting, story, CTA, unsubscribe)
- ☐ Story is 3â€"5 sentences with one clear message
- ☐ Exactly one CTA in the newsletter
- ☐ WhatsApp broadcast is shorter, with identification, one offer, one CTA, one opt-out
- ☐ Permission checklist completed (how they opt in, what they get, how they opt out, how you honour it)
- ☐ Sample email report analysed with three metrics noted

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task: You are the marketing manager for *Kelechi's Phone Repairs* (the fictional phone repair shop from Sessions 2, 4 and 5). Build the owned-channel plan for them.

Requirements:

1. Write a **newsletter draft** for Kelechi's Phone Repairs. Subject: a free phone care tip. Include all six parts.
2. Write a **WhatsApp broadcast** for the same business â€" a special offer on screen repairs. Include identification, one offer, one CTA, one opt-out.

3. Write a **permission script** â€" what Kelechi says to a customer who just paid for a repair, to ask if they want to join his WhatsApp list. (3â€"4 sentences.)
4. Write one sentence: "The most important rule of email and WhatsApp marketing isâ€¦"

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- Newsletter has all six parts with a specific subject line.
- WhatsApp broadcast is short, clear and permission-based.
- Permission script is polite, clear and gives the customer an easy yes or no.
- The final sentence shows understanding of the core rule.

Hints if stuck:

- Hint 1: For the newsletter, pick one phone care tip â€" "3 habits that kill your battery" or "Why your phone overheats".
- Hint 2: For the WhatsApp broadcast, make the offer specific â€" "Screen repair this week: â‚¦10,000 (save â‚¦2,000)".
- Hint 3: The permission script should feel natural â€" like something a real person would say after a sale.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

Newsletter draft:

> ***Subject:*** *3 habits that are killing your phone battery ðŸ"‹* ***Preview:*** *Plus: this week's screen repair special*
>
> *Hi Kelechi,*
>
> *Did you know charging your phone to 100% every night can reduce battery life by up to 30%? Here are 3 simple habits to make your battery last longer â€" and one sign it might be time for a replacement.*
>
> 1. *Charge to 80%, not 100%.*
> 2. *Avoid using your phone while it charges.*
> 3. *Keep it out of direct sunlight.*
>
> *If your battery still drains fast, it might need replacing. We do battery replacements in 30 minutes â€" â‚¦8,000 with a 30-day warranty.*
>
> *Reply YES to book, or click here to see our full price list.*
>
> *Kelechi's Phone Repairs Â· Trans-Amadi, PH*
>
> *P.S. Reply STOP anytime if you no longer want these messages.*

WhatsApp broadcast:

> ***Kelechi's Phone Repairs ðŸ"±***
>
> *This week only: screen repair â‚¦10,000 (save â‚¦2,000). Fixed in 2 hours, 30-day warranty.*
>
> *Reply YES to book, or STOP if you no longer want these messages.*
>
> *0803-XXX-XXXX Â· Trans-Amadi*

Permission script:

> *"Hi! Thanks for trusting us with your phone. We send a weekly message with phone care tips and special repair offers â€" no spam, just useful stuff. Would you like to join? Reply YES and I will add you. You can leave anytime by replying STOP."*

The most important rule: "The most important rule of email and WhatsApp marketing is permission â€" only message people who said yes, and always let them say no."

Learner marking (out of 10):

- Newsletter has all six parts with specific subject (3)
- WhatsApp broadcast is short, clear, permission-based (3)

- Permission script is polite and gives easy yes/no (2)
- Final sentence shows understanding of the core rule (2)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Adaeze* runs a small event planning business in Port Harcourt â€" *Glam Events PH* â€" specialising in birthday parties and small weddings. She has 200 contacts on her personal WhatsApp â€" past customers, enquiries and people who asked for quotes. She wants to send them a monthly message with party planning tips and special package offers. She also has 40 email addresses from past customers. Her business partner says: "Just add all 200 WhatsApp contacts to a group and send the advert â€" they all asked for quotes, so they are interested." Adaeze is unsure â€" she does not want to annoy people, but she also does not want to miss the opportunity.

Relevant facts.

- Of the 200 WhatsApp contacts, only 60 actually became customers. The other 140 asked for quotes but never booked.
- None of the 200 contacts explicitly agreed to receive marketing messages.
- The 40 email addresses are from past customers â€" they gave their email when booking, but were not asked if they want updates.
- Adaeze's business partner wants to create a WhatsApp group, add all 200 contacts and send monthly adverts.
- A competitor, *Sparkle Events*, sends a monthly WhatsApp broadcast â€" but only to 80 people who replied YES when asked.

Decision point. What should Adaeze do?

Possible approaches.

1. **Add all 200 contacts to a group and send adverts.** This is spam â€" most did not agree, group-blasting is against WhatsApp's rules, and it will damage her reputation and get her number banned.
2. **Do nothing â€" it is too risky.** This is safe but wasteful â€" she has 200 warm contacts and is not using them.
3. **Ask permission first â€" send a polite opt-in message to all 200 contacts, and only add those who say YES.** This is the right answer.

Recommended solution. Approach 3. Adaeze should:

1. **Send an opt-in message to all 200 WhatsApp contacts:**

   > *"Hi! This is Adaeze from Glam Events PH. I would like to send you monthly party planning tips and special package offers on WhatsApp. Reply YES if you would like to join, or ignore this message if not. You can leave anytime by replying STOP."*

2. **Only add the people who reply YES** to her broadcast list. If 80 say yes, she has a permission-based list of 80.
3. **Send a monthly newsletter to the 40 email addresses** â€" but first, send one email asking: "Thank you for being a customer. Would you like our monthly party tips and offers? Reply YES to confirm." Only keep those who confirm.
4. **Never add anyone who did not explicitly say YES.** No assumptions, no "they asked for a quote so they are interested".
5. **Honour every STOP immediately.** No exceptions.

Say to the class:

> *"Adaeze's business partner means well â€" but that approach would get her number banned and her reputation damaged. The permission-first approach takes one extra message, but it builds a list of people who actually want to hear from her. Those 80 people who say YES are worth more than 200 who did not. That is the power of permission â€" quality over quantity, always."*

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 (group spam): fast but destructive â€" banned number, damaged reputation, zero trust.
- Approach 2 (do nothing): safe but wasteful â€" 200 warm contacts going unused.
- Approach 3 (permission first): one extra step, builds a valuable owned asset, sustainable and legal.

Professional connection. This is the most common email/WhatsApp dilemma: a business has a pile of contacts and wants to market to them. The answer is always the same â€" ask first. The businesses that build permission-based lists are the ones that have direct customer relationships for years. The ones that spam are the ones that wonder why their number got banned and their messages get ignored. Permission is not a barrier â€" it is the foundation.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the live guide. Point learners to the row rather than giving the answer.

K.1 Buying or scraping contact lists

Symptoms: Learner says "I can buy a list of Nigerian phone numbers for â‚¦5,000." **Likely cause:** Not understanding that purchased lists are spam and illegal. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Did those people agree to hear from you?" **Corrective steps:** Explain the four legitimate list-building methods. Emphasise that bought lists bring zero customers and real risk. **How to confirm resolved:** Learner can explain why buying lists is wrong and name two legitimate alternatives. **Prevention:** The ethics note at the start of the session â€" and the opening activity contrast.

K.2 No opt-out in messages

Symptoms: Newsletter or broadcast has no "reply STOP" or unsubscribe link. **Likely cause:** The learner forgot, or thinks it is not necessary. **How to investigate:** Read the message â€" is there an opt-out? **Corrective steps:** Add an opt-out to every message. It is the law of the course and the practice of professional marketing. **How to confirm resolved:** Every drafted message includes a clear opt-out. **Prevention:** The six-part newsletter structure includes the unsubscribe as a required part.

K.3 Not honouring opt-outs

Symptoms: Someone replies STOP but stays on the list. **Likely cause:** The learner does not have a system for removing opt-outs. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What do you do when someone replies STOP?" **Corrective steps:** Establish a rule: when someone opts out, remove them immediately. On WhatsApp, delete them from the broadcast list. On email, use the platform's automatic unsubscribe. **How to confirm resolved:** Learner can describe the exact steps to honour an opt-out. **Prevention:** The permission checklist includes "how will you honour opt-outs?"

K.4 Group-blasting on WhatsApp

Symptoms: Adding people to WhatsApp groups to send adverts. **Likely cause:** Confusing groups with broadcast lists. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Are you sending to a group or a broadcast list?" **Corrective steps:** Explain the difference: broadcasts are private one-to-many messages to people who opted in. Groups are multi-person conversations â€" adding people to groups without permission is spam. **How to confirm resolved:** Learner can explain the difference and why groups are not for adverts. **Prevention:** The WhatsApp broadcast rules in Section F.4.

K.5 Sending too frequently

Symptoms: Daily broadcasts or newsletters â€" subscribers start ignoring or leaving. **Likely cause:** Enthusiasm without discipline. **How to investigate:** Ask: "How often are you planning to send? Can you sustain that?" **Corrective steps:** Set a realistic schedule â€" weekly or monthly â€" and stick to it. Consistency beats frequency. **How to confirm resolved:** Learner has a sustainable schedule. **Prevention:** The newsletter section emphasises: weekly or monthly, whatever you can sustain.

K.6 Vague subject lines

Symptoms: "Newsletter", "Update", "Hello" â€" low open rates. **Likely cause:** The learner does not know what makes a good subject line. **How to investigate:** Show the last subject line. Would you open it? **Corrective steps:** Make it specific and intriguing: "This week's soup: Ofe nsala ðŸ²" not "Newsletter #12". **How to confirm resolved:** Every subject line is specific and would make the reader curious. **Prevention:** The newsletter structure worksheet requires a specific subject line.

K.7 Assuming consent from a business relationship

Symptoms: "They bought from me, so I can send them adverts." **Likely cause:** Confusing a transaction with consent. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Did they explicitly agree to receive marketing messages?" **Corrective steps:** Explain that a purchase is not consent. Ask explicitly: "Would you like our weekly menu?" Only those who say yes are on the list. **How to confirm resolved:**

Learner asks for permission even from existing customers. **Prevention:** The permission rules in Section F.2 and the permission script exercise.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it (e.g., the learner can show you the exact message without an opt-out). Teach learners to confirm before concluding.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "Permission-Based Message â€" Newsletter and Broadcast"

Purpose: To practise drafting a newsletter and a WhatsApp broadcast that follow permission-based, ethical marketing principles â€" the skills that feed the capstone's owned-channel plan.

Realistic scenario. You are the marketing manager for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen (or your own approved business). She has 40 past customers who have given their WhatsApp number or email when ordering. She wants to start sending them a weekly message with her menu and special offers. Your job is to draft the first newsletter and the first WhatsApp broadcast, and to write the permission script she will use to ask customers to join.

Detailed instructions:

1. Write a **permission script** â€" what Mama Nkechi says (or messages) to a past customer to ask if they want to join her weekly list. (3â€"4 sentences. Must identify her, say what they will receive, and give an easy way to say no.)
2. Draft a **newsletter** for the weekly list. Include all six parts: subject line, preview text, greeting, one story (3â€"5 sentences), one CTA, one unsubscribe link.
3. Draft a **WhatsApp broadcast** for the same weekly message. Include identification, one offer, one CTA, one opt-out.
4. Write a **list-building plan** â€" three specific ways Mama Nkechi will grow her permission-based list over the next month. No buying, no scraping.
5. Write one final sentence: "The most important thing I learned about email and WhatsApp marketing isâ€¦"

Required deliverables:

- A permission script.
- A newsletter draft (all six parts).
- A WhatsApp broadcast draft.
- A list-building plan (three methods).
- The final reflection sentence.

Submission format: Handwritten or typed, submitted at the start of Session 7. Keep a copy in your working folder.

Deadline: Before Session 7.

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Permission script	4	Identifies, says what they will receive, gives easy yes/no
Newsletter (all six parts)	6	Subject, preview, greeting, story, CTA, unsubscribe â€" all present
WhatsApp broadcast	4	Short, clear, permission-based, with opt-out
List-building plan	4	Three legitimate methods, no buying/scraping
Reflection sentence	2	Gives a real insight

Common mistakes to avoid: no opt-out in messages; buying lists; assuming consent from a purchase; vague subject lines; newsletters that are too long or have multiple CTAs; WhatsApp broadcasts that are identical to the email (they should be adapted).

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners â€" model for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen):

Permission script:

"Hi! This is Mama Nkechi from Mama Nkechi's Kitchen. Thank you for your order. I send a weekly message with our menu and special offers â€" no spam, just useful updates. Would you like to join? Reply YES to join, or ignore this message if you prefer not to. You can leave anytime by replying STOP."

Newsletter:

> ***Subject:*** *This week's soup: Ofe nsala ðŸ²* ***Preview:*** *Plus: 2 tips for perfect party jollof*
>
> *Hi Chinedu,*
>
> *This week we are cooking Ofe nsala â€" white soup with goat meat, utazi and uziza. It is rich, spicy and perfect for this rainy weather.*
>
> *We only make 20 plates, so order early. â‚¦2,500 a plate, delivered hot to your door in GRA.*
>
> *Reply YES to order yours this week.*
>
> *Mama Nkechi ðŸ²*
>
> *P.S. Reply STOP anytime if you no longer want these messages.*

WhatsApp broadcast:

> ***Mama Nkechi's Kitchen ðŸ²***
>
> *Good morning! This week's special: Ofe nsala â€" white soup with goat meat. â‚¦2,500 a plate. Only 20 plates available.*
>
> *Reply YES to order, or STOP if you no longer want these messages.*
>
> *0803-XXX-XXXX Â· Port Harcourt*

List-building plan:

1. Ask every customer at checkout: "Would you like our weekly menu on WhatsApp? Reply YES to join." Add all YES responses to the broadcast list.
2. Add a WhatsApp button to the Google Business Profile and website: "Message us for our weekly menu."
3. Offer a small free item (a free drink with the first order) for customers who join the list this month.

Reflection sentence: "The most important thing I learned about email and WhatsApp marketing is that permission is not a barrier â€" it is the foundation. A small list of people who said yes is more valuable than a large list of people who did not."

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK AND SESSION 6 ETHICS CHECK â€" 10 ITEMS, /10

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

This is the LO6 Ethics Check. It has 10 items, 1 mark each â€" scored out of 10 (/10).

Item	Detail
Total	**10 items Ã— 1 mark = /10**
Pass mark	**7 of 10 (70%)**
7â€"10	Satisfies **LO6** (the 70% gate) and is recorded in the knowledge-check component (15%)
6 or below	**Resit required** before Session 7 â€" a different 10-item paper, same /10, same 7/10 pass mark
What it covers	consent and privacy Â· legitimate list building Â· STOP/unsubscribe handling Â· NDPR-minded data protection Â· ad labelling and transparency Â· bought followers Â· fake reviews Â· platform rules Â· honest reporting Â· permission-based messaging

Q1. Short answer. What is the difference between an "owned" channel and a "rented" channel? Give one example of each.

Q2. Multiple choice. Which of these is a legitimate way to build an email/WhatsApp list? a) Buying a list of Nigerian phone numbers b) Adding people to a WhatsApp group without asking c) Asking customers at checkout if they want to join d) Scraping numbers from Facebook groups

Q3. Explain. What are the six parts of a simple newsletter, in order?

Q4. Practical. Your friend runs a bakery and wants to send a WhatsApp broadcast. Write the broadcast message for her weekend special: buy one cake, get one free. Include identification, the offer, a CTA and an opt-out.

Q5. Ethics scenario. A customer replies STOP to your WhatsApp broadcast. What do you do, and what happens if you do not do it?

Q6. Ethics. True or false: "If someone bought from me once, I can add them to my marketing list without asking."

Q7. Ethics â€" consent, privacy and NDPR-minded data handling. You keep a spreadsheet of the 40 customers who joined your WhatsApp broadcast list, with their names, numbers and what they ordered. State **four** things you must (and must not) do with that spreadsheet, in line with Nigeria's data protection (NDPR-minded) rules.

Q8. Ethics â€" ad labelling and transparency. A soap company pays you â‚¦15,000 to post their new soap on your page. What **must** you say in the post, and what must you **never** do with that post? Explain why.

Q9. Ethics â€" bought followers and fake reviews. A new client offers you â‚¦30,000 to buy 5,000 followers for their page and to post five glowing reviews from accounts that have never used their service. Give **three** reasons you refuse â€" say what each tactic does to the client, to the data and to trust.

Q10. Ethics â€" platform rules and permission-based messaging. Your classmate says: "WhatsApp groups are for adverts. I will add every contact in my phone to five groups and blast the offer." Name **three** things that are wrong with this plan, and state the rule you would follow instead.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q10) â€" 1 mark per item, /10; pass at 7/10

A1. An owned channel is one where you control the relationship with the customer â€" no middleman decides who sees your message. A rented channel is one where the platform controls the reach. Owned example: email list, WhatsApp customer list. Rented example: Instagram, Google search, Facebook page.

A2. (c) Asking customers at checkout if they want to join. The other options are all spam â€" buying lists, group-blasting and scraping are illegal and unethical.

A3. Subject line, preview text, greeting, one story/message, one call-to-action (CTA), one unsubscribe link.

A4. (Accept any answer with identification, one offer, one CTA, one opt-out.) Example: "Adaeze's Bakes ðŸŽ‚, Weekend special: buy one cake, get one free! This Saturday and Sunday only. Reply YES to order, or STOP if you no longer want these messages. Call 0803-XXX-XXXX."

A5. Remove them from the broadcast list immediately â€" that same day. If you do not, you are spamming someone who explicitly said no. This violates their trust, breaks the academy's ethics rules, can get your number banned by WhatsApp, and can have legal consequences under Nigeria's data protection regulation.

A6. False. A purchase is not consent. You must explicitly ask: "Would you like to receive our weekly menu and offers?" Only those who say yes are on the list. Assuming consent from a transaction is a common mistake â€" and it is spam.

A7. (1 mark for any four correct points.) Collect only what you need; use it **only** for the agreed purpose; keep it secure (password/private storage, not shared or forwarded); never sell it or trade it; delete it when it is no longer needed or when a person opts out; add no one to the list without their own consent â€" a customer's details are never handed to another business. *(Consent and privacy + NDPR-minded handling.)*

A8. (1 mark.) The post must clearly say the content is **paid/sponsored** â€" e.g., "Ad", "Sponsored" or "#Ad" â€" and it must be an honest post: only claims the product can prove, real photos, no fake discounts or invented urgency. You must never pass a paid post off as your own independent recommendation, hide the payment, or present the brand's campaign as your own work. *(Ad labelling, transparency and honest reporting.)*

A9. (1 mark for any three sound reasons.) (1) **Bought followers never buy** â€" they are bots or idle accounts, so the client gets empty numbers, wasted money and distorted data (engagement rate collapses). (2) **Fake reviews are dishonest** â€" they mislead customers who cannot verify them; they are prohibited by platform rules and break the academy's ethics rules. (3) **Harm to the client** â€" when the fraud is discovered, the client loses trust, can be penalised or banned by the platform, and the marketer's reputation goes with it. Honest alternative: ask real customers for real reviews and grow followers with content and permission-based messaging. *(Bought followers + fake reviews + honest reporting.)*

A10. (1 mark for any three problems plus the correct rule.) Wrong: (1) most of those contacts did not ask to hear from the advert â€" that is **spam**; (2) adding people to groups without permission breaches **WhatsApp's platform rules** and can get the number banned; (3) it assumes consent from having a phone number â€" **a number is not permission**. The rule to follow instead: **permission-based messaging** â€" message only people who said yes, identify yourself, give an easy opt-out in every message and honour STOP the same day. Use a broadcast list built on opt-ins, never group-blasting. *(Platform rules + permission-based messaging + list-building ethics.)*

Marking and recording (instructor): award 1 mark per item, total /10, enter the score on the mark sheet. **7â€"10 = pass (LO6 satisfied). 6 or below = resit** before Session 7 using a fresh 10-item set (same /10, same 7/10 pass mark); record the resit score and one line of feedback. The ethics check is a graded gate inside the knowledge-check component (15%) â€" it is not optional, and it cannot be replaced by a strong quiz average elsewhere.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned to build on land you own. You learned that email and WhatsApp are **owned channels** â€" no algorithm decides who sees your message; you control the relationship directly. You learned to build a **permission-based list** legitimately â€" sign-up forms, giveaways, checkout questions, WhatsApp opt-ins â€" and why buying or scraping contacts is wrong. You learned the **six parts of a newsletter**: subject line, preview text, greeting, one story, one CTA, one unsubscribe link. You learned **WhatsApp Business**: profile, catalogue, labels and broadcasts â€" all permission-based. You learned to **measure** open rate, click rate and unsubscribe rate. And you learned the **ethics** that make these channels work: consent first, identify yourself, give an opt-out, honour it immediately, and handle data with NDPR-minded care.

Five important takeaways:

1. Email and WhatsApp are owned channels â€" build them; no algorithm can take them away.
2. Permission is the foundation â€" never buy, scrape or assume consent.
3. A newsletter has six parts â€" subject, preview, greeting, story, CTA, unsubscribe.
4. WhatsApp broadcasts are short, permission-based and always include an opt-out.
5. Consent, identification, opt-out, honouring opt-outs, NDPR-minded data handling â€" always.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I explain the difference between owned, rented and paid channels?
- Can I name three legitimate ways to build a permission-based list?
- Can I draft a newsletter with all six parts?
- Can I draft a WhatsApp broadcast with identification, one offer, one CTA and one opt-out?
- Can I explain what to do when someone replies STOP?

Connection to the next session. You now know the free channels â€" content, search, email and WhatsApp. Next session we learn the channel that can accelerate everything: **paid advertising**. You will learn the difference between Meta and Google ads, how to choose an objective, define an audience, judge creative and landing-page fit, and set a realistic naira budget. You will learn what â‚¦2,000, â‚¦10,000 or â‚¦50,000 a week can realistically buy â€" and why you optimise for customers, not likes. That is Session 7: Paid Ads Basics â€" the channel that turns attention into customers when the maths works.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner explains owned vs rented channels correctly and gives examples.
- Learner's newsletter has all six parts with a specific subject line.
- Learner's WhatsApp broadcast includes identification, one offer, one CTA and one opt-out.
- Learner's permission script is polite and gives an easy yes/no.
- Learner honours the ethics rules without being reminded â€" no buying lists, no assuming consent, no missing opt-outs.
- Learner can explain what to do when someone replies STOP.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "Email is dead." â†’ No â€" email is alive for newsletters and professional communication. WhatsApp dominates casual and immediate communication in Nigeria.
- "I can buy a list and send adverts." â†’ No â€" that is spam, illegal, and brings zero customers.
- "A purchase is consent." â†’ No â€" you must explicitly ask, even from existing customers.
- "Groups are fine for adverts." â†’ No â€" group-blasting is spam. Broadcasts are for opted-in contacts only.
- "The opt-out is optional." â†’ No â€" it is the law of the course and the practice of professional marketing.
- "More messages = more sales." â†’ No â€" too many messages cause unsubscribes and blocks. Consistency and relevance win.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Newsletter repair drill:** Give a broken newsletter (no subject, no CTA, no unsubscribe) and ask the learner to fix all three.
2. **Permission script drill:** Give a scenario (a salon, a shop, a school) and ask the learner to write a 3-sentence opt-in script.
3. **Opt-out drill:** Ask the learner to write the exact steps they would take when someone replies STOP on WhatsApp and on email.
4. **Channel sorting drill:** Give 10 channel examples (Instagram, email, Google Maps, WhatsApp, paid ads, website, TikTok, SMS, flyers, word of mouth) and ask the learner to classify each as owned, rented or paid.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** Provide the newsletter structure with the story already written â€" the learner adds the subject line, CTA and unsubscribe. Provide a fill-in-the-blank permission script.
- **Level 2 (standard):** The session as written â€" full newsletter, broadcast, permission script and list-building plan.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** Ask the learner to design a **4-week email sequence** for a new customer: a welcome email, a tip email, an offer email and a follow-up â€" each with all six parts. Then explain how the sequence builds trust and drives a first purchase.

Timing guidance. The priority is the guided practical (Section H) â€" learners drafting a newsletter and broadcast with the ethics rules applied. If the room is slow, shorten the lecture (combine F.2 and F.3) and reduce the case study (Section J) to a 5-minute discussion. If learners struggle with the ethics rules, run an extra 5-minute scenario drill: "Is this spam?" with five quick examples. Protect the practical time â€" a learner who leaves without a permission-based newsletter and broadcast has no owned-channel plan.

Capstone link. The newsletter and broadcast drafts become the capstone's owned-channel plan. The permission script and list-building plan become the capstone's permission strategy. The email report analysis becomes the capstone's measurement expectations. The ethics check score becomes part of the capstone's ethics statement. Keep all worksheets safe â€" the capstone assembles them in Session 9.

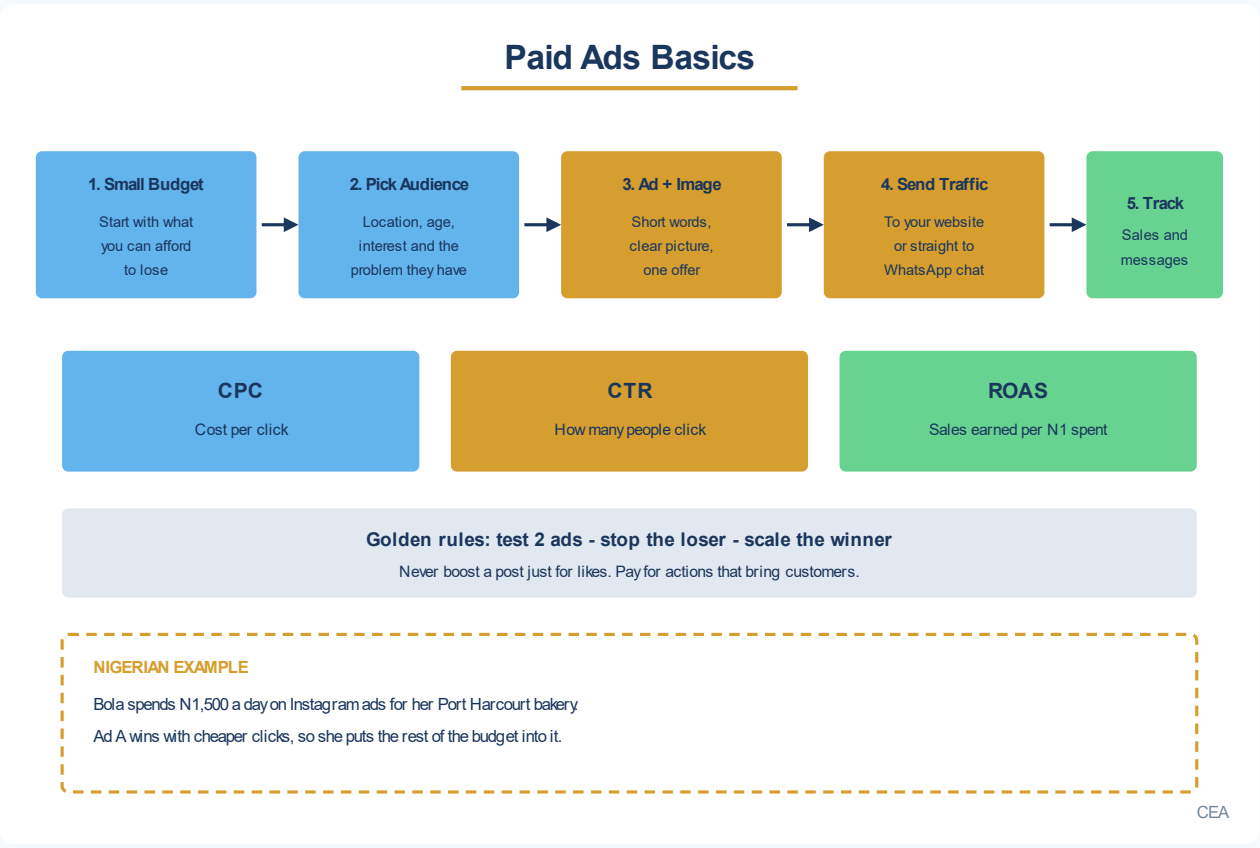
END OF SESSION 6

Next: Session 7 â€" Paid Ads Basics.

SESSION 07 OF 9

Paid Ads Basics

CONCEPT DIAGRAM — SESSION 07



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" DIGITAL MARKETING

SESSION 7 â€" PAID ADS BASICS

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	7 of 9
Session title	Paid Ads Basics
Week / Module	Week 3 â€" Module 3: Convert and Measure
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (concepts and structure, not heavy software)
Prerequisite knowledge	Sessions 1â€"6. Learners should be able to build an avatar, write a value proposition, plan content, set up a Google Business Profile, and draft permission-based messages. No prior ads

Item	Detail
	experience required.
Connection to previous work	In Sessions 4â€"6 we learned the free channels â€" content, search, email and WhatsApp. Today we learn the channel that can accelerate everything: paid advertising. We will compare Meta and Google ads, learn how to choose an objective, define an audience, set a naira budget, and understand ad structure. No ad spend is required â€" we learn the structure and the maths, and watch a small academy-funded demonstration.
Preparation before class	Academy computers or phones with internet ready. Prepare projector slides comparing Meta ads and Google ads. Print the Campaign Structure Sheet (Section H) per learner. Prepare a sample budget table showing what â‚¦2,000, â‚¦10,000 and â‚¦50,000 per week can realistically buy. Have the Meta Ads Manager and Google Ads interfaces ready for a demo (no spend). Prepare a fictional case brief for the independent exercise. If the academy funds a small demonstration budget (â‚¦2,000â€"â‚¦5,000), prepare that approval and setup.

Instructor note on tone: Paid ads can feel intimidating â€" learners worry about wasting money. Your job is to replace fear with structure. Ads are not gambling; they are a system with clear parts: objective, audience, creative, budget and measurement. When the maths works, ads work. When it does not, they do not. Today we learn to make the maths work â€" and to never spend more than we can afford to lose. Emphasise: this session teaches structure and thinking, not "how to spend money."

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Explain** the difference between Meta ads and Google ads â€" who they reach, when they reach them, and what each is best for.
2. **Choose a campaign objective** that matches a stated business goal, using the funnel stages from Session 1.
3. **Define a target audience** for a small local business, using location, interests and behaviours â€" and explain why "everyone" is the wrong audience.
4. **Describe the three parts of ad structure** â€" campaign, ad set and ad â€" and what belongs at each level.
5. **Propose a daily budget in naira** that matches a stated goal, and explain what that budget can realistically buy (and what it cannot).
6. **Judge ad creative and landing-page fit** â€" whether an ad's promise matches what the customer finds when they click.
7. **Apply honest advertising rules** â€" no fake discounts, no misleading claims, no buying engagement â€" to ad creative and copy.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner (with a notes app) or an academy computer with internet.
- Instructor computer connected to a projector.
- Whiteboard or flip chart.

Software

- Meta Ads Manager (free â€" accessible with a Facebook account).
- Google Ads interface (free â€" accessible with a Gmail account).
- Phone Notes or Google Docs for planning.

Sample files

- **Campaign Structure Sheet** (Section H) â€" one per learner.
- **Sample Budget Table** â€" what â‚¦2,000, â‚¦10,000 and â‚¦50,000 per week can buy.
- **Meta vs. Google Ads comparison slide** â€" projector-ready.
- **Ad Examples** â€" three sample ads (one Meta, one Google, one poor example) for the demo.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 7.1 â€" "Campaign Structure Planner" (campaign objective / ad set audience / ad creative).
- Worksheet 7.2 â€" "Naira Budget Calculator" (daily budget Ã— days = total; estimated reach and clicks).

Accounts

- Facebook account (for Meta Ads Manager access). Gmail (from Session 3, for Google Ads access). No spend required â€" we learn the interface without launching live ads.

Internet

- Required for the ads interface demos.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- A phone with a browser works for viewing the ads interfaces and completing the planning worksheets. The core skill is the *structure and the maths*, which can be done on paper.

Safety and ethics note:

- No learner is required to spend their own money on ads. The academy may fund a small demonstration budget on a fictional or academy-approved page. Any live ad shown is academy-funded and clearly labelled.
- We practice honest advertising only: no fake discounts, no misleading claims, no discriminatory targeting, no buying engagement.
- The "no paid subscription" rule applies: we learn ad structure for free; spending is optional and by personal choice only.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show two ad examples.

Ad 1 (Meta â€" Instagram feed ad): A photo of jollof rice, text overlay "Too tired to cook? We deliver ðŸ□²", sponsored label, CTA button "Order Now".

Ad 2 (Google â€" Search ad): A text ad at the top of a Google search results page for "jollof rice delivery Port Harcourt": "Mama Nkechi's Kitchen â€" Hot Jollof Delivered in 45 Min. Order on WhatsApp. â‚¦1,500."

What the instructor says:

> *"Two adverts for the same business. Both paid. Both trying to get the same customer. But they work in completely different ways. The first one â€" the Instagram ad â€" interrupts someone who is scrolling through photos of their friends. The second one â€" the Google ad â€" appears when someone is actively searching for food delivery. One interrupts. One answers. Both can work. But they need different approaches, different budgets and different expectations. Today you learn how both work â€" and how to decide which one your business needs, when, and how much to spend."*
>
> *"And here is the most important thing: paid ads are renting attention. While you pay, you are seen. When you stop, you are gone. So ads only work when the maths works â€" when the cost of getting a customer is less than what that customer is worth. Today we learn that maths."*

Why this opener works: It shows two very different ad types side by side, creates curiosity about how they differ, and sets up the central question: which one, when, and how much?

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "In Session 1, we learned the four funnel stages. What are they, in order?"

- Expected answer: Awareness, Consideration, Conversion, Retention.
- Common gap: learners mix up the order. Have them say it as a story.

Question 2: "In Session 2, we built a customer avatar for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen. What is the avatar's name, and what is one of his pains?"

- Expected answer: Chinedu; too tired to cook after work (or worried about food hygiene).
- Common gap: generic answers. Prompt for specifics.

Question 3: "In Session 6, we learned the difference between owned, rented and paid channels. Give one example of each."

- Expected answer: Owned â€" email/WhatsApp list. Rented â€" Instagram, Google. Paid â€" ads.
- Common gap: learners confuse rented and paid. Clarify: rented = free but platform-controlled; paid = you pay for reach.

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"We have the full map now â€" the funnel, the customer, the free channels and the owned channels. Today we add the accelerant: paid ads. But we add it last on purpose. Ads work best when the foundation is solid â€" when your Google listing is complete, your WhatsApp ordering works, and your content is good. Ads amplify what is already there. If the foundation is broken, ads just make you lose money faster. That is why this session comes after all the others."*

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 Meta ads vs. Google ads â€" the fundamental difference

The idea. Meta ads (Facebook and Instagram) and Google ads are the two main paid channels for a small business. They work in fundamentally different ways, and understanding that difference is the foundation of choosing the right one.

Meta ads â€" interruption marketing. Meta ads appear in people's Facebook and Instagram feeds, stories and reels â€" places where they are browsing, not searching. You are interrupting their scroll with something relevant. Because the person is not actively looking for your product, your ad must *stop the scroll* and *create interest*. Meta ads are best for:

- **Awareness** â€" reaching people who do not know you exist.
- **Demand creation** â€" making people want something they were not looking for.
- **Retargeting** â€" reaching people who visited your page or website but did not buy.

Google ads â€" intent marketing. Google ads appear when someone searches on Google, watches YouTube, or uses Google Maps. The person is actively looking for something. You are answering their search with your offer. Because the person is already looking, your ad must *match their search* and *be the best answer*. Google ads are best for:

- **High-intent searches** â€" people typing "jollof rice delivery Port Harcourt" or "phone repair near me".
- **Local searches** â€" people looking for businesses near them.
- **Capturing demand** â€" people who already know what they want and are choosing who to buy from.

The key comparison (say this):

> *"Meta ads are like a market trader calling out to passers-by: 'Come and look at this!' Google ads are like a shop with a sign that says exactly what people are searching for when they walk down the street. Meta creates demand. Google captures demand. Both are useful â€" but they do different jobs."*

Worked example â€" Mama Nkechi's Kitchen:

- **Meta ad:** An Instagram reel showing sizzling jollof rice with the text "Too tired to cook? We deliver ðŸ□²". Target: people in Port Harcourt aged 25â€"45 who follow food pages. Goal: get them to visit her WhatsApp and place an order.
- **Google ad:** A search ad for "jollof rice delivery Port Harcourt" showing "Mama Nkechi's Kitchen â€" Hot Jollof Delivered in 45 Min. â‚¦1,500. Order on WhatsApp." Target: people searching that phrase in Port Harcourt. Goal: get them to click and order immediately.

Which one first? For most small businesses, Google ads come first â€" because the person is already looking. But if you have no audience at all and need to build awareness first, Meta ads can create the demand that Google later captures. The answer depends on your goal, your budget and your foundation.

F.2 Campaign objectives â€" matching the goal to the funnel

The idea. Before you spend a single naira, you must know *what you want the ad to do*. This is your **campaign objective**. The objective determines who the platform shows your ad to, how it is priced, and how success is measured. Choosing the right objective is the most important decision in paid advertising.

The six common objectives (simplified):

1. **Awareness** â€" get as many people as possible to see your ad. Best for new businesses with no audience. Like putting up a billboard.
2. **Reach** â€" get your ad to as many *unique* people as possible. Similar to awareness but counts each person once.
3. **Traffic** â€" get people to click your ad and visit your website, Google Business Profile or WhatsApp.
4. **Engagement** â€" get likes, comments, shares and page follows. Useful for building a warm audience â€" but be careful: engagement does not equal sales.
5. **Leads** â€" get people to send their contact details (via a form, WhatsApp message or phone call).
6. **Sales** â€" get people to place an order or make a purchase. The hardest and most expensive objective â€" but the one that matters most.

Matching the objective to the funnel:

Funnel stage	Best objective	Why
Awareness	Awareness or Reach	They do not know you exist yet
Consideration	Traffic or Engagement	They are checking you out â€" drive them to your profile or website
Conversion	Leads or Sales	They are ready to buy â€" make it easy to order
Retargeting	Sales or Leads	They have visited before â€" remind them to come back

Say to the class:

> *"If you choose the wrong objective, you waste money. If your goal is orders but you choose 'engagement', the algorithm will optimise for likes â€" and likes do not pay bills. If your goal is awareness but you choose 'sales', the algorithm will struggle to find buyers â€" because most people who see your ad are not ready to buy yet. Match the objective to the funnel stage, and the algorithm will do its job."*

Common misconception. "I want likes and followers â€" that means my ad is working." No. Likes and followers are vanity metrics â€" they feel good but do not pay bills. The only metrics that matter are the ones tied to your goal: clicks, leads, sales and return on ad spend (ROAS). Optimise for customers, not likes.

F.3 Targeting â€" reaching the right people (not everyone)

The idea. Targeting is telling the platform who should see your ad. The platform has data on billions of people â€" their location, age, interests, behaviours and more. Your job is to define a specific audience so your money is not wasted showing your ad to people who will never buy.

The three targeting levels:

1. **Location** â€" where the person is. For a local business, this is the most important: "People in Port Harcourt" or "People within 10km of GRA". Never target all of Nigeria if you only deliver to Port Harcourt â€" you will waste money on people in Lagos and Abuja.
2. **Demographics** â€" age, gender, language. For Mama Nkechi's Kitchen: "Ages 25â€"45, English and Pidgin speakers" â€" the working professionals and parents who order food delivery.
3. **Interests and behaviours** â€" what they like, what they do. For Mama Nkechi: "People who follow food pages, people who search for food delivery, people who have ordered food online before."

The golden rule of targeting: narrow is better.

> *"Targeting 'everyone in Port Harcourt' is the most expensive and least effective strategy. You will show your ad to students, grandparents, people who never order food â€" and pay for every impression. Instead, narrow it: 'People in GRA and Trans-Amadi, aged 25â€"45, who follow food pages and have ordered online before.' That is a smaller audience â€" but every person in it is a potential customer. Narrow targeting costs less and converts more."*

The avatar connection: Your target audience should match your customer avatar. If your avatar is Chinedu (28, professional in GRA, orders food delivery), your targeting should be: location = GRA and Trans-Amadi, age = 25â€"45, interests = food delivery, dining, convenience. The avatar is the blueprint; targeting is the execution.

Common misconception. "I should target as many people as possible to get the most for my money." No â€" a small, well-targeted audience that converts beats a broad audience that ignores you. The algorithm rewards relevance. The more specific your audience, the cheaper and more effective your ads become.

F.4 Ad structure â€" campaign, ad set, ad

The idea. Both Meta and Google ads have a three-level structure. Understanding this structure is essential â€" it keeps your ads organised, your budget clear and your testing possible.

The three levels:

1. Campaign â€" the top level. This is where you set your **objective** (awareness, traffic, sales) and your **total budget**. One campaign = one objective. If you want awareness AND sales, you need two campaigns.

2. Ad set â€" the middle level. This is where you define your **audience** (location, demographics, interests) and your **budget** (daily or lifetime). One campaign can have multiple ad sets â€" for example, one targeting GRA and one targeting Trans-Amadi, each with its own budget.

3. Ad â€" the bottom level. This is the actual creative â€" the image, video, text and call-to-action. One ad set can have multiple ads â€" for example, two different images with different hooks â€" so you can test which performs better.

The structure in one sentence:

> *"Campaign = what you want (objective). Ad set = who you want (audience). Ad = what you show them (creative)."*

Worked example â€" Mama Nkechi's Kitchen, ad structure:

Level	What	Example
Campaign	Objective: Sales (orders on WhatsApp)	Budget: â‚¦10,000 for 7 days
Ad set 1	Audience: GRA, 25â€"45, food delivery interests	Budget: â‚¦5,000 (50% of campaign)
Ad set 2	Audience: Trans-Amadi, 25â€"45, food delivery interests	Budget: â‚¦5,000 (50% of campaign)
Ad 1 (in Ad set 1)	Photo of jollof, hook "Too tired to cook?", CTA "Order on WhatsApp"	
Ad 2 (in Ad set 1)	Reel of jollof being cooked, hook "Hot jollof in 45 minutes", CTA "Order on WhatsApp"	

Why this structure matters: It lets you test. If Ad 1 gets more clicks than Ad 2, you learn that photos work better than reels for this audience. If Ad set 1 (GRA) gets more orders than Ad set 2 (Trans-Amadi), you learn to shift budget to GRA. Structure enables learning.

Common misconception. "I should put all my budget into one ad." No â€" testing multiple ads and audiences is how you learn what works. A small budget spread across two or three options teaches you more than a large budget spent on one guess.

F.5 Naira budgets â€" what can you realistically buy?

The idea. Paid ads are rented attention. The more you pay, the more you get â€" but the relationship is not linear, and there is a minimum threshold below which ads simply do not work. Here is what realistic budgets can buy for a small Nigerian business.

The minimum viable budget: For Meta and Google ads, a daily budget of at least â‚¦500â€“â‚¦1,000 is the practical minimum. Below this, the algorithm cannot gather enough data to optimise. A weekly budget of â‚¦3,500â€“â‚¦7,000 is the minimum for a meaningful test.

What different budgets can buy (estimated, in naira):

Weekly budget	Estimated reach (people who see the ad)	Estimated clicks (people who click)	Estimated orders (if 2â€“5% convert)	What it is good for
â‚¦3,500â€“â‚¦7,000	2,000â€“5,000	50â€“150	1â€–7 orders	Testing â€” learning what works
â‚¦10,000â€–â‚¦20,000	5,000â€–15,000	150â€–400	3â€–20 orders	Growing â€” scaling what works
â‚¦30,000â€–â‚¦50,000	15,000â€–40,000	400â€–1,000	6â€–50 orders	Established â€” consistent customer acquisition

Say to the class:

> *"These are estimates â€” actual results depend on your targeting, your creative, your offer and your landing page. But notice the pattern: even a small budget of â‚¦10,000 a week can bring real orders if the foundation is solid. And notice what a budget cannot do: it cannot fix a broken offer, a weak Google listing or a confusing WhatsApp ordering process. Ads amplify what is there. If the foundation is strong, even a small budget works. If it is broken, even a large budget fails."*

The maths that matters â€” Customer Acquisition Cost (CAC):

> *"CAC = total ad spend Ã· number of customers acquired. If you spend â‚¦10,000 and get 5 customers, your CAC is â‚¦2,000 per customer. Now â€” is that worth it? If each customer spends â‚¦1,500 per order and orders twice a month, they are worth â‚¦3,000 a month. If they stay for 6 months, they are worth â‚¦18,000. A CAC of â‚¦2,000 to acquire a customer worth â‚¦18,000 is excellent. But if they only order once and never return, a CAC of â‚¦2,000 for a â‚¦1,500 order is a loss. The maths tells you whether ads work."*

Budget rules for beginners:

- Start small â€” â‚¦5,000 to â‚¦10,000 for a one-week test.
- Never spend more than you can afford to lose.
- Do not increase the budget until you have a proven winner (a positive ROAS).
- Turn off ads that are losing money â€” do not throw good money after bad.

Common misconception. "I need â‚¦100,000 a week to make ads work." No â€” many small businesses run effective ad campaigns on â‚¦10,000â€“â‚¦20,000 a week. The key is not the size of the budget but the quality of the foundation, the targeting and the creative. A small budget with a clear offer and a complete Google listing can outperform a large budget with a weak foundation.

F.6 Ad creative and landing-page fit â€” the promise and the delivery

The idea. Ad creative is what people see â€” the image, video, text and call-to-action. **Landing-page fit** is whether what people find when they click matches what the ad promised. If the ad says "hot jollof delivered in 45 minutes" and the customer clicks and finds no order button, no menu and no way to reach you â€” the ad is wasted.

The creativeâ€–fit rule:

> *"The ad makes a promise. The landing page must deliver that promise â€” fast. If the ad says 'â‚¦1,500 jollof', the customer should see â‚¦1,500 jollof on the page they land on. If the ad says 'order on WhatsApp', the customer should see a WhatsApp button within 3 seconds of landing. If the promise and the delivery do not match, you lose the customer and waste the money you spent on the click."*

What makes good ad creative:

- **A clear hook** â€" the image or first line stops the scroll.
- **A specific offer** â€" one thing, one price, one benefit.
- **A clear CTA** â€" "Order on WhatsApp", "Call now", "Book today".
- **Brand consistency** â€" same colours, fonts and tone as your other channels.
- **Honesty** â€" the ad promises what the business delivers.

What makes a good landing page (or Google Business Profile, or WhatsApp chat):

- **Fast** â€" the customer can see what they need in 3 seconds.
- **Clear** â€" one obvious next step (order button, call button, WhatsApp).
- **Matching** â€" the offer in the ad is the offer on the page.
- **Trustworthy** â€" photos, reviews, consistent NAP.

Worked example â€" good and bad creativeâ€"fit:

Ad promise	What the customer finds	Fit?
"Hot jollof, â‚¦1,500, delivered in 45 min â€" order on WhatsApp"	Opens WhatsApp chat with menu, prices and "Reply YES to order"	Good â€" promise matches delivery
"Hot jollof, â‚¦1,500, delivered in 45 min â€" order on WhatsApp"	Opens a website with no prices, no WhatsApp button, no menu	Bad â€" promise broken
"Best food in Port Harcourt!"	Opens a Google listing with 3 stars and 2 reviews	Bad â€" vague promise, weak delivery
"4.3 stars on Google â€" order hot jollof on WhatsApp"	Opens a Google listing with 4.3 stars and 15 reviews	Good â€" specific promise, proof delivered

Say to the class:

> *"The most common ad mistake is a great ad that leads to a dead end. People click, find nothing useful, and leave. You spent money on the click and got nothing. Always ask: when someone clicks my ad, what do they find? Does it match what I promised? Is it easy to take the next step? If the answer is no, fix the landing page before you spend another naira on ads."*

Common misconception. "A clever ad with a mystery CTA performs better." No â€" clarity beats cleverness in ads. Tell people exactly what you offer and exactly what to do. "Order on WhatsApp" outperforms "Click here to find out more" every time.

F.7 Honest advertising in ads â€" the rules that protect you

The idea. Paid ads amplify everything â€" including dishonesty. A misleading organic post might reach 200 people. A misleading ad might reach 20,000. The platform's rules, the law and basic ethics all demand that ads be honest.

The five honest advertising rules for ads:

1. **No fake discounts.** "Was â‚¦3,000, now â‚¦1,500" is a lie if it was always â‚¦1,500. Real discounts only.
2. **No invented urgency.** "Only 2 plates left!" is a lie if there are 200. Real urgency only â€" and it must be true.
3. **No misleading claims.** "Lose 10kg in one week" for a food product is fraud. "Delivered in 45 minutes" must be true.
4. **No discriminatory targeting.** Do not exclude people based on ethnicity, religion or other protected characteristics. Target by relevance â€" location, interests, behaviours â€" never by prejudice.
5. **No buying engagement.** Do not buy likes, comments or clicks on your ads. The platform detects this and penalises it â€" and it distorts your data so you cannot tell what is working.

Transparent labels: If an ad is paid, it should be labelled as such (the platforms do this automatically with a "Sponsored" label). If content is gifted or paid for in kind, say so. Never pass an ad off as an independent recommendation.

Say to the class:

> *"Honest advertising is not just the right thing to do â€" it is the smart thing to do. A misleading ad might get a few extra clicks today. But when the customer arrives and finds the truth, they leave, they tell friends, they leave a bad review, and they never come back. An honest ad might get fewer clicks â€" but the clicks it gets are from people who actually want what you offer. Honest ads build businesses. Misleading ads build refund requests."*

Common misconception. "Everyone exaggerates in ads â€" it is expected." No â€" exaggeration that crosses into falsehood is fraud. "Our jollof is delicious" is opinion (fine). "Our jollof is the best in Nigeria" is a claim you cannot prove (risky). "Our jollof is delivered in 45 minutes" is a verifiable promise (fine â€" if true). Know the difference between opinion, claim and verifiable promise.

F.8 Summary of the lecture

- **Meta ads** interrupt (awareness, demand creation). **Google ads** answer (high-intent searches).
- Choose the **objective** that matches the funnel stage: awareness, traffic, leads or sales.
- **Target narrowly**: location, demographics, interests â€" match your avatar.
- **Ad structure**: campaign (objective) â†' ad set (audience) â†' ad (creative).
- **Budgets**: â‚¦10,000/week can bring real orders if the foundation is solid. Calculate CAC.
- **Creativeâ€"fit**: the ad's promise must match the landing page's delivery.
- **Honest advertising**: no fake discounts, no invented urgency, no misleading claims, no discriminatory targeting, no buying engagement.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Set budget â‚¦] --> B[Choose audience]
    B --> C[Create ad creative]
    C --> D[Launch campaign]
    D --> E[Monitor daily]
    E --> F{Good results?}
    F -->|Yes| G[Scale budget]
    F -->|No| H[Tweak and retry]
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- On the projector: Meta Ads Manager and Google Ads interfaces (no spend).
- The Campaign Structure Sheet and the Sample Budget Table.
- Three ad examples (one Meta, one Google, one poor).

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€" compare two ads live (4 minutes)

Say: "Let me show you a Meta ad and a Google ad side by side."

Show the Meta ad (Instagram reel of jollof, "Too tired to cook? We deliver ðŸ□²", sponsored label, "Order Now" button). Show the Google ad (text ad for "jollof rice delivery Port Harcourt", "Mama Nkechi's Kitchen â€" Hot Jollof Delivered in 45 Min. Order on WhatsApp. â‚¦1,500").

Ask: "Who is seeing each ad? When? What are they doing? What should the ad say?" Let the class answer. Then summarise:

- Meta: person is scrolling, not looking for food. Ad must stop the scroll and create interest.
- Google: person is searching, ready to buy. Ad must match the search and be the best answer.

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€" build a campaign structure live (5 minutes)

Say: "Now let me show you how to structure a campaign. I will use Mama Nkechi's Kitchen and a weekly budget of â‚¦10,000."

Fill the Campaign Structure Sheet on the projector:

Level	What	Example
Campaign	Objective: Sales	Budget: â‚¦10,000 / 7 days
Ad set 1	GRA, 25â€“45, food delivery	Budget: â‚¦5,000
Ad set 2	Trans-Amadi, 25â€“45, food delivery	Budget: â‚¦5,000
Ad 1 (Ad set 1)	Photo: jollof, "Too tired to cook?"	CTA: Order on WhatsApp
Ad 2 (Ad set 1)	Reel: jollof cooking, "Hot jollof in 45 min"	CTA: Order on WhatsApp

Say:

> *"Two ad sets â€" two locations â€" so I can learn which area converts better. Two ads in Ad set 1 â€" so I can learn which creative works. The budget is split evenly for the test. After three days, I will look at the results and shift budget to the winner. That is how you run ads: structure, test, learn, adjust."*

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€" calculate the budget maths live (4 minutes)

Say: "Now the most important part â€" the maths. Let me show you what â‚¦10,000 a week can buy and whether it is worth it."

Write on the projector:

> *Weekly budget: â‚¦10,000 Estimated reach: 5,000â€"10,000 people Estimated clicks: 150â€"400 people (at â‚¦25â€"â‚¦50 per click) Estimated orders: 3â€"20 orders (at 2â€"5% click-to-order conversion) Average order value: â‚¦1,500 Revenue from orders: â‚¦4,500â€"â‚¦30,000 Return on Ad Spend (ROAS): 0.45xâ€"3x*

Say:

> *"Look at the range. If the ad performs poorly, â‚¦10,000 brings â‚¦4,500 in revenue â€" a loss. If it performs well, it brings â‚¦30,000 â€" a 3x return. The difference between those outcomes is your targeting, your creative, your offer and your landing page. That is why the foundation matters. The ad is just the amplifier â€" the signal is everything else."*

G.5 Questions to ask during the demo

- "Why do we split the budget between two ad sets?" (To learn which area converts better â€" and to avoid putting all the money on one guess.)
- "Why is Google often better for a brand-new business?" (Because the person is already searching â€" high intent, faster conversion.)
- "What happens if the landing page does not match the ad?" (The customer clicks, finds a broken experience, and leaves â€" you wasted the money spent on the click.)
- "Why do we optimise for sales, not likes?" (Because likes do not pay bills. Sales do.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding, each learner completes a Campaign Structure Sheet for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen with a naira budget, an audience definition, ad creative concepts and a budget calculation.

Starting materials: The Campaign Structure Sheet, the Naira Budget Calculator, a pen.

Procedure (instructor calls out each step; learners follow; instructor walks the room):

1. Choose your business â€" Mama Nkechi's Kitchen or your own approved business. Write the name at the top.
2. Set your **campaign objective**. What is the main goal? (Awareness, traffic, leads or sales?) Write it down and say which funnel stage it matches.
3. Set your **weekly budget**. Choose one: â‚¦5,000, â‚¦10,000 or â‚¦20,000. Write it down.

4. Define your **target audience**. Write: location (specific areas), age range, interests (at least two). Make it narrow â€" not "everyone in Port Harcourt".
5. **Pause and predict:** Does your audience match your customer avatar? If your avatar is Chinedu (28, GRA), does your targeting include him? If not, fix it.
6. Plan your **ad structure**: one campaign, two ad sets (two different locations or two different audience segments), and one ad concept per ad set. Write the objective, audience and budget for each.
7. For each ad, write: the **creative** (what image or video?), the **hook** (first line), the **offer** (what are you selling?) and the **CTA** (what should they do?).
8. **Pause and predict:** Does your ad promise match what the customer finds when they click? If your ad says "order on WhatsApp", is your WhatsApp ordering ready? If not, note what needs fixing.
9. Calculate your **budget maths** on the Naira Budget Calculator: estimated reach, estimated clicks, estimated orders, estimated revenue, estimated ROAS.
10. **Pause and predict:** Is your estimated ROAS above 1x (revenue greater than spend)? If not, what could you change â€" the offer, the targeting, the creative?
11. Compare your plan with a partner. Give one piece of feedback: "The strongest part is _____. One thing to improve is _____."
12. Keep your worksheets â€" this becomes the capstone's paid media section.

Expected result (model answer â€" instructor key):

A completed Campaign Structure Sheet with objective, budget, audience, two ad sets, ad creative concepts, and a budget calculation showing estimated ROAS.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 5: "Is your audience specific enough? Could you narrow it further?"
- After step 8: "What happens when someone clicks your ad? Walk me through the experience."
- After step 10: "If your ROAS is below 1x, what is the first thing you would change?"

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Objective is "likes and followers" â†' "What is the business goal? Likes do not pay bills. What action do you want the customer to take?"
- Audience is "everyone in Port Harcourt" â†' "Narrow it. Where does your avatar live? What does he care about?"
- Budget is â‚¦500 â†' "Below the minimum viable budget. What can you realistically afford for a one-week test?"
- Ad creative has no hook â†' "What stops the scroll? Add a question, warning or bold claim."
- Landing page is not ready â†' "Fix the foundation before spending on ads. What does the customer find when they click?"
- ROAS is below 1x â†' "Look at your offer, your targeting and your creative. Which one is weakest?"

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Campaign objective stated and matched to a funnel stage
- ☐ Weekly budget set (â‚¦5,000, â‚¦10,000 or â‚¦20,000)
- ☐ Target audience defined (location, age, interests â€" narrow)
- ☐ Ad structure planned (campaign â†' two ad sets â†' ad concepts)
- ☐ Each ad has creative, hook, offer and CTA
- ☐ Landing-page fit checked â€" promise matches delivery
- ☐ Budget calculated â€" estimated reach, clicks, orders, revenue, ROAS
- ☐ Partner feedback received and one improvement made

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task: You are the ad consultant for *Adaeze's Bakes* (the fictional bakery from Session 4). She wants to run a small Meta ad campaign to get more birthday cake orders. She has â‚¦15,000 for a one-week test.

Requirements:

1. Write a **campaign structure**: objective, audience (location, age, interests), two ad sets with different audiences, and one ad concept per ad set.

2. Write the **ad copy** for each ad: hook, offer, CTA.
3. Calculate the **budget maths**: estimated reach, clicks, orders, revenue and ROAS.
4. Write one **honesty check** sentence: "This ad is honest becauseâ€¦"

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- Campaign structure is complete and matches the funnel.
- Ad copy has a clear hook, specific offer and clear CTA.
- Budget maths is calculated and ROAS is estimated.
- Honesty check shows understanding of honest advertising.

Hints if stuck:

- Hint 1: Adaeze's avatar is a mum aged 25â€“40 planning a child's birthday party. Target her â€” not everyone.
- Hint 2: The objective should be sales (cake orders) â€” not awareness or likes.
- Hint 3: For the honesty check, ask: "Is everything in this ad true and verifiable?"

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€” do not show learners):

Campaign structure:

- **Objective:** Sales (birthday cake orders)
- **Budget:** â‚¦15,000 for 7 days
- **Ad set 1:** Location: Port Harcourt (GRA, Trans-Amadi, Rumuokwuta); Age: 25â€“40; Interests: baking, children's parties, event planning. Budget: â‚¦7,500.
- **Ad set 2:** Location: Port Harcourt; Age: 25â€–45; Interests: celebrations, cakes, gifts. Budget: â‚¦7,500.

Ad copy:

- **Ad 1 (photo):** Hook: "Planning a birthday party? ðŸŽ," Offer: "Custom birthday cakes from â‚¦8,000 â€” designed, baked and delivered." CTA: "Order on WhatsApp â€” 0803-XXX-XXXX."
- **Ad 2 (video concept):** Hook: "The cake that makes the birthday kid smile ðŸ˜Š" Offer: "Tell us the theme â€” we create the cake. From â‚¦8,000." CTA: "DM 'CAKE' to order."

Budget maths:

- Estimated reach: 7,000â€“15,000 people
- Estimated clicks: 200â€–500 (at â‚¦30â€“â‚¦50 per click)
- Estimated orders: 4â€–25 (at 2â€–5% conversion)
- Average order value: â‚¦15,000
- Estimated revenue: â‚¦60,000â€–â‚¦375,000
- Estimated ROAS: 4xâ€–25x (high because cake orders are high-value)

Honesty check: "This ad is honest because the price (â‚¦8,000) is the real starting price, the photos will be of real cakes we have made, and we deliver on the date promised. No fake discounts or invented urgency."

Learner marking (out of 10):

- Campaign structure complete and matched to funnel (3)
- Ad copy has hook, offer, CTA (3)
- Budget maths calculated with ROAS estimate (2)
- Honesty check shows understanding (2)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Chinedu* runs a phone accessory shop in Port Harcourt â€” *Chinedu's Gadgets* â€” selling phone cases, chargers, earpieces and screen protectors. He has a Facebook page with 800 followers and posts occasionally. A competitor two streets away runs a small Meta ad campaign â€” a photo of a popular phone case with the text "Protect your phone in style â€” â‚¦2,500. Free delivery in PH." The ad runs every day, gets 50â€–100 likes and brings 5â€–10 customers a week. Chinedu wants to compete.

He has â‚¦20,000 to spend on ads this month. He comes to you and says: "I want to run the same kind of ad. How do I make sure I do not waste my money?"

Relevant facts.

- Chinedu's products are similar in quality and price to his competitor's.
- His Facebook page has 800 followers but low engagement â€" his posts get 3â€"5 likes.
- His Google Business Profile is incomplete â€" no photos, no description, no reviews.
- His WhatsApp ordering is informal â€" customers message him personally.
- His competitor's ad works because it targets phone users in Port Harcourt with a specific, affordable product and a clear CTA.
- Chinedu does not know how Meta ads work â€" he has never set up a campaign.

Decision point. Chinedu is ready to spend â‚¦20,000 on ads. What should he do first?

Possible approaches.

1. **Set up a Meta ad immediately â€" copy his competitor's ad and target "everyone in Port Harcourt who likes phones."** â€" This would waste money. The targeting is too broad, the foundation is broken (no Google listing, no reviews, informal WhatsApp), and copying a competitor's ad is not a strategy.
2. **Spend the â‚¦20,000 on a professional photographer to take better product photos for his Facebook page.** â€" Better photos help, but they do not fix the structural problems. The photos would improve his organic content but not his ad readiness.
3. **Fix the foundation first â€" complete the Google Business Profile, add photos and reviews, set up WhatsApp Business â€" then run a targeted Meta ad with a specific product and a clear CTA.** â€" This is the right answer.

Recommended solution. Approach 3. Chinedu should:

1. **Fix the foundation first (free, one week):**
   - Complete his Google Business Profile: name, category, address, phone, hours, 10+ photos of products, description with keywords, products with prices.
   - Ask 5 recent customers for honest Google reviews.
   - Set up WhatsApp Business: profile, catalogue with products and prices, labels.
2. **Then run a targeted Meta ad (â‚¦20,000 over 4 weeks):**
   - Objective: Sales (orders on WhatsApp).
   - Audience: Port Harcourt, aged 18â€"45, interests in mobile phones, phone accessories, technology.
   - Creative: A photo of his most popular phone case with the hook "Protect your phone in style ðŸ›¡ï¸" and the offer "â‚¦2,500 â€" free delivery in PH. Order on WhatsApp."
   - CTA: "Order on WhatsApp" â€" linking to his WhatsApp Business.
   - Two ad sets: one targeting phone users, one targeting people interested in fashion/accessories.
3. **Measure and adjust:** After one week, check the results. If one ad set is performing better, shift the budget. If the click-to-order rate is low, fix the WhatsApp ordering experience.

Say to the class:

> *"Chinedu's competitor's ad works not because it is clever â€" but because the competitor has a complete foundation: a Google listing customers trust, a WhatsApp ordering system that works, and a specific product at a clear price. If Chinedu runs the same ad without that foundation, he will spend â‚¦20,000 and get nothing. Fix the foundation first â€" then the ad amplifies what is already there."*

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 (copy the competitor): fast but wasteful â€" broken foundation, broad targeting, no learning.
- Approach 2 (better photos): improves organic content but does not fix the structural gaps.
- Approach 3 (foundation first, then targeted ads): one week of free work, then a campaign that actually converts.

Professional connection. This is the single most common paid ads situation: a business sees a competitor's ad working and wants to copy it. The answer is never "copy the ad" â€" it is "understand why it works and build the same foundation." The ad is

the visible tip of the iceberg. The foundation â€" Google listing, WhatsApp ordering, clear offer, honest reviews â€" is what makes it work. Build the iceberg first; the tip takes care of itself.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the live guide. Point learners to the row rather than giving the answer.

K.1 Choosing the wrong objective

Symptoms: Campaign optimises for likes but gets no orders. **Likely cause:** Chose "engagement" instead of "sales" or "leads". **How to investigate:** Ask: "What is your business goal? What did you tell the platform to optimise for?" **Corrective steps:** Match the objective to the funnel stage. If the goal is orders, choose "sales". If the goal is WhatsApp messages, choose "leads". **How to confirm resolved:** Objective matches the stated business goal. **Prevention:** The objective-funnel matching table in Section F.2 â€" use it for every campaign.

K.2 Targeting "everyone"

Symptoms: Ad is shown to thousands of people who never click or buy. **Likely cause:** Targeting is too broad â€" "everyone in Port Harcourt" or "all ages". **How to investigate:** Check the audience definition. Is it narrower than the total population? **Corrective steps:** Narrow by location (specific areas), age (match the avatar) and interests (match the avatar's behaviours). **How to confirm resolved:** The audience definition matches the customer avatar. **Prevention:** The targeting exercise in Section H â€" does your audience match your avatar?

K.3 No ad structure (everything in one ad)

Symptoms: One ad with one image and one audience â€" no testing, no learning. **Likely cause:** The learner does not understand the campaignâ€"ad setâ€"ad structure. **How to investigate:** Ask: "How many audiences are you testing? How many ad creatives?" **Corrective steps:** Build the structure: one campaign, two ad sets (different audiences), one ad concept per ad set. Test and learn. **How to confirm resolved:** The campaign has at least two ad sets and two ad concepts. **Prevention:** The ad structure explanation in Section F.4 and the practical exercise.

K.4 Ad promise does not match landing page

Symptoms: People click the ad but do not order or message. **Likely cause:** The landing page (Google listing, website, WhatsApp) does not deliver what the ad promised. **How to investigate:** Click your own ad. What does the customer find? Does it match the promise? **Corrective steps:** Fix the landing page before increasing the budget. Make sure the offer, the CTA and the experience match. **How to confirm resolved:** A test click delivers exactly what the ad promised. **Prevention:** The creativeâ€"fit rule in Section F.6 â€" check it before every campaign.

K.5 Spending too much too soon

Symptoms: â‚¦50,000 spent in the first week with no clear results. **Likely cause:** Started with a large budget before testing with a small one. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What was your first budget? Did you test with a smaller amount first?" **Corrective steps:** Start with â‚¦5,000â€"â‚¦10,000 for a one-week test. Only scale what works. Turn off what does not. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner has a small-test-first approach. **Prevention:** The budget rules in Section F.5 â€" start small, test, then scale.

K.6 Misleading ad claims

Symptoms: "Best phone repair in Nigeria!" or "Lose 10kg in one week with our tea!" **Likely cause:** Exaggeration to get clicks. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Can you prove that claim? Is it true?" **Corrective steps:** Replace every unprovable claim with a specific, verifiable one. "Best" â†' "4.3 stars on Google". "Lose 10kg" â†' remove. **How to confirm resolved:** Every claim in the ad is verifiable. **Prevention:** The honest advertising rules in Section F.7.

K.7 Buying engagement on ads

Symptoms: "Let me buy 500 likes on my ad so it looks popular." **Likely cause:** Thinking bought engagement helps the campaign. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Where will you buy these likes? Are they from real people?" **Corrective steps:** Never buy engagement. It distorts your data, wastes money and violates platform rules. **How to confirm resolved:** Learner can explain why bought engagement is harmful. **Prevention:** The ethics rule â€" no buying engagement, ever.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it (e.g., the learner can show you the exact objective chosen, or the exact landing page that does not match). Teach learners to confirm before concluding.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "Campaign Structure Sheet â€" My Business on a Naira Budget"

Purpose: To practise building a complete ad campaign structure with a realistic naira budget â€" the skill that feeds the capstone's paid media section.

Realistic scenario. You are the ad consultant for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen (or your own approved business). She has â‚¦15,000 to spend on a one-week Meta ad test to get more WhatsApp orders. Your job is to plan the campaign structure, the audience, the creative and the budget maths.

Detailed instructions:

1. Set the **campaign objective** and say which funnel stage it matches.
2. Set the **weekly budget**: â‚¦15,000.
3. Define the **target audience**: location, age, interests â€" narrow and specific. Explain how it matches the customer avatar.
4. Plan the **ad structure**: one campaign, two ad sets (different locations or audience segments), and one ad concept per ad set.
5. For each ad, write: the **creative** (what image or video?), the **hook** (first line), the **offer** (what are you selling?) and the **CTA** (what should they do?).
6. Calculate the **budget maths**: estimated reach, clicks, orders, revenue and ROAS.
7. Write a **landing-page check**: "When someone clicks my ad, they find _____."
8. Write one **honesty check** sentence: "This ad is honest becauseâ€¦"
9. Write one final sentence: "The most important thing I learned about paid ads isâ€¦"

Required deliverables:

- Campaign structure (objective, audience, ad sets, ad concepts).
- Ad copy for each ad (hook, offer, CTA).
- Budget maths with ROAS estimate.
- Landing-page check and honesty check.
- Final reflection sentence.

Submission format: Handwritten or typed, submitted at the start of Session 8. Keep a copy in your working folder.

Deadline: Before Session 8.

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Campaign objective & funnel match	3	Clear objective matched to the correct funnel stage
Audience definition	3	Narrow, specific, matches the avatar
Ad structure	4	Two ad sets, one ad concept each, with creative details
Ad copy (hook, offer, CTA)	4	Specific hook, clear offer, one CTA per ad
Budget maths & ROAS	3	Calculated with realistic estimates
Landing-page check & honesty	2	Promise matches delivery; honesty demonstrated
Reflection sentence	1	Gives a real insight

Common mistakes to avoid: objective is "likes"; audience is "everyone"; no ad structure (everything in one ad); ad promise does not match the landing page; budget maths left blank; dishonest claims.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners â€" model for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen):

Campaign structure:

- **Objective:** Sales (WhatsApp orders) â€" matches the Conversion funnel stage.
- **Budget:** â‚¦15,000 for 7 days.
- **Ad set 1:** Location: GRA and Trans-Amadi; Age: 25â€"45; Interests: food delivery, Nigerian food, convenience. Budget: â‚¦7,500.
- **Ad set 2:** Location: Port Harcourt; Age: 25â€"45; Interests: cooking, home meals, family. Budget: â‚¦7,500.

Ad copy:

- **Ad 1 (photo):** Hook: "Too tired to cook? ðŸ²" Offer: "Hot jollof and small chops, delivered to your door in 45 minutes. â‚¦1,500 a plate." CTA: "Order on WhatsApp â€" 0803-XXX-XXXX."
- **Ad 2 (reel):** Hook: "Hot jollof, at your door, fast ðŸ"¥" Offer: "Order before 6pm and get a free drink. â‚¦1,500." CTA: "DM 'JOLLOF' to order."

Budget maths:

- Estimated reach: 7,000â€"15,000 people
- Estimated clicks: 200â€"500
- Estimated orders: 4â€"25
- Average order value: â‚¦1,500
- Estimated revenue: â‚¦6,000â€"â‚¦37,500
- Estimated ROAS: 0.4xâ€"2.5x

Landing-page check: "When someone clicks my ad, they open a WhatsApp chat with Mama Nkechi's Kitchen â€" business profile, catalogue with prices, and 'Reply YES to order'. The promise (â‚¦1,500 jollof, WhatsApp ordering) matches the delivery."

Honesty check: "This ad is honest because the price (â‚¦1,500) is the real price, the delivery promise (45 minutes) is what we actually deliver, and the photos will be of real food we have made."

Reflection sentence: "The most important thing I learned about paid ads is that they amplify what is already there â€" if the foundation is broken, ads just make you lose money faster."

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. What is the main difference between Meta ads and Google ads?

Q2. Multiple choice. Which campaign objective should you choose if your goal is to get WhatsApp orders? a) Awareness b) Engagement c) Sales d) Reach

Q3. Explain. What are the three levels of ad structure, and what belongs at each level?

Q4. Practical. A food kitchen has a Facebook ad that says "Order hot jollof on WhatsApp â€" â‚¦1,500" but when customers click, they find a personal WhatsApp with no catalogue, no prices and no clear way to order. What is the problem, and what should they fix?

Q5. Budget maths. A business spends â‚¦10,000 on ads and gets 4 customers. Each customer spends â‚¦2,000. What is the Customer Acquisition Cost (CAC) and the Return on Ad Spend (ROAS)? Is this good or bad?

Q6. Ethics. Your friend wants to write "Best jollof in all of Nigeria â€" guaranteed!" in his ad. What do you tell him, and why?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q6)

A1. Meta ads interrupt â€" they appear in people's feeds when they are browsing, not searching. They create demand and build awareness. Google ads answer â€" they appear when someone is actively searching. They capture existing demand. Meta is best for awareness and demand creation; Google is best for high-intent local searches.

A2. (c) Sales. The objective must match the goal. If the goal is WhatsApp orders, the objective is sales (or leads). Awareness, engagement and reach do not optimise for orders.

A3. Campaign (top level) â€" the objective and total budget. Ad set (middle level) â€" the audience and budget. Ad (bottom level) â€" the creative: image, video, text and CTA.

A4. The problem is a creativeâ€"fit failure. The ad promises a specific experience (WhatsApp ordering at â‚¦1,500) but the landing experience (personal WhatsApp, no catalogue, no prices) does not deliver it. They should fix the WhatsApp ordering experience: set up WhatsApp Business with a catalogue, clear prices and an easy "Reply YES to order" process â€" before spending more on ads.

A5. CAC = â‚¦10,000 Ã· 4 = â‚¦2,500 per customer. Revenue = 4 Ã— â‚¦2,000 = â‚¦8,000. ROAS = â‚¦8,000 Ã· â‚¦10,000 = 0.8x. This is bad â€" they spent â‚¦10,000 to get â‚¦8,000 in revenue. They are losing money. They need to either reduce the cost per customer, increase the conversion rate, increase the average order value, or improve repeat purchases.

A6. I would tell him not to write that. "Best in all of Nigeria" is a claim he cannot prove â€" it is not verifiable, and it could mislead customers. Instead, he should write something specific and verifiable: "4.3 stars on Google â€" hot jollof delivered to your door in 45 minutes." That is honest, credible and more trustworthy than an unprovable superlative. (Accept any answer that identifies the claim as unprovable and suggests a verifiable alternative.)

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned the channel that accelerates everything: paid ads. You learned that **Meta ads interrupt** (they appear in feeds, create demand) while **Google ads answer** (they appear in searches, capture demand). You learned to choose a **campaign objective** that matches the funnel stage â€" awareness, traffic, leads or sales. You learned to **target narrowly**: location, age, interests â€" matching your avatar, not "everyone." You learned the **three-level ad structure**: campaign (objective), ad set (audience), ad (creative). You learned **naira budget maths**: what â‚¦5,000, â‚¦10,000 or â‚¦20,000 a week can realistically buy, and how to calculate Customer Acquisition Cost and Return on Ad Spend. You learned the **creativeâ€"fit rule**: the ad's promise must match the landing page's delivery. And you learned **honest advertising**: no fake discounts, no invented urgency, no misleading claims, no discriminatory targeting, no buying engagement.

Five important takeaways:

1. Meta ads create demand; Google ads capture demand. Choose based on your goal.
2. Match the objective to the funnel â€" optimise for customers, not likes.
3. Target narrowly â€" your avatar is your audience blueprint.
4. Ads amplify the foundation â€" fix the Google listing and WhatsApp ordering first.
5. Honest advertising is not optional â€" it is the only sustainable way.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I explain the difference between Meta and Google ads?
- Can I choose a campaign objective that matches a stated goal?
- Can I define a narrow target audience that matches my avatar?
- Can I build a campaign structure with ad sets and ad creative?
- Can I calculate CAC and ROAS and say whether a campaign is working?
- Can I check whether an ad's promise matches its landing page?

Connection to the next session. You now know how to spend money on ads â€" but how do you know if it worked? Next session we learn the measurement layer: **KPIs, Google Analytics, UTM links, A/B testing and reporting**. Because the businesses that win at marketing are not the ones that spend the most â€" they are the ones that measure the most. You will learn to turn activity into evidence: to read a report, see what is working, and know exactly what to change. That is Session 8: Analytics, Tracking and Optimisation â€" the session that makes every other session pay for itself.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner explains Meta vs Google ads correctly with the interruption vs answer distinction.
- Learner chooses an objective that matches the stated goal and funnel stage.
- Learner's audience definition is narrow and matches the avatar.
- Learner's campaign has a proper structure: campaign, two ad sets, ad creative.
- Learner's budget maths is calculated and ROAS is estimated.

- Learner checks creativeâ€"fit and applies honest advertising rules.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "More likes = better ads." â†' No â€" optimise for the action that matches the goal (orders, messages, calls).
- "I should target everyone." â†' No â€" narrow targeting is cheaper and more effective.
- "I need a big budget for ads to work." â†' No â€" a small budget with a solid foundation can work.
- "The ad is everything." â†' No â€" the ad is the amplifier; the foundation is the signal.
- "Copying a competitor's ad is a strategy." â†' No â€" understand why it works and build your own foundation.
- "Exaggerated claims get more clicks." â†' No â€" misleading claims are fraud and destroy trust.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Objective matching drill:** Give five business goals and ask the learner to choose the correct objective for each.
2. **Targeting narrowing drill:** Give a broad audience ("everyone in Nigeria") and ask the learner to narrow it to match a specific avatar.
3. **Budget maths drill:** Give three budget scenarios (â‚¦5,000, â‚¦10,000, â‚¦20,000) and ask the learner to calculate estimated orders and ROAS for each.
4. **Creativeâ€"fit drill:** Give three adâ€"landing page pairs (one good fit, two bad fits) and ask the learner to identify which is which and explain why.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** Provide the campaign structure with the objective and audience already filled in â€" the learner plans the ad creative and calculates the budget maths.
- **Level 2 (standard):** The session as written â€" full campaign structure, audience, creative, budget maths and honesty check.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** Ask the learner to plan a **two-week campaign** with a budget of â‚¦30,000, including a week-one test plan and a week-one adjustment plan based on hypothetical results (e.g., "Ad set 1 got 10 clicks and 2 orders; Ad set 2 got 50 clicks and 1 order â€" what do you do in week two?"). This requires applying the test-learn-adjust cycle.

Timing guidance. The priority is the guided practical (Section H) â€" learners building a campaign structure with budget maths. If the room is slow, shorten the lecture (combine F.4 and F.5) and reduce the case study (Section J) to a 5-minute discussion. If learners struggle with the budget maths, walk through one calculation on the board step by step. Protect the practical time â€" a learner who leaves without a campaign structure has no paid media plan for the capstone.

Capstone link. The campaign structure sheet built today becomes the capstone's paid media section. The budget maths becomes the capstone's budget table. The audience definition becomes the capstone's targeting plan. The honesty check becomes part of the capstone's ethics statement. Keep all worksheets safe â€" the capstone assembles them in Session 9.

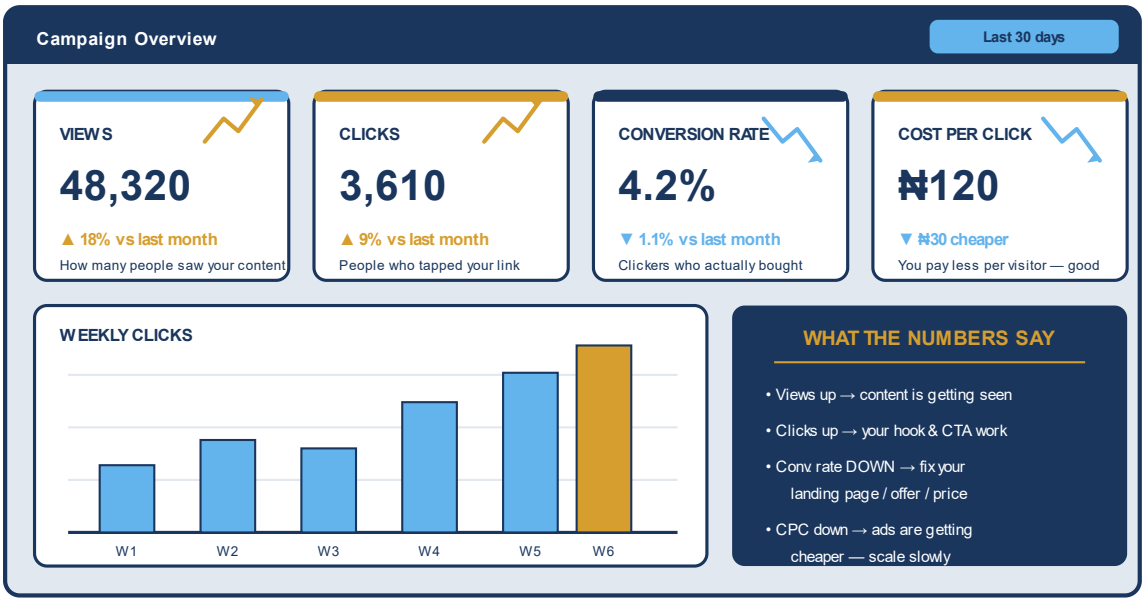
END OF SESSION 7

Next: Session 8 â€" Analytics, Tracking and Optimisation.

SESSION 08 OF 9

Analytics Tracking and Optimisation

CONCEPT DIAGRAM — SESSION 08



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" DIGITAL MARKETING

SESSION 8 â€" ANALYTICS, TRACKING AND OPTIMISATION

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	8 of 9
Session title	Analytics, Tracking and Optimisation
Week / Module	Week 3 â€" Module 3: Convert and Measure
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (concepts and reading, not heavy software)
Prerequisite knowledge	Sessions 1â€"7. Learners should be able to build an avatar, write a value proposition, plan content, set up a Google Business Profile, draft permission-based messages, and structure a

Item	Detail
	paid ad campaign. No prior analytics experience required.
Connection to previous work	In Session 7 we learned how to spend money on ads â€" objectives, targeting, budgets and creative. But spending without measuring is like driving with your eyes closed. Today we learn the measurement layer: how to choose the right numbers to watch, read a basic Google Analytics report, build UTM links so every click traces to its source, run a simple A/B test, and write a one-page report that says what happened and what to change. This is the session that makes every other session pay for itself.
Preparation before class	Academy computers or phones with internet ready. Prepare projector slides showing a sample Google Analytics dashboard (sessions, users, traffic sources, top pages). Print the KPI Matching Worksheet (Section H) per learner. Prepare a sample UTM link builder demonstration. Have a sample one-page report ready for the demo. Prepare a fictional analytics dataset for the independent exercise. Print the A/B Test Planner worksheet. **Print the SIMULATION brief â€" "Integrated Campaign Sprint" (Part 5, Template J) â€" instructor-held: do not hand it out until minute 66.**

Instructor note on tone: Many learners find analytics intimidating â€" they think it is for "data people." Your job is to replace fear with clarity. Analytics is not about being a mathematician; it is about being a detective. You are looking for clues: where did people come from, what did they do, and what should we change? Every small business owner can learn to read a basic report and make one good decision from it. That is the skill we build today.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Define KPIs** and explain the difference between vanity metrics and actionable metrics, choosing KPIs that match a stated business goal.
2. **Read a basic Google Analytics report** â€" identifying sessions, users, traffic sources, top pages and events â€" and explain what each metric tells them.
3. **Build correctly tagged UTM links** using a free UTM builder, with a consistent naming convention, so every click traces to its exact source.
4. **Plan a simple A/B test** â€" changing one variable only, defining a success metric, and deciding when to keep the winner.
5. **Write a one-page report** that says what happened, what it means, and what to change next.
6. **Apply honest measurement practice** â€" no cherry-picking data, no claiming causation from correlation, no ignoring results that contradict what they hoped was true.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner (with a notes app) or an academy computer with internet.
- Instructor computer connected to a projector.
- Whiteboard or flip chart.

Software

- Google Analytics (GA4) â€" free, accessible with a Gmail account. The instructor shows a sample dashboard; learners do not need their own GA4 property for this session.
- A free UTM builder (e.g., Google's Campaign URL Builder or any free online UTM generator).
- Phone Notes or Google Docs for planning.
- A spreadsheet app (Google Sheets or Excel) for the A/B test planner.

Sample files

- **Sample GA4 Dashboard Screenshot** â€" projector-ready, showing sessions, users, traffic sources, top pages and events for a fictional business.
- **Sample UTM Links** â€" three correctly tagged links and two incorrectly tagged ones for the demo.
- **Sample One-Page Report** â€" a finished report for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen showing the structure learners will follow.
- **Fictional Analytics Dataset** â€" a small table of numbers for the independent exercise (Section I).

Worksheets

- Worksheet 8.1 â€" "KPI Matching Table" (goal â†' KPI â†' why it matters).
- Worksheet 8.2 â€" "UTM Link Builder" (source, medium, campaign, term, content).
- Worksheet 8.3 â€" "A/B Test Planner" (variable, hypothesis, success metric, duration, decision rule).

Accounts

- Gmail (from Session 3) for Google Analytics access. No paid tools required.

Internet

- Required for the GA4 demo and UTM builder demonstration.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- A phone with a browser works for viewing the GA4 dashboard and building UTM links. The core skill is the *thinking* â€" choosing the right metrics, building the links, planning the test â€" which can be done on paper.

Safety and ethics note:

- We use only fictional or sample data in this session. Real customer data, phone numbers and emails are never used in class exercises.
- We practice honest measurement: no cherry-picking, no claiming causation from correlation, no ignoring uncomfortable results.
- The "no paid subscription" rule applies: Google Analytics and free UTM builders are free; no paid analytics tool is needed.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show two screenshots side by side.

Screenshot 1 â€" "The Vanity Dashboard": A social media analytics page showing: 10,000 followers, 50,000 likes, 500 comments, 2,000 shares. Big numbers. Impressive.

Screenshot 2 â€" "The Business Dashboard": A simple table showing: 200 website visitors, 45 WhatsApp messages, 12 orders placed, â‚¦18,000 revenue, â‚¦3,000 ad spend. Smaller numbers. Less impressive.

What the instructor says:

> *"Two businesses. Both looking at their numbers. The first one is celebrating â€" 10,000 followers, 50,000 likes. The second one is planning â€" 200 visitors, 45 messages, 12 orders, â‚¦18,000 in revenue. Which business is actually doing better? The first one has big numbers, but I do not know if they made a single naira. The second one has smaller numbers, but I know exactly what is happening: people are visiting, people are messaging, people are buying, and they are making more than they spent. Big numbers feel good. But small numbers that tell the truth are worth more. Today you learn to be the second business â€" the one that measures what matters."*

Why this opener works: It creates an immediate emotional contrast between vanity and substance. It sets up the central question: what should you actually measure? And it reassures learners that analytics is not about big numbers â€" it is about the right numbers.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "In Session 1, we learned the four funnel stages. What are they, in order?"

- Expected answer: Awareness, Consideration, Conversion, Retention.
- Common gap: learners mix up the order. Have them say it as a story.

Question 2: "In Session 7, we learned about campaign objectives. If your goal is to get WhatsApp orders, what objective do you choose?"

- Expected answer: Sales (or leads).
- Common gap: learners choose "engagement" or "awareness." Remind them: the objective must match the goal.

Question 3: "In Session 6, we learned about permission-based messaging. What is the rule for email and WhatsApp lists?"

- Expected answer: Only message people who said yes. No bought lists, no scraped numbers, no group-blasting.
- Common gap: learners think a large list is always better. Clarify: a small, permission-based list that converts beats a large, spammy list that gets you blocked.

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"We have built the foundation, learned the channels, and structured the paid ads. Now we answer the most important question in marketing: did it work? Not 'do I think it worked' â€" but 'can I prove it worked?' That is what measurement gives you. Not guesses. Not feelings. Evidence. Today you learn to collect that evidence, read it, and act on it."*

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 KPIs â€" measuring what matters, not what feels good

The idea. A **KPI** (Key Performance Indicator) is a number that tells you whether you are moving toward your goal. Not every number is a KPI. A KPI is a number you can act on â€" a number that helps you decide what to do next.

Vanity metrics vs. actionable metrics. This is the most important distinction in measurement.

- **Vanity metrics** feel good but do not help you make decisions. Examples: followers, likes, impressions, total page views. They go up, but you cannot tell what to do differently because of them.
- **Actionable metrics** tell you something you can act on. Examples: click-through rate, conversion rate, cost per lead, revenue per customer, bounce rate. They tell you what is working and what is not.

Say to the class:

> *"If your follower count goes from 1,000 to 2,000, what do you do differently? Nothing â€" you do not know why it grew or what to repeat. But if your click-through rate goes from 1% to 3%, you know something in your ad or post is working â€" and you can do more of it. Vanity metrics make you feel good. Actionable metrics make you make better decisions."*

Matching KPIs to goals â€" the golden rule:

Goal	KPI to watch	Why
Awareness (people know you exist)	Reach, impressions	You want to know how many people saw you
Traffic (people visit your site/profile)	Sessions, users, click-through rate	You want to know if people are clicking
Leads (people contact you)	Messages, form submissions, calls	You want to know if people are raising their hand
Sales (people buy)	Orders, revenue, conversion rate	You want to know if people are paying
Retention (people come back)	Repeat purchases, returning visitors	You want to know if people are loyal

The KPI-goal matching rule: Choose one primary KPI per goal. Do not try to watch everything â€" you will watch nothing. If your goal is orders, your primary KPI is orders (or conversion rate). If your goal is awareness, your primary KPI is reach. Everything else is secondary.

Worked example â€" Mama Nkechi's Kitchen:

- Goal: Get more WhatsApp orders.
- Primary KPI: Number of WhatsApp messages received (leads) and number of orders placed (conversion).
- Secondary KPI: Click-through rate on ads (are people clicking?), cost per message (how much does each enquiry cost?).
- Vanity metric to ignore: Follower count on Instagram.

Common misconception. "I should track everything so I do not miss anything." No â€" tracking everything means you pay attention to nothing. Choose one primary KPI per goal, watch it weekly, and act on it. You can always add more later.

F.2 Google Analytics basics â€" reading the story your website tells

The idea. Google Analytics (GA4) is a free tool that tracks what happens on your website. It tells you how many people visited, where they came from, what they did, and whether they took action. You do not need to be a data scientist to read it â€" you need to know five things.

The five things every beginner must know:

1. Sessions. A session is one visit to your website. If I visit your site, look at three pages, and leave, that is one session. If I come back tomorrow, that is another session. Sessions tell you how much traffic you are getting.

2. Users. A user is a unique person. If I visit your site five times, that is five sessions but one user. Users tell you how many real people are coming.

3. Traffic sources. This tells you where your visitors came from. The main sources are:

- **Organic search** â€" people who found you on Google.
- **Direct** â€" people who typed your URL or clicked a saved link.
- **Social** â€" people who clicked a link on Instagram, Facebook, etc.
- **Referral** â€" people who clicked a link on another website.
- **Paid** â€" people who clicked an ad.

4. Top pages. This tells you which pages on your site people actually visit. If your menu page gets 500 views but your order page gets 10, you have a problem â€" people are not finding the order page.

5. Events. An event is any action someone takes on your site: clicking a button, playing a video, submitting a form, clicking a WhatsApp link. Events tell you what people are *doing*, not just where they went.

Say to the class:

> *"Google Analytics is like a shopkeeper who stands at the door and counts everyone who walks in, notes where they came from, watches which aisles they browse, and writes down what they buy. You do not need to know everything it tracks. You need to know: how many people came, where they came from, what they looked at, and whether they took action. That is the story. Everything else is detail."*

Worked example â€" reading a GA4 dashboard for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen:

Metric	Number	What it means
Sessions (this week)	320	320 visits to the website
Users	210	210 unique people
Top traffic source	Social (45%)	Most visitors came from Instagram
Top page	Menu page (180 views)	People are looking at the menu
WhatsApp button clicks	45	45 people clicked the WhatsApp order button
Conversion rate	14%	45 out of 320 visitors clicked to order

What the story tells us: People are finding the website from Instagram (good â€" the content is working). They are looking at the menu (good â€" they are interested). And 14% of them are clicking to order on WhatsApp (good â€" the ordering process is

working). But 86% are leaving without ordering. That is the opportunity â€" why are 86% leaving? Is the menu unclear? Is the price too high? Is the WhatsApp button hard to find? The data tells you where to look.

Common misconception. "I need to understand every feature of Google Analytics." No â€" you need to understand five things: sessions, users, traffic sources, top pages and events. Master those, and you can read any basic report. The rest is detail you learn over time.

F.3 UTM links â€" knowing exactly where every click comes from

The idea. A **UTM link** is a normal link with a few extra words added to the end that tell Google Analytics exactly where the click came from. Without UTM links, all your social media clicks show up as "Social" â€" you cannot tell which post, which platform or which campaign brought the person. With UTM links, you know exactly.

The five UTM parameters:

Parameter	What it tells you	Example
`utm_source`	Where the click came from (platform)	`instagram`, `facebook`, `whatsapp`, `email`
`utm_medium`	What type of channel	`social`, `email`, `paid`, `organic`
`utm_campaign`	Which campaign or post	`week1-launch`, `jollof-promo`, `birthday-cakes`
`utm_content`	Which specific ad or creative (optional)	`photo-jollof`, `reel-cooking`
`utm_term`	Which keyword (optional, for paid search)	`jollof+delivery`

How to build a UTM link:

1. Start with your normal URL: `https://mamankitchen.com/order`
2. Add a question mark: `https://mamankitchen.com/order?`
3. Add the first parameter: `https://mamankitchen.com/order?utm_source=instagram`
4. Add an ampersand and the next parameter: `https://mamankitchen.com/order?utm_source=instagram&utm_medium=social`
5. Continue until all parameters are added: `https://mamankitchen.com/order?utm_source=instagram&utm_medium=social&utm_campaign=week1-launch&utm_content=photo-jollof`

The naming convention rule: Be consistent. Decide on your format and stick to it. Use lowercase, use hyphens (not spaces), and use the same names every time. If you use `instagram` one week and `Instagram` the next, Google Analytics will treat them as two different sources. Consistency is everything.

Worked example â€" Mama Nkechi's Kitchen UTM links:

Link	UTM tagged version
Instagram post (jollof photo)	`mamankitchen.com/order?utm_source=instagram&utm_medium=social&utm_campaign=week1-launch&utm_content=photo-jollof`
WhatsApp broadcast	`mamankitchen.com/order?utm_source=whatsapp&utm_medium=social&utm_campaign=week1-launch`
Facebook ad	`mamankitchen.com/order?utm_source=facebook&utm_medium=paid&utm_campaign=jollof-promo&utm_content=reel-cooking`
Email newsletter	`mamankitchen.com/order?utm_source=email&utm_medium=email&utm_campaign=weekly-menu`

Say to the class:

> *"Without UTM links, you are guessing. You know people came from social media, but you do not know which post, which platform or which campaign. With UTM links, you know exactly. You know that the Instagram photo brought 20 clicks, the WhatsApp broadcast brought 15, and the Facebook ad brought 5. Now you know where to spend your time and money. UTM links turn guessing into knowing."*

Common misconception. "UTM links are only for big businesses with websites." No â€" if you have a Google Business Profile, a landing page, or even a link-in-bio page, you can use UTM links. Anywhere you can put a link, you can tag it. And the free UTM builder does the work for you â€" you just fill in the blanks.

F.4 A/B testing â€" changing one thing, learning one thing

The idea. An **A/B test** is when you show two versions of something to see which performs better. Version A is the original (the "control"). Version B is the change (the "variant"). You split your audience, show each group one version, and measure which one wins.

The golden rule of A/B testing: change ONE variable only.

If you change the image AND the headline AND the CTA all at once, and version B wins, you do not know which change caused the win. Was it the image? The headline? The CTA? You cannot tell. But if you change only the image, and version B wins, you know the image was the reason. One variable. One lesson.

What you can A/B test:

- Ad creative (image A vs. image B)
- Ad copy (headline A vs. headline B)
- CTA (button text A vs. button text B)
- Landing page (layout A vs. layout B)
- Email subject line (subject A vs. subject B)
- WhatsApp broadcast message (message A vs. message B)

How to plan an A/B test:

1. **Choose one variable to test.** (e.g., the image in your Instagram ad)
2. **Create two versions.** Version A (control) and Version B (variant) â€" identical except for the one variable.
3. **Define your success metric.** (e.g., click-through rate, or number of orders)
4. **Decide how long to run the test.** (e.g., 3 days, or until you have at least 100 clicks per version)
5. **Decide your decision rule.** (e.g., "If version B gets a higher click-through rate after 100 clicks, I keep B. If not, I keep A.")
6. **Run the test, measure, and keep the winner.**

Worked example â€" Mama Nkechi's Kitchen A/B test:

Element	Version A (control)	Version B (variant)
Image	Photo of jollof rice	Reel of jollof being cooked
Headline	"Too tired to cook?"	"Hot jollof in 45 minutes"
CTA	"Order on WhatsApp"	"Order on WhatsApp"
Everything else	Same	Same

- **Variable being tested:** The image (photo vs. reel).
- **Success metric:** Click-through rate.
- **Duration:** 3 days or 100 clicks per version.
- **Decision rule:** Whichever version has a higher click-through rate after 100 clicks wins.
- **Result:** Version B (reel) got 4.2% CTR; Version A (photo) got 2.8% CTR. **Winner: Version B.** Keep the reel. Next test: try a different headline.

Say to the class:

> *"A/B testing is how you stop guessing and start knowing. You have two ideas for an ad image. Instead of arguing about which is better, you test it. You show each to a group of people, you measure the results, and you keep the winner. It is not about being clever â€" it is about being curious. The businesses that win at marketing are not the ones with the best ideas. They are the ones that test the most ideas."*

Common misconception. "I need a huge audience to run an A/B test." No â€" you need enough data to see a pattern. For a small business, 50â€"100 clicks per version is enough to see a clear winner. You do not need thousands. You need enough to be confident, and you need to change one variable at a time.

F.5 Reporting â€" saying what happened and what to change

The idea. A **report** is a short document that tells someone what happened, what it means, and what to do next. It is not a data dump â€" it is a story with a point. A good report answers three questions: What happened? So what? Now what?

The one-page report structure:

Section	What it says	Example
1. What happened	The key numbers, stated plainly	"This week we got 320 website visitors, 45 WhatsApp messages and 12 orders."
2. So what	What the numbers mean	"Traffic is up 20% from last week. The Instagram content is working. But 86% of visitors did not order â€" the ordering process may be confusing."
3. Now what	What you will change	"Next week we will: (1) add a clearer 'Order on WhatsApp' button to the menu page, (2) test a new ad image, and (3) send a WhatsApp broadcast to past customers."

The "so what" rule: Every number in your report must be followed by a "so what." Not "we got 320 visitors" â€" but "we got 320 visitors, which is up 20% from last week, which means our Instagram content is working." The number alone is noise. The number plus the meaning is signal.

Who is the report for?

- **For yourself:** to decide what to do next.
- **For the business owner:** to show them what their money is doing.
- **For a client:** to prove your work is working.

Say to the class:

> *"A report is not a homework assignment. It is a tool. It tells you what is working, what is not, and what to change. If you cannot write a one-page report about your marketing, you do not understand your marketing. The report forces you to think: what happened, what does it mean, and what do I do now? That thinking is the skill."*

Common misconception. "A report should include every number I can find." No â€" a report should include the numbers that matter for the goal. If the goal is orders, the report includes orders, conversion rate and cost per order. It does not include follower count, impressions or bounce rate unless they help explain the story. Less is more. One page. Three sections. Clear language.

F.6 Honest measurement â€" the rules that protect your data

The idea. Measurement is only useful if it is honest. If you cherry-pick data, ignore uncomfortable results or claim causation from correlation, you are not measuring â€" you are lying to yourself.

The four honest measurement rules:

1. **No cherry-picking.** Do not share only the numbers that make you look good. If your ad got 100 clicks but zero orders, that is the result. Report it.
2. **No claiming causation from correlation.** If sales went up the same week you posted more, it does not mean the posts caused the sales. Maybe it was payday. Maybe a competitor closed. Maybe the weather was bad and people ordered in. Correlation is not causation. Be careful with your claims.
3. **No ignoring uncomfortable results.** If your favourite ad is losing money, turn it off. If your best-performing post is a mistake you made, learn from it. The data does not care about your feelings.
4. **No measuring what you cannot act on.** If a number does not help you make a decision, do not track it. Track what you can change.

Say to the class:

> *"Honest measurement is not just about ethics â€" it is about effectiveness. If you lie to yourself with your data, you make bad decisions. You keep the ad that is losing money because you only looked at the clicks, not the orders. You post more of the wrong content because you only looked at the likes, not the sales. Honest data leads to good decisions. Bad data leads to wasted money."*

F.7 Summary of the lecture

- **KPIs** are numbers that tell you whether you are moving toward your goal. Choose one primary KPI per goal. Ignore vanity metrics.
- **Google Analytics** tells you five things: sessions, users, traffic sources, top pages and events. Read the story, not just the numbers.
- **UTM links** tell you exactly where every click came from. Use a consistent naming convention. Turn guessing into knowing.
- **A/B testing** means changing one variable, measuring the result, and keeping the winner. One variable. One lesson.
- **Reporting** answers three questions: what happened, so what, and now what. One page. Clear language.
- **Honest measurement** means no cherry-picking, no false causation, no ignoring uncomfortable results.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Set KPI] --> B[Track with UTM]
    B --> C[Read data weekly]
    C --> D{Underperforming?}
    D -->|Yes| E[A/B test]
    D -->|No| F[Keep going]
    E --> C
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- On the projector: a sample GA4 dashboard screenshot.
- A free UTM builder open in the browser.
- A sample one-page report.
- The A/B Test Planner worksheet.

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€" read a GA4 dashboard live (5 minutes)

Say: "Let me show you how to read a Google Analytics dashboard. This is Mama Nkechi's Kitchen's website data for one week."

Show the sample dashboard. Point to each metric and explain it:

- **Sessions: 320** â€" "320 visits. That is how many times people came to the website."
- **Users: 210** â€" "210 unique people. Some people visited more than once."
- **Top traffic source: Social (45%)** â€" "Almost half of visitors came from social media â€" mostly Instagram. That tells us the Instagram content is working."
- **Top page: Menu page (180 views)** â€" "Most people looked at the menu. Good â€" they are interested in the food."
- **WhatsApp button clicks: 45** â€" "45 people clicked the WhatsApp order button. That is a real action â€" they are trying to order."
- **Conversion rate: 14%** â€" "45 out of 320 visitors clicked to order. That is 14%. Not bad â€" but it means 86% left without ordering. That is our opportunity."

Ask: "What is the story here? What is working? What is not?" Let the class answer. Then summarise:

- Working: Instagram content is driving traffic. People are interested (looking at the menu).

- Not working: 86% are not ordering. Why? Maybe the menu is unclear. Maybe the WhatsApp button is hard to find. Maybe the prices are confusing.
- Next step: Look at the menu page. Make the order button more obvious. Test a new image.

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€" build a UTM link live (4 minutes)

Say: "Now let me show you how to build a UTM link. I will use Mama Nkechi's Kitchen's order page and tag it for an Instagram post."

Open the free UTM builder. Fill in the fields live:

- **Website URL:** `https://mamankitchen.com/order`
- **Campaign Source:** `instagram`
- **Campaign Medium:** `social`
- **Campaign Name:** `week1-launch`
- **Campaign Content:** `photo-jollof`

The builder generates: `https://mamankitchen.com/order?utm_source=instagram&utm_medium=social&utm_campaign=week1-launch&utm_content=photo-jollof`

Say:

> *"Now when someone clicks this link, Google Analytics will tell me: this person came from Instagram, it was a social post, it was part of the week1-launch campaign, and it was the jollof photo. I know exactly which post brought them. Without the UTM tag, it would just say 'social' â€" and I would not know which post worked."*

Show a bad example: `https://mamankitchen.com/order?utm_source=IG&utm_medium=social&utm_campaign=Week1&utm_content=photo` **Say:** "This looks fine, but it is inconsistent. 'IG' instead of 'instagram'. 'Week1' with a capital W. Next week I might type 'week1' in lowercase. Now Google Analytics thinks these are two different campaigns. Consistency is everything."

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€" plan an A/B test live (4 minutes)

Say: "Now let me show you how to plan an A/B test. I want to know: does a photo of jollof or a reel of jollof being cooked get more clicks?"

Fill the A/B Test Planner on the projector:

Element	Version A	Version B
Image	Photo of jollof	Reel of jollof cooking
Headline	"Too tired to cook?"	"Too tired to cook?"
CTA	"Order on WhatsApp"	"Order on WhatsApp"
Variable tested	Image only	Image only
Success metric	Click-through rate	Click-through rate
Duration	3 days or 100 clicks	3 days or 100 clicks
Decision rule	Higher CTR wins	Higher CTR wins

Say:

> *"I am changing only the image. The headline and CTA are the same. That way, if version B wins, I know it was the image â€" not the headline or the CTA. One variable. One lesson. After three days, I will look at the results and keep the winner."*

G.5 Demonstration 4 â€" write a one-page report live (2 minutes)

Say: "Finally, let me show you what a one-page report looks like. This is Mama Nkechi's Kitchen's weekly report."

Show the sample report:

Mama Nkechi's Kitchen â€" Week 1 Report

What happened: *320 website visitors, 45 WhatsApp messages, 12 orders, â‚¦18,000 revenue.*

So what: *Traffic is up 20% from last week â€" Instagram content is working. But 86% of visitors did not order. The menu page is the most visited page, but the order button may not be obvious enough.*

Now what: *Next week we will (1) make the WhatsApp order button bigger and brighter on the menu page, (2) test a reel image instead of a photo in our Instagram ad, and (3) send a WhatsApp broadcast to past customers with a 10% discount.*

Say:

> *"One page. Three sections. Clear language. That is a report. It tells you what happened, what it means, and what to change. If you can write this, you can measure anything."*

G.6 Questions to ask during the demo

- "What does a session tell us that a user count does not?" (A session tells us how many visits; a user tells us how many unique people. One person can have many sessions.)
- "Why do we need UTM links if Google Analytics already shows traffic sources?" (Because GA4 only shows the platform â€" 'social'. UTM links show the exact post, campaign and creative.)
- "Why do we change only one variable in an A/B test?" (So we know which change caused the result. If we change three things, we cannot tell which one worked.)
- "What is the 'so what' in a report?" (The meaning of the numbers â€" what they tell us about what is working and what is not.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding, each learner completes a KPI Matching Table, builds two UTM links, and plans a simple A/B test for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen (or their own approved business).

Starting materials: The KPI Matching Worksheet, the UTM Link Builder worksheet, the A/B Test Planner worksheet, a pen.

Procedure (instructor calls out each step; learners follow; instructor walks the room):

1. Choose your business â€" Mama Nkechi's Kitchen or your own approved business. Write the name at the top.
2. **KPI Matching:** Write down three business goals (e.g., get more orders, get more WhatsApp messages, build awareness). For each goal, write the primary KPI you would watch and why. (Worksheet 8.1)
3. **Pause and predict:** Look at your KPIs. Are they actionable â€" can you do something differently based on them? If not, change them.
4. **UTM Link 1:** Build a UTM link for an Instagram post promoting your business. Use the UTM builder worksheet. Write the full tagged URL.
5. **UTM Link 2:** Build a UTM link for a WhatsApp broadcast. Use the UTM builder worksheet. Write the full tagged URL.
6. **Pause and predict:** Check your naming convention. Are you using lowercase? Hyphens? Consistent names? If not, fix them.
7. **A/B Test:** Choose one thing to test (image, headline, or CTA). Fill the A/B Test Planner: Version A, Version B, the one variable being tested, the success metric, the duration, and the decision rule. (Worksheet 8.3)
8. **Pause and predict:** Is your test changing only one variable? If not, fix it. Can you act on the result? If not, change the success metric.
9. Compare your work with a partner. Give one piece of feedback: "The strongest part is _____. One thing to improve is _____."
10. Keep your worksheets â€" this becomes the capstone's measurement plan.

Expected result (model answer â€" instructor key):

A completed KPI Matching Table with three goals and their KPIs, two correctly tagged UTM links with consistent naming, and a complete A/B Test Planner with one variable, a success metric, a duration and a decision rule.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 3: "If your KPI went up or down, what would you do differently? If you cannot answer, it is not a good KPI."
- After step 6: "If you used 'IG' in one link and 'instagram' in another, what happens in Google Analytics?"
- After step 8: "If you changed the image AND the headline, and version B won, what would you know?"

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- KPI is "followers" â†' "Is that actionable? What would you do differently if it went up? If nothing, choose a different KPI."
- UTM link has spaces â†' "Replace spaces with hyphens. Google Analytics does not read spaces well."
- UTM naming is inconsistent â†' "Pick one format and use it every time. Lowercase, hyphens, same names."
- A/B test changes three things â†' "Choose one. Just one. You can test the others later."
- Success metric is vague â†' "What number will you measure? Clicks? Orders? Messages? Be specific."

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Three business goals written with a primary KPI for each
- ☐ KPIs are actionable (not vanity metrics)
- ☐ Two UTM links built with correct parameters
- ☐ Naming convention is consistent (lowercase, hyphens)
- ☐ A/B test planned with one variable only
- ☐ Success metric, duration and decision rule defined
- ☐ Partner feedback received and one improvement made

SIMULATION â€" INTEGRATED CAMPAIGN SPRINT (15%)

Assessment weight: 15% of the course grade. A one-sitting, closed-notes, individual task worth **/20**, scaled to the 15% weight. It is the only place **LO7 (paid ads structure)** and **LO8 (measurement)** are tested together, under mild time pressure. The brief is **instructor-held** (Part 5, Template J) and handed out when the timer starts.

Where the 30 minutes sit in today's 105-minute plan:

Minutes	Block	Note
0â€"6	**D.** Opening activity (6)	unchanged
6â€"13	**E.** Prerequisite review (7)	unchanged
13â€"33	**F.** Lecture (20)	**Â§F.5 Reporting shortened to 10 minutes**; Â§F.6 and Â§F.7 are folded into this simulation briefing and the summary slide
33â€"48	**G.** Demonstration (15)	unchanged
48â€"66	**H.** Guided practical (18)	protected â€" do not cut
66â€"96	**SIMULATION â€" Integrated Campaign Sprint (30)**	**new, graded, closed notes**
96â€"99	**L.** Assignment brief (3)	unchanged
99â€"104	**M. + N.** Knowledge check and recap (5)	unchanged
104â€"105	Close (1)	ethics reminder, next-session teaser

Session 8 timing changes: Â§I (independent exercise) and Â§J (case study) are **not run to time today** â€" the Simulation replaces Â§I (both are individual work), and the Adaeze's Bakes dataset is issued as practice with Assignment 8. Run Â§J as the closing discussion only if the room is ahead of time. Protect Â§H.

Say to the class (before minute 66):

> *"After Section H we stop, and you will sit the **Integrated Campaign Sprint** â€" one 30-minute task, closed notes, on your own. It is 15% of your course mark. You will get one fictional business and you will plan its next four weeks of marketing on*

a single sheet: who the customer is, which channels you would use and why, the campaign objective, one content idea, how you split the budget, the two numbers you would watch, and what you would change if week one fails. Everything you need was taught in Sessions 1â€"8. Reason it out â€" do not cram notes into the margin."

The brief you will be handed at minute 66 (learner copy):

> ***SIMULATION â€" INTEGRATED CAMPAIGN SPRINT | 30 minutes | closed notes | one A4 sheet | /20***
>
> ***Your client: Delta Bliss Laundry*** *(fictional) â€" a laundry and dry-cleaning shop in Rumuokwuta, Port Harcourt. Open 18 months; owner plus two staff. Wash-and-fold â‚¦2,500 a load (up to 8 kg), dry cleaning â‚¦1,500 a shirt, free pickup and delivery within 5 km. About 70% of customers walk in; repeat bookings are irregular. The business has a personal Instagram with 180 followers, no Google Business Profile and no website. Customers call or walk in to order; WhatsApp is used only to confirm pickup.*
>
> ***The owner's brief:*** *more repeat customers and steady weekend bookings over the next four weeks. Marketing money available:* ***â‚¦5,000 a week for four weeks*** *â€" nothing more. Free tools only (Instagram, WhatsApp Business, Google Business Profile, Canva free, Google Sites). Her one rule: nothing that embarrasses the business â€" honest claims only.*
>
> ***Produce ONE sheet with these seven parts:***
>
> 1. ***Target customer*** *â€" two lines: who they are and where they are.*
> 2. ***Two channels*** *â€" plus one reason for each, tied to that customer.*
> 3. ***One campaign objective*** *â€" matched to a funnel stage.*
> 4. ***One content idea for the week*** *â€" format, hook and CTA.*
> 5. ***Budget split*** *of the â‚¦5,000 weekly budget (in naira) â€" with one line of justification.*
> 6. ***Two KPIs*** *that match the goal (not followers, not likes).*
> 7. ***One sentence:*** *what you change if week one fails.*

Rules (state them aloud when you hand the brief out):

- 30 minutes, timed on the projector. Writing stops at 30 minutes.
- Individual work â€" no pairing, no talking, no phone, no laptop, no folder.
- Closed notes: the worksheets stay in your bag. This tests recall and judgement.
- One A4 sheet, front and back at most. Mark reasoning, not length.
- The business in the brief is fictional and on purpose â€" write your plan for **Delta Bliss Laundry**, not for a real business.

Marking: /20, scaled to the 15% Simulation weight.

Criterion	Marks	What a strong answer shows
Target customer (audience)	3	Two lines that name a specific person and place with a real pain â€" not "everyone in PH"
Channels reasoned from the audience	4	Two channels, each justified by where that customer actually spends time
Objective matches the goal and funnel stage	3	One objective that fits a conversion or retention goal, stated in plain language
Budget realistic and justified	3	The â‚¦5,000 split in naira, with a reason â€" and no claim that it buys more than it can
KPIs match the goal	3	Repeat orders, weekend bookings, messages â€" actionable numbers, not followers or likes
Feasible for one person, a phone and free tools	2	The plan could actually be run next week with no paid subscription and no ad budget beyond the one given
Honest â€" no promised results	2	No guaranteed sales, no promised follower counts, no bought followers, no fake reviews
Total	**20**	

Marking notes: mark reasoning, not handwriting or length. A plan written for a real business instead of the fictional one given loses the honesty marks (2) and is referred to the instructor. Record the /20 on the mark sheet â€" it is scaled to the 15% Simulation component with the other components.

After the sprint (minutes 96â€"99): collect the sheets immediately, then brief Assignment 8 as written.

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

(Session 8 timing note: in the standard Session 8 plan above, this block is not run to time â€" the Simulation takes its slot. Issue this dataset as practice alongside Assignment 8.)

Task: You are the marketing analyst for *Adaeze's Bakes* (the fictional bakery from Session 4). Below is one week of data from her website and social media. Your job is to read the data, identify what is working and what is not, and write a one-page report.

Data:

Metric	This week	Last week	Change
Website sessions	450	380	+18%
Website users	310	280	+11%
Top traffic source	Instagram (52%)	Instagram (48%)	+4%
Top page	Birthday cake page (220 views)	Menu page (190 views)	Different
WhatsApp button clicks	60	42	+43%
Orders placed	18	14	+29%
Revenue	â,¦270,000	â,¦210,000	+29%
Instagram ad spend	â,¦5,000	â,¦5,000	Same
Instagram ad clicks	120	95	+26%
Instagram ad orders	6	3	+100%

Requirements:

1. Write a **one-page report** with three sections: What happened, So what, Now what.
2. In "So what," identify at least one thing that is working and one thing that needs attention.
3. In "Now what," recommend at least two specific actions for next week.
4. Calculate the **Return on Ad Spend (ROAS)** for the Instagram ad: revenue from ad orders Ã· ad spend.
5. Write one sentence: "The most important thing I learned from this data isâ€¦"

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- Report has all three sections clearly labelled.
- "So what" identifies a strength and a weakness.
- "Now what" recommends at least two specific actions.
- ROAS is calculated correctly.
- The reflection sentence gives a real insight.

Hints if stuck:

- Hint 1: For ROAS, multiply the number of ad orders (6) by the average order value (â,¦15,000) to get revenue from the ad, then divide by ad spend (â,¦5,000).
- Hint 2: For "so what," look at the biggest changes â€" what went up the most? What does that tell you?
- Hint 3: For "now what," think about what you would do more of (because it is working) and what you would fix (because it is not).

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

One-page report:

> ***Adaeze's Bakes â€" Week 2 Report***
>
> ***What happened:*** *450 website sessions (up 18%), 60 WhatsApp button clicks (up 43%), 18 orders (up 29%), â‚¦270,000 revenue (up 29%). Instagram ad: 120 clicks (up 26%), 6 orders (up 100%), â‚¦5,000 spend.*
>
> ***So what:*** *The Instagram ad is working well â€" orders from the ad doubled (from 3 to 6) while spend stayed the same. ROAS = (6 Ã— â‚¦15,000) Ã· â‚¦5,000 = â‚¦90,000 Ã· â‚¦5,000 = 18x. That is excellent. The birthday cake page is now the top page (220 views), which suggests the ad is driving interest in birthday cakes specifically. However, 450 sessions but only 18 orders means a 4% conversion rate â€" 96% of visitors are not ordering. The website may be losing people before they reach the order button.*
>
> ***Now what:*** *(1) Increase the Instagram ad budget slightly (to â‚¦7,000) since ROAS is strong â€" scale what works. (2) Review the website's birthday cake page â€" make the WhatsApp order button more obvious and add a clear price list to reduce confusion. (3) Test a new ad image (a different cake design) to see if we can improve the click-through rate further.*
>
> ***Reflection:*** *"The most important thing I learned from this data is that a small ad budget can work very well if the targeting and creative are right â€" the ad doubled orders without increasing spend."*

Learner marking (out of 10):

- Report has all three sections (2)
- "So what" identifies a strength and a weakness (3)
- "Now what" recommends at least two specific actions (2)
- ROAS calculated correctly (2)
- Reflection sentence gives a real insight (1)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Ngozi* runs a small hair salon in Port Harcourt â€" *Ngozi's Glam* â€" offering braids, weaves and natural hair care. She has been posting on Instagram for six months and has 1,200 followers. She recently set up a simple website with a menu and a WhatsApp order button. She spent â‚¦10,000 on a Meta ad last week and wants to know if it worked. She comes to you with a screenshot of her Instagram Insights and asks: "Did my ad work? I do not know what to look at."

Relevant facts.

- Ngozi's Instagram ad ran for 7 days with a budget of â‚¦10,000.
- The ad got 2,500 impressions, 180 clicks, and 12 likes.
- Her website (which she did not tag with UTM links) got 400 sessions total last week.
- She received 25 WhatsApp messages and booked 8 appointments from the ad.
- Each appointment is worth â‚¦5,000 on average.
- She does not know how many of the 400 website sessions came from the ad.
- She is happy about the 12 likes on the ad.

Decision point. Ngozi wants to know: did the â‚¦10,000 ad work? What should she do next?

Possible approaches.

1. **"The ad got 12 likes and 2,500 impressions â€" that is great! Let me run it again."** â€" This focuses on vanity metrics. Likes and impressions do not tell her if the ad made money.
2. **"The ad got 180 clicks and 8 appointments. Each appointment is â‚¦5,000, so that is â‚¦40,000 in revenue. The ad worked!"** â€" This is better, but it assumes all 8 appointments came from the ad. Without UTM links, she cannot be sure.
3. **"Let me calculate the real numbers: cost per click, cost per appointment, and return on ad spend. And let me set up UTM links so I know exactly how many website visits came from the ad."** â€" This is the right answer.

Recommended solution. Approach 3. Ngozi should:

1. **Calculate the key metrics:**
   - Cost per click: â‚¦10,000 Ã· 180 clicks = â‚¦55.56 per click.

- Cost per appointment: â‚¦10,000 Ã· 8 appointments = â‚¦1,250 per appointment.
- Revenue from appointments: 8 Ã— â‚¦5,000 = â‚¦40,000.
- Return on Ad Spend (ROAS): â‚¦40,000 Ã· â‚¦10,000 = 4x. (For every â‚¦1 spent, she got â‚¦4 back.)

2. **Interpret the results:** A ROAS of 4x is strong â€" the ad is profitable. But she cannot be sure all 8 appointments came from the ad. Some might have come from her organic Instagram posts or word of mouth. She needs UTM links to know for certain.
3. **Set up UTM links for the next campaign:** Tag the ad's destination URL with `utm_source=instagram&utm_medium=paid&utm_campaign=salon-promo`. Now she will know exactly how many website visits came from the ad.
4. **Write a one-page report:** What happened (180 clicks, 8 appointments, â‚¦40,000 revenue). So what (ROAS is 4x â€" the ad is profitable, but she needs UTM links to be sure). Now what (run the ad again with UTM links, test a new image, and consider increasing the budget slightly since ROAS is strong).

Say to the class:

> *"Ngozi's story is every small business owner's story. She spent money, got some results, but does not know exactly what worked. The likes feel good, but they do not pay the bills. The 8 appointments are good â€" but are they from the ad? Without UTM links, she is guessing. With UTM links, she knows. And with a simple ROAS calculation, she knows whether the ad made money. That is the power of measurement. It turns 'I think it worked' into 'I know it worked â€" and here is the proof.'"*

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 (focus on likes): feels good, tells her nothing, leads to wasted money.
- Approach 2 (focus on appointments): better, but assumes all appointments came from the ad â€" risky without UTM links.
- Approach 3 (calculate real metrics + set up UTM links): takes 10 minutes, gives her the truth, and sets up every future campaign for success.

Professional connection. This is the difference between a business that guesses and a business that knows. The guessers keep spending on ads that might be working. The knowers track every click, calculate their ROAS, and scale what works. Measurement is not overhead â€" it is how you make money.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the live guide. Point learners to the row rather than giving the answer.

K.1 Tracking vanity metrics instead of actionable metrics

Symptoms: Learner reports follower count and likes as evidence of success. **Likely cause:** Vanity metrics feel good and are easy to see. **How to investigate:** Ask: "If that number went up, what would you do differently?" **Corrective steps:** Replace vanity metrics with actionable ones tied to the goal. Followers â†' conversion rate. Likes â†' click-through rate. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner's primary KPI is tied to a business action (orders, messages, calls). **Prevention:** The KPI-goal matching table in Section F.1 â€" use it for every goal.

K.2 Not using UTM links (or using them inconsistently)

Symptoms: All social media clicks show up as "Social" in Google Analytics â€" cannot tell which post or campaign brought the visitor. **Likely cause:** Learner does not know about UTM links, or uses different naming each time. **How to investigate:** Look at the traffic sources in GA4. Is everything just "Social" or "Direct"? **Corrective steps:** Build UTM links for every post, ad and broadcast. Use a consistent naming convention (lowercase, hyphens). **How to confirm resolved:** GA4 shows specific sources like "instagram" and "whatsapp" separately. **Prevention:** The UTM link builder demo in Section G.3 and the practical exercise.

K.3 Changing too many variables in an A/B test

Symptoms: Version B wins, but the learner does not know why. **Likely cause:** Changed the image, headline and CTA all at once. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What is different between version A and version B?" If the answer is more than one thing, the test is invalid. **Corrective steps:** Redesign the test with only one variable. Test the other variables in separate tests. **How to confirm**

resolved: The test has exactly one difference between A and B. **Prevention:** The A/B test golden rule in Section F.4 â€" one variable, one lesson.

K.4 Writing a data dump instead of a report

Symptoms: The report is three pages of numbers with no meaning or recommendations. **Likely cause:** The learner does not understand the purpose of a report. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What is the 'so what' of this report? What should the reader do differently?" **Corrective steps:** Restructure the report: What happened (the numbers), So what (the meaning), Now what (the actions). One page. **How to confirm resolved:** The report has three sections and fits on one page. **Prevention:** The one-page report structure in Section F.5.

K.5 Cherry-picking data

Symptoms: The learner shares only the positive numbers and ignores the negative ones. **Likely cause:** Fear of bad results, or wanting to look successful. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What about the numbers that are not good? What do they tell you?" **Corrective steps:** Report all the relevant numbers â€" good and bad. The bad ones tell you what to fix. **How to confirm resolved:** The report includes both strengths and weaknesses. **Prevention:** The honest measurement rules in Section F.6.

K.6 Claiming causation from correlation

Symptoms: "Sales went up because I posted more" â€" but other factors may have caused the increase. **Likely cause:** Assuming that because two things happened at the same time, one caused the other. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What else changed that week? Was it payday? Did a competitor close? Was the weather different?" **Corrective steps:** Use careful language: "Sales went up the same week we posted more â€" this may be connected, but we cannot be certain without more data." **How to confirm resolved:** The learner uses careful, honest language about causation. **Prevention:** The honest measurement rules in Section F.6.

K.7 Giving up on analytics because it is "too complicated"

Symptoms: Learner avoids looking at data, says "I am not a data person." **Likely cause:** Intimidation by the number of metrics and features. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What is the one number you care about most for your business?" **Corrective steps:** Start with one KPI. Just one. Watch it weekly. Add more later. Analytics is a skill, not a talent â€" it grows with practice. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner is tracking at least one KPI and can explain what it tells them. **Prevention:** The "five things you need to know" approach in Section F.2 â€" keep it simple.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it (e.g., the learner can show you the exact KPI they are tracking, or the exact UTM link they built). Teach learners to confirm before concluding.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "Measurement Plan â€" KPIs, UTM Links and A/B Test"

Purpose: To practise building a complete measurement plan â€" the skill that feeds the capstone's measurement section.

Realistic scenario. You are the marketing consultant for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen (or your own approved business). She wants to start measuring her marketing properly. Your job is to build her a measurement plan: the KPIs to watch, the UTM links to use, and an A/B test to run.

Detailed instructions:

1. Write down **three business goals** and the **primary KPI** for each. Explain why each KPI is actionable.
2. Build **two UTM links**: one for an Instagram post and one for a WhatsApp broadcast. Use a consistent naming convention.
3. Plan **one A/B test**: choose one variable to test, define the success metric, the duration, and the decision rule.
4. Write a **one-page report** on the following sample data: Last week, the business got 200 website visitors, 30 WhatsApp messages, 10 orders, and â‚¦15,000 revenue. The week before, it got 150 visitors, 20 messages, 7 orders, and â‚¦10,500 revenue. (Use the What happened / So what / Now what structure.)
5. Write one final sentence: "The most important thing I learned about measurement isâ€¦"

Required deliverables:

- Three goals with KPIs and explanations.
- Two UTM links with consistent naming.

- One A/B test plan.
- One one-page report.
- One reflection sentence.

Submission format: Handwritten or typed, submitted at the start of Session 9. Keep a copy in your working folder.

Deadline: Before Session 9.

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
KPIs match goals	4	Three goals, each with an actionable primary KPI and a clear explanation
UTM links correct	4	Two links with all parameters, consistent naming convention
A/B test planned	4	One variable, success metric, duration and decision rule defined
One-page report	5	Three sections, clear language, identifies strengths and weaknesses
Reflection sentence	1	Gives a real insight
Honest measurement	2	No cherry-picking, careful causation language

Common mistakes to avoid: vanity metrics as KPIs; UTM links with inconsistent naming; A/B tests with multiple variables; data-dump reports with no "so what"; claiming causation from correlation.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners â€" model for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen):

Three goals and KPIs:

1. Goal: Get more WhatsApp orders. KPI: Number of WhatsApp messages received. Why: It tells me if people are taking action â€" I can act on it by improving my content or ad.
2. Goal: Build awareness. KPI: Reach (number of people who see my posts). Why: It tells me if more people know about the business â€" I can act on it by posting more or running ads.
3. Goal: Increase revenue. KPI: Revenue per week. Why: It tells me if the business is actually making more money â€" I can act on it by focusing on what sells.

Two UTM links:

1. Instagram post: `mamankitchen.com/order?utm_source=instagram&utm_medium=social&utm_campaign=week1-launch&utm_content=photo-jollof`
2. WhatsApp broadcast: `mamankitchen.com/order?utm_source=whatsapp&utm_medium=social&utm_campaign=week1-launch`

A/B test:

- Variable: Ad image (photo of jollof vs. reel of jollof cooking)
- Success metric: Click-through rate
- Duration: 3 days or 100 clicks per version
- Decision rule: Whichever version has a higher CTR after 100 clicks wins

One-page report:

> ***What happened:*** *200 visitors (up 33%), 30 WhatsApp messages (up 50%), 10 orders (up 43%), â‚¦15,000 revenue (up 43%).*
>
> ***So what:*** *Everything is up significantly. The increase in WhatsApp messages (50%) is higher than the increase in visitors (33%), which means the website is converting better â€" more people who visit are taking action. The 10 orders from 200 visitors is a 5% conversion rate â€" solid for a small business.*
>
> ***Now what:*** *(1) Keep doing whatever drove the increase â€" was it a specific post or ad? (2) Test a new ad image to see if we can improve the click-through rate. (3) Send a WhatsApp broadcast to past customers to encourage repeat orders.*

Reflection sentence: "The most important thing I learned about measurement is that numbers tell a story â€" but only if you know which numbers to read and you are honest about what they are saying."

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. What is the difference between a vanity metric and an actionable metric? Give one example of each.

Q2. Multiple choice. Which of these is the best primary KPI for a business whose goal is to get more WhatsApp orders? a) Follower count b) Number of WhatsApp messages received c) Number of likes on posts d) Total impressions

Q3. Explain. What are the five UTM parameters, and what does each one tell you?

Q4. Practical. A business owner says: "My ad got 500 likes and 2,000 impressions â€" it is working!" But she got zero orders. What is the problem, and what should she measure instead?

Q5. A/B testing. You want to test whether a photo or a reel performs better in your Instagram ad. You change the image (photo â†' reel) AND the headline ("Too tired to cook?" â†' "Hot jollof in 45 minutes"). Version B wins. What is wrong with this test, and what can you conclude?

Q6. Reporting. What are the three sections of a one-page report, and what does each section say?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q6)

A1. A vanity metric feels good but does not help you make decisions (e.g., followers, likes, impressions). An actionable metric tells you something you can act on (e.g., click-through rate, conversion rate, cost per lead, orders). The key test: if the number went up or down, would you do something differently? If yes, it is actionable. If no, it is vanity.

A2. (b) Number of WhatsApp messages received. This is the action that matches the goal. Follower count, likes and impressions are vanity metrics â€" they do not tell you if people are ordering.

A3. The five UTM parameters are: (1) `utm_source` â€" where the click came from (e.g., instagram, facebook, whatsapp). (2) `utm_medium` â€" what type of channel (e.g., social, email, paid). (3) `utm_campaign` â€" which campaign or post (e.g., week1-launch, jollof-promo). (4) `utm_content` â€" which specific ad or creative (e.g., photo-jollof, reel-cooking). (5) `utm_term` â€" which keyword (optional, for paid search).

A4. The problem is that she is measuring vanity metrics (likes, impressions) instead of actionable metrics (orders, conversion rate, cost per order). Likes and impressions do not pay bills. She should measure: number of orders, conversion rate (orders Ã· clicks), and cost per order (ad spend Ã· orders). If she got zero orders from 2,000 impressions, the ad is not working â€" no matter how many likes it got.

A5. The test changed two variables (image and headline), so you cannot tell which one caused the win. Was it the reel? The new headline? Both? You cannot conclude anything from this test. The correct approach: change only one variable. Test the image first (keep the headline the same). Then test the headline separately (keep the image the same). One variable. One lesson.

A6. The three sections are: (1) **What happened** â€" the key numbers, stated plainly. (2) **So what** â€" what the numbers mean; what is working and what is not. (3) **Now what** â€" what you will change or do next. A good report answers all three in one page with clear language.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned the skill that makes every other skill pay off: measurement. You learned that a **KPI** is a number that tells you whether you are moving toward your goal â€" and that you should choose actionable metrics (orders, messages, conversion rates) over vanity metrics (followers, likes, impressions). You learned to read a basic **Google Analytics** report: sessions, users, traffic sources, top pages and events â€" the story your website tells. You learned to build **UTM links** so every click traces to its exact source, turning guessing into knowing. You learned to plan a simple **A/B test**: change one variable, measure the result, keep the winner. And you learned to write a **one-page report** that says what happened, what it means, and what to change.

Five important takeaways:

1. **Measure what matters, not what feels good.** Vanity metrics are noise. Actionable metrics are signal.
2. **Google Analytics tells a story.** Sessions, users, traffic sources, top pages and events â€" read them together.
3. **UTM links turn guessing into knowing.** Tag every link. Use a consistent naming convention.

4. **A/B testing: one variable, one lesson.** Change one thing, measure, keep the winner.
5. **A report answers three questions.** What happened? So what? Now what? One page. Clear language.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I choose a KPI that matches a stated business goal?
- Can I read a basic GA4 dashboard and explain what it tells me?
- Can I build a UTM link with the correct parameters?
- Can I plan an A/B test that changes only one variable?
- Can I write a one-page report with a clear "so what"?
- Can I calculate ROAS and say whether an ad is profitable?

Connection to the next session. You now have every piece of the puzzle: the audience, the channels, the content, the paid ads, and the measurement. Next session â€" Session 9, the capstone â€" you assemble everything into one complete **integrated digital marketing campaign plan**. You will bring your avatar, your value proposition, your content calendar, your keyword list, your email and WhatsApp plan, your campaign structure, and your measurement plan. You will check that every piece fits, write it up, and present it. That is the final session â€" where you prove you can think like a marketer.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner chooses actionable KPIs over vanity metrics without being prompted.
- Learner builds UTM links with correct parameters and consistent naming.
- Learner plans an A/B test with exactly one variable.
- Learner writes a report with a clear "so what" â€" not just a list of numbers.
- Learner calculates ROAS correctly and interprets it honestly.
- Learner uses careful language about causation ("may be connected" not "caused").

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "Followers and likes prove the marketing is working." â†' No â€" only actions that match the goal prove it.
- "I need to track every metric." â†' No â€" one primary KPI per goal. Track what you can act on.
- "UTM links are optional." â†' No â€" without them, you cannot tell which post or campaign brought the visitor.
- "If I change three things and it works, I know what worked." â†' No â€" you do not know which of the three caused it.
- "A report should include every number." â†' No â€" one page, three sections, clear language.
- "Correlation means causation." â†' No â€" be careful. Sales going up the same week you posted more does not prove the posts caused it.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **KPI sorting drill:** Give 10 metrics (some vanity, some actionable) and ask the learner to sort them into two columns and explain why.
2. **UTM building drill:** Give five scenarios (Instagram post, Facebook ad, WhatsApp broadcast, email newsletter, Google ad) and ask the learner to build a UTM link for each.
3. **A/B test design drill:** Give three poorly designed tests (each changing multiple variables) and ask the learner to fix them.
4. **Report writing drill:** Give a table of numbers and ask the learner to write a three-section report in 10 minutes.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** Provide the KPI matching table with the goals already filled in â€" the learner writes only the KPI and the explanation. Provide a UTM link template with the parameters listed â€" the learner fills in the values.
- **Level 2 (standard):** The session as written â€" full KPI table, UTM links, A/B test plan and one-page report.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** Ask the learner to design a **two-week measurement plan** for a â‚¦20,000 ad campaign, including: the KPIs to track, the UTM links to use, an A/B test to run in week one, and a decision rule for week two based on hypothetical results (e.g., "If ROAS is below 1x, what do you do? If it is above 3x, what do you do?"). This requires applying the full test-learn-adjust cycle.

Timing guidance. The priority is the guided practical (Section H) â€" learners building KPIs, UTM links and an A/B test plan â€" and the **30-minute Simulation block (Integrated Campaign Sprint, 15%)**, which runs at minutes 66â€"96 and must not be shortened or skipped. To make room: Â§F.5 Reporting is held to 10 minutes, Â§F.6â€"F.7 are folded into the simulation briefing, and Â§I and Â§J are not run to time today (Â§I's dataset is practice with Assignment 8; Â§J is a closing discussion only if the room is ahead). If learners struggle with UTM links, walk through one build on the board step by step. Protect the practical time â€" a learner who leaves without a measurement plan has no measurement section for the capstone.

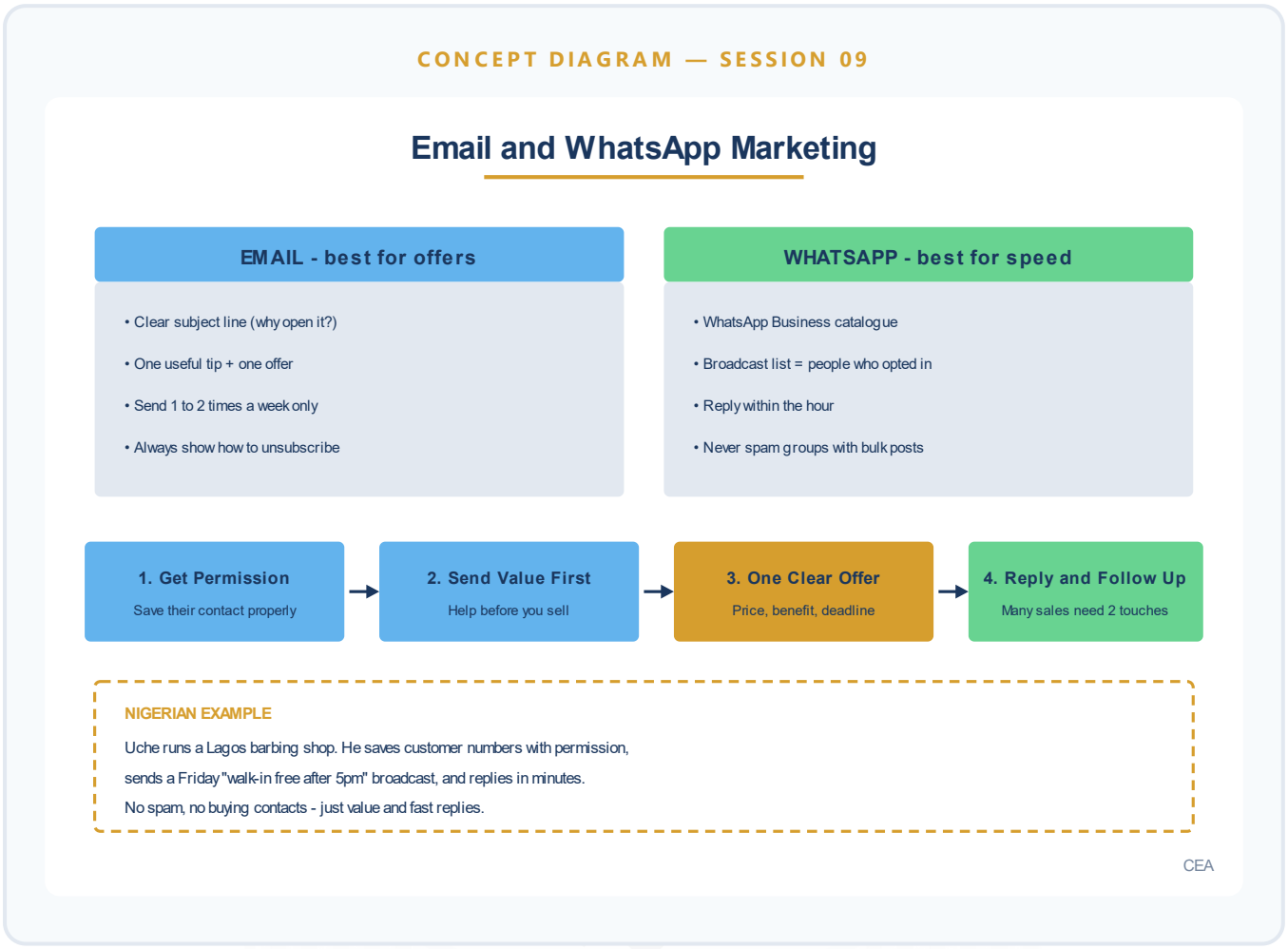
Capstone link. The KPI table, UTM links, A/B test plan and one-page report built today become the capstone's measurement plan. The ROAS calculation becomes part of the capstone's budget justification. Keep all worksheets safe â€" the capstone assembles them in Session 9.

END OF SESSION 8

Next: Session 9 â€" Capstone: Integrated Digital Marketing Campaign Plan.

SESSION 09 OF 9

Capstone Integrated Digital Marketing Campaign Plan



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" DIGITAL MARKETING

SESSION 9 â€" CAPSTONE: INTEGRATED DIGITAL MARKETING CAMPAIGN PLAN

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	9 of 9
Session title	Capstone: Integrated Digital Marketing Campaign Plan
Week / Module	Week 3 â€" Module 3: Convert and Measure
Recommended duration	105 minutes

Item	Detail
Difficulty level	Beginner (assembly, presentation and defence â€" not new technical skills)
Prerequisite knowledge	Sessions 1â€"8. Learners should have completed all mini-projects: avatar, value proposition, Google Business Profile draft, content calendar, keyword worksheet, newsletter and broadcast drafts, campaign structure sheet, and measurement plan (KPIs, UTM links, A/B test, one-page report).
Connection to previous work	In Sessions 1â€"8 we built every piece of the puzzle: the audience, the positioning, the online presence, the content plan, the SEO and local search actions, the email and WhatsApp plan, the paid ad structure, and the measurement plan. Today we assemble everything into one complete, integrated campaign plan â€" the capstone. Each learner checks that every piece fits, writes it up, and presents and defends their decisions. This is the session that earns the certificate.
Preparation before class	Academy computers or phones ready. Prepare projector slides showing the capstone structure (the eight components). Print the Capstone Checklist (Section H) per learner. Prepare a sample completed capstone (for demonstration only â€" do not distribute). Prepare presentation time slots (4â€"5 minutes per learner). Prepare peer feedback forms. Have the capstone assessment rubric ready (from Part 6). Prepare a course feedback form for the end of the session.

Instructor note on tone: This is the final session â€" the one everything has been building toward. Learners may feel proud of what they have built, and they may also feel nervous about presenting. Your job is to make this feel like a celebration, not an exam. The capstone is not about perfection â€" it is about completeness, coherence and honesty. A plan that is simple, clear and genuinely affordable is better than a plan that is impressive but unrealistic. Remind them: they have been building this for eight sessions. Today they put it together and show it off.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Assemble a complete integrated digital marketing campaign plan** covering all eight required components: cover page, contents and ethics and scope statement, goals and KPIs, audience and positioning, online presence, channel and content plan, SEO and owned channels, paid media and measurement, and timeline, budget and ethics statement.
2. **Check internal consistency** â€" ensuring that the audience matches the channels, the channels match the content, the content matches the budget, and the measurement plan matches the goals.
3. **Present the plan in a short talk** (4â€"5 minutes), explaining at least three key decisions aloud in plain language.
4. **Defend decisions under questioning** â€" answering at least three questions accurately, explaining the reasoning behind channel choices, budget choices and measurement choices.
5. **Give and receive constructive peer feedback** using a structured feedback form.
6. **Reflect on the course as a whole** â€" identifying what they have learned, what they can do now that they could not do before, and what they want to learn next.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner (with a notes app) or an academy computer with internet.
- Instructor computer connected to a projector.
- Whiteboard or flip chart.
- Timer or clock for presentation timekeeping.

Software

- Google Docs or Microsoft Word for assembling the capstone document.
- Canva (free tier) for the cover page if desired.

- Phone Notes or Google Docs for presentation notes.

Sample files

- **Capstone Structure Slide** â€" projector-ready, showing the eight components.
- **Sample Completed Capstone** â€" for demonstration only (do not distribute to learners).
- **Peer Feedback Form** â€" one per learner.
- **Course Feedback Form** â€" one per learner.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 9.1 â€" "Capstone Checklist" (all eight components, ticked as completed).
- Worksheet 9.2 â€" "Presentation Planner" (three key decisions, three anticipated questions, timing).
- Worksheet 9.3 â€" "Peer Feedback Form" (strengths, improvements, questions).

Accounts

- Gmail (from Session 3) for Google Docs. Canva account (free) for cover page design.

Internet

- Required for assembling the capstone document and accessing Canva.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- A phone with Google Docs works for assembling the capstone. A learner who cannot type quickly may write by hand or dictate to a classmate; the skill is the *thinking and assembling*, not the typing.

Safety and ethics note:

- Learners present only their own work. No copying from classmates or from the internet.
- The capstone must be honest: no fake results, no promised follower counts, no guaranteed sales.
- Real customer data, phone numbers and emails are never used in the capstone.
- The "no paid subscription" rule applies: the capstone is assembled with free tools only.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show two documents side by side.

Document 1 â€" "The Random Folder": A folder with eight separate files: an avatar sheet, a content calendar, a keyword list, a newsletter draft, a campaign structure sheet, a UTM link worksheet, a one-page report, and a Google Business Profile screenshot. All good work â€" but scattered, unconnected, with no overall plan.

Document 2 â€" "The Integrated Plan": One document with a cover page, a table of contents, and all eight components assembled into a single, coherent plan. The avatar connects to the channels. The channels connect to the content. The content connects to the budget. The budget connects to the measurement. Everything fits.

What the instructor says:

> *"Eight sessions of work. Eight separate pieces. On the left, they are scattered â€" good pieces, but no picture. On the right, they are assembled â€" one plan, one story, one strategy. Today you turn your folder into the document on the right. You take everything you have built â€" your avatar, your content calendar, your keywords, your newsletter, your ad structure, your measurement plan â€" and you put them together into one complete campaign plan. Not eight separate assignments. One integrated plan. That is what a real marketer delivers. That is what you deliver today."*

Why this opener works: It shows the transformation from scattered work to integrated plan. It makes the goal concrete and visual. And it reassures learners that they already have all the pieces â€" today is about assembly, not starting from scratch.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "In Session 2, we built a customer avatar. What is the avatar's name for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen, and what is one of his pains?"

- Expected answer: Chinedu; too tired to cook after work (or worried about food hygiene).
- Common gap: generic answers. Prompt for specifics.

Question 2: "In Session 4, we learned about content pillars. What are the three content pillars for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen?"

- Expected answer: Food (menu items, recipes, cooking tips), Behind-the-scenes (kitchen, preparation, team), and Customer love (reviews, testimonials, celebrations).
- Common gap: learners list random post ideas instead of pillars. Remind them: pillars are categories, not individual posts.

Question 3: "In Session 7, we learned about campaign objectives. If your goal is to get WhatsApp orders, what objective do you choose?"

- Expected answer: Sales (or leads).
- Common gap: learners choose "engagement." Remind them: the objective must match the goal.

Question 4: "In Session 8, we learned about UTM links. What does `utm_source` tell you?"

- Expected answer: Where the click came from (e.g., instagram, facebook, whatsapp).
- Common gap: learners confuse the parameters. Quickly review: source, medium, campaign, content, term.

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"You have every piece. The avatar, the content, the keywords, the email plan, the ad structure, the measurement plan. Today you put them together. But assembly is not just copy-paste. You have to check that everything fits. Does your audience match your channels? Do your channels match your content? Does your content match your budget? Does your measurement plan match your goals? If one piece does not fit, the whole plan is weak. Today you check, you fix, you assemble, and you present. That is the capstone."*

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 What the capstone is and why it matters

The idea. The **capstone** is the complete, integrated digital marketing campaign plan for a small business. It is not eight separate assignments stapled together â€" it is one document that tells one story: who we are talking to, where we reach them, what we say, how we pay for it, and how we know it worked.

Why it matters. In the real world, a business owner does not hire you to write a content calendar. They hire you to grow their business. The capstone proves you can think like a marketer â€" not just a poster, not just a copywriter, not just an ad buyer, but someone who sees the whole picture and can explain how the pieces work together.

What the capstone proves:

- You can define a customer and position a business.
- You can choose the right channels for a specific audience and goal.
- You can plan content that serves a strategy, not just fills a calendar.
- You can set a realistic budget and justify it.
- You can measure results and make decisions based on data.
- You can present and defend your thinking in plain language.

Say to the class:

> *"The capstone is not a test. It is a demonstration. It shows what you can do â€" not what you can memorise. A business owner should be able to read your plan and start work on Monday morning. That is the standard. Not perfect. Not agency-level. Just clear, complete, honest and usable."*

F.2 The eight components of the capstone

The idea. The capstone has eight required components. Each one was built in a previous session. Today you assemble them and check that they fit together.

The eight components:

1. Cover page, contents and ethics and scope statement. The learner's name, the course, the date, the business name, and a one-paragraph description of the plan; a table of contents; and â€" opening the plan â€" the **ethics and scope statement**: the business is fictional, this is a course exercise, what was in and out of scope, and a commitment to honest marketing. The ethics and scope statement is a **pass condition** (no statement = no marking) and sits inside component 1.

2. Goals and KPIs. Two or three SMART goals (Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-bound) with the exact metric and timeframe. For example: "Increase WhatsApp orders from 10 to 20 per week within 4 weeks." The KPI is orders per week.

3. Audience and positioning. The customer avatar (who, where, pains, objections, platforms), the value proposition (what you give, to whom, why you are different), and three messaging lines aimed at named pains.

4. Online presence. The Google Business Profile (or equivalent), the landing-page structure, brand consistency (name, logo, colours, fonts, tone), and trust signals (reviews, photos, consistent NAP).

5. Channel and content plan. The chosen channels with reasoning (why these channels for this audience?), a one-week content calendar (format, hook, CTA per item), and a repurposing note (how one idea becomes several posts).

6. SEO and owned channels. Ten or more keywords with volume/competition notes, a local SEO checklist (categories, keywords, posts, photos, reviews, NAP), and a permission-based email/WhatsApp plan with opt-out.

7. Paid media and measurement. A campaign structure with a naira budget, KPIs, two UTM link examples, a report format, and a one-variable A/B test.

8. Timeline, budget table and ethics statement. Four weeks of activity and costs (including the â‚¦0 organic option), plus an ethics statement covering honest advertising, real reviews only, no bought engagement, permission-based messaging and respectful data handling.

Say to the class:

> *"Eight components. You have built every one of them. Today you put them in order, check that they connect, and make them into one document. The cover page is the door. The goals are the destination. The audience is the compass. The channels are the vehicle. The content is the fuel. The budget is the map. The measurement is the mirror. And the ethics statement is the foundation. Everything else sits on top of it."*

F.3 Checking internal consistency â€" does every piece fit?

The idea. A plan can have all eight components and still be weak if the pieces do not fit together. Internal consistency means: the audience matches the channels, the channels match the content, the content matches the budget, and the measurement matches the goals.

The five consistency checks:

Check 1: Does the audience match the channels? If your avatar is Chinedu (28, professional in GRA, orders food delivery on his phone), your channels should be the ones he uses: Instagram, Google Search, WhatsApp. If your plan targets Chinedu but focuses on LinkedIn and Twitter, the pieces do not fit.

Check 2: Do the channels match the content? If your channels are Instagram and WhatsApp, your content should be visual (photos, reels) and conversational (broadcasts, personal messages). If your channels are Instagram and WhatsApp but your content is long blog posts and email newsletters, the pieces do not fit.

Check 3: Does the content match the budget? If your budget is â‚¦10,000 per week, your content plan should be realistic for that budget â€" a few posts per week, one or two ads, one broadcast. If your content plan requires daily video production, a professional photographer and a â‚¦50,000 budget, the pieces do not fit.

Check 4: Does the measurement match the goals? If your goal is orders, your KPIs should be orders, conversion rate and revenue. If your goal is awareness, your KPIs should be reach and impressions. If your goal is orders but your KPIs are followers and likes, the pieces do not fit.

Check 5: Does the timeline match the plan? If your plan says "post three times per week" but your timeline shows only two posts in week one, the pieces do not fit. If your plan says "run ads in week two" but your timeline shows ads starting in week one, the pieces do not fit.

Say to the class:

> *"A plan is like a chain. It is only as strong as its weakest link. If your audience is right but your channels are wrong, the plan fails. If your channels are right but your content is wrong, the plan fails. If your content is right but your budget is wrong, the plan fails. Today you check every link. You make sure every piece fits. That is what turns eight assignments into one plan."*

Worked example â€" consistency check for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen:

Check	Question	Answer	Fits?
Audience â†' Channels	Does Chinedu use Instagram, Google and WhatsApp?	Yes â€" he is on Instagram, searches Google for food, orders on WhatsApp.	Yes
Channels â†' Content	Does the content suit Instagram and WhatsApp?	Yes â€" photos and reels for Instagram, broadcasts for WhatsApp.	Yes
Content â†' Budget	Can we produce this content for â‚¦10,000/week?	Yes â€" phone photos, one ad, one broadcast.	Yes
Measurement â†' Goals	Do the KPIs match the goal (orders)?	Yes â€" orders, conversion rate, revenue.	Yes
Timeline â†' Plan	Does the timeline show the content plan being executed?	Yes â€" three posts in week one, ads in week two.	Yes

All five checks pass. The plan is internally consistent.

F.4 Assembling the document â€" structure and presentation

The idea. The capstone is assembled as one document. It should be clear, professional and easy to navigate. The reader should be able to find any component in seconds.

The recommended document structure:

1. **Cover page** â€" name, course, date, business, one-paragraph summary.
2. **Ethics and scope statement** â€" fictional business, course exercise, in/out of scope, honest marketing commitment. *(Opens the plan. Part of component 1 â€" a pass condition: no statement, no marking.)*
3. **Table of contents** â€" the eight components with page numbers.
4. **Section 1: Goals and KPIs** â€" two or three SMART goals with metrics and timeframes.
5. **Section 2: Audience and positioning** â€" avatar, value proposition, three messages.
6. **Section 3: Online presence** â€" Google Business Profile, landing page, brand, trust signals.
7. **Section 4: Channel and content plan** â€" channels with reasoning, one-week calendar, repurposing note.
8. **Section 5: SEO and owned channels** â€" keywords, local SEO checklist, email/WhatsApp plan.
9. **Section 6: Paid media and measurement** â€" campaign structure, budget, KPIs, UTM links, A/B test.
10. **Section 7: Timeline and budget table** â€" four weeks of activity and costs.
11. **Section 8: Ethics statement** â€" honest advertising, real reviews, no bought engagement, permission-based messaging, data respect.

Presentation tips:

- Use headings and subheadings â€" make it scannable.
- Use tables for the calendar, budget and KPI tracking.
- Use bullet points for lists â€" not paragraphs.
- Include visuals where helpful â€" a screenshot of the Google Business Profile, a sample post, a sample ad.
- Keep it honest â€" if something is a plan (not yet done), say so. "We will set upâ€¦" not "We have set upâ€¦"

Say to the class:

> *"Your capstone is a professional document. It should look like something you would show a client. Clear headings, clean layout, no spelling errors. You do not need fancy design â€" you need clarity. A one-page summary at the top that says what the plan is, who it is for, and what it will achieve. Then the detail underneath. Make it easy to read."*

F.5 Presenting and defending â€" the viva

The idea. After assembling the plan, each learner presents it in a short talk (4â€"5 minutes) and answers questions. This is the **viva** â€" the spoken defence of the plan. It proves the learner understands their own decisions and can explain them in plain language.

The presentation structure (4â€"5 minutes):

1. **Introduction (30 seconds):** "My plan is for [business name]. The goal is [goal]. Here is what I will cover."
2. **Audience and positioning (30 seconds):** "My customer is [avatar name]. He/She cares about [pain]. My value proposition is [one sentence]."
3. **Channels and content (1 minute):** "I chose [channels] because [reasoning]. My content plan includes [highlights]."
4. **Budget and measurement (1 minute):** "My budget is [amount] per week. I will measure [KPIs]. I will run [A/B test] to learn [variable]."
5. **Key decisions (1 minute):** "The three most important decisions I made are: [decision 1] because [reason], [decision 2] because [reason], [decision 3] because [reason]."
6. **Conclusion (30 seconds):** "This plan is realistic, affordable and measurable. It is ready to implement."

Anticipating questions: The viva will include questions like:

- "Why these channels and not others?"
- "What if week one fails?"
- "How do you know your budget is enough?"
- "What is the first thing you would change if results are poor?"
- "How will you know if the plan is working?"

How to prepare for questions:

- Know your reasoning for every decision. Why Instagram and not TikTok? Why â‚¦10,000 and not â‚¦50,000? Why orders and not followers?
- Be honest. If you do not know something, say "I do not know, but I would find out byâ€¦" â€" that is a better answer than making something up.
- Stay calm. The questions are not attacks â€" they are curiosity. The panel wants to understand your thinking.

Say to the class:

> *"The viva is not an interrogation. It is a conversation. You have done the work â€" now you explain it. The best answer to any question is the honest one. 'I chose Instagram because my customer is there' is a perfect answer. 'I chose Instagram because I saw a competitor using it' is a weak answer. Know your reasoning. Speak plainly. You know this plan better than anyone in the room."*

F.6 Giving and receiving peer feedback

The idea. After each presentation, peers give structured feedback. This teaches learners to evaluate marketing plans critically and to receive feedback gracefully.

The peer feedback form (three sections):

1. **What worked well?** (At least two specific things.)
    - Example: "The channel choice was well reasoned â€" you explained why Instagram fits the customer."
    - Example: "The budget was realistic and clearly justified."

2. **What could be improved?** (At least two specific, constructive suggestions.)
    - Example: "The content calendar is good, but it does not show what happens on days with no posts."
    - Example: "The measurement plan tracks orders, but it does not say how you will track repeat customers."
3. **Questions for the presenter.** (At least one question.)
    - Example: "What will you do if the ad gets clicks but no orders?"
    - Example: "How will you handle negative reviews on Google?"

Rules for giving feedback:

- Be specific. "The budget is good" is weak. "The budget is realistic because you showed what â‚¦10,000 buys" is strong.
- Be kind. Feedback is about the work, not the person.
- Be honest. If something does not fit, say so â€" but say it respectfully.

Rules for receiving feedback:

- Listen without defending.
- Ask questions if you do not understand.
- Thank the person â€" even if the feedback is hard to hear.
- Decide what to act on. Not all feedback is right, but all feedback is useful.

Say to the class:

> *"Feedback is a gift. It shows you what you cannot see yourself. The best marketers are not the ones who never make mistakes â€" they are the ones who learn fastest from feedback. Today you practise both giving and receiving it. Be honest, be kind, and be useful."*

F.7 The ethics statement â€" the foundation of the plan

The idea. Every capstone includes an ethics statement â€" a short section that says how the plan will be executed honestly and responsibly. This is not optional. It is the foundation that everything else sits on.

The ethics statement must cover:

1. **Honest advertising.** All claims will be true and verifiable. No fake discounts, no invented urgency, no misleading claims.
2. **Real reviews only.** Reviews will be asked for honestly from real customers. No fake reviews, no bought reviews, no reviews from people who did not use the service.
3. **No bought engagement.** No buying followers, likes, views, comments or shares. All growth will be earned.
4. **Permission-based messaging.** Email and WhatsApp messages will only go to people who said yes. Easy opt-out will be provided and honoured immediately.
5. **Respectful data handling.** Customer data will be collected only with consent, used only for the agreed purpose, kept secure and never sold.

Say to the class:

> *"The ethics statement is not a formality. It is a promise. It says: I will grow this business honestly. I will not cheat, I will not spam, I will not lie. That promise is what makes everything else in the plan trustworthy. A plan that is clever but dishonest is worthless. A plan that is simple but honest is priceless."*

F.8 Summary of the lecture

- The **capstone** is the complete, integrated campaign plan â€" eight components assembled into one document.
- The eight components: cover page, contents and ethics and scope statement, goals and KPIs, audience and positioning, online presence, channel and content plan, SEO and owned channels, paid media and measurement, timeline, budget and ethics.
- **Internal consistency** means every piece fits: audience matches channels, channels match content, content matches budget, measurement matches goals.

- The **viva** is a 4â€“5 minute presentation where the learner explains at least three key decisions and answers questions.
- **Peer feedback** teaches learners to evaluate plans critically and receive feedback gracefully.
- The **ethics statement** is the foundation â€” honest advertising, real reviews, no bought engagement, permission-based messaging, respectful data handling.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Campaign goals] --> B[Audience research]
    B --> C[Channel plan]
    C --> D[Content calendar]
    D --> E[Budget allocation]
    E --> F[Measurement plan]
    F --> G[Present to class]
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- On the projector: the capstone structure slide (eight components).
- A sample completed capstone (for demonstration only).
- The Capstone Checklist worksheet.
- The Presentation Planner worksheet.

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€” walk through the capstone structure (5 minutes)

Say: "Let me show you what a complete capstone looks like. This is a sample plan for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen."

Show the sample capstone on the projector. Walk through each component:

1. **Cover page, contents and ethics and scope statement:** "Mama Nkechi's Kitchen â€” Integrated Digital Marketing Campaign Plan. Prepared by [name], CEA Digital Marketing, [date]. This plan covers goals, audience, channels, content, budget and measurement for a four-week campaign." Then the statement that opens the plan: "Mama Nkechi's Kitchen is a **fictional** business used for this course. This plan is a **course exercise** and uses only invented data. **In scope:** the online presence, content, channels, budget and measurement described below. **Out of scope:** real customer data, real ad spend, real business operations. **Honest marketing commitment:** every claim will be true and verifiable â€” no fake reviews, no bought engagement, no misleading discounts, no invented urgency." Followed by the table of contents.
2. **Goals and KPIs:** "Goal 1: Increase WhatsApp orders from 10 to 20 per week within 4 weeks. KPI: Orders per week. Goal 2: Build a Google Business Profile with 10+ reviews within 4 weeks. KPI: Number of reviews."
3. **Audience and positioning:** "Avatar: Chinedu, 28, professional in GRA, orders food delivery. Value proposition: Hot, home-cooked meals delivered to your door in 45 minutes â€” the taste of home without the cooking. Three messages: (1) 'Too tired to cook? We deliver.' (2) 'Hot jollof, at your door, in 45 minutes.' (3) 'Real food, real fast, real affordable.'"
4. **Online presence:** "Google Business Profile: complete with photos, menu, hours, 10+ reviews. Landing page: one page with menu, prices, WhatsApp order button. Brand: consistent colours, logo, tone. Trust signals: reviews, photos, consistent NAP."
5. **Channel and content plan:** "Channels: Instagram (visual content), Google Search (local SEO), WhatsApp (direct ordering). One-week calendar: Monday â€” food photo, Wednesday â€” behind-the-scenes reel, Friday â€” customer review, Sunday â€” WhatsApp broadcast. Repurposing: one cooking video becomes a Reel, a TikTok, a WhatsApp Status and an email."
6. **SEO and owned channels:** "Keywords: 'food delivery Port Harcourt', 'jollof rice GRA', 'home cooked meals PH' â€” 10+ keywords with volume notes. Local SEO: complete profile, weekly posts, honest reviews, consistent NAP. Email/WhatsApp: permission-based list, weekly newsletter, broadcast with opt-out."
7. **Paid media and measurement:** "Campaign: Sales objective, â‚¦10,000/week, two ad sets (GRA and Trans-Amadi), two ad concepts. KPIs: orders, conversion rate, ROAS. UTM links: tagged for Instagram and WhatsApp. A/B test: photo vs. reel."
8. **Timeline, budget and ethics:** "Week 1: set up Google Business Profile, post 3 times, send 1 broadcast. Week 2: launch ads, post 3 times, send 1 newsletter. Week 3: review results, adjust ads, post 3 times. Week 4: final review, report, plan next

month. Budget: â‚¦10,000/week for ads, â‚¦0 for organic. Ethics: honest advertising, real reviews, no bought engagement, permission-based messaging, respectful data."

Say:

> *"That is the whole plan. Eight components. One story. Every piece fits. The audience is Chinedu, so the channels are Instagram, Google and WhatsApp. The channels are visual and conversational, so the content is photos, reels and broadcasts. The budget is â‚¦10,000 a week, so the content is realistic â€" phone photos, not a film crew. The goal is orders, so the KPIs are orders, not followers. Everything connects."*

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€" run the consistency check live (4 minutes)

Say: "Now let me show you how to check that every piece fits. I will use the five consistency checks."

Run through the checks on the projector:

Check	Question	Answer	Fits?
Audience â†' Channels	Does Chinedu use Instagram, Google and WhatsApp?	Yes	Yes
Channels â†' Content	Does the content suit these channels?	Yes â€" photos, reels, broadcasts	Yes
Content â†' Budget	Can we produce this for â‚¦10,000/week?	Yes â€" phone photos, one ad	Yes
Measurement â†' Goals	Do the KPIs match the goal?	Yes â€" orders, not followers	Yes
Timeline â†' Plan	Does the timeline match the plan?	Yes â€" 3 posts/week, ads in week 2	Yes

Say:

> *"All five checks pass. The plan is internally consistent. If any check had failed â€" if, say, the channels were LinkedIn and Twitter â€" I would fix it before presenting. The consistency check is your quality control. Run it before you present."*

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€" model a 4-minute presentation (4 minutes)

Say: "Now let me show you what a good presentation sounds like. I will present the sample plan in four minutes."

Model the presentation:

> *"My plan is for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen. The goal is to increase WhatsApp orders from 10 to 20 per week within four weeks.*
>
> *My customer is Chinedu. He is 28, he works in GRA, and he is too tired to cook after work. My value proposition is: hot, home-cooked meals delivered to your door in 45 minutes â€" the taste of home without the cooking.*
>
> *I chose three channels: Instagram, because Chinedu is on Instagram looking at food; Google Search, because he searches for food delivery; and WhatsApp, because that is where he orders. My content plan is three posts a week â€" a food photo, a behind-the-scenes reel, and a customer review â€" plus one WhatsApp broadcast.*
>
> *My budget is â‚¦10,000 a week for ads. I will measure orders, conversion rate and ROAS. I will run an A/B test â€" photo versus reel â€" to learn which image gets more clicks.*
>
> *The three most important decisions I made are: First, I chose Instagram over TikTok because Chinedu is on Instagram, not TikTok. Second, I set the budget at â‚¦10,000 because that is what Mama Nkechi can afford to lose while we learn. Third, I measure orders, not followers, because orders pay bills.*
>
> *This plan is realistic, affordable and measurable. It is ready to implement. Thank you."*

Say:

> *"That is four minutes. Clear, confident, honest. I explained three decisions. I answered the 'why' behind each one. I did not read from a script â€" I spoke plainly. That is what a good presentation sounds like."*

G.5 Demonstration 4 â€" model peer feedback (2 minutes)

Say: "After each presentation, you will give feedback. Let me show you what good feedback sounds like."

Model feedback on the sample presentation:

> *"What worked well: The channel choice was well reasoned â€" you explained why Instagram fits Chinedu. The budget was realistic and clearly justified.*
>
> *What could be improved: The content calendar shows three posts a week, but it does not say what happens on the other four days. Will there be WhatsApp Status updates? Also, the measurement plan tracks orders, but it does not say how you will track repeat customers â€" which is important for a food business.*
>
> *One question: What will you do if the ad gets clicks but no orders?"*

Say:

> *"Specific, kind, useful. That is good feedback. It tells the presenter what is working, what to improve, and it asks a question that makes them think. That is the standard."*

G.6 Questions to ask during the demo

- "What happens if one of the consistency checks fails?" (You fix the plan before presenting. You change the channel, the content, the budget or the KPI until it fits.)
- "How long should the presentation be?" (4â€"5 minutes. Enough to explain three decisions, not enough to read the whole plan.)
- "What if you do not know the answer to a question?" (Say "I do not know, but I would find out byâ€¦" â€" that is honest and shows you know how to learn.)
- "Is the ethics statement really necessary?" (Yes â€" it is the foundation. Without it, the plan is just tactics. With it, the plan is a promise.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding, each learner assembles their capstone document from their existing worksheets, runs the five consistency checks, and prepares their presentation.

Starting materials: All worksheets from Sessions 1â€"8 (avatar, value proposition, content calendar, keyword list, newsletter, broadcast, campaign structure, measurement plan). The Capstone Checklist. The Presentation Planner. A pen or Google Docs.

Procedure (instructor calls out each step; learners follow; instructor walks the room):

1. Lay out all your worksheets from Sessions 1â€"8. Check that you have all eight components. If anything is missing, note it â€" you will need to complete it today.
2. **Assemble the document.** Create a new Google Doc (or open a Word doc). Add a cover page with your name, the course, the date, the business name and a one-paragraph summary.
3. **Add the ethics and scope statement, then the table of contents.** The ethics and scope statement opens the plan (fictional business, course exercise, in/out of scope, honest marketing commitment) â€" it is a pass condition. Then list the eight components in the contents.
4. **Insert each component.** Copy or summarise each worksheet into the corresponding section. Do not just paste â€" make it readable. Use headings, tables and bullet points.
5. **Run the five consistency checks.** For each check, write one sentence: "Audience â†' Channels: [explanation]. Fits? [Yes/No]." If any check fails, fix the plan now.

6. **Write the ethics statement.** Five sentences covering: honest advertising, real reviews, no bought engagement, permission-based messaging, respectful data handling.
7. **Prepare your presentation.** Use the Presentation Planner: write your three key decisions, your reasoning for each, and three questions you expect.
8. **Practice once.** Stand up and present to yourself (or a partner) in 4â€“5 minutes. Time it.
9. **Pause and predict:** What is the hardest question you might be asked? Write down your answer.
10. Keep your document and presentation notes â€” you will present in the next part of the session.

Expected result (model answer â€” instructor key):

A complete capstone document with all eight components, a completed consistency check (all five pass), an ethics statement, and a prepared 4â€“5 minute presentation with three key decisions and three anticipated questions.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 5: "If any consistency check failed, what did you fix? Why?"
- After step 7: "What is your strongest decision? What is your weakest? Why?"
- After step 8: "Did you finish in 4â€“5 minutes? If not, what did you cut?"

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Missing a component â†' "Which session was that from? Can you complete a basic version now?"
- Consistency check fails â†' "Which piece does not fit? Can you change it to fit, or change something else?"
- Document is messy â†' "Use headings. Use tables. Make it scannable. The reader should find anything in 5 seconds."
- Presentation is too long â†' "Cut the detail. Keep the three decisions and the reasoning. That is what matters."
- Presentation is too short â†' "Add more reasoning. Why these channels? Why this budget? Why these KPIs?"

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ All eight components present in the document
- ☐ Cover page with name, course, date, business and summary
- ☐ Ethics and scope statement opens the plan (pass condition)
- ☐ Table of contents added
- ☐ Five consistency checks completed â€” all pass (or fixes made)
- ☐ Ethics statement written (five points covered)
- ☐ Presentation planned: three key decisions with reasoning
- ☐ Three anticipated questions with prepared answers
- ☐ Presentation practiced and timed (4â€“5 minutes)

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task: You are the marketing consultant presenting the capstone for *Adaeze's Bakes* (the fictional bakery from Session 4). Below is a summary of her plan. Your job is to prepare and deliver a 4-minute presentation defending three key decisions.

Adaeze's Bakes â€" Plan Summary:

- **Goal:** Increase birthday cake orders from 5 to 15 per week within 4 weeks.
- **Avatar:** Amaka, 32, mother in GRA, planning her child's birthday party. Pain: worried the cake will not be ready on time or will not look like the picture.
- **Value proposition:** Custom birthday cakes, designed, baked and delivered on the date you choose â€" the cake you pictured, at the party you planned.
- **Channels:** Instagram (visual content â€" cake photos and videos), Google Search (local SEO â€" "birthday cake Port Harcourt"), WhatsApp (direct ordering and delivery updates).
- **Content:** Three posts per week â€" a cake photo, a behind-the-scenes decorating video, a customer testimonial. Plus one WhatsApp broadcast to past customers.
- **Budget:** â‚¦10,000 per week for Meta ads.
- **KPIs:** Orders per week, conversion rate, ROAS.
- **A/B test:** Photo of a cake vs. video of cake being decorated.

- **Ethics:** Honest advertising (real cake photos, real prices), real reviews only, no bought engagement, permission-based messaging.

Requirements:

1. Write your **three key decisions** and the reasoning for each. (Choose from: channel choice, budget choice, KPI choice, content choice, A/B test choice.)
2. Write **three questions** you expect to be asked and your answers to each.
3. Practice your presentation. Time it. It must be 4â€"5 minutes.
4. Write one sentence: "The most important thing I learned from building this plan isâ€¦"

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- Three key decisions are clearly stated with reasoning.
- Three anticipated questions are relevant and answered accurately.
- Presentation is timed and fits within 4â€"5 minutes.
- The reflection sentence gives a real insight.

Hints if stuck:

- Hint 1: For channel choice, think about where Amaka spends her time and how she searches for cakes.
- Hint 2: For budget choice, think about what â‚¦10,000 a week can realistically buy and why that is enough to start.
- Hint 3: For anticipated questions, think about what a sceptical business owner would ask: "What if it does not work?" "How do I know it is working?" "Why not spend more?"

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

Three key decisions:

1. **Channel choice:** I chose Instagram, Google Search and WhatsApp because that is where Amaka is. She is on Instagram looking at cake ideas, she searches Google for "birthday cake Port Harcourt," and she orders on WhatsApp. I did not choose TikTok or Facebook because Amaka is not there â€" she is a busy mother, not a teenager.
2. **Budget choice:** I set the budget at â‚¦10,000 per week because that is what Adaeze can afford to lose while we learn. It is enough to run a meaningful test â€" two ad sets, two ad concepts â€" and it is not so much that a failure will hurt the business. Once we have a proven winner, we can increase it.
3. **KPI choice:** I measure orders, not followers, because orders pay bills. Followers feel good, but they do not pay for flour and sugar. I also measure conversion rate and ROAS because they tell me if the ad is actually making money.

Three anticipated questions:

1. **"What if the ad gets clicks but no orders?"** â†' That means the ad is working (people are interested) but the landing experience is not (they are not ordering). I would check the WhatsApp ordering process â€" is it easy to order? Is the price clear? Is the delivery promise clear? I would fix the landing experience before increasing the budget.
2. **"How will you know if the plan is working?"** â†' I will track orders per week. If orders go from 5 to 15 within 4 weeks, the plan is working. If they do not, I will look at the data â€" clicks, conversion rate, ROAS â€" and adjust. Maybe the ad creative needs to change. Maybe the targeting needs to narrow. The data will tell me.
3. **"Why not spend â‚¦50,000 a week and grow faster?"** â†' Because we do not know what works yet. A small budget lets us test safely. If we spend â‚¦50,000 and the ad does not work, we lose â‚¦50,000. If we spend â‚¦10,000 and it works, we scale up. Test small, then scale. That is how you avoid wasting money.

Reflection sentence: "The most important thing I learned from building this plan is that marketing is not about doing everything â€" it is about doing the right things for the right customer, and being able to explain why."

Learner marking (out of 10):

- Three key decisions stated with reasoning (4)
- Three anticipated questions relevant and answered (3)
- Presentation timed and fits 4â€"5 minutes (2)
- Reflection sentence gives a real insight (1)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Emeka* is a recent CEA Digital Marketing graduate. He completed the course three months ago and has been offering social media management services to small businesses in Port Harcourt. A local restaurant, *Taste of Naija*, hires him to grow their online presence. The restaurant has been open for one year, has a Facebook page with 300 followers, no Google Business Profile, no website and no mailing list. The owner, *Chef Obi*, says: "I want more customers. Can you help me?"

Emeka remembers his capstone. He knows he needs to build a complete plan â€" not just post randomly. He sits down and assembles a campaign plan for Taste of Naija, using everything he learned in the course.

Relevant facts.

- Taste of Naija serves Nigerian dishes â€" jollof, egusi, suya, pounded yam â€" for lunch and dinner.
- They are located in Trans-Amadi, near several offices and a market.
- Their customers are mostly office workers (lunch) and families (dinner).
- They have no online presence beyond a neglected Facebook page.
- Chef Obi can afford â‚¦15,000 per month for marketing.
- He wants more customers within 3 months.

Decision point. Emeka needs to present a plan to Chef Obi. What should the plan include, and how should he present it?

Possible approaches.

1. **"I will post on Facebook every day and run a small ad."** â€" This is random activity without strategy. No audience definition, no content plan, no measurement. It might work by luck, but it is not a plan.
2. **"I will build a complete plan: audience, channels, content, budget and measurement. I will present it to you and explain every decision."** â€" This is the right answer.

Recommended solution. Approach 2. Emeka should:

1. **Build the audience:** Office workers in Trans-Amadi (lunch) and families in Trans-Amadi and Rumuokwuta (dinner). Avatar: *Kelechi*, 30, office worker, wants a quick, affordable, tasty lunch. Pain: tired of the same food every day.
2. **Set the channels:** Instagram (visual food content), Google Search (local SEO â€" "lunch Trans-Amadi"), WhatsApp (ordering and delivery).
3. **Plan the content:** Three posts per week â€" a food photo, a behind-the-scenes kitchen video, a customer review. Plus one WhatsApp broadcast to past customers.
4. **Set the budget:** â‚¦15,000 per month = â‚¦3,750 per week. Start with a small Meta ad test (â‚¦3,750 for one week) to learn what works.
5. **Define the measurement:** Orders per week, conversion rate, ROAS. Set up UTM links for the ad.
6. **Present the plan:** Emeka presents the plan to Chef Obi in a 5-minute talk, explaining: "I chose Instagram and Google because that is where your customers are. I set the budget at â‚¦15,000 because that is what you can afford. I will measure orders, not followers, because orders pay bills. Here is the plan. Here is why it will work. Here is how we will know if it is working."

Say to the class:

> *"Emeka's story is your story in three months. You will sit across from a business owner who wants more customers. They do not want a content calendar â€" they want a plan. They do not want jargon â€" they want clarity. They do not want promises â€" they want honesty. The capstone is your proof that you can deliver. It is the first real item in your portfolio. When a client asks 'can you help me?', you say 'yes â€" and here is how.'"*

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 (random activity): fast to start, but no strategy, no measurement, no learning. Might work by luck, but probably will not.
- Approach 2 (complete plan): takes time to build, but every decision is reasoned, every naira is accounted for, and the client trusts you because you can explain your thinking.

Professional connection. This is the difference between a hobbyist and a professional. A hobbyist posts and hopes. A professional plans, executes, measures and adjusts. The capstone is your first professional deliverable. It is what you show clients, what you put in your portfolio, and what earns you referrals.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the live guide. Point learners to the row rather than giving the answer.

K.1 Assembling without checking consistency

Symptoms: All eight components are present, but the audience does not match the channels, or the content does not match the budget. **Likely cause:** The learner pasted everything together without checking how the pieces fit. **How to investigate:** Run the five consistency checks. Which one fails? **Corrective steps:** Fix the mismatched piece. Change the channel, the content, the budget or the KPI until everything fits. **How to confirm resolved:** All five consistency checks pass. **Prevention:** The consistency check exercise in Section H â€" run it before presenting.

K.2 Presenting without explaining reasoning

Symptoms: The learner says "I chose Instagram" but cannot say why. **Likely cause:** The learner made decisions by habit or guesswork, not by reasoning. **How to investigate:** Ask "why?" after every decision. If the learner cannot answer, the decision is not reasoned. **Corrective steps:** For every decision, write one sentence: "I chose X because Y." If you cannot write the sentence, reconsider the decision. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner can explain the reasoning for every key decision. **Prevention:** The Presentation Planner in Section H â€" three key decisions with reasoning.

K.3 Making promises the plan cannot keep

Symptoms: "This plan will get you 1,000 followers in one month" or "This ad will double your sales." **Likely cause:** Exaggeration to impress, or misunderstanding what a small budget can achieve. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What evidence do you have for that claim? Is it realistic for a â‚¦10,000 budget?" **Corrective steps:** Replace every promise with a realistic expectation. "This plan aims to increase orders by 50% within 4 weeks" â€" not "This plan will double your sales." **How to confirm resolved:** Every claim in the plan is realistic and honest. **Prevention:** The honest measurement rules from Session 8 â€" no promising what you cannot prove.

K.4 Ignoring the ethics statement

Symptoms: The ethics statement is missing, or it is one sentence: "I will be honest." **Likely cause:** The learner thinks ethics is a formality, not a foundation. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What specifically will you do to ensure honest advertising? How will you handle reviews? How will you handle customer data?" **Corrective steps:** Write a full ethics statement covering all five points: honest advertising, real reviews, no bought engagement, permission-based messaging, respectful data handling. **How to confirm resolved:** The ethics statement is specific and complete. **Prevention:** The ethics statement explanation in Section F.7.

K.5 Reading from the document during the presentation

Symptoms: The learner reads the capstone word for word, never looks up, and runs out of time. **Likely cause:** The learner is nervous and uses the document as a security blanket. **How to investigate:** Ask the learner to explain one decision without looking at the document. If they cannot, they do not know their own plan. **Corrective steps:** Practice speaking from notes, not from the document. Use bullet points, not paragraphs. Know your three key decisions by heart. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner can present the three key decisions without reading. **Prevention:** The presentation practice in Section H â€" stand up, speak, time it.

K.6 Being defensive when receiving feedback

Symptoms: The learner argues with every piece of feedback, or dismisses it entirely. **Likely cause:** Taking feedback personally, or not understanding its purpose. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What did you learn from that feedback? What will you change?" **Corrective steps:** Remind the learner: feedback is about the work, not the person. Listen, ask questions, thank the person, and decide what to act on. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner receives feedback gracefully and acts on at least one piece. **Prevention:** The peer feedback rules in Section F.6 â€" be specific, be kind, be honest.

K.7 Rushing the assembly and submitting a messy document

Symptoms: The document has no headings, no table of contents, spelling errors, and components are out of order. **Likely cause:** Leaving the assembly to the last minute. **How to investigate:** Look at the document. Can you find any component in 5 seconds? If not, it is not organised. **Corrective steps:** Add a table of contents. Use headings. Use tables for the calendar and

budget. Proofread for spelling. **How to confirm resolved:** The document is clean, organised and professional. **Prevention:** The assembly demonstration in Section G.2 â€" show the structure, then give time to assemble.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it (e.g., the learner can show you the exact consistency check that failed, or the exact decision they cannot explain). Teach learners to confirm before concluding.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "My Capstone â€" The Complete Campaign Plan"

Purpose: To assemble, check and present the complete integrated digital marketing campaign plan â€" the final deliverable of the course and the certificate requirement.

Realistic scenario. You are the marketing consultant for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen (or another **fictional** business approved by your instructor â€" the graded capstone is always written for a fictional business; a real business is for ungraded practice only, with the owner's written permission). You have completed all the mini-projects over eight sessions. Now you assemble them into one complete campaign plan, check that every piece fits, and prepare to present and defend it.

Detailed instructions:

1. Gather all your worksheets from Sessions 1â€"8.
2. Assemble them into one document with: cover page, table of contents, and all eight components.
3. Run the five consistency checks. Fix anything that does not fit.
4. Write the ethics statement (five points).
5. Prepare a 4â€"5 minute presentation: three key decisions with reasoning, three anticipated questions with answers.
6. Practice your presentation. Time it. It must be 4â€"5 minutes.
7. Write one final sentence: "The most important thing I learned in this course isâ€¦"

Required deliverables:

- The complete capstone document (assembled, checked, ethics statement included).
- The presentation planner (three decisions, three questions, timing).
- The reflection sentence.

Submission format: Submit the capstone document as a Google Doc (shared with the instructor) or as a printed document. Present in class in the next session.

Deadline: Before the next class (the presentation session).

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
All eight components present	4	Every component is included and complete
Internal consistency	4	All five consistency checks pass; every piece fits
Ethics statement	3	All five points covered specifically
Presentation quality	4	Clear, confident, timed, three decisions explained
Reasoning and defence	3	Every decision has a clear "because"
Professional presentation	2	Clean document, organised, easy to read

Common mistakes to avoid: missing components; inconsistent pieces (audience does not match channels); missing or vague ethics statement; reading from the document; making unrealistic promises; defensive response to feedback; messy, unorganised document.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners â€" model for Mama Nkechi's Kitchen):

Capstone structure:

1. Cover page: name, course, date, business, one-paragraph summary.
2. Table of contents.

3. Goals and KPIs: Goal 1 â€" Increase WhatsApp orders from 10 to 20 per week within 4 weeks. KPI: Orders per week. Goal 2 â€" Build a Google Business Profile with 10+ reviews within 4 weeks. KPI: Number of reviews.
4. Audience and positioning: Avatar â€" Chinedu, 28, professional in GRA, orders food delivery. Value proposition â€" Hot, home-cooked meals delivered to your door in 45 minutes. Three messages: (1) "Too tired to cook? We deliver." (2) "Hot jollof, at your door, in 45 minutes." (3) "Real food, real fast, real affordable."
5. Online presence: Google Business Profile â€" complete with photos, menu, hours, 10+ reviews. Landing page â€" one page with menu, prices, WhatsApp order button. Brand â€" consistent colours, logo, tone. Trust signals â€" reviews, photos, consistent NAP.
6. Channel and content plan: Channels â€" Instagram, Google Search, WhatsApp. One-week calendar â€" Monday: food photo, Wednesday: behind-the-scenes reel, Friday: customer review, Sunday: WhatsApp broadcast. Repurposing â€" one cooking video becomes a Reel, a TikTok, a WhatsApp Status and an email.
7. SEO and owned channels: Keywords â€" "food delivery Port Harcourt", "jollof rice GRA", "home cooked meals PH" â€" 10+ keywords. Local SEO â€" complete profile, weekly posts, honest reviews, consistent NAP. Email/WhatsApp â€" permission-based list, weekly newsletter, broadcast with opt-out.
8. Paid media and measurement: Campaign â€" Sales objective, â‚¦10,000/week, two ad sets, two ad concepts. KPIs â€" orders, conversion rate, ROAS. UTM links â€" tagged for Instagram and WhatsApp. A/B test â€" photo vs. reel.
9. Timeline, budget and ethics: Week 1 â€" set up Google Business Profile, post 3 times, send 1 broadcast. Week 2 â€" launch ads, post 3 times, send 1 newsletter. Week 3 â€" review results, adjust ads, post 3 times. Week 4 â€" final review, report, plan next month. Budget â€" â‚¦10,000/week for ads, â‚¦0 for organic. Ethics â€" honest advertising, real reviews, no bought engagement, permission-based messaging, respectful data handling.

Presentation:

- Three key decisions: (1) Channel choice â€" Instagram, Google, WhatsApp because that is where Chinedu is. (2) Budget choice â€" â‚¦10,000/week because that is what Mama Nkechi can afford to lose while we learn. (3) KPI choice â€" orders, not followers, because orders pay bills.
- Three anticipated questions: (1) "What if the ad gets clicks but no orders?" â†' Fix the landing experience. (2) "How will you know if it is working?" â†' Track orders per week. (3) "Why not spend more?" â†' Test small, then scale.
- Reflection: "The most important thing I learned in this course is that marketing is not about doing everything â€" it is about doing the right things for the right customer, and being able to explain why."

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. What are the eight components of the capstone, in order?

Q2. Multiple choice. Which of the following is the most important reason to run consistency checks before presenting your capstone? a) To make the document look professional b) To ensure every piece fits â€" audience matches channels, channels match content, content matches budget, measurement matches goals c) To fill time before the presentation d) To impress the instructor

Q3. Explain. What are the five consistency checks, and what does each one verify?

Q4. Practical. A learner's capstone targets a customer avatar of "Chinedu, 28, professional in GRA" but chooses LinkedIn and Twitter as the primary channels. Which consistency check fails, and what should they fix?

Q5. Presentation. What are the three key decisions you should be able to explain in your viva, and what should you be able to say about each one?

Q6. Ethics. What are the five points that must be covered in the ethics statement?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q6)

A1. The eight components are: (1) Cover page, table of contents and ethics and scope statement. (2) Goals and KPIs. (3) Audience and positioning. (4) Online presence. (5) Channel and content plan. (6) SEO and owned channels. (7) Paid media and measurement. (8) Timeline, budget table and ethics statement. The ethics and scope statement is a pass condition inside component 1 â€" no statement, no marking.

A2. (b) To ensure every piece fits â€" audience matches channels, channels match content, content matches budget, measurement matches goals. Internal consistency is what turns eight separate assignments into one integrated plan.

A3. The five consistency checks are: (1) Does the audience match the channels? (Are the channels the ones the avatar actually uses?) (2) Do the channels match the content? (Does the content suit the channels?) (3) Does the content match the budget? (Can the content be produced for the budget?) (4) Does the measurement match the goals? (Do the KPIs match the stated goals?) (5) Does the timeline match the plan? (Does the timeline show the plan being executed as described?)

A4. Check 1 fails: the audience does not match the channels. Chinedu is a 28-year-old professional in GRA who uses Instagram, Google and WhatsApp â€" not LinkedIn and Twitter. The learner should change the channels to match the avatar (Instagram, Google Search, WhatsApp) or change the avatar to match the channels (but that would be changing the customer to fit the plan, which is backwards).

A5. The three key decisions are typically: (1) Channel choice â€" why these channels for this audience. (2) Budget choice â€" why this amount and what it can realistically buy. (3) Measurement choice â€" why these KPIs and how they match the goals. For each, the learner should be able to say: "I chose X because Y" â€" a clear, reasoned explanation.

A6. The five points are: (1) Honest advertising â€" all claims true and verifiable, no fake discounts or invented urgency. (2) Real reviews only â€" no fake or bought reviews. (3) No bought engagement â€" no buying followers, likes, views or comments. (4) Permission-based messaging â€" email and WhatsApp only to people who said yes, with easy opt-out. (5) Respectful data handling â€" collect only what is needed, use it only for the agreed purpose, keep it secure, never sell it.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you assembled the capstone â€" the complete, integrated digital marketing campaign plan. You learned that the capstone has **eight components**: cover page, contents and ethics and scope statement, goals and KPIs, audience and positioning, online presence, channel and content plan, SEO and owned channels, paid media and measurement, and timeline, budget and ethics. You learned to check **internal consistency** â€" making sure the audience matches the channels, the channels match the content, the content matches the budget, and the measurement matches the goals. You learned to **present and defend** your plan in a 4â€"5 minute talk, explaining at least three key decisions and answering questions. You learned to **give and receive peer feedback** â€" specifically, kindly and honestly. And you learned that the **ethics statement** is the foundation: honest advertising, real reviews, no bought engagement, permission-based messaging and respectful data handling.

Five important takeaways:

1. **The capstone is one plan, not eight assignments.** Every piece must fit â€" audience, channels, content, budget, measurement.
2. **Internal consistency is quality control.** Run the five checks. Fix what does not fit.
3. **The viva is a conversation, not an interrogation.** Know your reasoning. Speak plainly. Be honest.
4. **Feedback is a gift.** Give it specifically and kindly. Receive it gracefully and act on it.
5. **Ethics is the foundation.** A plan that is clever but dishonest is worthless. A plan that is simple but honest is priceless.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I assemble a complete campaign plan from eight components?
- Can I check that every piece fits â€" audience, channels, content, budget, measurement?
- Can I present my plan in 4â€"5 minutes and explain three key decisions?
- Can I answer questions about my plan honestly and confidently?
- Can I give feedback that is specific, kind and useful?
- Can I write an ethics statement that covers all five points?

Connection to the course â€" the final word. This is the end of the CEA Digital Marketing course. You started nine sessions ago not knowing what digital marketing was. Now you can define a customer, position a business, plan content, choose channels, set a budget, build a campaign structure, measure results, write a report, and present and defend a complete plan. That is a real skill â€" one that businesses need and will pay for. You are now an **entry-level digital marketer**. Not a senior strategist. Not a data analyst. But someone who can walk into a small business and say: "I can help you grow â€" and here is how." That is worth something. Keep building. Keep learning. Keep measuring. From zero to expert â€" together.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner assembles all eight components into one coherent document.
- Learner runs the five consistency checks and fixes any mismatches.
- Learner presents three key decisions with clear reasoning ("I chose X because Y").
- Learner answers questions honestly â€" including "I do not know, but I would find out byâ€¦"
- Learner gives feedback that is specific, kind and useful.
- Learner's ethics statement covers all five points specifically.
- Learner's document is clean, organised and professional.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "The capstone is just pasting everything together." â†' No â€" it is checking that every piece fits and fixing what does not.
- "I should promise big results to impress." â†' No â€" honest expectations build trust; false promises destroy it.
- "The ethics statement is a formality." â†' No â€" it is the foundation. Without it, the plan is just tactics.
- "Feedback is personal criticism." â†' No â€" it is about the work, and it is how you improve.
- "Reading from the document is fine." â†' No â€" know your plan well enough to speak plainly.
- "More channels = better plan." â†' No â€" the right channels for the audience beat every channel for everyone.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Consistency check drill:** Give a plan with three intentional mismatches and ask the learner to find and fix them.
2. **Decision reasoning drill:** Give five channel choices and ask the learner to write "I chose X because Y" for each.
3. **Ethics statement drill:** Give a vague ethics statement ("I will be honest") and ask the learner to rewrite it covering all five points specifically.
4. **Presentation practice:** Have the learner present to you alone, then give one piece of feedback and have them present again.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** Provide the capstone structure with headings already created â€" the learner fills in each section. Provide the consistency check table with the questions already written â€" the learner writes the answers.
- **Level 2 (standard):** The session as written â€" full assembly, consistency check, presentation and peer feedback.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** Ask the learner to assemble the capstone for a **different business** than their own (e.g., a salon instead of a kitchen), adapting every component to the new context. This tests whether they understand the principles or have just memorised one plan.

Timing guidance. The priority is the guided practical (Section H) â€" learners assembling and checking their capstone. If the room is slow, shorten the lecture (combine F.3 and F.4) and reduce the case study (Section J) to a 5-minute discussion. If learners struggle with the consistency check, walk through one example on the board step by step. Protect the assembly time â€" a learner who leaves without a complete capstone has no certificate deliverable.

Capstone link. This session is the capstone. The document assembled today is the final deliverable. The presentation is the viva. Together they are 35% of the course grade (30% capstone + 5% viva). The learner's working folder â€" all worksheets from Sessions 1â€"8 â€" should be complete and organised. The capstone is the proof that the learner can think like a marketer: plan, execute, measure, adjust, and explain. That is the skill. That is the certificate. That is the beginning.

END OF SESSION 9

Congratulations â€" you have completed the CEA Digital Marketing course. From zero to expert, together.